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Learning Objectives

After studying this chapter, you should be able to:

- 15-1** Describe the common characteristics of organizational culture.
- 15-2** Compare the functional and dysfunctional effects of organizational culture on people and the organization.
- 15-3** Identify the factors that create and sustain an organization's culture.
- 15-4** Show how culture is transmitted to employees.

15-5 Describe the similarities and differences in creating an ethical culture, a positive culture, and a spiritual culture.

15-6 Show how national culture can affect the way organizational culture is transported to another country.

Employability Skills Matrix (ESM)

	Myth or Science?	Career Objectives	An Ethical Choice	Point/Counterpoint	Experiential Exercise	Ethic Diler
Critical Thinking	✓			✓	✓	✓
Communication	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓
Collaboration	✓	✓			✓	
Knowledge Application and Analysis	✓			✓	✓	✓
Social Responsibility			✓			✓

MyLab Management Chapter Warm Up

If your professor has assigned this activity, go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management to complete the chapter warm up.

“Uniform” Culture

For a long time, a job in law, banking, or accounting required a uniform just as much as a job in the police or fire service. There is a very strong visual link between the professional culture of an organization and the traditional corporate suit. A typical example is PricewaterhouseCoopers (PwC). The PwC network, formed in 1998 from the merger of Price Waterhouse and Coopers & Lybrand, focuses on delivering assurance, tax, and advisory services. The professional nature of an organization like PwC is often reinforced by a traditional suit, smart shirt, and tie for men, and appropriate alternatives for women. In sharp contrast, high-profile and successful companies like Google are going casual—no. 9 on “Ten Things We Know to Be True,” Google’s manifesto, is “You can be serious without a suit.” In the new hiring landscape, does an established firm like PwC need to change?

In 2015, Nicola Thorp was employed as a temporary worker at a PwC office in the United Kingdom. Arriving for work on her first day, she was told that she was not following the dress code with regard to footwear. She was given the option to go shopping and replace her flat shoes with ones that have a two- to four-inch heel. Thorp refused, and she was sent home without pay. After speaking to her friends, she decided to start a petition calling for a change in the law to make it illegal for a company to insist that a female worker should wear high heels. Having received enough signatures, a Parliamentary report considered the petition and concluded that this incident, along with many others identified in other companies, was an example of gender discrimination in the workplace. PwC argued that the requirement to wear high heels was specified by the agency, and in response to the Parliamentary report, it stressed that they had a flexible approach to work attire and were committed to values of equality, respect, and inclusion.

PwC is a truly global organization, employing over 236,000 staff in 158 countries, and in June 2016, PwC Australia announced a radical change to their dress code. The old code had very specific guidelines for everything from the suit to business socks; the new policy accepted the employee’s judgment of what is appropriate. Move on to 2017, and the once-conservative employer looks very different and is ranked no. 1 on LinkedIn’s Top Companies list in Australia. The dress code was just one of many changes; there are a whole range of new initiatives, including treadmill meetings, table tennis tables in the office, and flexible work spaces. Sue Horlin, a partner at PwC Australia, said that these initiatives were not a direct result of the UK incident but more of a strategy to help them recruit the best staff in a competitive environment. Taking a lead from many of the tech companies, PwC believes that giving talented people the space to work as they want to will attract and retain the best.

LinkedIn's poll suggests that this philosophy is working; evidently, staff and clients in Australia are ready to accept a more casual corporate culture. However, what about the other 157 countries where PwC operates? How do you manage a change in different national cultures? It has yet to be seen whether the high-heels incident will lead the United Kingdom and other countries to follow Australia and move toward a more relaxed dress code and working environment.

Sources: Nadia Khomami, "Receptionist 'Sent Home from PwC for Not Wearing High Heels,'" *The Guardian*, <https://www.theguardian.com/uk-news/2016/may/11/receptionist-sent-home-pwc-not-wearing-high-heels-pwc-nicola-thorp>; "PwC Response to High Heels and Workplace Dress Codes Report," January 25, 2017, <https://www.pwc.co.uk/press-room/press-releases/pwc-response-to-high-heels-and-workplace-dress-codes-report.html>; Dana McCauley, "PwC Named Australia's Top Company to Work for by LinkedIn," News Limited, <http://www.news.com.au/finance/work/careers/pwc-named-australias-top-company-to-work-for-by-linkedin/news-story/e1a36acf32b2081c7079385ef853e1dd>; Chris Pash, *Business Insider*, June 1, 2016, <https://www.businessinsider.com.au/pwc-has-ditched-its-old-dress-code-for-staff-in-australia-2016-6/>; PwC, "Culture," <https://www.pwc.co.uk/careers/experienced-jobs/aboutpwc/culture.html>; Google, "Ten Things We Know to Be True," <https://www.google.com/about/philosophy.html>; PwC, "About Us," <https://www.pwc.com/gx/en/about.html>.

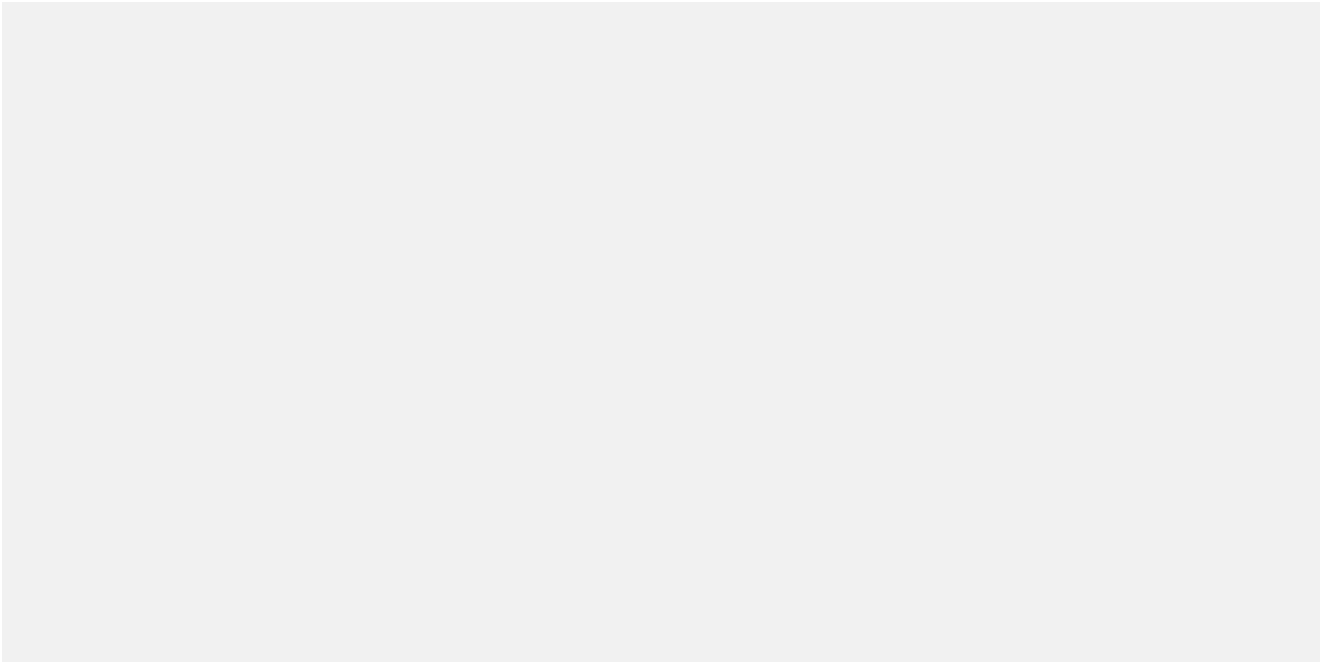
Organizations have values, beliefs, assumptions, and norms that govern how members behave. We call these expectations the *organizational culture*. Every organization has a culture that, depending on its strength, can have a considerable influence on the attitudes and behaviors of organization members, even if that effect is hard to measure precisely. In this chapter, we'll discuss what organizational culture is, how it affects employee attitudes and behavior, where it comes from, and whether it can be changed.

MyLab Management Watch It

If your professor has assigned this activity, go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management to complete the video exercise.

Organizational Culture Role Play

Watch it video.



Watch it video.

A **transcript** of this video is available [here](#).

Transcript

Organizational Culture Role Play

>> [Music]

>> Taylor: Where are you?

>> Andy: You know I'm at the food pantry until 11

>> on Thursdays, fulfilling my corporate responsibility hours.

>> Taylor: Didn't you get that AM email from Chris freaking

>> out about our lead story going away?

>> We're scrambling here.

>> Chris: Where's Andy?

>> Andy: I'm here.

>> It's Thursday.

>> Chris: I don't care if it's Christmas.

>> What are you doing right now?

>> Andy: I was actually following

>> up on the juicy lead at Greenlife Global.

>> I heard about it last night.

>> Chris: This better be good.

>> Andy: You know the environmental company

>> where Taylor's friend is doing a doc and some

>> of the employees secretly got pocket cams.

>> Chris: Right.

>> What's doing in happy greenland?

>> Andy: It's not all daisies and butterflies.

>> We just got inside access to a closed-door meeting

>> that could be headline material.

>> Their corporate culture is changing,

>> but not everyone is onboard.

>> [Music]

>> Courtney: Hey guys.

>> Mary: Hey, Courtney.

>> Courtney: Sorry I'm late.

>> The sitter was late, but I'm here now

>> so what's going on guys?

>> Joe: Hi, Courtney.

>> Courtney: Hi, Joe.

>> Mary: Look, we've got an issue

>> with the Eco Insulation account.

>> Courtney: Okay.

>> Mary: We're behind schedule by two weeks,

>> the client is very concerned.

>> If they don't have our component,

>> it's going to delay construction of the building in Tokyo,

>> which would be a problem.

>> Joe: Big problem.

>> Mary: So we need to find some efficiencies here.

>> So, I just wanted to brainstorm what the approach should be

>> with you and with Joe since you guys are the closest

>> to the project.

>> Joe: There are a couple of problems going

>> on with this thing, and I think what, the best way

>> to handle this is because it's such a big problem

>> with such a big client so far away.

>> Courtney: Right.

>> Joe: Is to get the whole team in here to kind

>> of brainstorm this thing and I think we need to do it

>> like tomorrow morning.

>> Courtney: Okay.

>> I'll Skype in.

>> Joe: No, I'd really like to have you here.

>> Courtney: I have no notice on it.

>> That's kind of impossible.

>> Joe: I understand you have no notice.

>> If I knew this was coming up, I would have told you.

>> Courtney: Right.

>> Joe: But, you know, I've been talking

>> with these people and emailing them.

>> You've been getting emails at all hours of the night.

>> We need to get together and figure out what we're going

>> to do, what our strategy is going to be and we need

>> to have everybody in here so we can do

>> that effectively and efficiently.

>> Courtney: Yeah.

>> I apologize, Joe, I have no sitter for tomorrow so I can,

>> however, be completely available, you know,

>> through Skype or emails.

>> I can be emailing at the same time and texting.

>> Joe: Well, see, my thing is that I really

>> like to have the people in the room.

>> Courtney: Right.

>> Joe: Get that dynamic going, that energy going, you know,

>> the thing that makes everybody better.

>> And Skype is lovely, you know, when it's working,

>> but it's not the same as being in the room, okay?

>> Courtney: I think I work pretty efficiently from here.

>> Joe: I think for the most part your doing stuff

>> from home is great; I don't have a problem with it.

>> But when we all need to get together to work on something

>> and I need everybody in the room that's

>> when I have a problem with it.

>> Courtney: Joe, I was hired under these circumstances.

>> Joe: I understand.

>> I know you've got a contract that stipulates that, you know,

>> you're home these days and you can come in, but it's flex time

>> and I think that, you know, that it's got to be flex

>> on both ends of the equation.

>> Mary: You guys, we're not going to resolve this right now.

>> Courtney: Right.

>> Mary: So, you know, I hear you, Courtney,

>> and I know that we hired you with the understanding

>> that you were going to flex three days a week.

>> Courtney: Right.

>> Mary: And so I think what we need to do and we're not going

>> to resolve this right now is we need to,

>> while respecting the original agreement with you,

>> come to some sort of understanding

>> as to how we're going to handle emergencies like this.

>> Courtney: Okay.

>> Mary: And, Joe, I hear you.

>> It, it is easier when everybody is face-to-face,

>> but the thing is, Joe, it's not the way it used to be.

>> You know, most of our clients now, we've got 40%

>> of our clients are overseas.

>> Joe: I understand that, I understand.

>> I know it's a worldwide business, I know all about that.

>> Mary: Nine to five doesn't cut it anymore.

>> Is it possible, Courtney, can we work something out so

>> that in the event of emergency

>> that you can make other arrangements

>> so that we can have you onsite

>> so that you can change your flex days that way?

>> Obviously the engineers that are in India are not going

>> to be able to show up tomorrow morning at.

>> Courtney: Right.

>> Mary: But if at all possible because it does, to Joe's point,

>> it does change the dynamics in the room,

>> you know, it is just easier.

>> You don't have the communication cutting in and out

>> and we appreciate the hours you put in, we appreciate the fact

>> that you're on call, you know, half the night for some

>> of these offshore clients.

>> Joe: But you do miss a lot when you're not here.

>> Courtney: Yeah.

>> Joe: I mean there's just no getting around that.

>> Mary: So particularly when there's an emergency

>> and we don't have the time to make up for some

>> of those miscommunications, if there's a way that you could set

>> up an extra safety net so that we could get you

>> in for an emergency that would be appreciated.

>> Courtney: Right.

>> And, you know, as a prophylactic measure if you think it's going

>> to go down this road, could we have a meeting, you know,

>> on the days that I do go in?

>> Like if it looks like it, you know, could possibly turn

>> into an emergency situation?

>> Mary: You know, Courtney brings up a good point.

>> We have seen that this was running off the tracks maybe

>> about a week ago.

>> So, I mean point well taken, Courtney.

>> It's, you know, we need to all do a better job

>> of being more responsive I think

>> when we think a project is going off the rails.

>> So let's do this then.

>> Tomorrow morning we need you on the call.

>> If you could please be there about 10 minutes early so that

>> when we hit the ground at everybody is present.

>> Courtney: Sure.

>> Joe: Actually could you do me a favor?

>> Courtney: Sure, Joe.

>> Joe: Make it 15 minutes early just in case

>> because I know this Skype thing cuts out sometimes

>> and if you've got to redo whatever you've got to redo

>> that would be great if we have a little bit of lead time.

>> Courtney: Will do.

>> Mary: Okay, and then, Joe, I'll put you in charge

>> at you're going to be on the session with Courtney

>> to make sure it's all set up?

>> Joe: Yep.

>> Mary: Okay, good.

>> Courtney: Okay, thank you.

>> Okay, guys, I'll see you tomorrow then.

>> Mary: All right, thanks.

>> Andy: What was that with Chris this morning?

>> Taylor: Oh, he was out of control for sure,

>> but I don't think it was all about you.

>> Andy: What did he think about the Greenlife piece?

>> Taylor: He loved it.

>> He's going to lead with it.

>> I'm about to review the confessionals from Greenlife,

>> you know, stuff about like face time

>> and dissatisfied employees, flex time burnout.

>> Andy: Sounds good.

>> Mary: You know, we've been Greenlife Global for years,

>> but only recently have we started

>> to actually be more global.

>> So, we've gone from a more traditional corporate culture

>> to one that is much more flexible

>> because we have offshore resources,

>> we have offshore clients, and we're starting to bring

>> in specialty sorts of employees that are demanding flex time.

>> It is a challenge having the flex time when we do

>> so much collaborative work.

>> If you're on a conference call, you can miss a lot

>> of the subtleties of the body communication.

>> When you're on Skype, you've got technical issues.

>> So, it presents challenges but they're not insurmountable.

>> There's a lot of communication that's informal in organizations

>> so there's a lot of good communication

>> that happens outside of formal meetings.

>> So, you know, you run into somebody at the break room

>> and you're chatting and you find out that there's synergy

>> between their project and your project.

>> That's an unfortunate causality of people working remotely.

>> The situation with Joe and Courtney is interesting

>> because Joe is definitely old school, you know, nine to five,

>> face time, he wants to be able to walk down the hall

>> and grab the person that he needs and Courtney is used

>> to being completely flexible, you know,

>> on call for client calls at

>> in the morning that sort of thing.

>> That's completely alien to Joe.

>> I can relate to Joe's frustration

>> because the first time you're getting used to dealing

>> with colleagues that you can't reach immediately

>> when you need to, it's frustrating especially

>> if you're used to just grabbing somebody

>> and getting something done.

>> One of the ways that I think is very helpful

>> when you have this sort of a culture flex is to make sure

>> that the people know one another really well.

>> So, if you've worked with somebody before and they go off

>> and flex, you don't worry about it because you know

>> that they're going to get the work done,

>> you know what their style is.

>> Part of the problem is that if these people were

>> in the same room they'd still be having some of the same clashes

>> because they're getting to know one another.

>> So, in cases like this, I try

>> to encourage more informal meetings,

>> get to know who that person is, what their working style is

>> so that when you layer on top of that the remote

>> and the flex it's less of an issue.

>> Chris: Geez, when did you get here?

>> Andy: I don't know; like, maybe.

>> I couldn't sleep after all the drama here yesterday.

>> Chris: Yeah, I know.

>> Crazy day, but after looking what Mary's dealing with,

>> Courtney and Joe, I realized how good I've got it.

>> Andy: I'm going to keep my eye on Greenlife.

>> They've got a lot of drama going on over there.

>> Who knew?

>> Chris: Sorry about yesterday.

>> I was in a jam, but maybe next time you could actually read my

>> deranged early morning emails before you do your own thing.

>> Andy: You got it, man.

>> [Music]

What Is Organizational Culture?

15-1 Describe the common characteristics of organizational culture.

An executive once was asked what he thought *organizational culture* meant. He gave essentially the same answer U.S. Supreme Court Justice Potter Stewart gave in defining pornography: “I can’t define it, but I know it when I see it.” In this section, we propose one definition and review several related ideas.

A Definition of Organizational Culture

Organizational culture ⓘ refers to a system of shared meaning held by members that distinguishes the organization from other organizations.¹ This system of shared meaning includes values, beliefs, and assumptions that characterize the organization. Six primary characteristics seem to capture the essence of an organization’s culture:²

1. **Adaptability.** The degree to which employees are encouraged to be innovative and flexible as well as to take risks and experiment.
2. **Detail orientation.** The degree to which employees are expected to exhibit precision, analysis, and attention to detail.
3. **Results/outcome orientation.** The degree to which management focuses on results or outcomes rather than on the techniques and processes used to achieve them.
4. **People/customer orientation.** The degree to which management decisions consider the effect of outcomes on people within and outside the organization.
5. **Collaboration/team orientation.** The degree to which work activities are organized around teams rather than individuals.
6. **Integrity.** The degree to which people exhibit integrity and high ethical standards in their work.

Each of these characteristics exists on a continuum from low to high. Appraising an organization on the strength of each provides a basis for the shared understanding that members have about the organization, how things are done in it, and the way they are supposed to behave. Exhibit 15-1 contrasts two companies that are very different along these

six dimensions.

Another common culture framework groups organizations into one of four types, each with its own assumptions, beliefs, values, artifacts, and even criteria for effectiveness:³

1. **“The Clan.”** A culture based on human affiliation. Employees value attachment, collaboration, trust, and support.
2. **“The Adhocracy.”** A culture based on change. Employees value growth, variety, attention to detail, stimulation, and autonomy.
3. **“The Market.”** A culture based on achievement. Employees value communication, competence, and competition.
4. **“The Hierarchy.”** A culture based on stability. Employees value communication, formalization, and routine.

The differences between these cultures are reflected in their internal versus external focus and their flexibility and stability.⁴ For instance, clans are internally focused and flexible, adhocracies are externally focused and flexible, markets are externally focused and stable, and hierarchies are internally focused and stable. A review of the prior studies conducted on clans, adhocracies, and markets (not enough research had been conducted on hierarchies to be conclusive) found that employees tend to be more satisfied with and committed to clan cultures. Markets and clans tend to be the most innovative, although all three tend to produce high-quality products and services.⁵

Exhibit 15-1 Contrasting Organizational Cultures

Organization A

This organization is a manufacturing firm. Managers are expected to fully document all decisions, and “good managers” are those who can provide detailed data to support their recommendations. Creative decisions that incur significant change or risk are not encouraged. Because managers of failed projects are openly criticized and penalized, managers try not to implement ideas that deviate much from the status quo. One lower-level manager quoted an often-used phrase in the company: “If it ain’t broke, don’t fix it.”

There are extensive rules and regulations in this firm that employees are required to

follow. Managers supervise employees closely to ensure there are no deviations. Management is concerned with high productivity, regardless of the impact on employee morale or turnover.

Work activities are designed around individuals. There are distinct departments and lines of authority, and employees are expected to minimize formal contact with other employees outside their functional area or line of command. Performance evaluations and rewards emphasize individual effort, although seniority tends to be the primary factor in the determination of pay raises and promotions.

Organization B

This organization is also a manufacturing firm. Here, however, management encourages and rewards risk taking and change. Decisions based on intuition are valued as much as those that are well rationalized. Management prides itself on its history of experimenting with new technologies and its success in regularly introducing innovative products. Managers or employees who have a good idea are encouraged to “run with it.” And failures are treated as “learning experiences.” The company prides itself on being market driven and rapidly responsive to the changing needs of its customers.

There are few rules and regulations for employees to follow, and supervision is loose because management believes that its employees are hardworking and trustworthy. Management is concerned with high productivity but believes that this comes through treating its people right. The company is proud of its reputation as being a good place to work.

Job activities are designed around work teams, and team members are encouraged to interact with people across functions and authority levels. Employees talk positively about the competition between teams. Individuals and teams have goals, and bonuses are based on achievement of these outcomes. Employees are given considerable autonomy in choosing the means by which the goals are attained.

Culture Is a Descriptive Term

If you’ve ever been in an organization (certainly you’ve been in many!), you probably noticed a pervasive culture among the members. *Organizational culture* describes how employees perceive the characteristics of an organization, not whether they like those

characteristics. In other words, it's a descriptive term. Research on organizational culture has sought to measure how employees see their organization: Does it encourage teamwork? Does it reward innovation? Does it stifle initiative? In contrast, job satisfaction seeks to measure how employees feel about the organization's expectations, reward practices, and the like. Although the two terms have overlapping characteristics, keep in mind that *organizational culture* is descriptive in that it describes an organization, much like how personality traits describe employees. On the other hand, *job satisfaction* is evaluative because it can be positive or negative (as is the case with job dissatisfaction).

Do Organizations Have Uniform Cultures?

Organizational culture represents a perception that the organization's members share. Statements about organizational culture are valid only if individuals with different backgrounds or at different levels in the organization describe the culture in similar terms.⁶ For example, the purchasing department can have a subculture that includes the core values of the dominant culture, such as aggressiveness, plus additional values unique to members of that department, such as risk taking.

The **dominant culture** ⓘ expresses the **core values** ⓘ that a majority of members share and that give the organization its distinct personality.⁷ **Subcultures** ⓘ tend to develop in large organizations in response to common problems or experiences that a group of members face in the same department or location.⁸ Most large organizations have a dominant culture and numerous subcultures.⁹ Sometimes the subcultures can be so strong, however, that they subtly reject the “official” culture and do not conform.¹⁰

If organizations were composed only of subcultures, the dominant organizational culture would be significantly less powerful. It is the “shared meaning” aspect of culture that makes it a potent device for guiding and shaping behavior. That's what allows us to say, for example, that the Zappos culture values customer care and dedication over speed and efficiency, which explains the behavior of Zappos executives and employees.¹¹

**Myth or
Science?**

An Organization's Culture Is Forever

This statement is not true. Although organizational culture is difficult to change and a notable change can take a long time, it can be done. Sometimes it is essential for survival. For years, Wisconsin's Wellspring system provided nursing homes in which inpatients had little input about their care, and the organizational culture allowed lax standards to prevail. Then the network of 11 nursing homes launched a culture change initiative. Management focused on caregiver collaboration, education, accountability, and empowerment. The results were excellent. Wellspring realized fewer state standards infractions and higher employee retention rates at the facilities, and the results for the patients were even greater: fewer bedridden residents, less use of restraints and psychoactive medication, less incontinence, and fewer tube feedings than in other nursing homes.

The Wellspring program illustrates the significant effect that positive organizational culture change can achieve. CEO Bob Flexon of Dynegy Inc., a Houston-based electric utility giant that emerged from bankruptcy, saved his company by changing the organizational culture. First, he ditched the cushy CEO office suite, \$15,000 marble desk, and Oriental rugs for a small cubicle on a warehouse-style floor shared with all 235 headquarters employees. Next, he visited company facilities, trained "culture champions," reinstated annual performance reviews, and increased employee collaboration. He created a plaque as a reminder to "Be Here Now" instead of multitasking and banned smartphones from meetings. Flexon said, "The idea was to instill a winning spirit," and he counts on his visibility as CEO to broadcast the culture change down to the lowest levels of the widespread organization.

Positive results at Dynegy have included a reduction in turnover from 8 percent in 2011 to 5.8 percent in the turnaround of 2012. Flexon said, "People are cautiously beginning to believe that we can win again." The company continues to report massive earnings losses, but Flexon is optimistic about Dynegy's rebound. He says, "Our ongoing focus on culture is what will make the difference." Through substantial growth following its bankruptcy, Dynegy makes around \$5.5 billion annually as of 2017.

Sources: Based on J. Bellot, "Nursing Home Culture Change: What Does It Mean to Nurses?," *Research in Gerontological Nursing* (October 2012): 264–73; T. Linquist, "Interview with Bob Flexon, CEO of Dynegy in Houston," *Leadership Lyceum: A CEO's Virtual Mentor* [podcast], <https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/part-1-2-interview-bob-flexon-ceo-dynegy-houston-thomas-linquist>; J. S. Lublin, "This CEO Used to Have an Office," *The*

Wall Street Journal, March 13, 2013, B1, B8; and J. Molineux, “Enabling Organizational Cultural Change Using Systemic Strategic Human Resource Management—A Longitudinal Case Study,” *International Journal of Human Resource Management* (April 1, 2013): 1588–612.

Strong versus Weak Cultures

It’s possible to differentiate between strong and weak cultures.¹² If most employees have the same opinions about the organization’s mission and values, the culture is strong; if opinions vary widely, the culture is weak.

In a **strong culture** ⓘ, the organization’s core values are both intensely held and widely shared.¹³ The more members who accept the core values and the greater their commitment, the stronger the culture and the greater its influence on member behavior. Nordstrom employees know exactly what is expected of them, for example, and these expectations go a long way toward shaping their behavior.

A strong culture should more directly affect organizational outcomes because it demonstrates high agreement about what the organization represents. Such unanimity of purpose builds cohesiveness, loyalty, meaning, and organizational commitment. For example, with high cultural consensus and intensity surrounding the adaptability dimension of culture, organizations in one study experienced gains in net income, revenue, and operating cash flow.¹⁴ A study of nearly 90,000 employees from 137 organizations found that culture strength or consistency was related to numerous financial outcomes when there was a strong sense of mission and high employee involvement.¹⁵

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

15.1.1 An organization’s culture develops over time and is rooted in _____ to which employees are strongly committed.

○ values

- ☐ tasks
- ☐ rewards
- ☐ both tasks and rewards

Check answer

Reset

15.1.2 A strong culture should reduce employee turnover because it results in

_____.

- ☐ a highly centralized organization
- ☐ narrow spans of control
- ☐ cohesiveness and organizational commitment
- ☐ a highly formalized organization

Check answer

Reset

What Do Cultures Do?

15-2 Compare the functional and dysfunctional effects of organizational culture on people and the organization.

Let's discuss the role that culture performs and whether it can ever be a liability for an organization.

The Functions of Culture

Culture defines “the rules of the game.” First, it has a boundary-defining role: It creates distinctions between organizations. Second, it conveys a sense of identity for organization members. Third, culture facilitates commitment to something larger than individual self-interest. Fourth, it enhances the stability of the social system. Culture is the social glue that helps hold the organization together by providing standards for what employees should say and do. Finally, it is a sense-making and control mechanism that guides and shapes employees' attitudes and behavior. This last function is of particular interest to us.¹⁶

A strong culture supported by formal rules and regulations (i.e., an organizational infrastructure) ensures that employees will act in a relatively uniform and predictable way. Today's trend toward decentralized organizations (see Chapter 15) makes culture more important than ever, but ironically it also makes establishing a strong culture more difficult. When formal authority and control systems are reduced through decentralization, culture's *shared meaning* can point everyone in the same direction. However, employees organized in teams may show greater allegiance to their team and its values than to the organization. Strong leadership that fosters a strong culture by communicating frequently about common goals and priorities may be especially important for organizations. Research on hundreds of CEOs and top management team (TMT) members suggests that more positive organizational outcomes are achieved when the culture and leadership styles are *complementary in content* and not *redundant*.¹⁷ When leadership behaviors and an organization's cultural values are redundant, the leaders have less of an effect on organizational outcomes. However, when leaders provide something that is lacking in the organization's culture, they can substitute or fill in for the element that is missing. For example, a transformational leader in a

bureaucratic, hierarchical culture would be more effective than a transactional leader in the same type of culture.

Individual–organization “fit”—that is, whether the applicant’s or employee’s attitudes and behavior are compatible with the culture—strongly influences who gets a job offer, a favorable performance review, or a promotion.¹⁸ It’s no coincidence that Disney theme park employees appear almost universally attractive, clean, and wholesome and smile brightly. The company selects employees who will maintain that image.

Culture Creates Climate

If you’ve worked with someone whose positive attitude inspired you to do your best, or if you have worked with a lackluster team that drained your motivation, you’ve experienced the effects of climate. **Organizational climate** ⓘ refers to the shared perceptions that organizational members have about their organization and work environment.¹⁹ These perceptions are directed at the policies, practices, and procedures experienced by the employees. When everyone has the same general feelings about what’s important or how well things are working, the effect of these attitudes will be more than the sum of the individual parts. One meta-analysis found that, across dozens of different samples, psychological climate was strongly related to individuals’ level of job satisfaction, involvement, commitment, and motivation.²⁰ A positive workplace climate has been linked to higher customer satisfaction and organizational financial performance as well.²¹



Employees of French videogame publisher Ubisoft Entertainment are shown working on “Just Dance 3” at the firm’s creative studio near Paris. Ubisoft’s 26 creative studios around the world share a climate of creative collaboration that reflects the diversity of team members.

Source: Charles Platiau/Reuters



Recent theory also suggests that there is a difference between *espoused* (i.e., adopted on-the-surface) and *enacted* (i.e., actually put into practice) cultural values, beliefs, and assumptions and that this difference has implications for how climate emerges.²² In making sense of their environments, employees draw a distinction between what they “hear” or “see” being supported by organizational leaders in meetings, memos, rulebooks, and so on, and what they “actually” see being enacted. Climate, then, is a function of what employees perceive is being rewarded. Research in Australia suggests that when there is alignment between espoused and enacted organizational values, employees have higher organizational commitment.²³

Dozens of dimensions of climate have been studied, including innovation, creativity, communication, warmth and support, involvement, safety, justice, diversity, and customer service.²⁴ For example, someone who encounters a safety climate will have higher levels of job satisfaction and organizational commitment, have better health, and be more prone to engage in safety behaviors.²⁵ Climate influences the habits that people adopt. If there is a climate of safety, everyone wears safety gear and follows safety procedures even if

individually they wouldn't normally think very often about being safe. Indeed, many studies have shown that a safety climate decreases the number of documented injuries on the job.²⁶ Climates can also interact with one another to produce various outcomes. For example, a climate of worker empowerment can lead to higher levels of performance in organizations that also have a climate of personal accountability.²⁷

The Ethical Dimension of Culture

Organizational cultures are not neutral in their ethical orientation, even when they are not openly pursuing ethical goals. **Ethical culture** ⓘ develops over time as the shared concept of right and wrong behavior in the workplace. The ethical culture reflects the true values of the organization and shapes the ethical decision making of its members.²⁸ Research indicates that ethical cultures espouse clear ethical standards, with ethical behavior modeled by leadership and with employees who are capable of and committed to behaving ethically. Employees and managers are open to discuss ethical issues and are reinforced for their ethical behavior.²⁹

Researchers have developed *ethical climate theory (ECT)* and the *ethical climate index (ECI)* to categorize and measure the shared perceptions of the ethical work context and environment as reflected in an organization's policies, practices, and procedures.³⁰ Of the nine identified ECT climate categories, five are most prevalent in organizations: *instrumental*, *caring*, *independence*, *law and code*, and *rules*. Each explains the general mindset, expectations, and values of the managers and employees in relationship to their organizations. For instance, in an *instrumental* ethical climate, managers may frame their decision making around the assumption that employees (and companies) are motivated by self-interest (egoistic). Conversely, in a *caring* climate, managers may operate under the expectation that their decisions will have a positive effect on the greatest number of stakeholders (employees, customers, suppliers) possible.

Ethical climates of *independence* rely on everyone's personal moral ideas to dictate his or her workplace behavior. *Law and code* climates require managers and employees to use an external, standardized moral compass such as a professional code of conduct for norms, while *rules* climates tend to operate by internal standardized expectations from, perhaps, an organizational policy manual. Organizations often progress through various categories as they move through their business life cycle.

An organization's ethical climate is a powerful influence on the way its individual

members feel they should behave, so much so that researchers have been able to predict organizational outcomes from the climate categories.³¹ Instrumental climates are negatively associated with employee job satisfaction and organizational commitment, even though those climates appeal to self-interest (of the employee and the company). They are positively associated with turnover intentions, workplace bullying, and deviant behavior. Caring and rules climates may bring greater job satisfaction. Caring, independence, rules, and law and code climates also reduce employee turnover intentions, workplace bullying, and dysfunctional behavior. Recent research also suggests that ethical climates have a strong influence on sales growth over time when there is also a customer service climate to support it.³²

Studies of ethical climates and workplace outcomes suggest that some ECT climate categories are likely to be found in certain organizations.³³ Industries with exacting standards, such as engineering, accounting, and law, tend to have a rules or law and code climate. Industries that thrive on competitiveness, such as financial trading, often have an instrumental climate. Industries with missions of benevolence are likely to have a caring climate, even if they are for-profit, as in an environmental protection firm. We cannot conclude, however, that instrumental climates are bad or that caring climates are good. Instrumental climates may foster the individual-level successes their companies need to thrive, for example, and they may help underperformers to recognize that their self-interest is better served elsewhere. Managers in caring climates may be thwarted in making the best decisions when only choices that serve the greatest number of employees are acceptable.³⁴ The ECI, first introduced in 2010, is one way researchers are seeking to understand the context of ethical drivers in organizations. By measuring the collective levels of moral sensitivity, judgment, motivation, and character of our organizations, we may be able to determine the strength of the influence that our ethical climates have on us.³⁵

Although ECT was first introduced more than 25 years ago, researchers have been recently studying ethics in organizations more closely to determine not only how ethical climates behave but also how they might be fostered or even changed.³⁶ Eventually, we may be able to provide leaders with clear blueprints for designing effective ethical climates.

Culture and Sustainability

Sustainability ⓘ refers to maintaining practices over very long periods of time³⁷ because the

tools or structures that support the practices are not damaged by the processes. One survey found that a substantial majority of executives saw sustainability as an important part of future success.³⁸ Concepts of sustainable management have their origins in the environmental movement, so processes that are in harmony with the natural environment are encouraged. *Social sustainability* practices address the ways that social systems are affected by an organization's actions over time and how changing social systems may affect the organization.



For example, farmers in Australia have been working collectively to increase water use efficiency, minimize soil erosion, and implement tilling and harvesting methods that ensure long-term viability for their farm businesses.³⁹ In a very different context, 3M has an innovative pollution-prevention program rooted in cultural principles of conserving resources, creating products that have minimal effects on the environment, and collaborating with regulatory agencies to improve environmental effects.⁴⁰

Sustainable management doesn't need to be purely altruistic. Systematic reviews of the research literature show a generally positive relationship between sustainability and financial performance.⁴¹ However, there is often a strong moral and ethical component that shapes organizational culture and which must be a genuine value for the relationship to exist.

To create a truly sustainable business, an organization must develop a long-term culture and put its values into practice.⁴² In other words, there needs to be a sustainable system for creating sustainability! In one workplace study, a company seeking to reduce energy consumption found that soliciting group feedback reduced energy use significantly more than simply issuing reading materials about the importance of conservation.⁴³ In other words, talking about energy conservation and building the value into the organizational culture resulted in positive employee behavioral changes. Like other cultural practices we've discussed, sustainability needs time and nurturing to grow.



Visitors to “The Crystal” in London, which is the largest exhibition about the future of the world’s cities and one of the most sustainable buildings in the world. The Crystal was created by Siemens, an international conglomerate who prides itself on being the most energy-efficient firm in its industry and who took the top spot in the 2017 Global 100 list of most sustainable organizations in the world.

Source: Jason Redmond/Reuters/Alamy Stock Photo

Culture and Innovation

The most innovative companies are often characterized by their open, unconventional, collaborative, vision-driven, accelerating cultures.⁴⁴ Start-up firms often have innovative cultures because they are usually small, agile, and focused on solving problems to survive and grow. Consider digital music leader Echo Nest, recently bought by Spotify. As a start-up, the organization was unconventional, flexible, and open; it hosted music app “hack” days for users and fostered a music culture.⁴⁵ All these are hallmarks of Spotify’s culture, too, making the fit rather seamless.⁴⁶ Because of the similar organizational cultures, Echo Nest and Spotify may be able to continue their start-up level of innovation.

At the other end of the start-up spectrum, consider 30-year-old Intuit, one of the World’s 100 Most Innovative Companies according to *Forbes*. Intuit employees attend workshops to teach them how to think creatively and unconventionally. Sessions have led to managers

talking through puppets and holding bake sales to sell prototype apps with their cupcakes. The culture stresses open accountability. “I saw one senior guy whose idea they’d been working on for nine months get disproved in a day because someone had a better way. He got up in front of everyone and said, ‘This is my bad. I should have checked my hypothesis earlier,’” said Eric Ries, author of *The Lean Startup*. As a consultant for entrepreneurs, Ries considers the older software company equally innovative to start-ups because of its culture.⁴⁷

Alexion Pharmaceuticals is also one of *Forbes*’ Most Innovative and, like Intuit, it has been in operation long past the usual innovation life-cycle stage. Unlike Intuit, though, this maker of life-saving medicines is not known for unconventional management practices. The key to its continuing innovation is a culture of caring, which drives it to develop medicines that save victims of rare diseases, even when the patients affected are few, the cost of development is prohibitively high, and the probability of success is low.⁴⁸



Founded in 1969, Samsung Electronics of South Korea is past the usual innovation life cycle stage yet continues to foster a climate of creativity and idea generation. Samsung emulates a start-up culture through its Creative Labs, where employees like engineer Ki Yuhoon, shown here, take up to a year off from their regular jobs to work on innovative projects.

Source: Lee Jin-man/AP Images



Israeli research suggests that CEOs who value self-direction can lead to the formation of a creative culture, which in turn, is related to employee innovative behavior *and* employees recognizing creative solutions more readily.⁴⁹

Culture as an Asset

As we have discussed, organizational culture can provide a positive ethical environment and foster innovation. Culture can also contribute significantly to an organization's bottom line in many ways.

One strong example is found in the case of ChildNet.⁵⁰ ChildNet is a nonprofit child welfare agency in Florida whose organizational culture was described as “grim” from 2000 (when one of its foster children disappeared) through 2007 (when the CEO was fired amid FBI allegations of fraud and forgery). “We didn’t know if we would have jobs or who would take over,” employee Maggie Tilelli said. However, after intense turnaround efforts aimed at changing the organizational culture, ChildNet became Florida’s top-ranked agency within four years and *Workforce Management*’s Optima award winner for General Excellence in 2012. President and CEO Emilio Benitez, who took charge in 2008, effected the transformation by changing the executive staff, employing innovative technology to support caseworkers in the field and new managers at headquarters, acknowledging the stress employees and managers felt by establishing an employee recognition program, and creating cross-departmental roundtables (work groups) for creative problem solving. The roundtables have been able to find solutions to difficult client cases, resulting in better placement of foster children into permanent homes. “From a business perspective, [the new problem-solving approach] was a tremendous cost savings,” Benitez said. “But at the end of the day, it’s about the families we serve.”

While ChildNet demonstrates how an organizational culture can have a positive effect on outcomes, Dish Network illustrates the elusiveness of matching a culture to an industry or organization.⁵¹ By every measure, Dish Network is a business success story—it is the second-largest U.S. satellite TV provider, and it has made founder Charlie Ergen one of the richest men in the world. Yet Dish was ranked as one of the worst U.S. companies to work for nearly every year since 2012 by 24/7 Wall Street, and employees say the fault is the micromanaging culture Ergen created and enforces. Employees describe arduous mandatory overtime, fingerprint scanners to record work hours to the minute, public berating (most

notably from Ergen), management condescension and distrust, quarterly “bloodbath” layoffs, and no working from home. One employee advised another online, “You’re part of a poisonous environment ... go find a job where you can use your talents for good rather than evil.”

At ChildNet, positive changes to the organization’s performance have been clearly attributed to the transformation of its organizational culture. Dish, on the other hand, may have succeeded *despite* its culture. We can only wonder how much more successful it could be if it reformed its toxic culture. There are many more cases of business success stories due to excellent organizational cultures than there are of success stories despite bad cultures, and almost no success stories because of bad ones. Research suggests that part of the reason why culture affects an organization’s performance is through customer satisfaction: One study of nearly 100 automobile dealerships over a 6-year time frame found that a positive culture leads to improved sales performance because it increases customer satisfaction.⁵²

Culture as a Liability

Culture can enhance organizational commitment and increase the consistency of employee behavior, which clearly benefits an organization. Culture is valuable to employees too because it spells out how things are done and what’s important. But we shouldn’t ignore the potentially dysfunctional aspects of culture, especially a strong one, on an organization’s effectiveness. Hewlett-Packard, once known as a premier computer manufacturer, rapidly lost market share and profits as dysfunction in its TMT trickled down, leaving employees disengaged, uncreative, unappreciated, or in a polarized environment.⁵³ Let’s unpack some of the major factors that signal a negative organizational culture, beginning with institutionalization.

Institutionalization When an organization undergoes **institutionalization** ⓘ—that is, it becomes valued for itself and not for the goods or services it produces—it takes on a life of its own, apart from its founders or members.⁵⁴ Institutionalized organizations often don’t go out of business even if the original goals are no longer relevant. Acceptable modes of behavior may become largely self-evident to members; although this isn’t entirely negative, it does mean behaviors and habits go unquestioned, which can stifle innovation and make maintaining the organization’s culture an end in itself.

Barriers to Change Culture is a liability when shared values don't agree with those that further the organization's effectiveness. This is most likely when an organization's environment is undergoing rapid change, and its entrenched culture may no longer be appropriate.⁵⁵ Consistency of behavior, an asset in a stable environment, may then burden the organization and make it difficult to respond to changes.

Barriers to Diversity Hiring new employees who differ from the majority in race, age, gender, disability, or other characteristics creates a paradox.⁵⁶ Management wants to demonstrate support for the differences that these employees bring to the workplace, but newcomers who wish to fit in must accept the organization's core culture. Second, because diverse behaviors and unique strengths are likely to diminish as people assimilate, strong cultures can become liabilities when they effectively eliminate the advantages of diversity. Third, a strong culture that condones prejudice, supports bias, becomes insensitive, or overemphasizes differences can undermine formal corporate diversity policies or the positive effects of demographic diversity.⁵⁷ It seems that these barriers to diversity can start at the community level: One study of nearly 150 retail bank locations in the United States found that the demographic composition of the community serves as an important signal in setting the diversity norms that are adopted and made part of an organization's culture and climate.⁵⁸

Toxicity and Dysfunctions In general, we've discussed cultures that cohere around a positive set of values and attitudes. This consensus can create powerful forward momentum. However, coherence around negativity and dysfunctional management systems in a corporation can produce downward forces that are equally powerful yet toxic. For example, research on 862 bank employees in about 150 branches of a large bank in the United States suggests that branch managers model conflict management styles, which then shape conflict cultures within each branch.⁵⁹ Collaborative cultures (i.e., encouraging proactive, constructive, and collaborative conflict resolution) tended to increase the cohesion and satisfaction of the branch and decrease levels of burnout. Dominating cultures (i.e., encouraging active confrontation and aggressive competition among employees when there is conflict) tend to reduce branch cohesion and customer service performance. Avoidance cultures (i.e., those that passively avoid conflict) tend to be less creative.



Barriers to Acquisitions and Mergers Historically, when management looked at

acquisition or merger decisions, the key decision factors were potential financial advantage and product synergy. In recent years, cultural compatibility has become the primary concern.⁶⁰ All things being equal, whether the acquisition works seems to have much to do with how well the two organizations' cultures match up. When they don't mesh well, the organizational cultures of both become a liability to the whole new organization. A study conducted by Bain and Company found that 70 percent of mergers failed to increase shareholder values, and Hay Group found that more than 90 percent of mergers in Europe failed to reach financial goals.⁶¹ Considering this dismal rate of success, Lawrence Chia from Deloitte Consulting observed, "One of the biggest failings is people. The people at Company A have a different way of doing things from Company B ... you can't find commonality in goals."

Culture clash was commonly argued to be one of the causes of AOL Time Warner's problems. The \$183 billion merger between America Online (AOL) and Time Warner in 2001 was the largest in U.S. corporate history. It was also a disaster. Only 2 years later, the new company saw its stock fall an astounding 90 percent, and it reported what was then the largest financial loss in U.S. history—it has since been acquired by Verizon and is being merged, yet again, with Yahoo under the umbrella company "Oath."⁶²



Recent research on acquisitions in the Taiwanese electronics industry suggests that the success of mergers and acquisitions hinge on *how* the acquisition was acquired, the organizational structure (e.g., centralization and divisional integration), *and* the organizational culture.⁶³

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

15.2.1 Which of the following statements is true regarding the establishment of organizational culture and its effects on the organization?

- Today's trend toward decentralized organizations makes it easier to establish a strong culture.

- ☐ In a virtual organization, a strong culture can be established quickly and easily.
- ☐ Employees organized in teams always show greater allegiance to the values of the organization as a whole than to their team and its values.
- ☐ Culture acts as a control mechanism and guides the behavior of employees.

Check answer

Reset

15.2.2 Culture is most likely to be a liability when _____.

- ☐ the employees of the organization are highly skilled
- ☐ the organization's environment is dynamic
- ☐ the organization's management is highly efficient
- ☐ the organization is highly centralized

Check answer

Reset

Creating and Sustaining Culture

15-3 Identify the factors that create and sustain an organization's culture.

An organization's culture doesn't pop out of thin air and, once established, it rarely fades away. What influences the creation of a culture? What reinforces and sustains it once in place?

How a Culture Begins

An organization's customs, traditions, and general way of doing things are largely due to what it has done before and how successful it was in doing it. This leads us to the ultimate source of an organization's culture: the founders.⁶⁴ Founders have a vision of what the organization should be, and the firm's initial small size makes it easy to impose that vision on all members.



Culture creation occurs in three ways.⁶⁵ First, founders hire and keep only employees who think and feel the same way they do. Second, they indoctrinate and socialize employees to their way of thinking and feeling. And finally, the founders' own behavior encourages employees to identify with them and internalize their beliefs, values, and assumptions. When the organization succeeds, the founders' personalities become embedded in the culture. For example, the fierce, competitive style and disciplined, authoritarian nature of Hyundai, the giant Korean conglomerate, exhibits the same characteristics often used to describe founder Chung Ju-Yung.⁶⁶ Other founders with sustaining impact on their organization's culture include Bill Gates at Microsoft, Ingvar Kamprad at IKEA, Herb Kelleher at Southwest Airlines, Fred Smith at FedEx, and Richard Branson at the Virgin Group.

Keeping a Culture Alive

Once a culture is in place, practices within the organization maintain it by giving employees a set of similar experiences.⁶⁷ The selection process, performance evaluation criteria, training and development activities, and promotion procedures (all discussed in Chapter 17) ensure

those hired fit in with the culture, reward those employees who support it, and penalize (or even expel) those who challenge it.⁶⁸ Three forces play a particularly important part in sustaining a culture: selection or hiring practices, actions of top management, and socialization or onboarding methods (e.g., teaching and including new employees). Let's look at each.

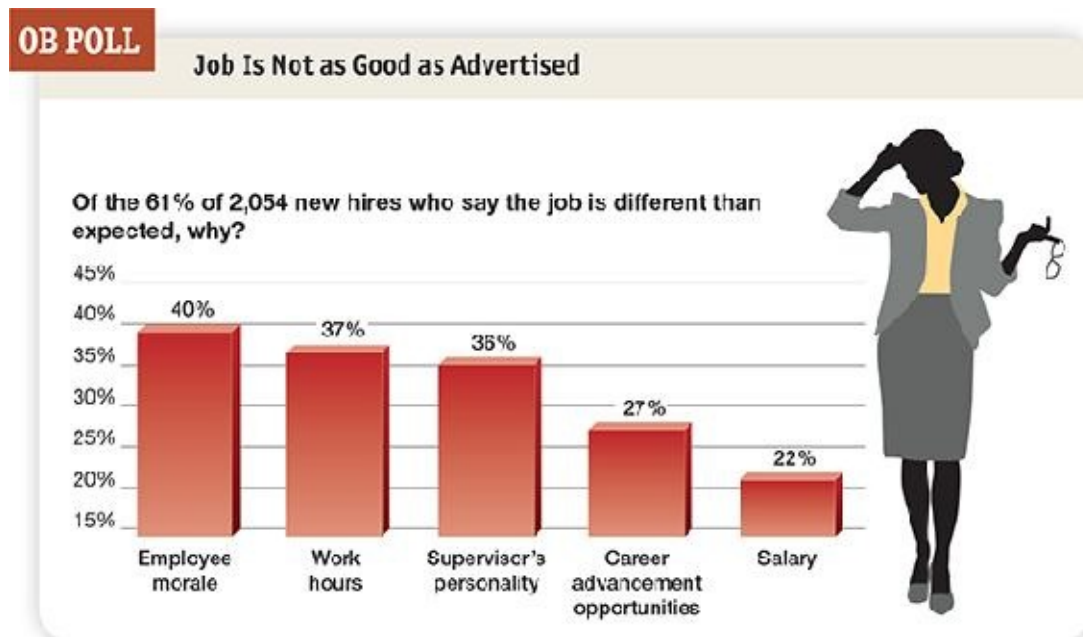
Selection The explicit goal of the selection process is to identify and hire individuals with the knowledge, skills, and abilities to perform successfully. The final decision, because it is significantly influenced by the decision maker's judgment of how well candidates will fit into the organization, identifies people whose values are consistent with at least a good portion of the organization's.⁶⁹ The selection process also provides information to applicants. Those who perceive a conflict between their values and those of the organization can remove themselves from the applicant pool.⁷⁰ Selection thus becomes a two-way street, allowing employer and applicant to avoid a mismatch and to sustain an organization's culture by removing those who might attack or undermine its core values, for better or worse.

W. L. Gore & Associates, the maker of Gore-Tex fabric used in outerwear, prides itself on its democratic culture and teamwork. There are no job titles at Gore, nor are there bosses or chains of command. All work is done in teams. In Gore's selection process, teams put job applicants through extensive interviews to ensure that they can deal with the level of uncertainty, flexibility, and teamwork that's normal in Gore plants. Not surprisingly, W. L. Gore appears regularly on *Fortune's* list of 100 Best Companies to Work For (number 52 in 2017) partially because of its selection process emphasis on culture fit.⁷¹

Top Management The actions of top management have a major impact on the organization's culture.⁷² Through words and behavior, senior executives establish norms that filter through the organization about, for instance, whether risk taking is desirable; how much freedom managers give employees; appropriate dress; and what actions earn pay raises, promotions, and other rewards.

The culture of supermarket chain Wegmans—which believes driven, happy, and loyal employees are more eager to help one another and provide exemplary customer service—is a direct result of the beliefs of the Wegman family. Their focus on fine foods separates Wegmans from other grocers—a focus maintained by the company's employees, many of whom are hired based on their interest in food. Top management at the company believes in

taking care of employees to enhance satisfaction and loyalty. For example, Wegmans has paid more than \$105 million in educational scholarships for more than 33,000 employees since 1984. Top management also supports above average pay for employees, which results in annual turnover for full-time employees at a mere 5 percent (the industry average is 27 percent). Wegmans regularly appears on *Fortune*'s 100 Best Companies to Work For list (number 2 in 2017), in large measure because top management sustains the positive organizational culture begun by its founding members.⁷³

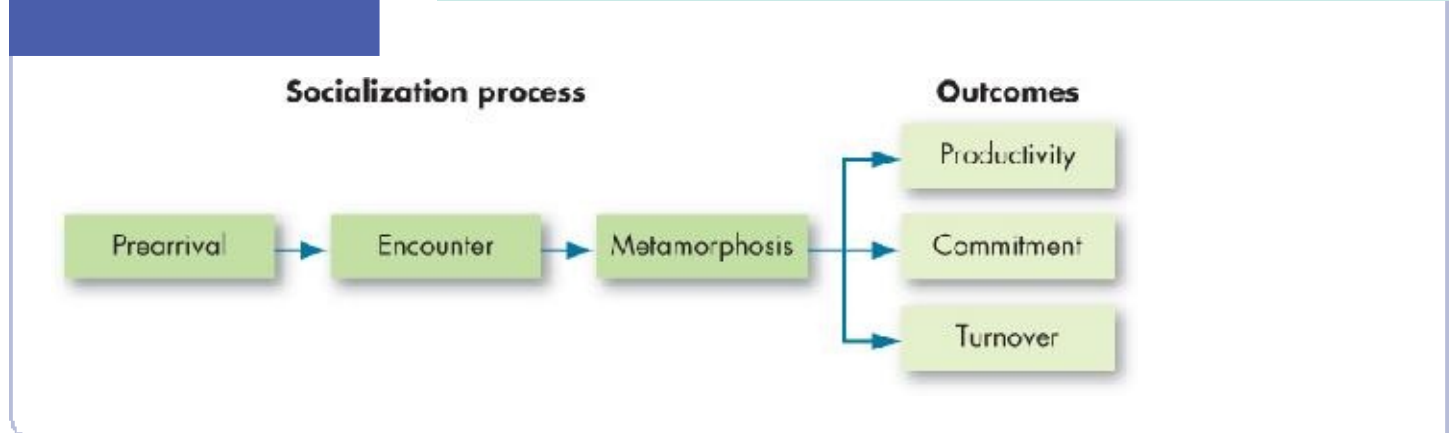


Source: Based on S. Bates, "Majority of New Hires Say Job Is Not What They Expected," *Society for Human Resource Management*, May 28, 2012, <http://www.shrm.org/hrdisciplines/employeerelations/articles/pages/newhiresfeelmisled.aspx>.

Socialization No matter how good a job the organization does in recruiting and selection, new employees need help adapting to the prevailing culture. This help comes in the form of **socialization** practices.⁷⁴ Socialization can help alleviate the problem many employees report when their new jobs are different from what they expected (see OB Poll). For example, the consulting firm Booz Allen Hamilton begins its process of bringing new employees onboard even before their first day of work. New recruits go to an internal Web portal to learn about the company and understand the culture. After they start work, a social networking application links them with more established members of the firm and helps ensure that the culture is reinforced over time.⁷⁵ Clear Channel Communications, Facebook, Google, and other companies are adopting fresh onboarding (new hire acclimation) procedures, including assigning "peer coaches," holding socializing events, personalizing

orientation programs, and giving out immediate work assignments. “When we can stress the personal identity of people, and let them bring more of themselves at work, they are more satisfied with their job and have better results,” researcher Francesca Gino of Harvard said.⁷⁶

Exhibit 15-2 A Socialization Model



We can think of socialization as a process with three stages: prearrival, encounter, and metamorphosis.⁷⁷ This process, shown in Exhibit 15-2, has an impact on the new employee’s work productivity, commitment to the organization’s objectives, and decision to stay with the organization.

The **prearrival stage** ⓘ recognizes that each individual arrives with a set of values, attitudes, and expectations about both the work and the organization. One major purpose of a business school, for example, is to socialize students to the attitudes and behaviors that companies desire in future employees. Newcomers to high-profile organizations with strong market positions have their own assumptions about what it’s like to work there.⁷⁸ Most new recruits will expect Nike to be dynamic and exciting, and a stock brokerage firm to be high in pressure and rewards. How accurately people judge an organization’s culture before they join the organization, how proactive their personalities are, and their anticipated “psychological contract” with the organization become critical predictors of how well they adjust.⁷⁹

The selection process can help inform prospective employees about the organization as a whole. Upon entry into the organization, the new member enters the **encounter stage** ⓘ and confronts the possibility that expectations—about the job, coworkers, boss, and organization in general—may differ from reality. If expectations were accurate, this stage merely cements earlier perceptions. However, this is not often the case. At the extreme, a new member may become disillusioned enough to resign. Proper recruitment, selection, and socialization (e.g.,

giving a realistic preview of the job) should significantly reduce this outcome, along with encouraging friendship ties in the organization—newcomers are more committed when friendly coworkers help them “learn the ropes.”⁸⁰

Finally, to work out any problems discovered during the encounter stage, the new member changes or goes through the **metamorphosis stage** ⓘ.⁸¹ The options presented in Exhibit 15-3 are alternatives designed to bring about metamorphosis. Most research suggests two major “bundles” of socialization practices.⁸² The more management relies on formal, collective, fixed, and serial socialization programs while emphasizing divestiture, the more likely newcomers’ differences will be stripped away and replaced by standardized predictable behaviors. These *institutional* practices are common in police departments, fire departments, and other organizations that value rule following and order. Programs that are informal, individual, variable, and random while emphasizing investiture are more likely to give newcomers an innovative sense of their roles and methods of working. Creative fields such as research and development, advertising, and filmmaking rely on these *individual* practices. Most research suggests that high levels of institutional practices encourage person–organization fit and high levels of commitment, whereas individual practices produce more role innovation.⁸³

Exhibit 15-3 Entry Socialization Options

Formal vs. Informal The more a new employee is segregated from the ongoing work setting and differentiated in some way to make explicit his or her newcomer’s role, the more socialization is formal. Specific orientation and training programs are examples. Informal socialization puts the new employee directly into the job, with little or no special attention.

Individual vs. Collective New members can be socialized individually. This describes how it’s done in many professional offices. They can also be grouped together and processed through an identical set of experiences, as in military boot camp.

Fixed vs. Variable This refers to the time schedule in which newcomers make the transition from outsider to insider. A fixed schedule establishes standardized stages of transition. This characterizes rotational training programs. It also includes probationary

periods, such as the 8- to 10-year “associate” status used by accounting and law firms before deciding on whether or not a candidate is made a partner. Variable schedules give no advance notice of their transition timetable. Variable schedules describe the typical promotion system, in which one is not advanced to the next stage until one is “ready.”

Serial vs. Random Serial socialization is characterized by the use of role models who train and encourage the newcomer. Apprenticeship and mentoring programs are examples. In random socialization, role models are deliberately withheld. New employees are left on their own to figure things out.

Investiture vs. Divestiture Investiture socialization assumes that the newcomer’s qualities and qualifications are the necessary ingredients for job success, so these qualities and qualifications are confirmed and supported. Divestiture socialization tries to strip away certain characteristics of the recruit. Fraternity and sorority “pledges” go through divestiture socialization to shape them into the proper role.

The three-part entry socialization process is complete when new members have internalized and accepted the norms of the organization and their work groups, are confident in their competence, and feel trusted and valued by their peers. They understand the system—not only their own tasks but the rules, procedures, and informally accepted practices as well. Finally, they know what is expected of them and what criteria will be used to measure and evaluate their work. As Exhibit 15-2 showed earlier, successful metamorphosis should have a positive impact on new employees’ productivity and their commitment to the organization, and reduce their propensity to leave the organization (turnover).

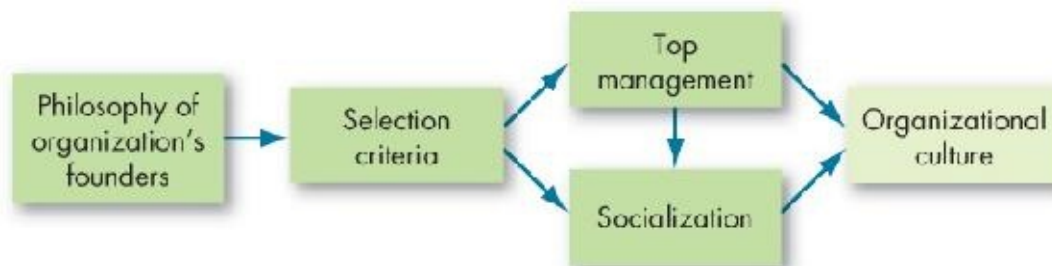
Researchers examine how employee attitudes change during socialization by measuring at several points over the first few months. Several studies have now documented patterns of “honeymoons” and “hangovers” for new workers, showing that the period of initial adjustment is often marked by decreases in job satisfaction as idealized hopes come into contact with the reality of organizational life.⁸⁴ Newcomers may find that the level of social support they receive from supervisors and coworkers is gradually withdrawn over the first few weeks on the job, as everyone returns to “business as usual.”⁸⁵ Role conflict and role overload may rise for newcomers over time, and workers with the largest increases in these

role problems experience the largest decreases in commitment and satisfaction.⁸⁶ The initial adjustment period for newcomers may present increasing demands and difficulties, at least in the short term.

Summary: How Organizational Cultures Form

Exhibit 15-4 summarizes how an organization's culture is established and sustained. The original culture derives from the founder's philosophy and strongly influences hiring criteria as the firm grows. The success of socialization depends on the deliberateness of matching new employees' values to those of the organization in the selection process and on top management's commitment to socialization programs. Top managers' actions set the general climate, including what is acceptable behavior and what is not, and employees sustain and perpetuate the culture.

Exhibit 15-4 How Organizational Cultures Form



Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

15.3.1 The ultimate source of an organization's culture is _____.

- its top management
- its environment

- ☐ the country in which the organization operates
- ☐ its founders

Check answer

Reset

15.3.2 _____ is a process that helps new employees adapt to the prevailing organizational culture.

- ☐ Satisficing
- ☐ Reciprocal interdependence
- ☐ Socialization
- ☐ Formalization

Check answer

Reset

How Employees Learn Culture

15-4 Show how culture is transmitted to employees.

Culture is transmitted to employees in several forms, the most potent being stories, rituals, material symbols, and language.

Stories

When Henry Ford II was chair of Ford Motor Company, you would have been hard-pressed to find a manager who hadn't heard how he reminded his executives, when they got too arrogant, "It's my name that's on the building." The message was clear: Henry Ford II ran the company.

Today, a number of senior Nike executives spend much of their time serving as corporate storytellers.⁸⁷ When they tell how cofounder (and Oregon track coach) Bill Bowerman went to his workshop and poured rubber into a waffle iron to create a better running shoe, they're talking about Nike's spirit of innovation. When new hires hear tales of Oregon running star Steve Prefontaine's battles to make running a professional sport and attain better performance equipment, they learn of Nike's commitment to helping athletes.

Stories such as these circulate through many organizations, anchoring the present in the past and legitimizing current practices.⁸⁸ They typically include narratives about the organization's founders, rule breaking, rags-to-riches successes, workforce reductions, relocations of employees, reactions to past mistakes, and organizational coping.⁸⁹ Employees also create their own narratives about how they came either to fit or not to fit with the organization during the process of socialization, including first days on the job, early interactions with others, and first impressions of organizational life.⁹⁰

Rituals

Rituals ⓘ are repetitive sequences of activities that express and reinforce the key values of the organization—what goals are most important, and/or which people are important versus which are expendable.⁹¹ Some companies have nontraditional rituals to help support the values of their cultures. Kimpton Hotels & Restaurants, one of *Fortune's* 100 Best

Companies to Work For, maintains its customer-oriented culture with traditions like a Housekeeping Olympics that includes blindfolded bedmaking and vacuum races.⁹² At marketing firm United Entertainment Group, employees work unusual hours a few times a year, arriving in the late afternoon and working until early morning. CEO Jarrod Moses does this to support a culture of creativity. He says, “You mess with somebody’s internal clock, and some interesting ideas come out.”⁹³

Symbols

The layout of corporate headquarters, the types of automobiles top executives are given, and the presence or absence of corporate aircraft are a few examples of **material symbols** ⓘ, sometimes also known as artifacts.⁹⁴ Others include the size of offices, the elegance of furnishings, perks, and attire.⁹⁵ These convey to employees who is important; the degree of egalitarianism top management desires; and the kinds of behavior that are appropriate, such as risk taking, and conservative, authoritarian, participative, individualistic, or social behavior. Material symbols also offer a sense of connection and stir emotions in employees who make sense of the symbols.⁹⁶

One example of the intentional use of material symbols is Texas electric company Dynegy. Dynegy’s headquarters doesn’t look like a typical operation. There are few individual offices, even for senior executives. The space is essentially made up of cubicles, common areas, and meeting rooms. This informality conveys to employees that Dynegy values openness, equality, creativity, and flexibility. While some organizations provide their top executives with chauffeur-driven limousines and a corporate jet, other CEOs drive the company car themselves and travel in airlines’ economy section. At some firms, like Chicago shirtmaker Threadless, an “anything goes” atmosphere helps emphasize a creative culture. At Threadless, meetings are held in an Airstream camper parked inside the company’s converted FedEx warehouse, while employees in shorts and flip-flops work in bullpens featuring disco balls and garish decorations chosen by each team.⁹⁷



Baidu, a Chinese Web services firm, describes its culture as “simple”—meaning direct, open, and uncomplicated—and “reliable”—meaning trusting the competence of colleagues. Baidu’s casual workplaces reflect this trust with lounges, gyms, yoga studios, and dome-shaped nap rooms employees may use at any time.

Source: Lou Linwei/Alamy Stock Photo

Some cultures are known for the perks in their environments, such as Google’s bocce courts, Factset Research’s onsite pie/cheese/cupcake trucks, software designer Autodesk’s bring-your-dog-to-work days, SAS’s free health care clinic, Microsoft’s organic spa, and adventure-gear specialist REI’s free equipment rentals. Other companies communicate the values of their cultures through the gift of time to think creatively, either with leaders or offsite. For instance, Biotech leader Genentech and many other top companies provide paid sabbaticals. Genentech offers every employee 7 weeks’ paid leave for every 5 years of service to support a culture of equitability and innovative thinking.⁹⁸

An Ethical Choice

A Culture of Compassion

In the world of banking, success and ethical culture don’t necessarily go hand in hand. Leaders who desire ethical cultures in their organizations must choose to build

ethics into the company's definition of success in ways that translate into ethical actions for managers and employees. Contrast two financial success stories, Goldman Sachs and JP Morgan Chase & Company. Both megabanks are among the Fortune 100 (the largest U.S. companies ranked by revenue). They are also two of *Fortune's* World's Most Admired Companies, a list that ranks the largest companies in revenue by nine criteria including social responsibility. Yet their organizational cultures appear to be vastly different. Goldman Sachs seems to struggle to achieve an ethical culture for its employees and clients, while JP Morgan Chase seems to emanate a culture of compassion. Consider some headlines:

- *Mefit "Mike" Mecevic was a loyal janitor for Goldman Sachs when Superstorm Sandy hit New York in 2012. Mecevic and his coworkers rode out the storm in the company's Manhattan skyscraper and worked nonstop for days to keep floodwaters back. Then a Goldman Sachs manager threw him out without explanation. Mecevic said to him, "I live in Staten Island, there's a state of emergency, there are no cars, no trains, no lights. The water is up to our necks." I was begging for my life. But he said, 'Leave the building.'* Mecevic left but was later fired anyway. "I worked day and night," Mecevic said. "They destroyed my life for nothing. Nothing."
- Jamie Dimon, CEO of JP Morgan Chase & Company, proclaims, "People are our most important asset. The long-term growth and success of JP Morgan Chase depends on our ability to attract and retain our employees. Maintaining a diverse and inclusive workplace where everyone can thrive is not only the smart thing to do—it's the right thing to do." The culture of JP Morgan Chase is driven by performance and merit, partnership and inclusion, and directness. It has programs that support the success of women and minorities.

Organizational culture is where leaders' ethical choices demonstrate their expectations for others' decisions throughout the company. These examples suggest that the two cultures may make very different ethical choices.

Sources: Based on JP Morgan Chase & Co., "People and Culture,"

<https://www.jpmorganchase.com/corporate/About-JPMC/ab-people-culture.htm>, accessed April 18, 2017; B. Ross, A. Ng, and C. Siemaszko, "Ex-Goldman Sachs Janitor Sues for Being Forced into Post-Hurricane Sandy

Destruction,” *New York Daily News*, June 7, 2013, www.nydailynews.com/new-york/janitor-sues-tossed-aftermath-hurricane-sandy-article-1.1366334; and M. Schiffrin and H. Touryalai, “The Bank That Works,” *Forbes*, February 13, 2012, 66–74.

Language

Many organizations and subunits within them use language to help members identify with the culture, attest to their acceptance of it, and help preserve it.⁹⁹ Unique terms describe equipment, officers, key individuals, suppliers, customers, or products that relate to the business. New employees may be overwhelmed at first by acronyms and jargon that, once assimilated, act as a common denominator to unite members of a given culture or subculture.

MyLab Management Try It

If your professor has assigned this activity, go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management to complete the Mini Sim.

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

15.4.1 Which of the following is not a means of transmitting culture within an organization?

- ☐ stories
- ☐ people orientation
- ☐ rituals
- ☐ language

Check answer

Reset

15.4.2 Which of the following is not a message conveyed by material symbols?

- ☐ organizational hierarchy
- ☐ top management's egalitarianism
- ☐ the marketing strategy of the organization
- ☐ appropriate risk-taking behavior

Check answer

Reset

Influencing an Organizational Culture

15-5 Describe the similarities and differences in creating an ethical culture, a positive culture, and a spiritual culture.

As we discussed, the culture of an organization is set by its founders and is often difficult to change afterward. It's true that the ideal scenario is a strong founder or founders who carefully plan the organization's culture beforehand. That's seldom the case, though; organizational culture usually grows organically over time. When we think of the development of culture as ongoing and conducted through each employee, we can see ways to increase the ethical, positive, and/or spiritual aspects of the environment, which we discuss next.

Developing an Ethical Culture

Despite differences across industries and cultures, ethical organizational cultures share some common values and processes.¹⁰⁰ Therefore, managers can create a more ethical culture by adhering to the following principles:¹⁰¹

- *Be a visible role model.* Employees will look to the actions of top management as a benchmark for appropriate behavior, but everyone can be a role model to positively influence the ethical atmosphere. Send a positive message.
- *Communicate ethical expectations.* Whenever you serve in a leadership capacity, minimize ethical ambiguities by sharing a code of ethics that states the organization's primary values and the judgment rules employees must follow.
- *Provide ethical training.* Set up seminars, workshops, and training programs to reinforce the organization's standards of conduct, clarify what practices are permissible, and address potential ethical dilemmas.
- *Visibly reward ethical acts and punish unethical ones.* Evaluate subordinates on how their decisions compare with the organization's code of ethics. Review the means as well as the ends. Visibly reward those who act ethically and conspicuously punish those who don't.

- *Provide protective mechanisms.* Seek formal mechanisms so everyone can discuss ethical dilemmas and report unethical behavior without fear of reprimand. These might include identifying ethical counselors, ombudspeople, or ethical officers for liaison roles.

A widespread positive ethical climate must start at the top of the organization.¹⁰² When top management emphasizes strong ethical values, supervisors are more likely to practice ethical leadership. Positive attitudes transfer down to line employees, who show lower levels of deviant behavior and higher levels of cooperation and assistance. Several other studies have come to the same general conclusion: The values of top management are a good predictor of ethical behavior among employees. For example, one study involving auditors found perceived pressure from organizational leaders to behave unethically was associated with increased intentions to engage in unethical practices.¹⁰³ Clearly the wrong type of organizational culture can negatively influence employee ethical behavior. Conversely, ethical leadership has been shown to improve group ethical voice, or the extent to which employees feel comfortable speaking up about issues that seem unethical to them, through improvements in ethical culture.¹⁰⁴ Finally, employees whose ethical values are similar to those of their department are more likely to be promoted, so we can think of ethical culture as flowing from the bottom up as well.¹⁰⁵

Developing a Positive Culture

At first, creating a positive culture may sound hopelessly naïve or like a Dilbert-style conspiracy. The one thing that makes us believe this trend is here to stay, however, are signs that management practice and Organizational Behavior (OB) research are converging. A **positive organizational culture** ⓘ emphasizes building on employee strengths, rewards more than it punishes, and encourages individual vitality and growth.¹⁰⁶ Let's consider each of these areas.



Brunello Cucinelli, an Italian luxury cashmere brand, believes in the dignity of work and importance of leisure time. The firm prefers to have a lower profit than its competitors in order to offer employees high salaries and decent working conditions. Moreover, Brunello, the founder, invites all employees to leave the office at 5 p.m. in order to participate in their numerous non-working activities, and he encourages the managers of the company to do the same.

Source: Dpa picture alliance/Alamy Stock Photo

Building on Employee Strengths Although a positive organizational culture does not ignore problems, it does emphasize showing workers how they can capitalize on their strengths. As management guru Peter Drucker said, “Most Americans do not know what their strengths are. When you ask them, they look at you with a blank stare, or they respond in terms of subject knowledge, which is the wrong answer.”¹⁰⁷ Wouldn’t it be better to be in an organizational culture that helped you discover your strengths and how to make the most of them?

As CEO of Auglaize Provico, an agribusiness based in Ohio, Larry Hammond used this approach during the firm’s worst financial struggles. When the organization had to lay off one-quarter of its workforce, he took advantage of what was right, rather than dwelling on what went wrong. “If you really want to [excel], you have to know yourself—you have to know what you’re good at, and you have to know what you’re not so good at,” he said. With the help of Gallup consultant Barry Conchie, Hammond focused on discovering and using employee strengths to help the company turn itself around. “You ask Larry [Hammond] what the difference is, and he’ll say that it’s individuals using their natural talents,” says

Rewarding More Than Punishing Although most organizations are sufficiently focused on extrinsic rewards such as pay and promotions, they often forget about the power of smaller (and cheaper) rewards such as praise. Part of creating a positive organizational culture is “catching employees doing something right.” Many managers withhold praise because they’re afraid employees will coast or because they think praise is not valued. Employees generally don’t ask for praise, and managers usually don’t realize the costs of failing to give it.



Consider El’zbieta Górską-Kolodziejczyk, a plant manager for International Paper’s facility in Kwidzyn, Poland. Employees worked in a bleak windowless basement. Staffing became roughly one-third its prior level, while production tripled. These challenges had defeated the previous three managers. When she took over, recognition and praise for staff were at the top of her list. She initially found it difficult to give praise to those who weren’t used to it, especially men. “They were like cement at the beginning,” she said. “Like cement.” Over time, however, she found they valued and even reciprocated praise. One day a department supervisor pulled her over to tell her she was doing a good job. “This I do remember, yes,” she said.¹⁰⁹

Encouraging Vitality and Growth No organization will get the best from employees who see themselves as mere cogs in the machine. A positive culture recognizes the difference between a job and a career. It supports not only what the employee contributes to organizational effectiveness but how the organization can make the employee more effective—personally and professionally. Top companies recognize the value of helping people grow. Safelite AutoGlass, *Workforce Management*’s 2012 Optima award winner for Competitive Advantage, attributes its success in part to its PeopleFirst Plan talent development initiative. “The only way we can stand out is if we have the best people,” says Senior Vice President Steve Miggo.¹¹⁰



It may take more creativity to encourage employee growth in some industries. From the Masterfoods headquarters in Brussels, Philippe Lescornez led a team of sales promoters, including Didier Brynaert, who worked in Luxembourg, nearly 150 miles away. Lescornez decided Brynaert’s role could be improved if he were an expert on the unique

features of the Luxembourg market. So Lescornez asked Brynaert for information he could share with the home office. “I started to communicate much more what he did internally to other people [within the company], because there’s quite some distance between the Brussels office and the section he’s working in. So I started to communicate, communicate, communicate. The more I communicated, the more he started to provide material,” he said. As a result, “Now he’s recognized as the specialist for Luxembourg—the guy who is able to build a strong relationship with the Luxembourg clients,” says Lescornez. What’s good for Brynaert was, of course, also good for Lescornez, who got credit for helping Brynaert grow and develop.¹¹¹

Limits of Positive Culture Is a positive culture a cure-all? Though many companies have embraced aspects of a positive organizational culture, it is a new enough idea for us to be uncertain about how and when it works best.



Not all national cultures value being positive as much as the U.S. culture does and, even within U.S. culture, there surely are limits to how far organizations should go. The limits may need to be dictated by the industry and society. For example, Admiral, a British insurance company, has established a Ministry of Fun in its call centers to organize poem writing, foosball, conkers (a British game involving chestnuts), and fancy-dress days, which may clash with an industry value of more serious cultures. When does the pursuit of a positive culture start to seem coercive? As one critic notes, “Promoting a social orthodoxy of positiveness focuses on a particular constellation of desirable states and traits but, in so doing, can stigmatize those who fail to fit the template.”¹¹² There may be benefits to establishing a positive culture, but an organization also needs to be objective and not pursue it past the point of effectiveness.

A Spiritual Culture

What do Southwest Airlines, Hewlett-Packard, Ford, The Men’s Wearhouse, Tyson Foods, Wetherill Associates, and Tom’s of Maine have in common? They’re among a growing number of organizations that have embraced workplace spirituality.

What Is Spirituality? Workplace spirituality is *not* about organized religious practices. It’s not about God or theology. **Workplace spirituality**  recognizes that people have an inner

life that nourishes and is nourished by meaningful work in the context of community.¹¹³ Organizations that support a spiritual culture recognize that people seek to find meaning and purpose in their work and desire to connect with other human beings as part of a community. Many of the topics we have discussed—ranging from job design to corporate social responsibility (CSR)—are well matched to the concept of organizational spirituality. When a company emphasizes its commitment to paying Third World suppliers a fair (above-market) price for their products to facilitate community development—as did Starbucks—or encourages employees to share prayers or inspirational messages through e-mail—as did Interstate Batteries—it may encourage a more spiritual culture.¹¹⁴

Why Spirituality Now? As noted in our discussion of emotions in Chapter 4, the myth of rationality assumed that the well-run organization eliminated people's feelings. Concern about an employee's inner life had no role in the perfectly rational model. But just as we realize that the study of emotions improves our understanding of OB, an awareness of spirituality can help us better understand employee behavior.

Of course, employees have always had an inner life. So why has the search for meaning and purposefulness in work surfaced now? We summarize the reasons in Exhibit 15-5.

Characteristics of a Spiritual Organization The concept of workplace spirituality draws on our previous discussions of values, ethics, motivation, and leadership. Although research remains preliminary, several cultural characteristics tend to be evident in spiritual organizations:¹¹⁵

- *Benevolence.* Spiritual organizations value kindness toward others and the happiness of employees and other organizational stakeholders.
 - *Strong sense of purpose.* Spiritual organizations build their cultures around a meaningful purpose. Although profits may be important, they're not the primary value.
 - *Trust and respect.* Spiritual organizations are characterized by mutual trust, honesty, and openness. Employees are treated with esteem and value, consistent with the dignity of each individual.
 - *Open-mindedness.* Spiritual organizations value flexible thinking and creativity among employees.
-

Exhibit 15-5 Reasons for the Growing Interest in Spirituality

- Spirituality can counterbalance the pressures and stress of a turbulent pace of life. Contemporary lifestyles—single-parent families, geographic mobility, the temporary nature of jobs, new technologies that create distance between people—underscore the lack of community many people feel and increase the need for involvement and connection.
- Formalized religion hasn't worked for many people, and they continue to look for anchors to replace lack of faith and to fill a growing feeling of emptiness.
- Job demands have made the workplace dominant in many people's lives, yet they continue to question the meaning of work.
- People want to integrate personal life values with their professional lives.
- An increasing number of people are finding that the pursuit of more material acquisitions leaves them unfulfilled.

Achieving Spirituality in the Organization Many organizations have grown interested in spirituality but have had trouble putting principles into practice. Several types of practices can facilitate a spiritual workplace,¹¹⁶ including those that support work-life balance. Leaders can demonstrate values, attitudes, and behaviors that trigger intrinsic motivation and a sense of fulfilling a calling through work. Encouraging employees to consider how their work provides a sense of purpose can help achieve a spiritual workplace; often this is done through group counseling and organizational development, the latter of which we take up in Chapter 18.

A growing number of companies, including Taco Bell and Sturdisteel, offer employees the counseling services of corporate chaplains. Many chaplains are employed by agencies, such as Marketplace Chaplains USA, while some corporations, such as R.J. Reynolds Tobacco and Tyson Foods, employ chaplains directly. The workplace presence of corporate chaplains, who are often ordained Christian ministers, is obviously controversial, although their role is not to increase spirituality but to help human resources departments serve the employees who already have Christian beliefs.¹¹⁷ Similar roles for leaders of other faiths certainly must be

encouraged.

Career OBjectives

How do I learn to lead?

I'll be starting a new job in a few weeks. It's my first time working as a leader for a team, and I know I have a lot to learn. Is there any way I can be sure I'll achieve success as a leader?

—Gordon

Dear Gordon:

Learning about a new job is always complicated. Learning how to be a leader is doubly complicated. It's expected that you have the capacity to provide direction and purpose for employees and that you will respect the existing culture of the group as well as the capacities of individual members. Here are a few key insights toward making your transition into leadership successful:

- *Ask questions.* New leaders are often anxious about asking questions of employees who report directly to them for fear of being seen as incompetent or weak. However, inquiring about how things have been done in the past and asking about individual goals signals that you are concerned about the team members. Familiarizing yourself with the group's culture and practices can also help you develop techniques to harness the team's strengths and overcome challenges.
- *Build relationships with other leaders.* Remember—you were put into this role for a reason, and the company wants to see you succeed, so make the most of the resources of others. Take detailed notes regarding specific activities and strategies that were successful, and schedule a check-in to discuss how these strategies have worked over time. If you can show you are truly engaged in the learning process, you'll find others are more willing to provide you with assistance and advice.
- *Start small.* Much has been written about the importance of gaining small wins early to build your reputation. The old saying “You never get a second chance to make a first impression” definitely holds true in the workplace. Try to develop new initiatives with clear outcomes that will allow you to demonstrate your

leadership traits.

The best leadership transitions include learning what the situation calls for and setting your team up for success from the start.

Be proactive!

Sources: Based on T. B. Harris, N. Li, W. R. Boswell, X. Zhang, and Z. Xie, "Getting What's New from Newcomers: Empowering Leadership, Creativity, and Adjustment in the Socialization Context," *Personnel Psychology* 67 (2014): 567–604; Y. H. Ji, N. A. Cohen, A. Daly, K. Finnigan, and K. Klein, "The Dynamics of Voice Behavior and Leaders' Network Ties in Times of Leadership Successions," *Academy of Management Proceedings* (2014): 16324; and B. Eckfeldt, "5 Things New CEOs Should Focus On," *Business Insider*, June 1, 2015, <http://www.businessinsider.com/5-things-new-ceos-should-focus-on-2015-6>.

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Criticisms of Spirituality Critics of the spirituality movement in organizations¹¹⁸ have focused on three issues. First is the question of scientific foundation. What really is workplace spirituality? Is spirituality just a new management buzzword? Second, are spiritual organizations legitimate? Specifically, do organizations have the right to claim spiritual values? Third is the question of economics: Are spirituality and profits compatible?

First, there is comparatively little research on workplace spirituality. Spirituality has been defined so broadly in some sources that practices from job rotation to corporate retreats at meditation centers have been identified as spiritual. Questions need to be answered before the concept gains full credibility.

Second, an emphasis on spirituality can clearly make some employees uneasy. Critics have argued that secular institutions, especially business firms, should not impose spiritual values on employees.¹¹⁹ This criticism is undoubtedly valid when spirituality is defined as bringing religion and God into the workplace. However, it seems less stinging when the goal is limited to helping employees find meaning and purpose in their work lives. If the concerns

listed in Exhibit 15-5 truly characterize a large segment of the workforce, then perhaps organizations can help.

Third, whether spirituality and profits are compatible objectives is a relevant concern for managers and investors in business. The evidence, although limited, indicates they are. In one study, organizations that provided their employees with opportunities for spiritual development outperformed those that didn't.¹²⁰ Other studies reported that spirituality in organizations was positively related to creativity, employee satisfaction, job involvement, and organizational commitment.¹²¹

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

15.5.1 To create a more ethical culture, management should do all of the following except _____.

- ☐ serve as a visible role model
- ☐ encourage unbridled competition
- ☐ provide ethical training
- ☐ communicate ethical expectations

Check answer

Reset

15.5.2 A positive organizational culture emphasizes all of the following except which?

- ☐ building employee strengths
- ☐ tailoring positions to encourage work–life balance
- ☐ rewarding more than it punishes
- ☐ encouraging individual vitality

Check answer

Reset

The Global Context

15-6 Show how national culture can affect the way organizational culture is transported to another country.

We considered global cultural values (collectivism–individualism, power distance, and so on) in Chapter 5. Here our focus is a bit narrower: How is organizational culture affected by the global context? Organizational culture is so powerful that it often transcends national boundaries. But that doesn't mean organizations should, or could, ignore local culture.



Organizational cultures often reflect national culture.¹²² The culture at AirAsia, a Malaysian-based airline, emphasizes openness and friendships. The carrier has lots of parties, participative management, and no private offices, reflecting Malaysia's relatively collectivistic culture. The culture of many U.S. airlines does not reflect the same degree of informality. If a U.S. airline were to merge with AirAsia, it would need to take these cultural differences into account. Organizational culture differences are not always due to international culture differences, however. One of the chief challenges of the merger of US Airways and American Airlines was the integration of US Airway's open-collar culture with American's button-down culture.¹²³

One of the primary things U.S. managers can do is to be culturally sensitive. The United States is a dominant force in business and in culture—and with that influence comes a reputation. “We are broadly seen throughout the world as arrogant people, totally self-absorbed and loud,” says one U.S. executive. Some ways in which U.S. managers can be culturally sensitive include talking in a low tone of voice, speaking slowly, listening more, and avoiding discussions of religion and politics.

The management of ethical behavior is one area where national culture can rub against corporate culture.¹²⁴ U.S. managers endorse the supremacy of anonymous market forces as a moral obligation for business organizations. This worldview sees bribery, nepotism, and favoring personal contacts as highly unethical. They also value profit maximization, so any action that deviates from profit maximization may suggest inappropriate or corrupt behavior. In contrast, managers in developing economies are more likely to see ethical decisions as embedded in the social environment. That means doing special favors for family and friends

is not only appropriate but possibly even an ethical responsibility. Managers in many nations view capitalism skeptically and believe the interests of workers should be put on a par with the interests of shareholders, which may limit profit maximization.



Creating a multinational organizational culture can initiate strife between employees of traditionally competing countries. When Swedish, Norwegian, Finnish, and Danish banks combined to form Nordea Bank AB, the stereotypes some employees held based on the countries' historical relationships created tensions. Finland had originally been a colony of Sweden, and Norway had been a part of Denmark and then of Sweden. The fact that none of the employees had yet been born when their countries were colonies didn't matter; complex alliances within Nordea formed along nationalistic lines. To bridge these gaps, Nordea employed storytelling to help employees identify with positive aspects of their shared geographical *region*. The organization reinforced the shared identity through press releases, corporate correspondence, equal country representation in top management, and championing of shared values. Although the organization continues to struggle with a multinational culture, the successes it has enjoyed can be attributed to careful attention to national differences.¹²⁵



As national organizations seek to employ workers in overseas operations, management must decide whether to standardize many facets of organizational culture. For example, should organizations offer wellness plans and work-life balance initiatives from the home country to the satellite offices, or should they tailor the plans for the norms of each society? Either can be problematic. For instance, when U.S. company Rothenberg International introduced its alcohol abuse remediation plan to Russian employees as part of its employee assistance program (EAP), it didn't foresee that Russians resist the concept of "assistance" and prefer "support" instead. Rothenberg could adjust, but sometimes local laws intercede (as a help or a hindrance) when employers roll out homeland plans. Brazil has a government anti-HIV plan that employers can use, for instance, and the United Kingdom's National Health Service pays for smoking cessation programs, while in Germany private insurance must pay for wellness plans.¹²⁶ At this point, there is no clear consensus on the best course of action, but the first step is for companies to be sensitive to differing standards.

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

15.6.1 How can United States managers be culturally sensitive?

- ☐ by indulging in frequent discussions about religion
- ☐ by discussing politics frequently
- ☐ by listening more
- ☐ by speaking quickly

Check answer

Reset

15.6.2 Which of the following statements is true regarding effects of national culture on organizational culture and ethical behavior within an organization?

- As compared to managers in the United States, managers in developing economies are less likely to see ethical decisions as embedded in a social environment.
- Organizations can safely ignore local culture while establishing its operation in another country.
- Generally, United States managers see bribery, nepotism, and favoring personal contacts as highly unethical.
- Organizational cultures rarely reflect national culture.

Check answer

Reset

Summary

Exhibit 15-6 depicts the impact of organizational culture. Employees form an overall subjective perception of the organization based on factors such as the degree of risk tolerance, team emphasis, and support of individuals. This overall perception represents, in effect, the organization's culture or personality and affects employee performance and satisfaction, with stronger cultures having greater impact.

Exhibit 15-6 How Organizational Cultures Have an Impact on Employee Performance and Satisfaction



Implications for Managers

- Realize that an organization's culture is relatively fixed in the short term. To effect change, involve top management and strategize a long-term plan.
- Hire individuals whose values align with those of the organization; these employees will tend to remain committed and satisfied. Not surprisingly, "misfits" have considerably higher turnover rates.
- Understand that employees' performance and socialization depend to a considerable degree on their knowing what to do and what not to do. Train your employees well and keep them informed of changes to their job roles.

- You can shape the culture of your work environment, sometimes as much as it shapes you. All managers can do their part to create an ethical culture and to consider spirituality and its role in creating a positive organizational culture.
- Be aware that your company's organizational culture may not be “transported” easily to other countries. Understand the cultural relevance of your organization's norms before introducing new plans or initiatives overseas.



MyLab Management **Personal Inventory Assessments**

Go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management to complete the Personal Inventory Assessment related to this chapter.

Organizational Culture Can Be “Measured”

Point

Greg Besner, the CEO of CultureIQ, has spent 15 years as an entrepreneur and leader following hundreds of companies to be able to accurately measure organizational culture. CultureIQ focuses on measuring and managing organizational culture using a software package, and they have found, over time, what they believe are 10 indicators that help a company assess their organizational cultures (especially the mission and values aspect). Besner suggests that companies should assess all of the following:

1. Communication, including employee voice and downward communication from leaders
2. Innovation, including employee creativity and organizational receptiveness to new ideas
3. Agility, including employee perceptions of whether the organization adapts to

changes

4. Wellness, including the mental and physical well-being of employees
5. Environment, including the comfort and usability of the office space
6. Collaboration, including how well employees work with one another
7. Support, including the assistance that employees get from their supervisors, coworkers, and organization as a whole
8. Performance orientation, including role clarity, rewards, and employee recognition
9. Responsibility, including employee accountability and autonomy
10. Mission and values, including awareness and implementation

Beyond Besner's approach, a variety of other researchers and practitioners have claimed to assess organizational culture accurately. Primarily, they have used surveys and interviews to assess organizational culture and have amassed evidence that the surveys and interviews measure what they should and measure them consistently. One example of these measures asks employees to respond to questions related to the dimensions of organizational culture discussed at the beginning of the chapter (the same "objective factors" listed in Exhibit 15-6) and to compare how their stance on these values aligns with those of the organization.

Counterpoint

Can something so complex, so deep, and so difficult to define clearly be measured by asking someone about his or her organization's culture in an interview or a survey? Probably not, according to some researchers. As Professor John Traphagan notes, "The problem with the term 'culture' is that it tends to essentialize groups: It simplistically represents a group of people as a unified whole that share simple common values, ideas, practices, and beliefs." Not only does it reduce complex systems to unified wholes, organizational culture is also deterministic, meaning that it is a given, complete entity that changes slowly and tends to have a strong, straightforward effect on behavior. But the reality is that these assumptions are probably not grounded.

The survey measures and interviews that are employed to assess organizational culture often fail to "meet the mark" because either they assess other phenomena that we inappropriately call "culture" (e.g., communication, performance, attitudes, etc.) or they

do not fully capture the deep complexities of organizational culture. For example, should organizational culture assessments focus on myths? Stories? Values? Behavior? Artifacts? Beliefs? Underlying assumptions? Although it is easy to see how values, behavior, and beliefs can be assessed with surveys, it is perhaps very difficult to make sense of the organization's stories, artifacts, and underlying assumptions. Furthermore, how can we distinguish reliably between the effect of subcultures or the national culture and the overall culture as a whole?

A final issue can be found in *what* we should measure. As can be seen throughout this chapter, many different forms of organizational culture and dimensions have been forwarded by organizational behavior researchers over many decades. Which ones are correct? The answer to this question plays into the question of how we should measure organizational culture. It seems clear that, although organizational cultures appear to be real and to influence people, it is incredibly difficult to “measure” them.

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Chapter Review

MyLab Management Discussion Questions

Go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management to complete the problems marked with this icon .

Questions for Review

- 15-1** What is organizational culture, and what are its common characteristics?
- 15-2** What are the functional and dysfunctional effects of organizational culture?
- 15-3** What factors create and sustain an organization's culture?
- 15-4** How is culture transmitted to employees?
- 15-5** What are the similarities and differences in creating an ethical culture, a positive culture, and a spiritual culture?
- 15-6** How does national culture affect what happens when an organizational culture is transported to another country?

Application and Employability

In this chapter, you were introduced to organizational culture and climate as well as their differentiating characteristics. You should also know now that they matter—a poor organizational culture, in many ways, can be a make-or-break factor for an organization. Organizational cultures are often taken very seriously by organizations. By learning about organizational cultures and how they work, you are improving your employability by enabling you to adapt to distinct types of cultures, to craft positive organizational cultures if you are to be in a leadership position, and to demonstrate your fit with the values of a

company at which you are interviewing. You are also aware of the negative aspects of organizational culture, which will help you avoid or circumvent potentially troublesome situations when you are either on the job or applying to an organization that might have a negative organizational culture. In this chapter, you improved your communication skills by considering the forces of organizational culture change, learning how to be a better leader, differentiating between compassionate cultures in the banking industry, and debating whether it is possible to “measure” organizational culture. In the next section, you will improve your critical thinking and knowledge application and analysis skills by designing an organizational culture of your own, examining how cultures can encourage dishonesty or corruption, discussing how aspects of office and organizational design contribute to organizational culture, and questioning the pros and cons of an active culture.

Experiential Exercise Creating a Green Culture

Form groups of three or four students. Each group will be the founder of a new organization based in a different country. Drawing from the content developed in this chapter, your goal is to create a company with a strong organizational culture that emphasizes sustainability, attention to internal as well as external stakeholders, and promotion of ethical behaviors. Consider the term “sustainability” in its broader meaning, which encompasses not only attention toward the environment and a more conscious use of natural resources but also takes into account employees’ well-being, workload, and work–life balance. Each group needs to provide the following information about their new organization and culture and be ready to justify their decision in class:

- *Name of the organization*
- *Products or services provided*
- *Primary country chosen for the headquarters*
- *Founding members*
- *Mission or vision statement*
- *Three primary values guiding the organization*
- *Five core beliefs that guide the conduct of business in the organization*
- *Three examples of organizational policies that enable the organization’s vision to be accomplished or which reinforce its values*
- *One or more artifacts or symbols that represent the organization’s mission or values*

Questions

- 15-7.** Was it easy for your team to consider sustainability in its broader meaning to focus on both environmental protection and employees’ well-being? Why or why not?
- 15-8.** Paradoxically, contemporary organizations seem to commit greater attention and resources toward the protection of the environment than the care of people working for them. As a team, discuss three possible reasons behind this paradox and possible remedies to foster greater attention toward employees’ wellbeing at work.
- 15-9.** What specific organizational interventions could be implemented to help employees achieve greater work–life balance in their lives?

Ethical Dilemma Culture of Deceit

We have noted throughout the text that honesty is generally the best policy in managing OB. But that doesn't mean honest dealing is always the rule in business.

Studies have found, in fact, that whole industries may encourage dishonesty. In one experiment, subjects were first asked either to think about their professional identities or to complete a generic survey. They were then asked to report on a series of coin flips; they were told in advance that the more times the coin showed heads, the more money they would make. The bankers who took the generic survey were about as honest in reporting coin flips as people who worked in other fields. The bankers told to think about their professional identities, however, exaggerated how often the coin turned up heads. People in other professions didn't do so—the tie between professional identity and dishonesty was unique to those who worked in banking. These results are certainly not limited to the banking industry. Many other ways of priming people to think about financial transactions seem to generate more dishonesty. And studies have also found that many individuals feel pressured to engage in dishonest behavior to meet the bottom line. Money provides powerful motives for dishonesty.

Money motivations are strong in professional sports. For example, the number of top leaders in FIFA (Fédération Internationale de Football Association, the international governing body of association football [soccer], futsal, and beach soccer) who were indicted in 2015 suggests that behaving dishonestly has been accepted within FIFA and covering up for the dishonesty of others has been encouraged. Domenico Scala, FIFA's audit and compliance committee chair, noted, "To support the change we need a culture that censures inappropriate behavior and enforces rules vigorously, fairly, and [is] responsive." There is consensus that to overcome corruption, those in positions of authority must demonstrate commitment to an ethical culture. As Scala noted, "It is the leaders' tone that ensures it is embedded at all levels of the organization. This must be honest and communicated with sincerity in both words and actions." There may well be a tendency to become dishonest when there's money to be made, so leaders may need to be especially vigilant and communicate clear expectations for ethical behavior.

Fortunately, evidence shows that asking people to focus on relationships and the way they spend their time can make them behave more honestly and helpfully. This suggests that a

focus on the social consequences of our actions can indeed help to overcome corruption.

Questions

- 15-10.** What are the negative effects of a culture that encourages dishonesty and corruption on an organization's reputation and its employees?
- 15-11.** Why might some organizations push employees to behave in a dishonest or corrupt manner? Are there personal benefits to corruption that organizational culture can counteract?
- 15-12.** What actions can you take as a new employee if you are pressured to violate your own ethical standards at work? How might midlevel employees' responses to this question differ from those of more senior managers?

Sources: Based on F. Gino, "Banking Culture Encourages Dishonesty," *Scientific American*, December 30, 2014, <http://www.scientificamerican.com/article/banking-culture-encourages-dishonesty/>; A. Cohn, E. Fehr, and M. A. Maréchal, "Business Culture and Dishonesty in the Banking Industry," *Nature*, 2014, doi:10.1038/nature13977; L. Geggel, "FIFA Scandal: The Complicated Science of Corruption," *Scientific American*, May 31, 2015, <http://www.scientificamerican.com/article/fifa-scandal-the-complicated-science-of-corruption/>; and K. Radnedge, "Culture Change Required if FIFA Is to Eliminate Wrongdoing," *World Soccer*, May 29, 2015, <http://www.worldsoccer.com/columnists/keir-radnedge/culture-change-required-if-fifa-is-to-eliminate-wrongdoing-362278>.

Case Incident 1 Culture of Fear

A Sports Direct store is a fixture in nearly every town in the United Kingdom. Founded by Mike Ashley in 1982, the retailing group has grown to become Britain's largest sporting goods retailer, with approximately 465 stores and 29,000 employees. However, a number of reports, most recently by *The Guardian* newspaper in 2015, revealed a number of questionable work practices. It seems that the company's success may have been underpinned by a culture of fear.

Undercover *Guardian* reporters at the company's Derbyshire warehouse found individual employees being told to work faster via a public-address system and security searches at the end of a shift (taking place after employees had clocked out). Most disturbing was the warning system, referred to as the "six strikes." You could receive a "strike" for a number of reasons, including errors in your work, having long toilet breaks, or a period of reported sickness. Receiving six strikes over a six-month period would result in your contract being terminated.

In 2016, a Parliamentary committee was set up to investigate the claims from *The Guardian* and other sources. They concluded that the success of Sports Direct had been achieved through a culture that allowed some employees to be treated without dignity or respect. Although the committee did concede that there were probably other organizations guilty of employee mistreatment, they identified Sports Direct as a particularly bad example of this type of exploitation.

Reviewing evidence regarding the "six strikes" policy, the committee heard from a union representative who described people coming to work ill as they feared that they would receive a strike for calling in sick. This increase in presenteeism—going to work when you are too ill to do so—thus poses health and safety risks. Between January 1, 2013, and April 19, 2016, a total of 110 ambulances or paramedics were dispatched to the warehouse. Of these, 50 cases were classed as life-threatening, including a woman giving birth in the toilet. Although strikes were often given in a very arbitrary manner, the committee concluded that workers were unlikely to argue as they were employed as agency workers and protest could mean that they would probably not be given as many hours work in the future.

The strict control systems in force suggest a strong culture; however, it is difficult to say whether this case highlights a subculture specific to the warehouse or a dominant culture

demonstrating core values across the organization. It is clear that there was a negative workplace climate at the warehouse that was affecting the health and wellbeing of the employees. After the committee, Ashley agreed to look into a number of issues, including the “six strikes” policy and allegations of bullying and physical intimidation. As the founder of the company, a cultural change has to be driven by him.

A year on and some things have clearly changed. The company has a staff wellbeing service and a staff listening group as well as an employee representative who attends board meetings.

Questions

- 15-13.** How would you describe the culture at the Sports Direct warehouse? How might this culture be a liability to the organization?
- 15-14.** What does the case study tell you about the six characteristics of organizational culture at Sports Direct?
- 15-15.** With so many stores and employees, how do you change the organizational culture at Sports Direct? What action do you think should be taken and by whom?

Sources: Simon Goodley and Jonathan Ashby, “Revealed: How Sports Direct Effectively Pays below Minimum Wage,” *The Guardian*, December 9, 2015, <https://www.theguardian.com/business/2015/dec/09/how-sports-direct-effectively-pays-below-minimum-wage-pay>; Jeff Farrell, “Sports Direct ‘Identifies Staff by Fingerprint’ after Asking Them to Press Happy or Sad Face Emoji,” *Independent*, 2 September 2017, <http://www.independent.co.uk/news/uk/home-news/sports-direct-sad-happy-face-emoji-unite-steve-turner-nottingham-protest-mike-ashley-work-conditions-a7925401.html>; House of Commons, Employment Practices at Sports Direct, Business, Innovation and Skills Committee (July 21 2016), https://publications.parliament.uk/pa/cm201617/cmselect/cmbis/219/21902.htm?utm_source=219&utm_medium=fullbullet&utm_campaign=modulereports7; Sports Direct International plc, Reports and Presentations, <http://www.sportsdirectplc.com/investor-relations/reports-and-presentations/rp-2017.aspx>.

Case Incident 2 Active Cultures

Employees at many successful companies start the day by checking the economic forecast. Patagonia's Ventura, California, employees start the day by checking the surf forecast. The outdoor clothing company encourages its workforce to take time from the workday to get outside and get active. For Patagonia, linking employees with the natural environment is a major part of the culture.

New hires are introduced to this mindset very quickly. Soon after starting at Patagonia, marketing executive Joy Howard was immediately encouraged to go fly fishing, surfing, and rock climbing all around the world. She notes that all this vacationing is not just playing around—it's an important part of her job. "I needed to be familiar with the products we market," she said. Other practices support this outdoors-oriented, healthy culture. The company has an on-site organic café featuring locally grown produce. Employees at all levels are encouraged through an employee discount program to try out activewear in the field. And highly flexible hours ensure that employees feel free to take the occasional afternoon off to catch the waves or get out of town for a weekend hiking trip.

Are there bottom-line benefits to this organizational culture? Some corporate leaders think so. As Neil Blumenthal, one of the founders of Warby Parker eyewear, observes, "[T]hey've shown that you can build a profitable business while thinking about the environment and thinking about your team and community." As Patagonia CEO Rose Marcario says, "People recognize Patagonia as a company that's ... looking at business through a more holistic lens other than profit." However, she is quick to add, "Profit is important; if it wasn't you wouldn't be talking to me."

Patagonia's culture obviously makes for an ideal workplace for some people—but not for others who don't share its values. People who are just not outdoor types would likely feel excluded. While the unique mission and values of Patagonia may not be for everyone, for its specific niche in the product and employment market, the culture fits like a glove.

Questions ★

15-16. What do you think are the key dimensions of culture that make Patagonia successful?

How does the organization help to foster this culture?

15-17. Does Patagonia use strategies to build its culture that you think could work for other

companies? Is the company a useful model for others that aren't so tied to a lifestyle? Why or why not?

15-18. What are the drawbacks of Patagonia's culture? Might it sometimes be a liability and, if so, in what situations?

Sources: Based on J. Murphy, "At Patagonia, Trying New Outdoor Adventures Is a Job Requirement," *Wall Street Journal*, March 10, 2015, <http://www.wsj.com/articles/at-patagonia-trying-new-outdoor-adventures-is-a-job-requirement-1425918931>; B. Schulte, "A Company That Profits as It Pampers Workers," *Washington Post*, October 25, 2014, http://www.washingtonpost.com/business/a-company-that-profits-as-it-pampers-workers/2014/10/22/d3321b34-4818-11e4-b72e-d60a9229cc10_story.html; and D. Baer, "Patagonia CEO: 'There's No Way I Should Make One Decision Based on Quarterly Results,'" *Business Insider*, November 19, 2014, <http://www.businessinsider.com/patagonia-ceo-interview-2014-11>.

MyLab Management Writing Assignments

If your instructor has assigned this activity, go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management for the following assisted-graded writing assignments:

15-19. From your reading of Case Incident 1, would you typify the culture as being functional or dysfunctional? Explain your view.

15-20. Refer again to Case Incident 2. What might Patagonia do to reinforce its culture even further?

15-21. MyLab Management only—additional assisted-graded writing assignment.

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End of Chapter Quiz

Test Your Understanding

1 Alessio's boss doesn't care whether Alessio works at home, at the office, or from his beach house. All he cares about is that the project is completed on time, on budget, and with exemplary quality. Which characteristic of organizational culture best describes this aspect of Alessio's job?

- ☐ low risk-taking
- ☐ high outcome orientation
- ☐ high attention to detail
- ☐ low aggressiveness

Check answer

Reset

2 Which of the following characteristics of an organization's culture indicates the degree to which management decisions take into consideration the effect of outcomes on employees within the organization?

- ☐ attention to detail
- ☐ outcome orientation
- ☐ team orientation
- ☐ people orientation

Check answer

Reset

3 Which of the following statements is not true regarding subcultures?

- Subcultures include core values of the organization.
- Subcultures typically exist within a department.
- When we talk about an organization's culture, we are referring to its subculture.
- If organizations were composed only of numerous subcultures, organizational culture as an independent variable would be significantly

less powerful.

Check answer

Reset

4 Trends Inc. is an apparel company. To keep up with the latest changes in the fashion industry, the company has to come up with innovative designs and follow strict time lines. The culture of the company values aggressiveness, innovation, and risk-taking. The members of the organization accept these cultural values. They know exactly what is expected of them and these expectations go a long way in shaping their behavior. In addition to this, the culture of the marketing department is outcome oriented, and the finance department emphasizes attention to detail. Aggressiveness, innovation, and risk-taking are the _____ of the culture of Trends Inc.

- ☐ foundational values
- ☐ institutional traits
- ☐ core values
- ☐ significant traits

Check answer

Reset

5 Which of the following statements is true regarding the functions of culture in an organization?

- ☐ It hinders the generation of commitment to something larger than individual self-interest.
- ☐ It conveys a sense of identity for organization members.
- ☐ It reduces the stability of the social system.
- ☐ It reduces distinctions between one organization and others.

Check answer

Reset

6 Janice works for a pet store where everyone is committed to the happiness of the animals. Often employees, bosses, and hourly workers alike, come into the store “off the clock” and spend time training the animals. Everyone loves the store, the animals, and their jobs. This attitude of her coworkers inspires Janice to do her best. Based on this information, we can say that Janice is experiencing the effects of _____.

- ☐ decentralization
- ☐ organizational climate
- ☐ high departmentalization
- ☐ high formalization

Check answer

Reset

7 In recent years, _____ has become the primary concern in acquisitions and mergers.

- cultural compatibility

- ☐ employee diversity
- ☐ financial advantage
- ☐ product synergy

Check answer

Reset

8 Your first day at work is part of the _____ stage of socialization.

- ☐ orientation
- ☐ pre-arrival
- ☐ encounter
- ☐ metamorphosis

Check answer

Reset

9 The _____ stage of the socialization process explicitly recognizes that each individual that the organization comes across during the selection process has a set of values, attitudes, and expectations about both the work to be done and the organization.

- ☐ post-encounter
- ☐ pre-arrival
- ☐ metamorphosis
- ☐ pre-encounter

Check answer

Reset

10 New employees are usually comfortable with their organizations by the end of the _____ stage of socialization.

- ☐ encounter
- ☐ post-arrival
- ☐ establishment
- ☐ metamorphosis

Check answer

Reset

11 Nunya employees are allowed to dress informally. This is an example of a _____ through which organizational culture is transmitted.

- ☐ story
- ☐ ritual
- ☐ material symbol
- ☐ symbolic act

Check answer

Reset

12 Nunya is a computer software company that employs highly intelligent, but somewhat unusual people. Every Friday, free lollipops, toys, or other treats are given out to encourage employees to remember how creative they were when they were children. All the new members of the organization are told about the founders who were three young people who “got lucky” and sold a video game that they invented. The employees are allowed to dress informally and can set their own working hours. Informing employees about the founders is an example of which technique for transmitting culture?

- ☐ stories
- ☐ material symbols
- ☐ language
- ☐ rituals

Check answer

Reset

13 Company chants are examples of _____.

- ☐ rituals
- ☐ material symbols
- ☐ stories
- ☐ company policies

Check answer

Reset

14 Larry has an employee who is amazing at clearly seeing rules and enforcing them. He has recently promoted her to the lead position in quality assurance. Which aspect of creating a positive organizational culture is Larry utilizing?

- rewarding more than punishing
- building on organization strengths
- encouraging intense competition
- building on employee strengths

Check answer

Reset

15 A positive culture recognizes the difference between _____.

- ☐ a good employee and a poor employee
- ☐ a job and a career
- ☐ a reward and a punishment
- ☐ a manager and a leader

Check answer

Reset

Human Resources Policies and Practices



Source: Stephen Lam/Reuters/Alamy Stock Photo

Learning Objectives

After studying this chapter, you should be able to:

- 16-1** Describe the value of recruitment methods.
- 16-2** Specify initial selection methods.
- 16-3** Identify the most useful substantive selection methods.

16-4 Compare the main types of training.

16-5 List the methods of performance evaluation.

16-6 Describe the leadership role of human resources (HR) in organizations.

Employability Skills Matrix (ESM)

	Myth or Science?	Career Objectives	An Ethical Choice	Point/Counterpoint	Experiential Exercise	Ethical Dilemma
Critical Thinking		✓	✓		✓	✓
Communication		✓			✓	
Collaboration					✓	
Knowledge Application and Analysis	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓
Social Responsibility			✓	✓		✓

MyLab Management Chapter Warm Up

If your professor has assigned this activity, go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management to complete the chapter warm up.

An Unusual Perk

What perk could help tech companies attract female employees? Paid maternity leave? Onsite day care? What about the ability to delay having children altogether?

One of the biggest challenges for tech companies is attracting and retaining female employees. In a field that requires creativity, many Silicon Valley companies are trying to take advantage of the innovative edge that comes from having a more gender-diverse workforce. Unfortunately, even with a competitive maternity leave policy, much of the female workforce may have trouble having kids in their late twenties and early thirties while juggling a career in such a competitive market. This can put career women in a difficult spot because the most crucial part of their careers may also be their most fertile years.

CEO Mark Zuckerberg of Facebook, pictured here, wants to give female employees more options. In 2014, Facebook had one of the most generous benefits packages for parents, even by Silicon Valley standards. New parents received four months of paid maternity leave as well as a \$4,000 bonus. Expectant mothers could also use onsite care facilities for all their health care needs. Yet Zuckerberg thought he could do more. The Facebook founder expanded employees' health benefits by covering the cost of extracting and freezing eggs. By freezing their eggs, career-oriented Facebook employees could postpone having children until their careers slowed down without risking infertility in their thirties.

Like many things related to Facebook, Zuckerberg's announcement started a trend. Facebook continues to pay for egg freezing for their female employees, as does Apple and many other tech companies in Silicon Valley. By 2017, egg freezing had spread across the pond. CARE Fertility, one of the largest fertility companies in the United Kingdom, announced that they had been contacted by several different British companies about offering their employees egg freezing.

Egg freezing is just one of many unusual perks that companies in Silicon Valley cover for their employees. Apple provides employees with free concerts, transportation, an online wellness center, and even an unlimited supply of their namesake fruit. The tech start-up Asana gives employees \$10,000 to custom-furnish their offices. Dropbox employees get access to free laundry service and dinners with an open bar, costing the company up to \$25,000 for each employee. Yet Google reigns supreme for employee perks, with nap pods, a concierge service for errands, a free cafeteria, and over 30 cafés.

Why would companies pay for benefits that cut into their profits? After all, egg freezing alone costs about \$20,000 for each employee that takes advantage of the program. Many companies use unusual perks to attract talent. In areas with a labor shortage, such as Silicon

Valley, offering such perks improves the chances that a top candidate will accept a job offer. On a broader level, these benefits can enhance an organization's culture. Free dinners can build camaraderie. Concierge services and nap pods can reduce employee stress. Some of these nonessential benefits (free meals, custom offices) can also improve satisfaction. And when employees are satisfied with their jobs, they're more likely to stay, saving the company turnover costs.

Sources: Based on B. Molina and E. Weise, "Apple, Facebook to Pay for Women to Freeze Eggs," *USA Today*, October 14, 2014, <https://www.usatoday.com/story/tech/2014/10/14/apple-facebook-eggs/17240953/>; C. Purtill, "Silicon Valley's Newest Trend Is Realizing Its Most Insane Perks Aren't Sustainable," *Quartz Media*, May 10, 2016, <https://qz.com/679889/silicon-valleys-newest-trend-is-realizing-its-most-insane-perks-arent-sustainable/>; A. Robinson, "Egg Freezing Offered as Perk to Female Employees," *Sky News*, April 24, 2017, <http://news.sky.com/story/egg-freezing-offered-as-perk-to-female-employees-10848413>; and L. Bradford, "13 Tech Companies That Offer Cool Work Perks," *Forbes*, July 27, 2016, <https://www.forbes.com/sites/laurencebradford/2016/07/27/13-tech-companies-that-offer-insanely-cool-perks/#165aa9c679d1>.

The message of this chapter is that human resources (HR) policies and practices—such as employee recruitment, selection, training, and performance management—influence an organization's effectiveness.¹ Studies show that managers—even HR managers—often don't know which HR practices work and which don't, so they constantly experiment with techniques ranging from free tuition to stress-based interviews. Let's discuss both new and tried-and-true methods, and their effect on Organizational Behavior (OB), beginning with the recruitment function.

Recruitment Practices

16-1 Describe the value of recruitment methods.

The first stage in any HR program is recruiting, closely followed by selection. A selection system can only be as good as the individuals who apply in the first place.² Strategic recruiting has become a cornerstone for many companies, in which recruiting practices are developed in alignment with long-term strategic goals. As for defining “success” in recruiting, most research suggests that the best system attracts candidates who are highly knowledgeable about the job and the organization.³ Such candidates are likely to have a better fit between their skills and the job requirements, and to be more satisfied in the jobs they take. Consistent with these findings, some of the most effective recruiting techniques include internal referrals, internship programs, and other methods that give potential applicants enough information to adequately evaluate the roles they may be occupying.

Companies are increasingly turning away from outside recruiting agencies and relying on their own executives and HR professionals for talent searches.⁴ The most effective recruiters—internal or external—are well informed about the job, are efficient in communicating with potential recruits, and treat recruits with consideration and respect.⁵ In addition, it is very important that internal recruiters use fair and just practices while recruiting employees because fairness perceptions are related to job offer acceptance.⁶ Recruiters also use a variety of online tools, including job boards and social media, to bring in applications. Online recruiting has yielded an exponentially increased number of applications, even as the means to identify the best online recruitment sources are still developing.⁷ Social-networking services have facilitated many connections. Some organizations are pioneering unique methods, such as online programming contests that masquerade as games, to identify individuals with top skill sets who may be attracted to apply for positions. These contests have been successful for recruiting applicants from all over the globe.⁸

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

16.1.1 The best recruitment systems attract candidates who are highly knowledgeable about the job and which other key area?

- ☐ the organization
- ☐ the competition
- ☐ the recruitment process
- ☐ themselves

Check answer

Reset

16.1.2 Which of the following is an important attribute for the most effective internal recruiters?

- ☐ ability to use unfair practices
- ☐ lack of knowledge about the specific job role
- ☐ efficient communication
- ☐ ability to treat potential recruits disrespectfully

Check answer

Reset

Selection Practices

16-2 Specify initial selection methods.

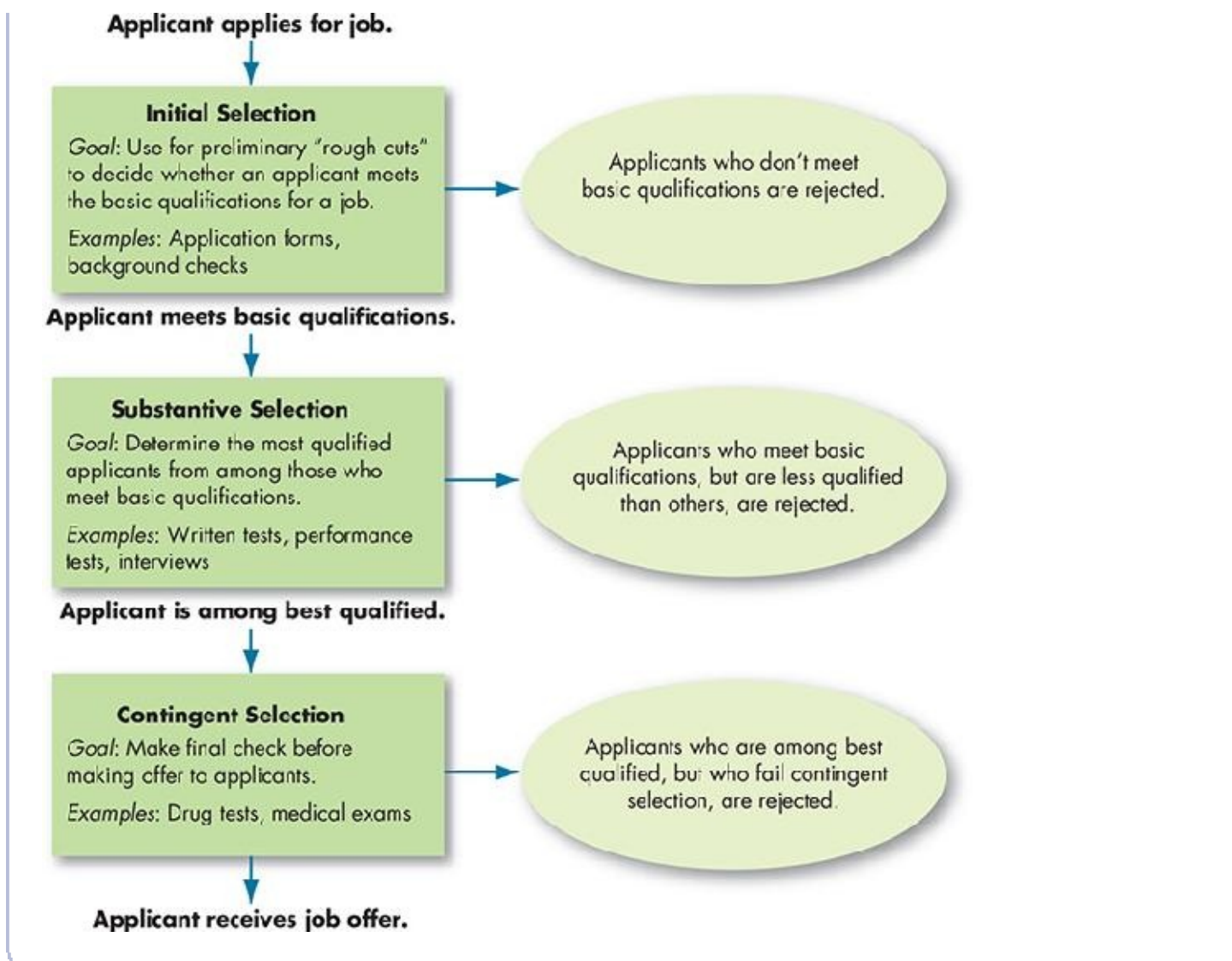
One of the most important HR functions is hiring the right people. When companies hire the right people, they increase their human capital resources. **Human capital resources** ⓘ are the capacities available to an organization through its employees.⁹ The resources include specialized skills, collective knowledge, abilities, and other resources available through an organization's workforce.

How do you figure out who the right people are from all the candidates? Identifying the top candidates is the objective of the selection process, which matches individual characteristics (ability, experience, and so on) with the requirements of the job.¹⁰ When management fails to get a proper match, employee performance and satisfaction both suffer. With more applications than ever coming in, it is paramount to ensure that your organization has an effective method for identifying the most qualified applicants. Technology has come a long way in a short time, but its recruiting uses are not yet streamlined. Technology that sorts through applications to find the unique combinations of traits and experience needed for the job is not enough; you are looking for top performers. Even technology to inform applicants of their status in the hiring process is not universally operational.¹¹

How the Selection Process Works

Exhibit 16-1 shows how the selection process works in most organizations. Having decided to apply for a job, applicants go through several stages—three are shown in the exhibit—during which they can be rejected at any time. In practice, organizations often forego some of these steps in the interest of saving time. (For example, a meatpacking plant may hire anyone who walks in the door because there are not many people who want to “thread” a pig's intestines for a living.) But most organizations follow a process that looks something like this exhibit. Let's go into a bit more detail about each stage.

Exhibit 16-1 Model of Selection Process in Organizations



Initial Selection

Initial selection devices are used for preliminary rough cuts to decide whether the applicant meets the basic qualifications for a job. Application forms and résumés (including letters of recommendation) are initial selection devices. Background checks are either an initial selection device or a contingent selection device, depending on how the organization handles them. Some organizations prefer to look into an applicant's background right away. Others wait until the applicant is about to be hired, contingent on everything else checking out. Still others seem to barely check anything, instead hiring friends and family. This practice is controversial partly because it thwarts the workplace diversity that can increase organizational performance.¹²

Application Forms You have no doubt submitted your fair share of applications. By itself,

the information submitted on an application form is not a very useful predictor of performance. However, it can be a good initial screen. For example, there's no sense spending time interviewing an applicant for a registered nurse position if he doesn't have the proper credentials (education, certification, experience). Managers must be careful about the questions they ask on applications, though. Obviously, questions about race, gender, and nationality are disallowed. However, other questions also put companies in legal jeopardy. For example, applications should not inquire about marital status, dependents, and family obligations.



Many organizations encourage applicants to apply online. It takes them only a few minutes, and the form can be forwarded easily to the people responsible for making the hiring decision. Most major corporations have a career page on their websites where prospective employees can search for available positions by location or job type and then apply online. These days, you are more likely to e-mail or upload your résumé than send anything by mail, and applicants sometimes create video résumés. Candidate preferences are constantly changing. Research in the Netherlands suggested that applicants from minority ethnic groups (in this case, Turkish and Moroccan) preferred the personal nature of the video résumé.¹³

Employers are asking for photos with applicant submissions more often, and some are then scanning the photo with facial-recognition software to match the face to the applicant's home address, Social Security number, criminal record, and affiliations. While this seems like a good business practice, experts recommend against it, unless the business operates in a high-security environment, because applicants can claim discrimination based on their facial characteristics.¹⁴ In addition, many minority applicants may want to conceal their race to avoid discrimination in the selection process. In fact, unless an organization indicates that they value diversity, many minority applicants may “whiten” their résumés to reduce discrimination.¹⁵

When you are the candidate, be careful about what you put on your online applications. Many HR departments, faced with an overwhelming number of electronic submissions, are using software to preselect candidates based on keyword matches between applications and the qualifications needed for the job. Their software often seeks to screen out unacceptable candidates rather than select potentially good ones. While you will want to incorporate all the keywords that accurately describe your experience, including paid and volunteer work,¹⁶ and

use whatever prompts you are given to outline the personal characteristics that qualify you, be careful not to overstate.¹⁷

Background Checks More than 80 percent of employers conduct both employment and personal reference checks on applicants at some point in the hiring process. The reason is obvious: They want to know how an applicant did in past jobs and whether former employers would recommend hiring the person. The problem is that former employers rarely provide useful information. In fact, nearly two-thirds refuse to give detailed references because they are afraid of being sued for saying something bad about a former employee. Although this concern is often unfounded (employers are safe as long as they stick to documented facts, and several states have passed laws protecting truthful information provided in reference checks), in our litigious society, most employers play it safe. The result is a paradox: Most employers want reference information, but few will give it out. Employers do call personal references for a more candid idea of the applicant; however, research found that 30 percent of hiring managers regularly discovered references that were false or misleading.¹⁸ Some organizations have turned to reference-checking software that sends 10-minute surveys to references. Research indicates this new technology may result in better (more objective) information.¹⁹

Letters of recommendation are another form of background check. These aren't as useful as they may seem. Applicants select references who will write positive things about them, so almost all letters of recommendation are positive. In the end, readers either ignore them or read "between the lines" to try to find hidden meaning.

Many employers search for candidates online through a general Internet search or through a targeted search of social-networking sites. The legality of this practice has come into question, but there is no doubt that many employers include an electronic search to see whether candidates have any history that might make them a dubious choice for employment. For some potential employees, an embarrassing or incriminating photo circulated through Facebook may make it hard to get a job. A study found that independent raters viewing candidate Facebook profiles were able to accurately determine candidate conscientiousness, agreeability, and intelligence that later translated into predictable job performance scores as rated by supervisors.²⁰ More recent research found that recruiters' ratings did not predict job performance and turnover beyond normal selection and screening measures (e.g., traditional personality measures). Ratings of social media also reflected bias toward white and female

candidates.²¹

Some employers check credit histories. A bank hiring tellers, for example, would probably want to know about a candidate's credit history, but credit checks are increasingly being used for nonbanking jobs. There is some evidence in favor of this practice. Task performance, organizational citizenship behavior (OCB), and conscientiousness (which is a predictor of job performance, see Chapter 5) were found to be positively related to credit scores.²² However, the consistency of the links is questioned—research also found that minority status was adversely related to credit scores, while age and educational attainment were positively related.²³ Because of discrimination concerns and the invasive nature of credit checks, employers must be sure there is a need for them.

Some employers conduct criminal background checks. Currently, 65 million U.S. adults (one in four) have criminal records, and for many it is difficult or impossible to find work.²⁴ The Equal Employment Opportunity Commission (EEOC) states that candidates cannot be denied employment based only on the findings of background checks, and experts point out that the checks are often inaccurate anyway. Also, because job candidates are seldom told why they are turned down, individuals can be hurt without having the opportunity for correction.²⁵ When given a chance to explain a conviction, many applicants are able to redeem themselves in the eyes of recruiters.²⁶ To complicate matters further, a criminal history can legally be used for rejection only if the violation relates to the job (an embezzler could be disqualified for jobs in finance, but not in, say, the medical field).²⁷ A civil rights movement has sought to ban employers from even asking applicants whether they have criminal convictions.

Background checks are usually but not always necessary, with interesting outcomes. Notably, some companies deliberately set out to hire applicants who wouldn't pass background checks, like those with criminal backgrounds. These organizations value second chances in their cultures and report that many of these workers become valuable contributors to their organizations and society. Such hires are not without risk, however, and they must be carefully managed.²⁸ Although it would seem best that employers refrain from conducting criminal background checks, *not* checking can carry a legal cost if an employee with a record commits a crime while on the job.

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

16.2.1 Which of the following is most likely to be an initial selection device?

- ☐ technical interview
- ☐ drug test
- ☐ written test
- ☐ background check

Check answer

Reset

16.2.2 Stefan is looking for a job. Today he went to the Web site of Qriosity Inc., where he filled out an online application and attached a copy of his CV. In which part of the selection process is Stefan?

- ☐ physical selection
- ☐ job offer
- ☐ initial selection
- ☐ contingent selection

Check answer

Reset

Substantive and Contingent Selection

16-3 Identify the most useful substantive selection methods.

If an applicant passes the initial screens, next are substantive selection methods. These selection methods are at the heart of the selection process and include written tests, performance-simulation tests, and interviews. We will discuss these and contingent selection tests, which are usually issued to candidates who pass the substantive tests.



At this Sarku Japan fast-food restaurant, employees applying for management positions must take written tests as part of the company's substantive selection process. Written tests for intelligence, integrity, personality, and interests are popular selection devices that help predict which applicants will be successful on the job.

Source: Michael S. Williamson/The Washington Post/Getty Images

Written Tests

Long popular as selection devices, written employment tests—called paper-and-pencil tests, although most are now available online—declined in use between the late 1960s and mid-1980s, especially in the United States. They were frequently characterized as discriminatory,

and many organizations had not validated them as job-related. Since then, however, there has been a resurgence, and today most organizations have at least considered using one or more tests.²⁹ Managers recognize that valid tests can help predict who will be successful on the job.³⁰ Applicants, however, tend to view written tests as less valid and fair than interviews or performance tests.³¹ Typical tests include (1) intelligence or cognitive ability tests, (2) personality tests, and (3) integrity tests.



Intelligence or Cognitive Ability Tests Tests of intellectual ability/cognitive

ability/intelligence (the terms are sometimes used interchangeably), spatial and mechanical ability, perceptual accuracy, and motor ability have long proven valid predictors for the performance of many skilled, semiskilled, and unskilled operative jobs.³² Overall, intelligence tests have proven to be particularly good predictors for jobs that include cognitively complex tasks (like learning the ever-more-complicated playbooks in the National Football League).³³ Many experts say intelligence tests are the *single best* selection measure across jobs and that they are at least as valid in the European Union (EU) as in the United States.³⁴ While cognitive ability tests have long been considered to measure a single, unified cognitive capacity, some recent work suggests that they may be useful tests for different specific abilities depending on the requirements of a job.³⁵ For example, differentiating mathematical, verbal, and technical abilities in hiring processes may lead to better predictions of job performance than relying on just one overall cognitive ability score.



Personality Tests Personality tests are inexpensive and simple to administer, and

their use has grown. However, concerns about applicants faking responses remain, partly because it's fairly easy to claim to be hard-working, motivated, and dependable when asked in a job application setting even if that's not accurate, and partly because applicants aren't always aware they are faking.³⁶ One study of Croatian university students suggested that individuals can be partially successful in faking a desirable profile.³⁷ Another study in China indicated that including warning messages for potential faking behavior with the tests may help curb the behavior.³⁸ Two reviews comparing self-reported personality to observer-rated personality found that observer ratings are better predictors of job performance and other behaviors.³⁹ Thus, employers might want to consider adding messages about the need for truthfulness in personality tests and asking employment references about an applicant's

personality as part of the screening process.

Integrity Tests As ethical problems in organizations have increased, integrity tests have gained popularity. These paper-and-pencil tests measure factors such as dependability, carefulness, responsibility, and honesty. They have proven to be powerful predictors of job performance (as measured as objectively as possible by supervisors) and of the potential for theft, discipline problems, and excessive absenteeism.⁴⁰ However, the many available tests do not all predict job performance outcomes equally well. Managers must be careful to choose one that measures ethical criteria matched to the job responsibilities.⁴¹

Performance-Simulation Tests

What better way to find out whether applicants can do a job successfully than by having them do it? That's precisely the logic of performance-simulation tests. Although they are more complicated to develop and administer than standardized tests, performance-simulation tests have higher *face validity* (the measurement of whether applicants perceive the measures to be accurate), and their popularity has increased. Predictive simulations are commonly available through work samples, assessment centers, situational judgment tests, and realistic job previews.

Work Sample Tests **Work sample tests** ⓘ are hands-on simulations of part or all the work that workers in the job routinely must perform. Each work sample element is matched with a job-performance element to measure applicants' knowledge, skills, and abilities with more specificity than written aptitude and personality tests.⁴² Work samples are widely used in the hiring of skilled workers such as welders, machinists, carpenters, and electricians. Work sample tests are increasingly used for all levels of employment.

Assessment Centers A more elaborate set of performance-simulation tests, specifically designed to evaluate a candidate's managerial potential, is administered in **assessment centers** ⓘ. Line executives, supervisors, and/or trained psychologists evaluate candidates as they go through one to several days of exercises that simulate real problems they would confront on the job.⁴³ For example, a candidate might be required to play the role of a manager who must decide how to respond to 10 memos in an in-basket within a 2-hour period. Assessment centers are good predictors of performance; however, some debate their

validity because ratings may be confounded by many factors. For example, the results of assessment center exercises may be affected by whether it is easy for applicants to guess the traits needed to perform well or by the disposition of role players.⁴⁴

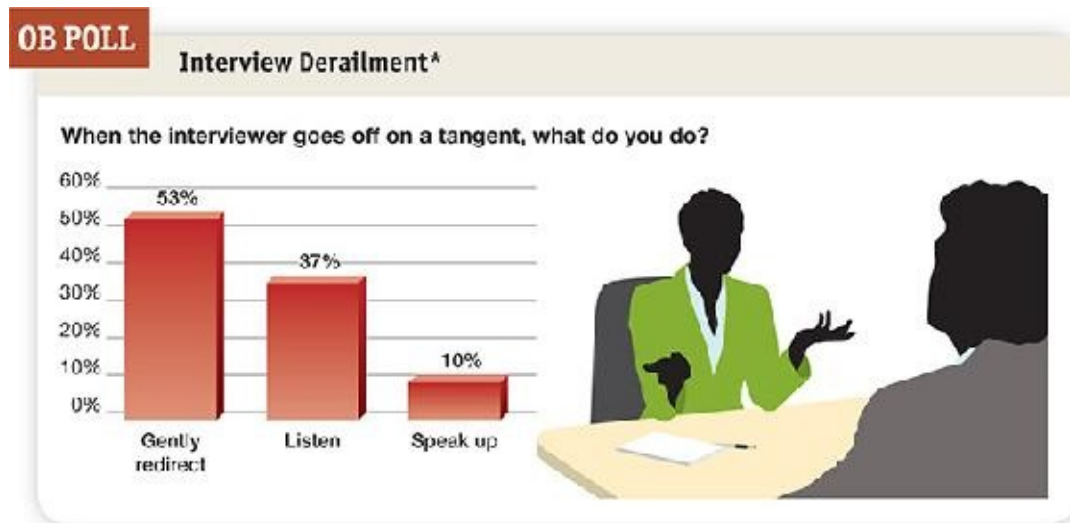
Situational Judgment Tests To reduce the costs of job simulations, many organizations have started to use **situational judgment tests** ⓘ, which ask applicants how they would perform in a variety of job situations and then compare their answers to the answers of high-performing employees.⁴⁵ Coaching can improve scores on these tests, though, which raises questions about whether they reflect true judgment or merely good test preparation.⁴⁶ One study comparing situational judgment tests to assessment centers found the assessment centers were a better predictor of job performance, although the difference was not large.⁴⁷ Ultimately, the lower cost of the situational judgment test may make it a better choice for some organizations than a more elaborate work sample or assessment center experience.

Realistic Job Previews Employers are increasingly using work sample methods that go beyond assessment testing into the realm of actual work performed and evaluated. These are sometimes known as **realistic job previews** ⓘ or job tryouts, and they are given as a way to assess talent versus experience. Experts are finding that they also decrease turnover because both employers and new hires know what they are getting into ahead of time.⁴⁸ When George McAfee applied for a vice president position in the tech industry, he was required to give presentations, conduct research, and hold talks with executives about their ongoing business concerns for over a week, all unpaid. He felt the employer was taking advantage of his free labor, but he said, “You just have to accept that and not be offended.”⁴⁹ HR managers may risk losing qualified candidates who object to this extensive job test and withdraw from the process. Those who identify with an organization’s mission, people, or products will be less likely to withdraw, suggesting that HR managers should seek to engage candidates with the organization early in the selection process.⁵⁰

Interviews

Of all the selection devices that organizations around the globe use to differentiate candidates, the interview has always been a standard practice. It also tends to have a disproportionate amount of influence. Overreliance on interviews is problematic because extensive evidence shows that impression management techniques (see Chapter 13) such as

self-promotion have a strong effect on interviewer preferences even when the displayed traits are unrelated to the job.⁵¹ Conversely, the candidate who performs poorly in the employment interview is likely to be cut from the applicant pool regardless of experience, test scores, or letters of recommendation. And unfortunately, candidates can be rated lower for something as trivial as a blemish on their faces, one study found.⁵²



* Note: Based on a survey of 150 job candidates.

Source: Based on J. Yang and P. Trap, *USA Today*, November 13, 2012, 1B.

Interviews are either structured or unstructured. The popular **unstructured interview** ⓘ—short, casual, and made up of random questions—is simply not a very effective selection device,⁵³ and it can easily derail into nonproductive conversation (see OB Poll). The data it gathers are typically biased and often only modestly related to future job performance. Still, managers are reluctant to use **structured interviews** ⓘ—planned interviews designed to gather job-related information—in place of their favorite questions, such as “If you could be any animal, what would you be, and why?” Structured interviews limit subjectivity as much as possible and therefore can provide more reliable responses. Harry West, CEO of innovation design firm Continuum, asks all candidates the same basic questions: “What is it you want to do? What is it that you’re good at? What is it that you’re not good at? Tell me about what you’ve done.” This is an excellent start in that the questions are objective in nature, prompt open-ended responses, and are standardized for all candidates.⁵⁴



Arcadio Cruz (left) uses a structured interview approach in gathering information from job applicants for positions at Orchard Hardware Supply store in Los Angeles. Questions asked in structured interviews are objective and standardized for all applicants and encourage open-ended responses.

Source: Patrick Fallon/Bloomberg/Getty Images

Without structure, interviewers tend to favor applicants who share their attitudes, give undue weight to negative information, and allow the order in which applicants are interviewed to influence their evaluations.⁵⁵ Structured interviews, on the other hand, reduce the extent to which interviewers are influenced by applicant appearance and impression management tactics, such as flattery and self-promotion.⁵⁶ To reduce bias and improve the validity of interviews, managers should adopt a standardized set of questions, a uniform method of recording information, and standardized ratings of applicants' qualifications. Training interviewers to focus on specific dimensions of job performance, practicing evaluation procedures of candidates, and giving *interviewers* feedback on how well they focused on job-relevant characteristics significantly improves the accuracy of their ratings,⁵⁷ although initial impressions from unstructured conversations at the beginning of an interview may still influence interviewer ratings.⁵⁸ Interview effectiveness also improves when employers use *behavioral structured interviews*, probably because these assessments are less influenced by interviewer biases.⁵⁹ These interviews require applicants to describe how they handled specific problems and situations in past jobs, based on the assumption that past

behavior offers the best predictor of future behavior. **Panel interviews** ⓘ—structured interviews conducted with a candidate and a number of panel members in a joint meeting—also minimize the influence of individual biases and have higher validity.

In practice, most organizations use interviews for a number of reasons. Companies as diverse as Southwest Airlines, Disney, Bank of America, Microsoft, Procter & Gamble, and Harrah's Entertainment use interviews to assess applicant–organization fit. In addition to evaluating specific, job-related skills, managers look at personality characteristics and personal values to find individuals who fit the organization's culture and image. Some companies also use job interviews as a recruiting tool, trying to “sell” applicants on the value of the job and organization. This strategy may sometimes be necessary because of a tight labor market, but it may also be problematic. One study showed that interviewers who were trying to promote the organization during interviews were significantly worse at identifying applicant personality traits and selection than those who focused exclusively on assessing candidate qualifications.⁶⁰

Contingent Selection Tests

If applicants pass the substantive selection methods, they are ready to be hired, contingent on final checks. One common contingent check is a drug test. Publix grocery stores make tentative offers to applicants contingent on their passing such a test as drug-free, as do many other organizations.

Drug testing is controversial. Many applicants think testing without reasonable suspicion is invasive or unfair and say that they should be tested on job-performance factors, not lifestyle choices that may not be relevant. Employers might counter that drug use and abuse are extremely costly, not just in financial terms but also in terms of people's safety. In the United States, they have the law on their side. The Supreme Court has concluded that drug tests are “minimally invasive” selection procedures that, as a rule, do not violate individuals' rights.

Under the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA), U.S. firms may not require employees to pass a medical exam before a job offer is made. However, they can conduct medical exams *after* making a contingent offer—but only to determine whether an applicant is physically or mentally able to do the job. Employers also sometimes use medical exams to find out whether and how they can accommodate employees with disabilities. For jobs requiring

exposure to heavy physical or psychological demands, such as air traffic controllers or firefighters, medical exams are obviously an important indicator of the ability to perform.

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

16.3.1 Which of the following have/has proven to be a particularly good predictor for jobs that include cognitively complex tasks?

- ☐ intelligence tests
- ☐ integrity evaluations
- ☐ work sampling
- ☐ drug tests

Check answer

Reset

16.3.2 Which of the following statements is most likely to be true regarding behavioral structured interviews?

- ☐ they are most useful when interviewing knowledge workers.
- ☐ they increase the effectiveness of the interview technique.
- ☐ they are conducted in a similar manner as audition-type interviews.
- ☐ they are useful only for interviewing nonskilled workers.

Check answer

Reset

Training and Development Programs

16-4 Compare the main types of training.

Competent employees don't remain competent forever. Skills deteriorate and can become obsolete, and new skills need to be learned. That's why corporations in the United States spend over \$70 billion annually, and organizations worldwide spend over \$130 billion annually, on training.⁶¹

Types of Training

Training and development programs are usually in the purview of HR departments. Training can include everything from teaching employees basic reading skills, improving executive leadership, helping employees become more accepting of diversity, and increasing work-life balance (discussed later in the chapter).⁶² Here, we discuss four general skill categories—basic skills, technical skills, problem-solving skills, and interpersonal skills—and civility and ethics training.

Basic Skills One survey of more than 400 HR professionals found that 40 percent of employers believe high school graduates lack basic skills in reading comprehension, writing, and math.⁶³ As work has become more sophisticated, the need for these basic skills has grown significantly, leading to a gap between employer demands for skills and the available skills in the workforce.⁶⁴ The challenge isn't unique to the United States; it's a worldwide problem, from the most developed countries to the least.⁶⁵ For many undeveloped countries, widespread illiteracy means there is almost no hope of competing in a global economy.

Organizations increasingly have to teach employees basic reading and math skills. These interventions can yield worthwhile improvements for the organization. In a classic example, a literacy audit showed that employees at gun manufacturer Smith & Wesson needed at least an eighth-grade reading level to do typical workplace tasks.⁶⁶ Yet 30 percent of the company's 676 workers with no degree scored below eighth-grade levels in either reading or math. After the first round of basic-skills classes, company-paid and on company time, 70 percent of attendees brought their skills up to the target level, allowing them to do a better job. They displayed increased abilities to use fractions and decimals; better overall

communication; greater ease in writing and reading charts, graphs, and bulletin boards; and a significant increase in confidence.

Technical Skills Most training is directed at upgrading and improving an employee's technical skills, which is increasingly important for two reasons: new technology and new structural designs in the organization.



As organizations flatten their structures, expand their use of teams, and break down traditional departmental barriers, employees need mastery of a wider variety of tasks and increased knowledge of how their organization operates. Indian companies and others have faced a dramatic increase in demand for skilled workers in areas like engineering for emerging technologies, but many recent engineering graduates lack up-to-date knowledge required to perform these technical tasks.⁶⁷ Many organizations offer technical training to bridge the gap. Companies like Tata and Wipro provide new hires with up to 3 months of training to ensure that they have the knowledge to perform the technical work demanded. In addition, these organizations are attempting to form partnerships with engineering schools to ensure that academic curricula meet the needs of contemporary employers.

Problem-Solving Skills Problem-solving training for managers and other employees can include activities to sharpen their logic, reasoning, and problem-defining skills as well as their ability to assess causation, develop and analyze alternatives, and select solutions. Problem-solving training has become part of almost every organizational effort to introduce self-managed teams or implement quality-management programs.

Interpersonal Skills Most employees belong to a work unit, and their work performance depends on their ability to interact effectively with their coworkers and bosses. Some employees have excellent interpersonal abilities, but others require training to improve listening, communicating, and team-building skills. Although many professionals are greatly interested in interpersonal skills training, most evidence suggests that skills learned in such training do not readily transfer to the workplace;⁶⁸ this may depend, however, on the type of skills taught in training. For example, a recent review of training specifically designed for improving interpersonal interactions among team members in hospitals suggests that team training improved patient outcomes.⁶⁹

Civility Training As HR managers have become increasingly aware of the effects of social behavior in the workplace, they have paid more attention to the problems of incivility, bullying, and abusive supervision in organizations. Examples of incivility include being ignored, being blamed for others' mistakes and receiving no credit for achievements, having one's reputation undermined in front of others, and experiencing other situations meant to demean or disparage an employee or others.⁷⁰ Researchers have shown that these forms of negative behavior can decrease satisfaction, reduce job performance, increase perceptions of unfair treatment, increase depression, and lead to psychological withdrawal from the workplace.⁷¹ Therefore, organizations are getting involved in reducing the incidence rate to improve their workplaces and limit their liability.



After receiving many complaints from patients about rude and insulting behavior from its nursing staff, hospital officials at a clinic in southern China hired flight attendants to give the nurses civility training. During a training intervention, nurses learned how to greet patients politely and care for them with grace, kindness, and patience.

Source: Europics/Newscom

Is there anything HR departments can do to minimize incivility, bullying, and abusive supervision? One possibility is training specifically targeted to building civility by holding directed conversations about it and supporting the reduction of incivility on an ongoing basis. Following one training intervention, civility, respect, job satisfaction, and trust increased,

while incivility, cynicism, and absences decreased.⁷² Thus, the evidence suggests that deliberate interventions to improve the workplace climate and foster positive behavior can indeed minimize the problems of incivility.

Ethics Training It is common for employees to receive ethics and values guidance incorporated in new-employee orientations, in ongoing developmental programs, or as periodic reinforcements of ethical principles.⁷³ But the jury is still out on whether you can actually teach ethics.⁷⁴ Critics argue that ethics are based on values, and value systems are learned by example at an early age. They say that by the time employees are hired, ethical values are fixed. In support, some research suggests ethics training does not have a significant long-term effect on participants' values and even that exposure to business and law school programs *decreases* students' level of prosocial ethical values.⁷⁵

Supporters of ethics training say values *can* be learned and changed after early childhood. And even if an individual's values can't be changed, ethics training helps employees recognize ethical dilemmas and become more aware of the ethical issues underlying their actions. It also reaffirms an organization's expectations that members will act ethically. Research has found that individuals who have greater exposure to organizational ethics codes and ethics training tend to be more satisfied and perceive their organizations as more socially responsible, so ethics training does have some positive effects.⁷⁶

Training Methods

Historically, *training* meant “formal training,” planned in advance and following a structured format. HR departments play a big role in this training. Formal training and development programs are in use, but much of the workplace learning takes place in *informal training*—unstructured, unplanned, and easily adapted for situations and individuals. In reality, most informal training is nothing other than employees helping each other, sharing information, and solving work-related problems together. Thus, many managers are now supportive of what used to be considered “idle chatter.”

Job Training *On-the-job training* methods include job rotation, apprenticeships, understudy assignments, and formal mentoring programs. U.S. companies have been increasingly using longer-term job rotations to train managers for higher positions and to foster collaboration.⁷⁷ But because on-the-job training methods often disrupt the workplace,

organizations also invest in *off-the-job training*. The \$130 billion figure we cited earlier for training was largely spent on the formal off-the-job variety, the most popular method being live classroom lectures. But it also encompasses public seminars, self-study programs, Internet courses, webinars, podcasts, and group activities that use role play and case studies. Larger organizations are increasingly building corporate universities to house formal training programs. The formal instruction given in the corporate university classes is often supplemented with informal online training.⁷⁸



Off-the-job training at Chrysler's World Class Manufacturing Academy includes hands-on and classroom learning for engineers and plant employees that teaches them how to reduce waste and increase productivity and quality. Shown here is an employee using a human motion capture system to learn how to analyze the movements of assembly-line workers.

Source: Jim West/Alamy Stock Photo

Computer-Based Training The fastest-growing training medium is computer-based training, or e-training or e-learning.⁷⁹ E-learning systems emphasize learner control over the pace and content of instruction, allow e-learners to interact through online communities, and incorporate other techniques such as simulations and group discussions. Computer-based training that lets learners actively participate in exercises and quizzes can be more effective than traditional classroom instruction.⁸⁰ Employers can improve computer-based training by providing learners with regular prompts to set goals for learning, effective study strategies,

and progress measurements toward the learning goals.⁸¹ Organizations are even exploring delivering e-training through microlessons, on-the-spot tips, and learning games sent to mobile devices.⁸²

Evaluating Effectiveness

The *effectiveness* of a training program can refer to the level of student satisfaction, the amount students learn, the extent to which they transfer the learned material to their jobs, and/or the company's financial return on investments in training.⁸³ These results are not always related. Some people who have a positive experience in an upbeat, fun class learn very little; some who learn a great deal have difficulty figuring out how to use their knowledge at work; and changes in employee behavior are sometimes not large enough to justify the expense of training. This means rigorous measurement of multiple training outcomes should be part of every training effort.

The success of training also depends on the individual. If individuals are unmotivated or not engaged, they will learn very little. What creates training motivation? Personality is important: Those with an internal locus of control, high conscientiousness, high cognitive ability, and high self-efficacy learn more. Other personal factors, such as stereotype threat, may play a role in training performance, like when a minority is doing a training task for the first time and performs poorly because he or she is aware of the stereotype that members of his or her ethnic group perform poorly at this type of task. The climate also is important: People need to see how the training they're receiving is directly applicable to their jobs. Finally, after-training support from supervisors and coworkers has a strong influence on whether employees transfer their learning into new behavior.⁸⁴ For a training program to be effective, it must not just teach the skills but also change the work environment to support the trainees.



Is there general evidence related to training, development practices, and organizational performance? A variety of studies show that investments in on-the-job training lead to increases in productivity of significantly greater value than the cost of providing the training.⁸⁵ Similarly, research indicated that cross-cultural training was effective in raising performance when the training was done after the person was working in a new country but not when the training was conducted before departure to a new country.⁸⁶ The climate for employee development has also been related to business unit performance.⁸⁷ For example,

one study of 260 companies in Korea found that training expenditures were positively related to corporate innovation.⁸⁸ Overall, most studies have shown that investments in training can indeed have positive effects at the aggregate level.

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

16.4.1 Your organization is situated in an urban area where many students do not finish high school. You will probably first have to address the skill category termed _____ skills.

- ☐ basic
- ☐ technical
- ☐ interpersonal
- ☐ problem-solving

Check answer

Reset

16.4.2 Most training is directed at upgrading and improving an employee's _____ skills.

- ☐ financial
- ☐ technical
- ☐ problem-solving
- ☐ interpersonal

Check answer

Reset

Performance Evaluation

16-5 List the methods of performance evaluation.

Would you study differently or exert a different level of effort for a college course graded on a pass–fail basis than for one that awarded letter grades A to F? Students typically tell us they study harder when letter grades are at stake. When they take a course on a pass–fail basis, they tend to do just enough to ensure a passing grade.

What applies in the college context also applies to employees at work. In this section, we show how the choice of a performance evaluation system and the way it's administered can influence employee behavior.

What Is Performance?

In the past, most organizations assessed only how well employees performed the tasks listed on a job description, but today's less hierarchical and more service-oriented organizations require more. Researchers now recognize three major types of behavior that constitute performance at work:

1. **Task performance.** ⓘ Performance of the duties and responsibilities that contribute to the production of a good or service, or to administrative tasks. These include most of the tasks in a conventional job description.
2. **Citizenship.** ⓘ Performance of actions that contribute to the psychological environment of the organization, such as helping others when not required, supporting organizational objectives, treating coworkers with respect, making constructive suggestions, and saying positive things about the workplace.
3. **Counterproductivity.** ⓘ Behavior that actively damages the organization, including stealing, damaging company property, acting aggressively toward coworkers, and taking avoidable absences.

Most managers believe that good performance means doing well on the first two dimensions and avoiding the third.⁸⁹ A person who does core job tasks very well but is rude and aggressive toward coworkers is not going to be considered a good employee in most

organizations, and the most pleasant and upbeat worker who can't do the main job tasks well is not going to be a good employee either.

Purposes of Performance Evaluation

Performance evaluation serves a number of purposes.⁹⁰ One is to help management make general *human resources decisions* about promotions, transfers, and terminations. Evaluations also *identify training and development needs*. They *pinpoint employee skills and competencies* for which remedial programs can be developed. Finally, they *provide feedback to employees* on how the organization views their performance and are often the *basis for reward allocations*, including merit pay increases.

Because our interest here is in OB, we emphasize the performance evaluation as a mechanism for providing feedback and determining reward allocations.

What Do We Evaluate?

The criteria that management chooses to evaluate has a major influence on what employees do. The three most popular sets of criteria are individual task outcomes, behaviors, and traits.

Individual Task Outcomes If ends count rather than means, management should evaluate on outcomes such as quantity produced, scrap generated, and cost per unit of production for a plant manager, or on overall sales volume in the territory, dollar increase in sales, and number of new accounts established for a salesperson.

Behaviors It is difficult to attribute specific outcomes to the actions of employees in advisory or support positions whose work assignments are part of a group effort. We may readily evaluate the group's performance, but if it is hard to identify the contribution of each group member, management will often evaluate the employee's behavior. A plant manager might be evaluated on promptness in submitting monthly reports or leadership style, and a salesperson on average number of contact calls made per day or helpfulness toward other sales representatives.

Measured behaviors needn't be limited to those directly related to individual productivity. As we pointed out in discussing OCB (see Chapters 1 and 3), helping others, making suggestions for improvements, and volunteering for extra duties make work groups and organizations more effective and often are incorporated into evaluations of employee

performance.

Traits Having a good attitude, showing confidence, being dependable, staying busy, or possessing a wealth of experience can be desirable in the workplace, but it's important to remember that these traits may not be highly correlated with positive task outcomes. However, we cannot ignore the reality that organizations still use such traits to assess job performance.



Behaviors such as helping children, assisting coworkers, and building trusting relationships with parents are important elements in evaluating the performance of employees working at this child day care center in Leipzig, Germany. These subjective factors add to the center's reputation as a high-quality, safe, and respectful organization.

Source: Waltraud Grubitzsch/dpa picture alliance/Alamy Stock Photo

Who Should Do the Evaluating?

Who should evaluate an employee's performance? By tradition, the task has fallen to managers because they are held responsible for their employees' performance. But others may do the job better, particularly with the help of HR departments.

With many of today's organizations using self-managed teams, telecommuting, and other formats that distance bosses from employees, the immediate superior may not be the most

reliable judge of an employee's performance. Peers and even subordinates are being asked to take part in the process, and employees are participating in their own evaluations. As you might expect, self-evaluations often suffer from overinflated assessment and self-serving bias, and they seldom agree with superiors' ratings.⁹¹ They are probably better suited to developmental than evaluative purposes.

In most situations, it is highly advisable to use multiple sources of ratings; any individual performance rating may say as much about the rater as about the person being evaluated. By averaging across raters, we can obtain a more reliable, unbiased, and accurate performance evaluation.

Another popular approach to performance evaluation is the use of 360-degree evaluations.⁹² These provide performance feedback from the employee's full circle of daily contacts, from subordinates to customers, to bosses, to peers (see Exhibit 16-2). The number of appraisals can be as few as 3 or 4 or as many as 25; most organizations collect 5 to 10 per employee.

Exhibit 16-2 360-Degree Evaluation



What's the appeal of the 360-degree appraisal? By relying on feedback from people who know the employee well in a variety of contexts, organizations hope to give everyone a sense of participation in the review process, increase employee accountability, and obtain more accurate readings on employee performance.



Evidence on its effectiveness is mixed.⁹³ The 360-degree evaluation provides employees with a wider perspective on their performance, but many organizations don't spend the time to train evaluators in giving constructive criticism. Some organizations allow employees to choose the peers and subordinates who evaluate them, which can artificially inflate positive feedback. There is a risk of giving too much weight to people who don't know much about the employee's actual performance. It's also difficult to reconcile disagreements between rater groups. There is clear evidence that peers tend to give much more lenient ratings than supervisors or subordinates and also to make more errors in appraising performance. A study of a 360-degree appraisal system in a mid-sized Chinese accounting firm found that employees manipulate their ratings of peers, giving better ratings to less qualified peers and poorer ratings to more qualified peers. This strategic approach means that promotional chances of more-qualified employees are not as good with 360-degree appraisal compared to traditional "top-down" schemes.⁹⁴ These evaluations may thus supplement an understanding of the consistency of an employee but should not supplant objective evaluations of performance.

Methods of Performance Evaluation

We've discussed *what* we evaluate and *who* should do the evaluating. Now we ask: "*How* do we evaluate an employee's performance? What are the specific techniques for evaluation?"

Written Essays Probably the simplest method is to write a narrative describing an employee's strengths, weaknesses, past performance, potential, and suggestions for improvement. The written essay requires no complex forms or extensive training to complete. But a written appraisal may be determined as much by the evaluator's writing skill as by the employee's actual level of performance. It's also difficult to compare essays for different employees (or for the same employees written by different managers) because there is no standardized scoring key.

Critical Incidents **Critical incidents** ⓘ focus the evaluator's attention on the difference between executing a job effectively and executing it ineffectively. The appraiser describes what the employee did that was especially effective or ineffective in a situation, citing only specific behaviors. A list of such critical incidents provides a rich set of examples to show the employee desirable behaviors that call for improvement.

Graphic Rating Scales One of the oldest and most popular methods of evaluation is the **graphic rating scale** ⓘ. The evaluator goes through a set of performance factors—such as quantity and quality of work, depth of knowledge, cooperation, attendance, and initiative—and rates each on incremental scales. The scales may specify, say, five points, where *job knowledge* might be rated 1 (“is poorly informed about work duties”) to 5 (“has complete mastery of all phases of the job”). Although they don't provide the depth of information that essays or critical incidents do, graphic rating scales are less time consuming to develop and administer, and they allow for quantitative analysis and comparison.

Behaviorally Anchored Rating Scales **Behaviorally anchored rating scales (BARS)** ⓘ combine major elements from the critical incident and graphic rating scale approaches. The appraiser rates employees on items along a continuum, but the items are examples of actual behavior on the job rather than general descriptions or traits. To develop the BARS, participants first contribute specific illustrations of effective and ineffective behavior, which are translated into a set of performance dimensions with varying levels of quality.

Forced Comparisons **Forced comparisons** ⓘ evaluate one individual's performance against the performance of another or others. It is a relative rather than an absolute measuring device. The two most popular comparisons are group order ranking and individual ranking.

Group order ranking ⓘ requires the evaluator to place employees into a particular classification, such as the top one-fifth or the second one-fifth. If a rater has 20 employees, only 4 can be in the top fifth, so, of course, 4 must also be relegated to the bottom fifth. This method is often used in recommending students to graduate schools.

The **individual ranking** ⓘ approach rank-orders employees from best to worst. If the manager is required to appraise 30 employees, the difference between the first and second employee is assumed to be the same as that between the twenty-first and twenty-second. Some employees may be closely grouped, but no ties are permitted. The result is a clear ordering from the highest performer to the lowest.

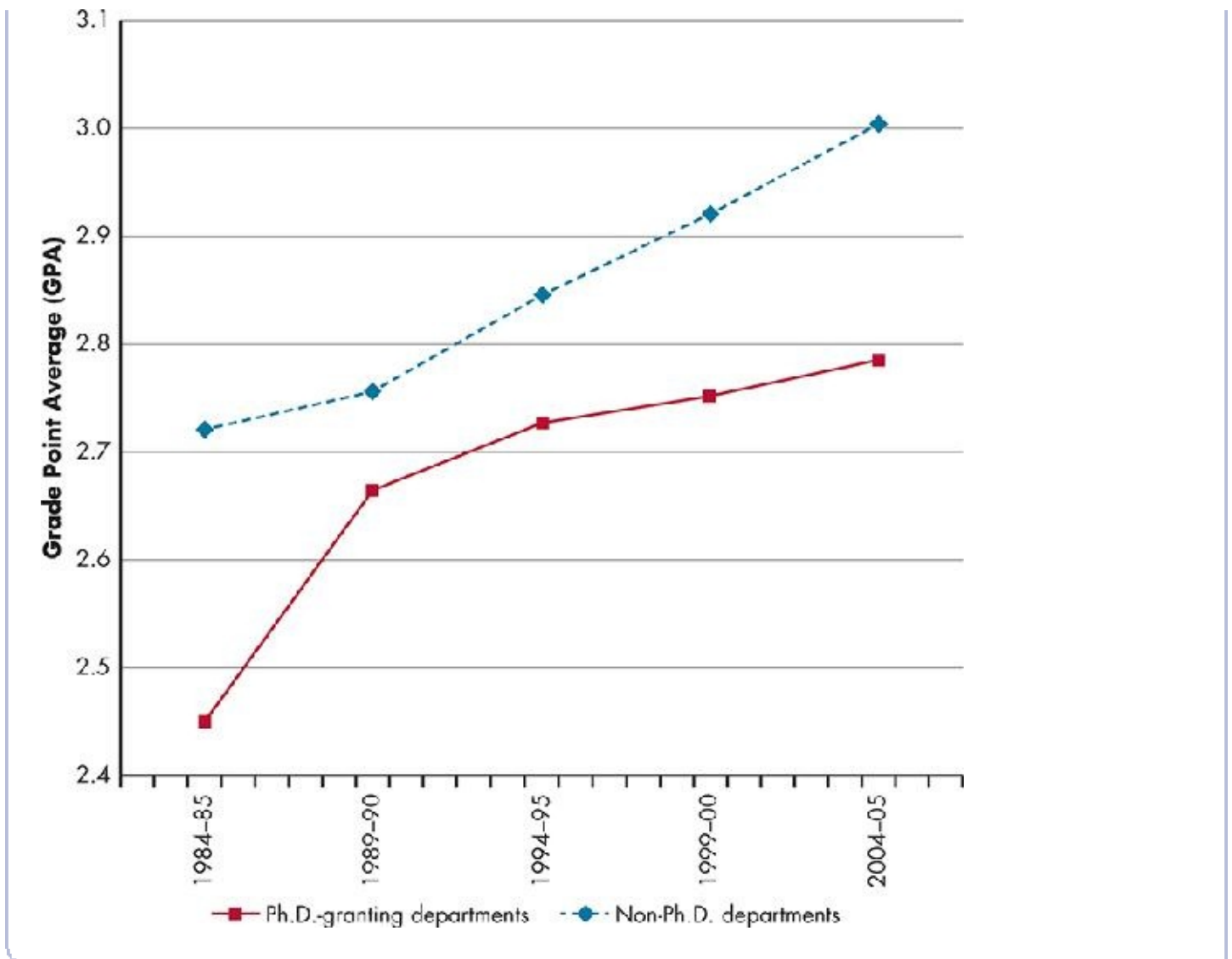
One parallel to forced ranking is forced distribution of college grades. As shown in Exhibit 16-3, average grade point averages (GPAs) have risen.⁹⁵ Although it is not clear exactly why, many attribute the rise to the popularity of student evaluations as a means of assessing professor performance (generous grades might produce higher student evaluations). It's also the case that higher grades can help students become more competitive candidates for graduate school and jobs.

In response to grade inflation, some colleges have instituted forced grade distributions, whereby professors must give a certain percentage of A's, B's, and C's. This is exactly what Princeton did; each department can give A's to no more than 35 percent of its students.

Improving Performance Evaluations

The performance evaluation process is a potential minefield. Evaluators can unconsciously inflate evaluations (positive leniency), understate performance (negative leniency), or allow the assessment of one characteristic to unduly influence the assessment of others (the halo error). Some appraisers bias their evaluations by unconsciously favoring people who have qualities and traits similar to their own (the similarity error). For example, introverts may rate extraverts lower on performance. And some evaluators see the evaluation process as a political opportunity to overtly reward or punish employees they like or dislike. One review on performance appraisals demonstrates that many managers deliberately distort performance ratings in order to maintain a positive relationship with their subordinates or to achieve a positive image of themselves by showing that all their employees are performing well.⁹⁶ Although no protections *guarantee* accurate performance evaluations, the following suggestions can make the process more objective and fair.

Exhibit 16-3 Median Grade Point Average (GPA) by Academic Year and Degree Level*



* Note: Study of GPA from 1,683 courses, 28 departments, and 3,176 instructors at a large public university.

Source: Based on R. Todd Jewell, M. A. McPherson, and M. A. Tieslau, “Whose Fault Is It? Assigning Blame for Grade Inflation in Higher Education,” *Applied Economics* 45 (2013): 1185–200.

Use Multiple Evaluators As the number of evaluators increases, the probability of attaining more accurate information increases, as does the likelihood that the employee will accept the feedback as valid.⁹⁷ We often see multiple evaluators in competitions in sports such as diving and gymnastics. A set of evaluators judges a performance, the highest and lowest scores are dropped, and the final evaluation is made up of those remaining. The logic of multiple evaluators applies to organizations as well. If an employee has ten supervisors, of whom nine rated her excellent and one poor, we can safely discount the one poor evaluation. By moving employees within the organization to gain a number of evaluations, or by using multiple assessors (as in 360-degree appraisals), we increase the probability of achieving

more valid and reliable evaluations.

Evaluate Selectively To increase agreement among evaluations, appraisers should evaluate the areas of performance for which they have working knowledge.⁹⁸ Appraisers should thus be as close as possible, in organizational level, to the individual being evaluated. The more levels that separate the evaluator from the employee, the less opportunity the evaluator has to observe the individual's behavior and therefore the greater the possibility for inaccuracies.

Train Evaluators If you can't *find* good evaluators, *make* them. Training can produce more accurate raters.⁹⁹ Most rater training courses emphasize changing the raters' frame of reference by teaching them what to look for, so everyone in the organization defines *good performance* in the same way. Another effective training technique is to encourage raters to describe the employee's behavior in as much detail as possible. Asking for more detail encourages raters to remember more about the employee's performance rather than just acting on their feelings about the employee at the moment.

Provide Employees with Due Process The concept of *due process* can be applied to appraisals to increase the perception that employees are being treated fairly.¹⁰⁰ Three features characterize due process systems: (1) Individuals are provided with adequate notice of what is expected of them, (2) all evidence relevant to a proposed violation is aired in a fair hearing so the individuals affected can respond, and (3) the final decision is based on the evidence and is free of bias.

One technique that organizations might consider to enhance due process is posting appraisals online so employees can see their own performance scores exactly as the supervisor enters them. One company that did so found employees believed rater accountability and employee participation were higher when appraisal information was available online prior to appraisal interviews.¹⁰¹ Maybe raters were more sensitive to providing accurate ratings when they knew employees would be able to see their own information directly.

Providing Performance Feedback

Few activities are more unpleasant for many managers than providing performance feedback to employees. In fact, unless pressured by organizational policies and controls, managers are

likely to ignore this responsibility. Why?

First, even though almost every employee could stand to improve in some areas, managers fear confrontation when presenting negative feedback. Second, many employees do tend to become defensive when their weaknesses are pointed out. Instead of accepting the feedback as constructive and a basis for improving performance, some criticize the manager or redirect blame to someone else. Finally, employees tend to have an inflated assessment of their own performance. Statistically speaking, half of all employees must be below-average performers. But the average employee's estimate of his or her own performance level generally falls much higher. So even when managers are providing good news, employees are likely to perceive it as not good enough.

Career OBjectives

How do I fire someone?

One of the people who reports to me really isn't living up to his job responsibilities, and I'm afraid that I have to let him go. I have no idea how to approach him so the meeting will turn out okay. What's the best way to terminate him?

— Ariana

Dear Ariana:

Most supervisors agree that terminating a problem employee can be one of the hardest parts of management. In general, the number one way to reduce the stress of firing is to avoid giving surprises. A problem employee needs to be told as soon as possible that there are issues with performance. Be sure to document performance problems early, and let your employee know the consequences of failing to improve. It may even be the case that identifying problems can eliminate the need for firing through initiating development strategies and providing training that may improve his performance.

If you've decided the termination needs to proceed, then begin to plan the termination meeting. Good HR guidance can be one of your best resources in this process. It's natural to be worried about how your employee is going to react, but here are some strategies that may help you end the employment relationship in a way that

minimizes conflicts:

- *Ask your HR representatives what alternatives and techniques they'd recommend.* Many companies have established policies and procedures that will help you conduct this meeting in a professional manner.
- *Practice.* A chance to practice the meeting with a neutral party (*not* someone with connections to the person or your organization) will help you reduce stress and anticipate how the meeting will go.
- *Be sure to respect your employee during the process.* When possible, conduct the termination behind closed doors. Send a clear message that his employment is at an end. The last thing you want is a situation where he doesn't get the message or feels you are so indecisive that he can argue his way out of the termination. Attempts to "soften the blow" by providing positive feedback or working your way up to the bad news are often confusing and can create an opening for an extended, unpleasant, and unproductive argument.
- *Avoid going over past mistakes in detail.* At the point of termination, there is no reason to rehash old problems you've previously discussed—it's better just to make a clean statement that things aren't working out, and your documentation should have the details for later reference if needed. Going over the reasons that the relationship is over will make your employee feel insulted or offended.
- *Have an after-meeting plan.* What are your organization's policies—does your employee need to be escorted immediately out of the building, for instance? What are the policies for returning business property? Demonstrate adherence to the plan to keep the termination process objective.

Of course, none of this advice can remove all the stress of terminations, but a combination of preparation, respect, and clarity can help make the situation better than it would be otherwise.

Sources: Based on S. R. McDonnell, "10 Steps Needed to Properly Fire Someone," *Entrepreneur*, May 26, 2015, <http://www.entrepreneur.com/article/246573>; E. Fraenheim, "Employee Crisis Communications 101," *Workforce*, November 13, 2013, <http://www.workforce.com/articles/20036-employee-crisis-communications-101>; and R. A. Mueller-Hanson and E. D. Pulakos, "Putting the 'Performance' Back in Performance Management," *SHRM-SIOP Science of HR White Paper Series*, 2015,

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The solution to the problem is not to ignore it but to train managers to conduct constructive feedback sessions. An effective review—in which the employee perceives the appraisal as fair, the manager as sincere, and the climate as constructive—can leave the employee feeling upbeat, informed about areas needing improvement, and determined to correct them.¹⁰² This is a perfect outcome if the evaluation is fair and thorough, but unfortunately an employee may feel this way in situations where the evaluator feels an interdependence with the employee and therefore is more lenient in the evaluation.¹⁰³

It probably won't surprise you that employees in a bad mood are much less likely to take advice than employees in a good mood.¹⁰⁴ Appraisals should also be as specific as possible. People are most likely to overrate their own performance when asked about overall job performance, but they can be more objective when feedback is about a specific area.¹⁰⁵ It's also hard to figure out how to improve your performance globally—it's much easier to improve in specific areas. The performance review should be a counseling activity more than a judgment process, best accomplished by allowing it to evolve from the employee's self-evaluation.

International Variations in Performance Appraisal

Let's examine performance evaluation globally in the context of cultural dimensions, particularly individualism versus collectivism.



Individual-oriented cultures such as the United States emphasize formal performance evaluation systems more than informal systems. They advocate written evaluations performed at regular intervals, the results of which managers share with employees and use in the determination of rewards. On the other hand, the collectivist cultures that dominate Asia and much of Latin America are characterized by more informal

systems—downplaying formal feedback and disconnecting reward allocations from performance ratings. Some of these differences may be narrowing, however. In Korea, Singapore, and Japan, the use of performance evaluations has increased dramatically in the past decade, though not always smoothly or without controversy. One survey of Korean employees revealed that a majority questioned the validity of their performance evaluation results.¹⁰⁶



One study focused on the banking industry and found significant differences across countries in performance appraisal practices.¹⁰⁷ Formal performance appraisals were used more frequently in countries that were high in assertiveness, high in uncertainty avoidance, and low in ingroup collectivism. In other words, assertive countries that see performance as an individual responsibility and that desire certainty about where people stand were more likely to use formal performance appraisals. On the other hand, in high uncertainty-avoidance cultures, performance appraisals were also used more frequently for communication and development purposes (as opposed to being used for rewards and promotion). Another study found that individuals who were high in power distance and high in collectivism tend to give more lenient performance appraisals.¹⁰⁸

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

16.5.1 Treating co-workers with respect, making constructive suggestions, and saying positive things about the workplace are a part of the _____ behavior that constitutes performance at work.

- ☐ citizenship
- ☐ counterproductivity
- ☐ social loafing
- ☐ deviant workplace

Check answer

Reset

16.5.2 If a manager uses critical incidents as a method of performance evaluation, then _____.

- ☐ the employees generally receive poor ratings
- ☐ the evaluator's writing skills become the determining factor of the evaluation
- ☐ the employees are more likely to become motivated to achieve their goals
- ☐ the focus of the evaluation will center on specific behaviors

Check answer

Reset

The Leadership Role of Human Resources (HR)

16-6 Describe the leadership role of human resources (HR) in organizations.

We have discussed the important functions HR departments serve in recruiting, selection practices, training and development, and the performance evaluation process. Arguably, these are an organization's most important tasks in managing its most valuable asset—its people. However, HR also plays a key leadership role in nearly all facets of the workplace environment, from designing and administering benefits programs, to conducting attitude surveys, to drafting and enforcing employment policies. HR is on the frontlines in managing adversarial employment conditions such as work–life conflicts, mediations, terminations, and layoffs. It is on the scene when an employee joins and leaves, and all along the way. HR departments uniquely represent both the employees' and the company's perspectives as needed, so we will discuss the importance of HR communication before each of the facets of HR leadership.



Companies have only recently begun to recognize the potential for HR to influence employee performance. Researchers have been examining the effects of a **high-performance work system (HPWS)** ⓘ, a group of human resources practices that some organizations have been implementing. These practices work together and reinforce one another to improve organizational outcomes. These practices can include those that enhance motivation, such as profit sharing programs and other reward systems, as well as practices that improve skills, such as training and development programs. HPWS may increase employee engagement. In addition, a study of 163 Spanish companies suggests that an HPWS can especially increase performance when the organization has a learning culture.¹⁰⁹ More recent research has shown that having an HPWS may increase organizational performance, but higher organizational performance may also reinforce high-performance practices by providing more resources to an HPWS. HPWS may also have more of an effect on organizational performance when leadership is not oriented toward organizational goals (e.g, improving customer service).¹¹⁰

Communicating HR Practices

Leadership by HR begins with informing employees about HR practices and explaining the

implications of decisions that might be made around these practices. It is not enough simply to have a practice in place; HR needs to let employees know about it. When a company successfully communicates how the whole system of HR practices has been developed and what function this system serves, employees feel they can control and manage what they get out of work.¹¹¹ We've noted in other chapters that knowing you can influence the outcomes of your work is highly motivational. Employees can come to see the HR philosophy and system as an employer's expression of concern, and the positive feelings that result have been shown to increase employee commitment, retention, and engagement.¹¹²

The evidence supporting the contribution of communication and perception to HR effectiveness is considerable. For example, one study of different business units within a large food-service organization found that employee perceptions of HR practices, rated at the work-group level, were significant predictors of OCB, commitment, and intention to remain with the company,¹¹³ but the HR practices led to these positive outcomes only if employees were aware they were in place. Other studies have found that HR practices have different effects depending on how employees perceive the reason for them.¹¹⁴ Employees who think HR practices are established to improve performance and benefit workers reciprocate with greater commitment and performance. Employees who think these same practices are established to exploit workers do not have the same positive reactions.

The effectiveness of HR practices also depends on employee attitudes. One review found that HR practices were more likely to lead to positive outcomes when employees felt motivated.¹¹⁵ Other research indicated that employees who were more knowledgeable about the purpose of a performance management system used the system more effectively to improve their efficiency and thoroughness.¹¹⁶ Taken together, these results suggest that it isn't enough for employers simply to set up practices—they need to show that the practices are actually attempts to make the company more successful and help employees achieve better outcomes. Leadership communication can help shape employee attitudes and perceptions about HR practices.



Practices tend to be perceived differently in various business cultures. For example, the use of educational qualifications in screening candidates seems to be a universal practice, but aside from this, different countries emphasize different selection techniques. Structured interviews are popular in some countries and nonexistent in others. Research shows that across the Netherlands, the United States, France, Spain, Portugal, and Singapore, most

applicants prefer interviews and work sample tests and dislike the use of personal contacts and integrity tests.¹¹⁷ There was little variation in preferences across these countries. In other words, it appears that even if there are international differences in practices, there are not as many international differences in what employees consider fair. Communication is the bridge for HR to demonstrate that intentions are fair.

Designing and Administering Benefits Programs

As we've seen throughout this text, employers are more willing than ever to consider an infinite range of benefits to offer employees in efforts to recruit and retain the best talent. For every issue facing workers—health, child care, aging parents, education, workplace conditions, and others—there exists a potential benefit that organizations may consider to meet the need. The responsibility for designing and administering an organization's benefits program falls to the HR department, with input from executive management.

Ideally, a benefits program should be uniquely suited to the organizational culture, reflect the values of the organization, demonstrate economic feasibility, and be sustainable in the long term. Such benefits will likely improve employees' psychological well-being and therefore increase organizational performance.¹¹⁸

Consider employees who are mothers of infants. Options that HR might consider could range from support to intolerance. Should the company give paid time off for working mothers to breast-feed their babies? Should it provide a break room for mothers to breast-feed their babies at work? Should it allow mothers to pump milk at work to give to babies at home? What about mothers who are bottle-feeding? Federal laws do not require companies to provide any accommodation for breast-feeding mothers beyond an undefined "reasonable break time," and a case in Texas originally ruled against a woman who was fired for asking to use the back room to pump milk for her child.¹¹⁹ While that case was settled out of court after the Court of Appeals reversed the decision, stating it was a sex discrimination case and a medical condition, the issue is not definitive.¹²⁰ An HR manager in a company that produces lactation pumps, supports La Leche League International, and employs women of childbearing age may want to offer some benefits because the policies would agree with the company's principles. An HR manager in a company whose mission is unrelated to the issue may explore providing some benefits upon employee requests. Each manager may then perform an analysis of the costs associated with providing different levels of benefits, along

with the positive organizational outcomes for each, to determine which benefit would be sustainable for the company in the long term. Of course, this is just one example of possible benefits to consider, and it applies only to a segmented group of workers. Other benefits may affect a larger population of your workforce, such as health care options and vacation benefits.

Drafting and Enforcing Employment Policies

Along with benefits come responsibilities, and employees need to know what the organization expects from them. Employment policies that are informed by current laws but go beyond minimum requirements will help define a positive organizational culture. Policies differ from benefits in that they provide the guidelines for behavior, not just the working conditions. A company might provide the benefit of a special break room for mothers of young children, but a policy is needed to outline the expectation for conduct. May mothers elect to feed their babies in other places in the facility or only in the breakroom? What timing is acceptable? Where can collected breast milk be stored? Establishing policies to address potential questions can help minimize confusion and awkwardness for all employees.

An Ethical Choice

HIV/AIDS and the Multinational Organization

It wasn't long ago that an AIDS diagnosis was a death sentence, and the ethical choices for HR departments were about offering palliative care and death benefits. Those days are gone, at least for most. Now the ethical choice is about the standards of care and support that organizations want to provide, for which employees worldwide, and for how long. "There has been an uptick with those employed that have HIV/AIDS" as the disease has become more chronic than fatal, said Randy Vogenberg of the Institute for Integrated Healthcare. However, whether someone can continue working still depends on drug therapy, workplace accommodations, and employee education. In most countries, standards are not specifically mandated, leaving employers to choose the level of support to offer. "It's not a question of whether a business is going to be confronted with this," labor law attorney Peter Petesch says.

“It’s a question of how soon.”

By current estimates, more than 1.1 million people in the United States and 36.7 million people globally live with HIV. Over two-thirds of HIV infections are in sub-Saharan Africa, and 70 percent of new cases are in this region. Worldwide, there is little consistency in the approach to the problem. Few U.S. companies have specific HIV/AIDS policies, for example, and although benefit plans cover the illness, employees’ out-of-pocket costs for the expensive drug therapy can range significantly. HIV/AIDS treatment is available in Europe through the national health care system. Some larger African companies run clinics where national health care or insurance is insufficient, but not all companies offer insurance. In India and China, insurers do not cover HIV/AIDS, so companies need to consider separate employee reimbursement to match their intentions for coverage.

When it comes to HIV/AIDS, an ounce of prevention is worth a pound of cure, or more literally, dramatic corporate savings. Research found that the investment companies made in preventing the disease from spreading and in treating infected employees saved money and lives. HR initiatives like providing peer educators to teach employees about prevention and accommodation, free counseling services, free voluntary testing, and well-being monitoring have been effective worldwide.

“Nobody needs to die of this disease anymore,” said Jenni Gillies, head of business development for beer brewer SABMiller, which has 70,000 employees in 75 countries and is committed to helping eradicate HIV/AIDS through employee education and support. But there are costs and responsibilities associated with each decision about the level of care to support or supply, and the distance companies should go to meet this need over other employee needs will be a constant question. Some organizations may conclude that governments and other systems are responsible for the care of citizens. It’s a tough call. Meanwhile, individual managers can assist in preventing discrimination and encouraging education.

Sources: Based on “HIV/AIDS Basic Statistics,” Center for Disease Control,

<http://www.cdc.gov/hiv/statistics/basics.html>, accessed July 21, 2015; “U. S. Statistics,” HIV.gov,

<https://www.hiv.gov/hiv-basics/overview/data-and-trends/statistics>, accessed June 2017; J. Mooney, “People with

HIV and AIDS: Living and Working Longer,” *HR Magazine*, June 2012, 41–44; SABMiller corporate website,

“Inside View” page, www.insideview.com/directory/sabmiller-plc, accessed June 18, 2013; and World Health

The lactation case is an example of a potential benefit and policy combination that will ensure employees recognize the benefit as an employer’s aid to their well-being while understanding how and where to use it. However, any policy must have enforcement to be effective. HR managers are responsible for setting the organizational consequences of infractions and often for enforcing policies as well.

Sometimes, HR managers need to take action even when the employee’s direct manager may not agree, especially if compliance with the law is at issue. For example, many companies in the entertainment, nonprofit, publishing, and marketing industries use unpaid postcollege interns, who are supposed to receive on-the-job experience as compensation. The Labor Department stipulates that interns who are unpaid must be provided a vocational education experience and that their work cannot profit the employer. Interns report getting stuck doing menial tasks an employer would need to pay someone else to do. If these companies want to continue using unpaid interns, HR managers need to set policies that clarify the assignments the supervisors can give and then ensure that the policies are followed. Otherwise, their organizations will face lawsuits like the one from Eric Glatt, an intern on the movie *Black Swan*, who sued for minimum wage violations.¹²¹ A judge in the U.S. District Court ruled that he was improperly cataloged as an intern.¹²² The decision cited criteria from the Labor Department wherein an unpaid internship must provide work similar to training the person would receive in a school, benefit the intern not the employer, and not displace other employees.¹²³ This ruling sparked similar claims against NBC Universal, Fox, Viacom, and other large organizations, often ending in out-of-court settlements. The issue is far from conclusive, however, leaving the burden on interns to litigate if they are unfairly treated. See Case Incident 1 for discussion on the role of interns from a different perspective: Yours.

Managing Work–Life Conflicts

We introduced work-life balance in Chapter 1 and discussed the blurring lines between work life and personal life. Here, we focus specifically on what organizations can do to help employees reduce conflicts.

Myth or Science?

The 24-Hour Workplace Is Harmful

This statement appears to be true in many cases. Although technology makes it possible for employees to be plugged in all the time, in constant contact around the globe, research suggests that employers who push employees to check in at all hours and stay connected may well be doing themselves (and their employees) a disservice.

A growing body of research has uncovered serious health consequences of insufficient sleep, and work practices that encourage employees to be plugged in 24 hours a day may be making the situation worse. One study examined how late-night work influenced job outcomes by having employees complete diary surveys on their sleep and engagement at work over multiple days. Those who used smartphones at night for work were less engaged in their work tasks the next day, even after accounting for other technology use.

From another angle, researchers have looked at the personal consequences of workaholism, which is the tendency to think constantly about work off the job and to feel compelled to work excessive hours. This habit is associated with higher levels of burnout, stress, and family problems. While workaholism is partially driven by personality factors, surveys suggest that features of the workplace itself can enhance workaholic tendencies, including excessive workloads, conflicting work priorities, and time pressures. Workaholics may not immediately perceive these effects because they are often highly committed to their work and enjoy it in the short term, until burnout occurs.

The key to maintaining performance over time may lie in developing psychological detachment from work. Alongside studies showing the negative effects of overexposure to work demands we can place another body of work showing that short regular breaks made up of total rest and avoidance of work responsibilities can recharge a person's energy. Unplugging from constant work demands for short periods actually makes us much more productive over the long haul. Therefore the evidence is clear: Unplug to recharge yourself. HR can support this effort by presenting the research findings to

managers and helping to establish practices and boundaries that benefit everyone.

Sources: Based on K. Lanaj, R. E. Johnson, and C. M. Barnes, "Beginning the Workday yet Already Deprived? Consequences of Late-Night Smartphone Use and Sleep," *Organizational Behavior and Human Decision Processes* 124 (May 2014): 11–23; M. A. Clark, J. S. Michel, L. Zhdanova, S. Y. Pui, and B. B. Baltes, "All Work and No Play? A Meta-Analytic Examination of the Correlates and Outcomes of Workaholism," *Journal of Management*, February 2014, doi:10.1177/0149206314522301; and S. Sonnentag and C. Fritz, "Recovery from Job Stress: The Stressor-Detachment Model as an Integrative Framework," *Journal of Organizational Behavior* 36 (2015): S72–S103.

Work–life conflicts grabbed management’s attention in the 1980s, largely as a result of the increased entry into the workforce of women with dependent children. In response, most major organizations took actions to make their workplaces more family-friendly.¹²⁴ They introduced onsite child care, summer day camps, flextime, job sharing, leave for school functions, telecommuting, and part-time employment. But organizations quickly realized work–life conflicts were not limited to female employees with children. Heavy workloads and increased travel demands, for instance, made it increasingly hard for male workers and women without children to meet both work and personal responsibilities. A Boston College survey of nearly 1,000 fathers with professional careers showed that participants put more importance on job security and flexible, family-friendly working schedules than on high income and advancement opportunities.¹²⁵

Organizations are modifying their workplaces with scheduling options and benefits to accommodate the varied needs of a diverse workforce. Employees at NestléPurina can bring their dogs to the office; SAS Institute has onsite child care, a health care center, and a fitness center; and other firms offer perks ranging from onsite laundry, to food services, to free child care.¹²⁶ Colgate-Palmolive, number one in 2015 on *Forbes’* Best Companies for Work-Life Balance list, offers emergency in-home care for dependents and professional counseling services to help employees stay on the job.¹²⁷ Exhibit 16-4 lists some other initiatives to help employees reduce work–life conflicts.

Time pressures aren’t the primary problem underlying work–life conflicts.¹²⁸ The psychological incursion of work into the family domain—and vice versa—leaves people worrying about personal problems at work and thinking about work problems at home, creating conflict. This suggests organizations should spend less effort helping employees

with time management issues and more effort helping them clearly segment their lives. Keeping workloads reasonable, reducing work-related travel, and offering onsite high-quality child care are examples of practices that can help in this endeavor. Employees can also reduce interference between work and home by increasing the amount of planning they do.¹²⁹

Not surprisingly, people differ in their preference for scheduling options and benefits.¹³⁰ Some prefer organizational initiatives that better segment work from their personal lives, as flextime, job sharing, and part-time hours do by allowing employees to schedule work hours less likely to conflict with personal responsibilities. Others prefer initiatives to integrate work and personal life, such as gym facilities and company-sponsored family picnics. On average, most people prefer an organization that provides support for work-life balance. A study found that potential employees, particularly women, are more attracted to organizations that have a reputation for supporting employee work-life balance.¹³¹

MyLab Management Watch It

If your professor has assigned this activity, go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management to complete the video exercise.

Patagonia Human Resource Management

Watch it video.

A **transcript** of this video is available [here](#).

Transcript

Patagonia Human Resource Management

>> [Background music] Aloha.

>> This is Patagonia.

>> What's up?

>> There are companies with great products,

>> companies that take care of their employees, and companies

>> that respect the environment.

>> Then, there is Patagonia.

>> [Music]

>> Patagonia's mission is to build the best product,

>> cause no unnecessary harm, inspire and implement solutions

>> to the environmental crisis.

>> The rewards to a new hire at Patagonia Outdoor Equipment

>> and Clothing are, in some ways, unprecedented

>> in almost any industry.

>> Founder Yvon Chouinard's attitude towards rigid schedules

>> is summed up in his well-known mantra, "Let my people surf."

>> An employee tasked with selling wetsuits should have some

>> experience with how the product performs on the waves.

>> That means that at Patagonia every life experience is not

>> just a learning experience

>> but an on-the-job training experience.

>> [Background noise] That's what makes us a manufacturer

>> of very high quality apparel because we are the customer.

>> But surfing isn't the only reason an employee might want

>> to take a few hours off in the middle of the workday.

>> Many of Patagonia's employees have families,

>> and a family emergency, like a child getting sick at school,

>> can be a headache for parents in ordinary companies.

>> At Patagonia, you can just go take care of the problem so long

>> as you get your work done on time.

>> It's a special respect that Patagonia has

>> for its employees based on an understanding

>> of what a parent's priorities should be, family first.

>> Having onsite daycare with 75 children right here

>> in the backyard, you hear their voices through the windows

>> when you're having company meetings tends to put life

>> into perspective a little bit.

>> In-house daycare is common at many companies today,

>> but it wasn't always that way.

>> Patagonia was one of the pioneers of this benefit.

>> Our program opened in 1984.

>> By providing childcare here, it gives children the opportunity

>> to see their parents at work.

>> We want to do our best to really enhance the relationship

>> between the parent and the child

>> because fundamentally that's the most important relationship

>> there is.

>> Yeah, so I'm sitting in front

>> of the mural, this beautiful mural.

>> All of the children that have either gone through

>> or are currently in our Great Pacific Child Development

>> Center, that's the daycare center that we have on site.

>> We have children of the children who have been

>> to the Child Development Center who are now in the program,

>> and their parents are still here.

>> The kids go to school here, and many times they'll come back

>> as adults and end up working here.

>> So they have a really unique connection to this place.

>> An extremely liberal policy of flextime allows an employee

>> to leverage to manage family and outside situations

>> without any kind of conflict with the job.

>> The expectation is that you're going to come back

>> and complete what you had planned to do that day.

>> It creates a culture of personal responsibility, and therefore,

>> people are more engaged because they're treated like adults.

>> Knowing that I have this trust to get my job done

>> and knowing that I have flexibility makes me

>> work harder.

>> You don't feel like you're at work.

>> You feel like you're here because you want to be here

>> and we're not being forced into anything.

>> If you're forced to do something, you don't want

>> to do it, but if you're not forced, you know,

>> if you're not forced to eat your broccoli,

>> you might kind of want to eat it.

>> [Laughter]

>> A company having that kind of faith in its employees is rare,

>> but when you have employees as passionate and committed

>> to what they do on every level as Patagonia does,

>> you have faith that they will always behave as adults.

>> When you come through the door at Patagonia,

>> you come in as yourself.

>> You bring all your baggage with you, which is a beautiful thing.

>> So, I think a lot of companies and corporations, you know,

>> when you get to work, you're at work.

>> At five o'clock you're done, and then you go back

>> to being yourself and seeing your family and friends,

>> but here at Patagonia, it's all encompassing.

>> Patagonia is repeatedly voted one of the best companies

>> to work at and one of the best companies for working mothers.

>> So, a lot of people want to get in.

>> When they do the occasional hire,

>> they want to make absolutely sure

>> that the candidate is a good fit.

>> Yvon Chouinard observes, "We don't want

>> to hire anyone we wouldn't want to have dinner with."

>> Where Patagonia differentiates is

>> that we do a lot of group interviews

>> where we'll bring a candidate in, and we, therefore,

>> have more of a conversation

>> because a collaborative working style is an emblematic part

>> of our culture.

>> Using that as part of the interview process is a great way

>> for us to assess their comfort with that kind of work style.

>> In fact, if Patagonia has any human resources problems at all,

>> it's probably a completely unexpected one,

>> not enough openings.

>> So how do they keep their best and brightest?

>> We have a very robust employee development program

>> where we have people that move to different jobs

>> when employees are out for a leave of absence.

>> Most predominantly when a mom goes out for a maternity leave,

>> which is usually 4 months, it gives us a great opportunity

>> to move another employee into her job,

>> and subsequently they gain those skills, and there's no break

>> in service for that particular role.

>> I became the PR director for 10 years, and now I'm back

>> in HR again, my second time around, because it's clear to me

>> that my strength and my passion and my joy is working

>> with the employees at this organization.

>> [Background noise] Oh.

>> I got all choked up.

>> [Laughter] It's true.

>> That really is where I get the joy.

>> Yes, that's right.

>> You just witnessed an employee tearing up talking

>> about the company she works for.

>> There's so much about this culture and about this brand

>> that resonates for the people that work here,

>> and it takes a long time to get a job at Patagonia,

>> many interviews, many conversations.

>> Patagonia pays a little less

>> than the industry average though the perks are unmatched.

>> One amazing perk is that after a year,

>> every employee can take 60 days off to take an internship

>> with an environmental activist group.

>> And receive their paycheck while doing so.

>> We've had people go all over the world,

>> following their own personal passion

>> about an environmental endeavor

>> that they might be interested in.

>> Rather than writing a check to the environmental group,

>> we send them a skill set, we send them a talent,

>> and help them leverage their mission

>> through that person's work.

>> And every once in a while one of them doesn't come back,

>> and that's just fine with Patagonia

>> because activist work is very important,

>> and they do eventually need some openings for promotions.

>> The concept is part of the larger trend in businesses

>> like Patagonia to respect a variety of non-work adventures

>> as part of a protean career.

>> That's the recognition that it's the employees overall

>> experiences in various jobs, hobbies, and life experiences

>> that create his or her career.

>> It also recognizes that a person's measure

>> of success is an internal barometer

>> of personal satisfaction, not a collection

>> of advancements or material rewards.

>> I always think when I think of other companies

>> for some reason I envision there people coming in and wanting

>> to climb the corporate ladder and make more and more money

>> and just get more and more responsibility and purely

>> because that's what you do,

>> not because necessarily that's what you want to be doing

>> or what's right for you personally.

>> Here at Patagonia, we hire incredibly ambitious people,

>> but they're here for a different reason.

>> We're here because the core values of this company resonate

>> with us, and we couldn't work anywhere else.

>> It's a great place to be if this is what you're looking for

>> and this kind of a culture resonates with you.

>> [Music]

Exhibit 16-4 Work–Life Initiatives

Time-based strategies

- Flextime
- Job sharing
- Leave for new parents
- Telecommuting

Management consulting firm A. T. Kearney's Success with Flex program allows for schedule adjustments, telecommuting, and "hybird" positions. At biopharmaceutical firm AbbVie, 98% of

	• Paid time off	employees use a flextime schedule. Cisco provides job-sharing and videoconferencing facilities to minimize needs for travel away from family. Deloitte offers employees 3-6 months sabbatical at 40% salary, and they have 40 paid days off per year.
Information-based strategies	• Work–life support • Relocation assistance • Elder care resources • Counseling services	Blue Cross Blue Shield of North Carolina provides networking opportunities to remote workers. Hallmark offers employees monthly meetings to talk about career management for women. Johnson and Johnson promotes weekends free of e-mail. Hewlett-Packard offers counselors, mentors, and \$5,000 annual tuition aid.
Money-based strategies	• Insurance subsidies • Flexible benefits • Adoption assistance • Discounts for child care tuition • Direct financial assistance • Domestic partner benefits • Scholarships, tuition reimbursement	Accenture offers a \$5,000 adoption assistance benefit. Carlson offers employees scholarships of up to \$20,000 to attend the University of Minnesota’s Carlson School of Management. Citi employees can save up to \$5,000 per year in pretax dependent care accounts, with a match of up to 30% from the company. Colgate-Palmolive provides up to \$10,000 per year in annual tuition aid for job-related courses. Prudential employees who are caregivers can use 100 hours of dependent backup care and six hours of geriatric care management

		services annually.
Direct services	• Onsite child care • Fitness center • Summer child care • Onsite conveniences • Concierge services • Free or discounted • company products	Abbott provides a child-care center that serves 800 and discounts for 2,800 day care facilities. Companies like AOL and Verizon have onsite fitness centers and discounts at gyms nationwide. Bristol-Myers Squibb offers full-time, part-time, and backup care for kids up to age 5, and summer camps for older children. Turner Broadcasting offers a caregiver concierge to arrange babysitting, dog walking, and elder companions. REI employees can participate in a program that offers large discounts on company products.
Culture-change strategies	• Establishing work–life balanced culture; training managers to help employees deal with work–life conflicts • Tie manager pay to employee satisfaction • Focus on employees’ actual performance, not face time	At American Express, employee networks have been established to address issues directly. Investment firm Robert W. Baird’s CEO Paul Purcell has one rule: “There are no a**holes here.” W. L. Gore & Associates company slogan reads, “We don’t manage people, we expect people to manage themselves.” Pearson developed a Flexible Work Options Accountability Guide that trains managers in the use of flextime for their employees.

Sources: Based on “2014 100 Best Companies,” Working Mother, <http://www.workingmother.com/best-company-list/156592>, accessed July 21, 2015; “100 Best Companies to Work For,” *CNNMoney*, www.money.cnn.com, accessed June

Mediations, Terminations, and Layoffs



HR departments often take center stage when unpleasant events such as disputes, substandard performance, and downsizing occur. Employees need to be able to trust their HR professionals to maintain appropriate confidentiality and a balanced perspective. Managers need to be able to trust HR, too, to know the laws and represent the company's perspective. The HR professional should be well trained in mediation techniques and rely on company policies to seek positive resolutions. Sometimes, HR managers are integral to the termination process, when employees are not able to resolve issues with management. Termination processes are subject to union labor contracts and laws, which can confound the situation. In Spain, for instance, labor laws have traditionally protected older workers with near-guaranteed employment.¹³²

For departing employees, the HR department is often the last stop on their way out. HR managers are thus in charge of leaving a favorable impression with the employee and collecting helpful input from the exit interview. This is never truer than when organizations terminate employees in layoffs. Employees who think the layoff process was handled fairly are more apt to recommend the company to others and to return to work if asked.¹³³ Employees who survive a layoff and stay employed with the company also evaluate the fairness of the downsizing process, according to another study, particularly in individualistic countries. Downsizing organizations that are able to demonstrate fairness are therefore more likely to realize the financial gains they hoped for.¹³⁴

In sum, the role of HR is increasing in organizations worldwide, and top management is realizing human resources leadership is needed to create the cultures and positive business outcomes that top corporations need to stay competitive.

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

16.6.1 Which of the following is one of the techniques used by organizations to make their workplace more family-friendly?

- ☐ telecommuting
- ☐ job enlargement
- ☐ classroom training
- ☐ mentoring program

Check answer

Reset

16.6.2 Biozone provides its employees with career counseling, skills workshops, and networking sessions. This work-life initiative used by Biozone falls under the category of _____.

- ☐ direct services
- ☐ time-based strategies
- ☐ information-based strategies
- ☐ money-based strategies

Check answer

Reset

Summary

An organization's human resources (HR) policies and practices create important forces that greatly influence organizational behavior (OB) and important work outcomes. HR departments have become increasingly integral in shaping the composition of the organization's workforce. First, as more organizations have turned to internal recruitment methods, HR departments have taken the lead in creating online portals and other easy-access methods for candidates to learn about the organization and be attracted to apply. Second, HR departments are involved in all phases of selection: initial selection, substantive selection, and contingent selection. The greatest increase in the involvement of HR in selection may be in the initial selection phase, wherein HR professionals develop, monitor, and screen the great numbers of applications that are submitted. However, HR involvement has increased in all areas of selection, and HR professionals are responsible for understanding the applicable laws and guidelines to serve as an informed, up-to-date resource for managers.

In effective organizations, HR remains present throughout an employee's time with the organization. HR departments create and administer training and development programs, and they set policies and practices with top management that govern the performance evaluation system. HR serves in a leadership capacity with responsibilities that include the need to communicate practices to employees regularly; design and administer benefits programs; manage work-life conflicts; and conduct mediations, terminations, and layoffs. HR should bring an awareness of ethical issues to all stages of an individual's experience with the organization. Knowledgeable HR professionals are therefore a great resource to all levels of the organization, from top management, to managers, to employees.

Implications for Managers

- An organization's selection practices can identify competent candidates and accurately match them to the job and the organization. Consider assessment methods that are most likely to evaluate the skills directly needed for jobs you are looking to fill.
- Use training programs for your employees to achieve direct improvement in the skills necessary to successfully complete the job successfully. Employees who are motivated

will use those skills for their greater productivity.

- Training and development programs offer ways to achieve new skill levels and thus add value to your organization. Successful training and development programs include an ethical component.
- Use performance evaluations to assess an individual's performance accurately and as a basis for allocating rewards. Make sure the performance evaluations are as fair as possible. As discussed in Chapter 7 about equity theory, evaluations perceived as unfair can result in reduced effort, increased absenteeism, or a search for another job.
- Give your employees the opportunity to participate in their evaluations so they understand the performance criteria and engage with the improvement process.

MyLab Management Personal Inventory Assessments



Go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management to complete the Personal Inventory Assessment related to this chapter.

Employers Should Check Applicants' Criminal Backgrounds

Point

Depending on where you live, you may have been asked about your criminal arrest record on a job application. Even if you weren't asked outright, the company may have investigated anyway by using a background check service. Surveys suggest that nearly 70 percent of companies do some sort of criminal background check on job applicants. When so many are using the same basic strategy, it's likely they have a good reason.

Companies check criminal records for many purposes. Most obviously, nothing predicts future criminal behavior like prior criminal behavior. Many employees have used the access and privileges of their jobs to commit crimes, ranging from theft to assault or even murder. A check of their criminal records may help screen out these individuals.

As Lucia Bone, founder of the nonprofit Sue Weaver Cause, says, “It is the employer’s responsibility to protect ... their business, their employees, and their customers.” This is a deeply meaningful issue for Bone. The organization she founded is named after her sister, Sue Weaver, murdered by a man with a criminal record who had access to her home to clean air ducts. Many hiring managers check criminal backgrounds specifically because they do not want their own lack of diligence to lead to similarly tragic outcomes.

Besides signaling the direct risk of criminal activity on the job, criminal records may be good behavioral indicators of other deviant workplace behavior. People who are willing to violate social conventions in one area may well be likely to violate them in others. When employers screen for use of illegal drugs or shoplifting arrests, they are trying to identify people who might lie to supervisors or embezzle money. Information gathered from criminal records is likely to be more objective and accurate than a manager’s gut feelings about who is going to pose a problem in the future.

Counterpoint

According to sociologist Devah Pager, the high U.S. incarceration rate means employers’ hiring decisions have major labor market and social implications if based on criminal records. Koch Industries has stopped asking applicants about criminal records. CEO Charles Koch notes, “If ex-offenders can’t get a job, education, or housing, how can we possibly expect them to have a productive life?” Koch’s concern is valid. One study linked a young-adult arrest record to lower incomes and education levels later in life, and a conviction record to even lower levels.

There are also substantial racial and ethnic group differences in arrest rates, and men are much more likely to have arrest and conviction records than women. The Equal Employment Opportunity Commission (EEOC) concludes that excluding individuals with criminal records from jobs effectively discriminates against African American men in particular.

Criminal background checks don’t necessarily give employers the information they

seek. A core principle of modern criminal justice holds that we all are innocent until proven guilty. However, some screens will turn up both conviction and arrest records. This is problematic because fewer than half of arrests end in conviction. While the use of arrest records is prohibited in many localities, that is far from a universal rule. Other investigations have found that online criminal records checks are prone to false positives, reporting that someone has a criminal past when they do not.

Another problem is lack of relevance. While many would agree that a person convicted of assault is not a good candidate for work that requires carrying a weapon or associating with vulnerable populations, it's less clear how a petty-theft conviction might raise the same concerns. Sociologist Christopher Uggen summarizes by observing, "We haven't really figured out what a disqualifying offense should be for particular activities."

Sources: Based on B. Appelbaum, "Out of Trouble, but Criminal Records Keep Men out of Work," *New York Times*, February 28, 2015, http://www.nytimes.com/2015/03/01/business/out-of-trouble-but-criminal-records-keep-men-out-of-work.html?_r=0; C. Zillman, "Koch Industries Stops Asking Job Candidates about Their Criminal Records," *Fortune*, April 27, 2015, <http://fortune.com/2015/04/27/koch-industries-stops-asking-job-candidates-about-their-criminal-records/>; and G. Fields and J. R. Emshwiller, "As Arrest Records Rise, Americans Find Consequences Can Last a Lifetime," *Wall Street Journal*, August 18, 2014, <http://www.wsj.com/articles/as-arrest-records-rise-americans-find-consequences-can-last-a-lifetime-1408415402>.

Chapter Review

MyLab Management Discussion Questions

Go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management to complete the problems marked with this icon .

Questions for Review

- 16-1** What is the value of various recruitment methods?
- 16-2** What are the methods of initial selection?
- 16-3** What are the most useful methods of substantive selection?
- 16-4** What are the similarities and differences among the main types of training?
- 16-5** What are the methods of performance evaluation?
- 16-6** What are the various roles of HR in the leadership of organizations?

Application and Employability

Human resources policies and practices have a tremendous influence on the culture and ultimately on the success of an organization. Recruitment and selection enables organizations to increase their human capital resources. Training can also strengthen the knowledge, abilities, and skills of employees that drive organizational performance. HR practices and policies also determine how performance is measured, which guides many important organizational decisions. In this chapter, you helped develop many skills that are useful in the workplace. You learned how to apply your knowledge by examining how the 24-hour workplace can be harmful and examining the best way to fire someone. You also learned valuable lessons about social responsibility concerning HIV/AIDS and hiring candidates with

criminal records. In the next section, you will continue to build these skills while also applying critical thinking to designing an assessment center exercise, deciding whether to hire a friend, looking at problems with internships, and facing modern slavery in the United States.

Experiential Exercise Responding to Employees' Requests of Flexibility

After class, members will form groups of approximately five each. The groups will then consider the following scenario. One student will assume the role of the HR manager of a large manufacturing company who is leading a meeting with four senior managers working in the finance, marketing, production, and research and development departments, whose roles will be played by the remaining students.

The HR manager must present to the senior managers the requests for flexibility of three employees working in their units who have asked to work remotely for a minimum of two days per week. The goal of the meeting is to make a collegial decision to approve or deny the requests, motivate such decisions, and think about the development of a corporate policy for flexible work arrangements for the entire company in order to avoid managing ad-hoc requests in the future. The senior managers have a mix of experience with such requests and different attitudes toward telecommuting. The managers of marketing and research and development seem more favorable as they know that work–life balance is important. The managers of finance and production believe that not being physically present is detrimental to productivity and the climate within their department.

Here are the requests for working remotely advanced by three employees:

1. John is a 35-year-old employee working in the Quality Assurance department. He has been working for the company for 24 months with good results overall. He has asked to work two days per week remotely so he can be within a short distance of his father, who recently had a heart surgery and may need immediate assistance in case of urgencies.
2. Rebecca is a 34-year-old employee who has been working in the marketing department for 8 years. She is a mother of two young daughters and is considered a good and reliable employee but not a top performer. She has asked to work remotely two days per week so she can drive her daughters to and from school, as her husband is often at work at the time.
3. Luisa is a 27-year old employee recently hired by the company given her extraordinary academic performance. After only a few months of work, everybody has noticed that she has an edge over others. She lives 40 miles away from the workplace and commutes each day for about 75 minutes. Working at home for two days will save her commute time and

allow her to pursue her hobby, photography.

After the group has discussed these three requests and the team has made the final decision, the following questions can serve as the basis for class discussion.

Questions

- 16-7.** What do you think are the concerns for the company when deciding whether to approve or deny these three requests? Should the company care about the motivation behind each request?
- 16-8.** What was your group's recommendations? Have you thought about a possible corporate policy about how to manage such requests? Which criteria would you be likely to consider for judging them?
- 16-9.** Let us imagine that the team has decided to approve only Rebecca's request. Do you think this decision has been influenced by gender and societal norms regarding men's and women's participation in work and in family life? How can this decision affect employees with no families but many personal interests besides work?

Ethical Dilemma Should I Pay the Staff More and Reduce Company's Profit?

Ryanair has radically changed the travel habits of European citizens over the last decade, with 131 million customers in 2017 alone. Popular among Millennials especially for its cheap fares, Ryanair faced an unexpected crisis in the fall of 2017 with more than 20,000 cancelled flights and 700,000 passengers who had to be refunded or diverted to other flights. The problem was due to a staffing crisis, with a high number of pilots deciding to quit the company after having been offered higher compensation and better working conditions by Ryanair's competitors.

In an extreme attempt to remedy the pilot roster crisis, CEO Michael O'Leary wrote a letter promising a loyalty bonus to those pilots who would remain with the company and agree to fly additional hours during their time off. The letter was an attempt to show more gratitude to pilots and indirectly reply to unions that, in the months leading up to the crisis, had denounced Ryanair's employment model, which was characterized by a systematic use of external contractors and self-employed pilots who are hired through external agencies. These pilots do not receive compensation for non-flight hours and are not entitled to vacation, sickness, or paid leave.

Regardless of the specific circumstances of Ryanair's case, this story brings to light a hotly debated question in human resource management: Should the workforce be paid more at expense of company's profit? Should personnel be treated in a better fashion with greater provision of benefits programs? Many would likely say yes, but the answer to this question is not as straightforward as it seems. Many employers would like to pay their staff more and promote them more often, but there are several constraints, including global competition and customers who might not be keen to pay more for products or services whose prices are justified by better employment conditions. Yet, as the case demonstrates, there are some drawbacks to failing to treat well those who could cause severe damage to the company's reputation and regular functioning.

Questions

16-10. How might Ryanair's CEO convince pilots to remain loyal to the company? Would monetary incentives be sufficient?

- 16-11.** Is it appropriate to write pilots a letter to promise a bonus for accepting to fly more hours during time off? What could Ryanair do differently to better communicate their HR practices?
- 16-12.** Does more sustainable management of the workforce impose costs or generate benefits for companies?

Sources: Ryanair's Corporate Website, "Fact and Figures," <http://corporate.ryanair.com/about-us/fact-and-figures/>; Simon Calder, "Ryanair Boss Michael O'Leary Writes to Pilots Offering Bonuses if They Stay with Airline," *The Independent*, October 6, 2017, <http://www.independent.co.uk/travel/news-and-advice/ryanair-michael-oleary-boss-pilot-shortages-bonus-offer-letter-flight-cancellations-airline-a7985906.html>; Rob Davies, "Ryanair Staff Brand Company a 'Disgrace' over Handling of Issues," *The Guardian*, September 22, 2017, <https://www.theguardian.com/business/2017/sep/22/ryanair-pilots-michael-oleary-cancellations>; European Cockpit Association, "Ryanair Pilots Unite—Questionable Employment Model Challenged," press release, September 22, 2017, <https://www.eurocockpit.be/news/ryanair-pilots-unite-questionable-employment-model-challenged>.

Case Incident 1 Getting a Foot in the Door?

Many business students are familiar with the pressure to get internships or part-time jobs in their career field while in school. The surest route to the career track for many is to take on these limited-duration work assignments. Internships do give employers an easy way to size up potential applicants in a setting identical to the one in which they would perform. And unlike employees, interns are easily terminated if they don't pan out. It's the same situation for part-time or summer workers, who are sometimes let go at a moment's notice.

Internships are such a powerful tool for finding jobs that some students have begun to take on low-paid or even unpaid work assignments. While such internships used to be associated primarily with large organizations, many start-ups have begun to attract students. For example, Remy Agamy took an internship at a three-person design company, knowing that it wasn't likely to turn into a job. Still, in the job market she found that other prospective employers were keen on learning what she'd done in this internship. "I think we talked more about my eight-week internship than my four years of consulting experience," she said.

The value of internships for students, however, has long been questioned. While there may be a promise of a chance to learn, many students complain of doing little more than acting as unpaid, unskilled labor. Christina Isnardi is one student who felt exploited by the system. She described working 16- or 17-hour days at Lions Gate Entertainment, doing work like taking breakfast orders or working in locations far from the actual film set, which Isnardi mentioned made her "feel as though our dreams are holding us hostage to this unfair, unethical labor practice." Isnardi's experiences are not uncommon. Interns working for organizations as diverse as MTV, Warner Music Group, and Madison Square Garden describe similar experiences, which is why all these organizations have faced lawsuits from former interns.

Other students have negotiated great-sounding internships at organizations that regularly hire interns and pay them, but then the organizations don't know what to do with these temporary employees. One student we know of was encouraged to make the best use of his time during his summer internship in a major city, including taking a paying job elsewhere and just staying in touch by phone when work hours overlapped! Because of his ingenuity, he reported it was a very productive summer, but the internship didn't provide the learning opportunity he was seeking. Whether internships have value remains an open question. Most of the controversy does suggest that students need to know the details before agreeing to

these arrangements because not all internships offer a fair living wage or a strong career experience. HR departments are responsible for monitoring and designing internship programs.

Questions ★

- 16-13.** If you were an HR professional at Lions Gate Entertainment, how might you evaluate Isnardi's claim of exploitation? What changes might you suggest to top management and to managers?
- 16-14.** What specific characteristics would you look for in an internship?
- 16-15.** Do you think interns who feel they've had a negative or exploitive relationship with a company should file lawsuits? Why or why not? What types of company actions might make you think a lawsuit is justified?

Sources: Based on R. Feintzeig and M. Korn, "Internships Go under the Microscope," *Wall Street Journal*, April 23, 2014, B7; L. Gellman, "Diving into the Intern Pool before Starting at B-School," *Wall Street Journal*, February 5, 2014, B7; and C. Zillman, "Unpaid Interns Have Their Day in Court—Again," *Fortune*, January 29, 2015, <http://fortune.com/2015/01/29/unpaid-internships-legal-battle/>.

Case Incident 2 Indentured Doctors

Brazil abolished slavery in 1888, but in 2013 a new wave of workers, labelled by many as slaves belonging to Cuba, arrived in Brazil. But these 18,000 had little in common with the estimated 4 million slaves working on plantations in Brazil when they finally won their freedom all those years ago. Under an agreement signed between Cuba and Brazil, the workers were in fact trained doctors.

The deal was worth an estimated \$225 million to Cuba in hard currency. The doctors would work for three years for the hard-pressed and undermanned Brazilian health service. The deal was in response to widespread unrest across Brazil at the poor state of the health service. In poorer regions that had no doctors, the influx of new doctors allowed many health centers to reopen.

For many years, Cuba has been providing doctors to countries that shared its ideological beliefs. Now the export of doctors is for a more prosaic reason—cash. In exchange for preferential deals in oil, Cuba sent an estimated 30,000 health workers to Venezuela. Under the terms of the Barrio Adentro plan, Cuban workers operate in many of the shanty towns surrounding Caracas. At home, Cuban doctors can earn a maximum monthly salary of \$30. Even with the bulk of their pay going to the Cuba government, the doctors can still earn more abroad.

Despite the misgivings of many Brazilians, in most areas, the arrival of the Cuban doctors signals that the Brazilian government is actually trying to do something about healthcare. Cuba, it seems, has plenty of doctors to spare; they have an estimated 6.7 per 1,000 people, compared to just 1.9 in Brazil.

Brazil pays the Cuban doctors \$3,620 per month. However, 80 percent of that goes to the Cuban government. The doctors receive less than half of the remaining pay (in cash in Brazil); the rest is passed on the doctor's family in Cuba. The doctors are provided with free board and lodging but are not allowed to bring their families with them to Brazil.

Critics allege that the doctor's passports are taken from them, that Cuba maintains surveillance on them, and that a huge proportion of their pay is withheld. All of this is claimed to be in breach of the Trafficking in Persons Protocol and the International Labor Organization's Convention on the Protection of Wages.

In late 2016, 150 Cubans staged a “slave revolt” and filed lawsuits in Brazilian courts.

They demanded that the arrangement should be terminated and that they should be treated as independent contractors and receive their full salary instead of than the Cuban government. Unfortunately for the doctors, the Brazilian courts take their time to even list the cases, and the backlog of cases might mean that the ruling will take many years to be considered. Cuban officials, however, did act with speed. Each of the 150 were fired and were given a simple choice: they could either return home within 24 hours or face an eight-year period of exile.

Questions ★

16-16. Are these Cuban doctors little more than modern-day slaves?

16-17. The complaints and actions from the Cuban doctors is new. Is there really a case to answer?

16-18. Why might the doctors be reluctant to return to Cuba?

Sources: “Cuban Doctors Tend to Brazil’s Poor, Giving Rousseff a Boost,” Reuters,

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[http://www.nytimes.com/2013/12/30/world/americas/brazil-forging-economicties-with-cuba-while-hiring-its-doctors.html?](http://www.nytimes.com/2013/12/30/world/americas/brazil-forging-economicties-with-cuba-while-hiring-its-doctors.html?_r=0)

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MyLab Management Writing Assignments

If your instructor has assigned this activity, go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management for the following assisted-graded writing assignments:

16-19. Refer again to Case Incident 1. What responsibility do you think HR professionals have in designing, supporting, and telling candidates about their organization’s internships?

16-20. With regard to Case Incident 2, how might an HR department unravel this type of situation once it has become public and immediate action is required?

16-21. MyLab Management only—additional assisted-graded writing assignment.

Endnotes

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End of Chapter Quiz

Test Your Understanding

1 The adoption of online recruitment tools has led to which of the following outcomes?

- ☐ limited connections
- ☐ no unique methods
- ☐ a lower number of applications
- ☐ an exponential increase in applications

Check answer

Reset

2 Which of the following is most likely to be used for preliminary 'rough cuts' to decide whether an applicant meets the basic qualifications for a job?

- ☐ drug test
- ☐ application form
- ☐ hr interview
- ☐ written test

Check answer

Reset

3 Which of the following is a form of background check?

- ☐ aptitude test
- ☐ offer letter
- ☐ letters of recommendation
- ☐ application form

Check answer

Reset

4 Assessment centers are typically used to evaluate a candidate's _____ potential.

- ☐ linguistic
- ☐ technical
- ☐ cognitive
- ☐ managerial

Check answer

Reset

5 Which of the following tends to have a disproportionate amount of influence on employee selection decisions?

- ☐ interview
- ☐ written test
- ☐ performance-simulation test
- ☐ work sampling method

Check answer

Reset

6 Drug testing is controversial. Which of the following is an argument used against drug testing?

- ☐ the results of drug tests can be faked easily.
- ☐ drug use is a private matter.
- ☐ drug tests are costly.
- ☐ drug tests are generally inaccurate.

Check answer

Reset

7 Dunder Mifflin Inc. is considering implementing employee ethics training programs. Some members of senior management are opposed to these programs. Their opposition is most likely based on which of the following beliefs?

- ☐ ethics training is very expensive.
- ☐ ethics change from country to country.
- ☐ individual value systems are fixed at an early age.
- ☐ integrity cannot be taught by example.

Check answer

Reset

8 Which of the following is an on-the-job training method?

- ☐ live classroom lectures
- ☐ apprenticeships
- ☐ public seminars
- ☐ podcasts

Check answer

Reset

9 _____ training involves employees helping each other out at the workplace in an unplanned and unstructured environment.

- ☐ formal
- ☐ ethics
- ☐ interpersonal
- ☐ informal

Check answer

Reset

10 Researchers now recognize three major types of behavior that constitute performance at work. Which of the following are these three major types of behavior?

- ☐ task performance, productivity, tenure
- ☐ productivity, efficiency, absenteeism
- ☐ task performance, citizenship, counterproductivity
- ☐ citizenship, counterproductivity, personality

Check answer

Reset

11 Performance evaluations are used to _____.

- improve group cohesiveness
- define departmental structure
- help management make HR decisions
- identify how jobs are completed

Check answer

Reset

12 Which of the following methods of performance evaluation allows for quantitative analysis and comparison?

- ☐ critical incident
- ☐ graphic rating scale
- ☐ assessment center evaluation
- ☐ written essay

Check answer

Reset

13 Marcel hates the annual review process he has to do for the employees in his department. Although he is fully aware of some of his employees' faults, he is reluctant to discuss them in person, and is only comfortable writing them in an unsigned report that his supervisor will review. Marcel's behavior demonstrates _____.

- ☐ provision of due process
- ☐ fear of confrontation
- ☐ organizational citizenship behavior
- ☐ managerial sincerity

Check answer

Reset

14 Ozu Tech offers employees four unpaid weeks sabbatical, or three to six partially paid weeks off for family-related reasons. This work-life initiative offered by Ozu Tech is a type of _____.

- ☐ time-based strategy
- ☐ information based strategy
- ☐ money-based strategy
- ☐ direct service

Check answer

Reset

15 The government passes a new law requiring all companies to offer employees unpaid time off to care for their children. This would harm the economic competitiveness of the nation's businesses as companies must be free to set their own employment policies without mandated parental-leave regulations. Which of

the following, if true, would weaken the argument?

- A parental-leave law will serve to strengthen the family as a social institution in this country.
- Most businesses in the country already offer employees some form of

parental leave.

- ☐ Some of the countries with the most economically competitive businesses have strong parental-leave regulations.
- ☐ The proposed parental-leave law does not apply to small-scale industries.

Check answer

Reset

Organizational Change and Stress Management



Source: ferli/123RF

Learning Objectives

After studying this chapter, you should be able to:

- 17-1** Contrast the forces for change and planned change.
- 17-2** Describe ways to overcome resistance to change.
- 17-3** Compare the four main approaches to managing organizational change.
- 17-4** Demonstrate three ways of creating a culture for change.

- 17-5** Identify the potential environmental, organizational, and personal sources of stress at work and the role of individual and cultural differences.
- 17-6** Identify the physiological, psychological, and behavioral symptoms of stress at work.
- 17-7** Describe individual and organizational approaches to managing stress at work.

Employability Skills Matrix (ESM)

	Myth or Science?	Career Objectives	An Ethical Choice	Point/Counterpoint	Experiential Exercise	Ethic Dilemma
Critical Thinking			✓	✓	✓	✓
Communication		✓			✓	
Collaboration		✓	✓		✓	
Knowledge Application and Analysis	✓			✓	✓	✓
Social Responsibility		✓	✓	✓		✓

MyLab Management Chapter Warm Up

If your professor has assigned this activity, go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management to complete the chapter warm up.

Stress and Well-Being

Straight out of college, Naoya Nishigaki joined a large Japanese telecommunications company. He would work until he could catch the last train, and if he missed it, he would sleep at his desk. In some cases, he would work through the night until the following evening—a 37-hour stretch. After a few years of this, he died of an overdose of medication. His death was ruled a case of *karoshi*, a term used in Japan to describe the phenomena of working oneself to death.

There are many other examples in Japan of overwork leading to suicide, heart attacks, and strokes. In the recession that followed the collapse of the economic bubble in the late 1980s, many companies downsized, forcing the remaining staff to work harder. According to a 2017 BBC World report, the Japanese government is intervening, but it is difficult to change national and organizational cultures where many employees are clocking over 80 hours a month of overtime as a matter of course. Critics say that not enough is being done to address these issues, and that short-term profits are taking priority.

Meanwhile, in the other hemisphere, stress levels have been on the rise in New Zealand. According to a 2017 report by the *New Zealand Herald*, employees stress levels have risen by more than 20 percent within the last two years, and in companies with more than 50 staff, the figures rose to more than 30 percent. They say that the change is due to the increase in demand for goods as a result of a newly signed free-trade agreement with China. Demand for production is up, and this, coupled with external factors such as the disruption caused by the earthquakes in Wellington and Christchurch, has played a role in the higher levels of stressed employees.

In these examples, we can see how changes in market conditions, an organization's structure, or even factors such as natural catastrophes can contribute to stress for people in organizations. However, greater recognition of these issues and further research and investment by companies in stress management is making a difference. Ingrid Ozols, Managing Director of MentalHealth@Work, cites the case of Andrew, an employee in Australia, who spoke to his boss about his feelings of anxiety since the last round of organizational restructuring. He was experiencing difficulty in concentrating, which resulted in his taking time off every week. Eventually, he was treated with medication and cognitive behavioral therapy, and after a couple of months, Andrew's level of anxiety was under control and he was fully back at work. He was later promoted to a senior executive position

and has never missed a day of work since that anxiety attack. Now thriving, he was able to move on with his career despite all stress-related issues.

Recent approaches to change management support a shift from traditional to more resilience-building initiatives by firms to address issues of employee stress. Here we see a move from top-down change management to more increased engagement of staff. Financial incentives as a form of motivation take a back seat to specific initiatives that build resilience. Performance management becomes more integrated in the change process and involves HR managers and staff-development initiatives. At a strategic level, a firm will move away from compliance to policies and toward a longer-term view of embedding well-being into everyday behavior in the organization.

According to the Black Dog Institute, organizational change such as restructuring or downsizing can result in increased job strain. Employees who are not at risk of job loss can also experience mental illness, sickness absence, and disability. The Institute suggests that better planning of changes can lead to more job satisfaction and improved moods. This, of course, goes much deeper than simply providing fitness classes or placing fruit bowls by the coffee machine; it has to involve leadership as well as business processes and strategy.

Sources: Edwin Lane, "The Young Japanese Working Themselves to Death," BBC World Service, June 2, 2017, <http://www.bbc.com/news/business-39981997>; Tamsyn Parker, "Employee Stress Levels Up More Than 20pc in Two Years," *NZ Herald*, August 1, 2017, http://www.nzherald.co.nz/business/news/article.cfm?c_id=3&objectid=11897146; Caitlin Fitzsimmons, "Yoga and Free Fruit Won't Solve the Scourge of Workplace Stress," *The Sydney Morning Herald*, June 14, 2017, <https://www.smh.com.au/national/yoga-and-free-fruit-wont-solve-the-scourge-of-workplace-stress-20170613-gwq6ap.html>; Robertsoncooper, "Embedding Well-Being and Resilience to Support Change Management," http://www.robertsoncooper.com/files/download/Wellbeing_to_support_change_download.pdf; Jocelyn Lowinger, "Your Workplace and Its Impact on Your Mental Health," ABC Health & Wellbeing, <http://www.abc.net.au/health/features/stories/2014/07/07/4040588.htm>; Black Dog Institute, "Workplace Wellbeing," <https://www.blackdoginstitute.org.au/docs/default-source/factsheets/workplacewellbeing>; K. Roy, "The Personal Costs of Organizational Change: A Qualitative Study," *Public Performance & Management Review* 39, no. 1 (2016): 223–47; Roy Smollan and Edwina Pio, "Organisational Change, Identity and Coping with Stress," *New Zealand Journal of Employment Relations* 43, no. 1 (2018): 56–82.

Many changes bring about a great deal of stress. As Andrew's experiences highlight, it is extremely important to know how to deal with change: Think strategically about

choosing a career, seek out learning and development opportunities that can hone your career skills, work hard, and be resilient and adaptive in handling the many stressors that are sent your way. In this chapter, we describe environmental forces that require firms and people to change, the reasons people and organizations often resist change, and the way this resistance can be overcome. We review processes for managing organizational change. Then we move to the topic of stress and its sources and consequences. In closing, we discuss what individuals and organizations can do to better manage stress levels and realize positive outcomes for organizational behavior (OB), which, after all, is the purpose of this text.

Change

17-1 Contrast the forces for change and planned change.



No company today is in a particularly stable environment. Even those with a dominant market share must change, sometimes radically. For example, the market for smartphones has been especially volatile.¹ During the fourth quarter of 2016, 77 million iPhones were sold, compared with 76.8 million Samsung sales.² Contrast this with the fourth quarter of 2015, in which considerably fewer (71.5 million) iPhones were sold, versus considerably more (83.4 million) Samsung phones.³ At the same time, the Chinese mobile phone company Oppo, and its parent company, BBK Electronics, have been moving rapidly into the market: Collectively they hold only 6 percent less market share than either Samsung or Apple.⁴ A look just a few years further back shows formerly dominant players like Nokia, Xiaomi, or Research in Motion (makers of the Blackberry) shrinking dramatically in size. In this and many markets, competitors are constantly entering and exiting the field, gaining and losing ground quickly.

Forces for Change

“Change or die!” is the rallying cry among today’s managers worldwide.⁵ Exhibit 17-1 summarizes six specific forces that stimulate change.

Throughout the text, we’ve discussed the *changing nature of the workforce*. Almost every organization must adjust to a multicultural environment, demographic changes, immigration, and outsourcing. *Technology* is continually changing jobs and organizations. It is not difficult to imagine the idea of an office becoming an antiquated concept in the near future.



Economic shocks also have a significant impact on organizations. During the great recession of 2007 to 2009, millions of jobs were lost worldwide; home values dropped dramatically; and many large, well-known corporations like Merrill Lynch, Countrywide Financial, and Ameriquest disappeared or were acquired.⁶ Recovery has occurred in many countries, and with it has come new job prospects and investments. Other countries, like Greece, struggle to regain their economic footing, limiting the economic viability of many Greek organizations.⁷

Competition is changing. Competitors are as likely to be across the ocean as across town. Successful organizations are fast on their feet, capable of developing new products rapidly and getting them to market quickly. In other words, they are flexible and require an equally flexible and responsive workforce.⁸

Social trends don't remain static either. Organizations must therefore adjust product and marketing strategies continually to be sensitive to changing social trends, as Instagram did when it debuted "Instagram Stories," media (e.g., pictures, videos, text) that disappears some time after sending, essentially re-creating "Snapchat Stories."⁹ Consumers, employees, and organizational leaders are also increasingly sensitive to environmental concerns. Green practices are quickly becoming expected rather than optional.¹⁰

Exhibit 17-1 Forces for Change

Force	Examples
Nature of the workforce	- More cultural diversity - Aging population - Increased immigration and outsourcing
Technology	- Faster, cheaper, and more mobile computers and handheld devices - Emergence and growth of social-networking sites - Deciphering of the human genetic code
Economic shocks	- Rise and fall of global housing market - Financial sector collapse - Global recession
Competition	- Global competitors - Mergers and consolidations - Increased government regulation of commerce
Social trends	- Increased environmental awareness - Liberalization of attitudes toward gay, lesbian, and transgender employees - More multitasking and connectivity
World politics	- Rising health care costs - Negative social attitudes toward business and executives - Opening of new markets worldwide

Not even globalization's strongest proponents could have imagined the change in *world politics* in recent years. We've seen a major set of financial crises that have rocked global markets, a dramatic rise in the power and influence of China, populism and nationalist movements gaining headway in Europe and the United States, and intense shakeups in governments across the Arab world. Throughout the industrialized world, businesses—particularly in the banking and financial sectors—have come under new scrutiny.

Planned Change

A group of housekeeping employees who work for a small hotel confronted the owner: "It's very hard for most of us to maintain 7-to-4 work hours," said their spokeswoman. "Each of us has significant family and personal responsibilities. Rigid hours don't work for us. We're going to begin looking for someplace else to work if you don't set up flexible work hours." The owner listened thoughtfully to the group's ultimatum and agreed to make changes. The next day, a flextime plan for these employees was introduced.

A major automobile manufacturer spent several billion dollars to install state-of-the-art robotics. One area that received the new equipment was quality control, where sophisticated computers significantly improved the company's ability to find and correct defects. Because the new equipment dramatically changed the jobs in the quality-control area, and because management anticipated considerable employee resistance to it, executives developed a program to help people become familiar with the change and deal with any anxieties they might be feeling.

Both of these scenarios are examples of **change** ⓘ, or making things different. However, only the second scenario describes **planned change** ⓘ.¹¹ Many changes are like the one that occurred at the hotel: They just happen. Some organizations treat all change as an accidental occurrence. In this chapter, we address change as an intentional, goal-oriented activity.

What are the goals of planned change? First, it seeks to improve the ability of the organization to adapt to changes in its environment. Second, it seeks to change employee behavior.

Who in organizations is responsible for managing change activities? The answer is **change agents** ⓘ.¹² They see a future for the organization others have not identified, and they are able to motivate, invent, and implement this vision. Change agents can be managers

or nonmanagers, current or new employees, or outside consultants.

Some change agents look to transform old industries to meet new capabilities and demands. For instance, Sandy Jen, Cameron Ring, Monica Lo, and Seth Sternberg are working together to apply social marketplace concepts to online business—a concept exemplified by rideshare company Uber and crowdfunding firm Kickstarter. The group has created an innovative service for senior care called Honor.¹³ In contrast to older methods of matching seniors and their families with services through nursing facilities, Honor uses an online marketplace. Caregivers list qualifications and desired job attributes, and seniors specify the type of services they need. Then Honor facilitates meeting the needs. This new model could alter the entire field of care, based on the vision of a core group of dedicated leaders.

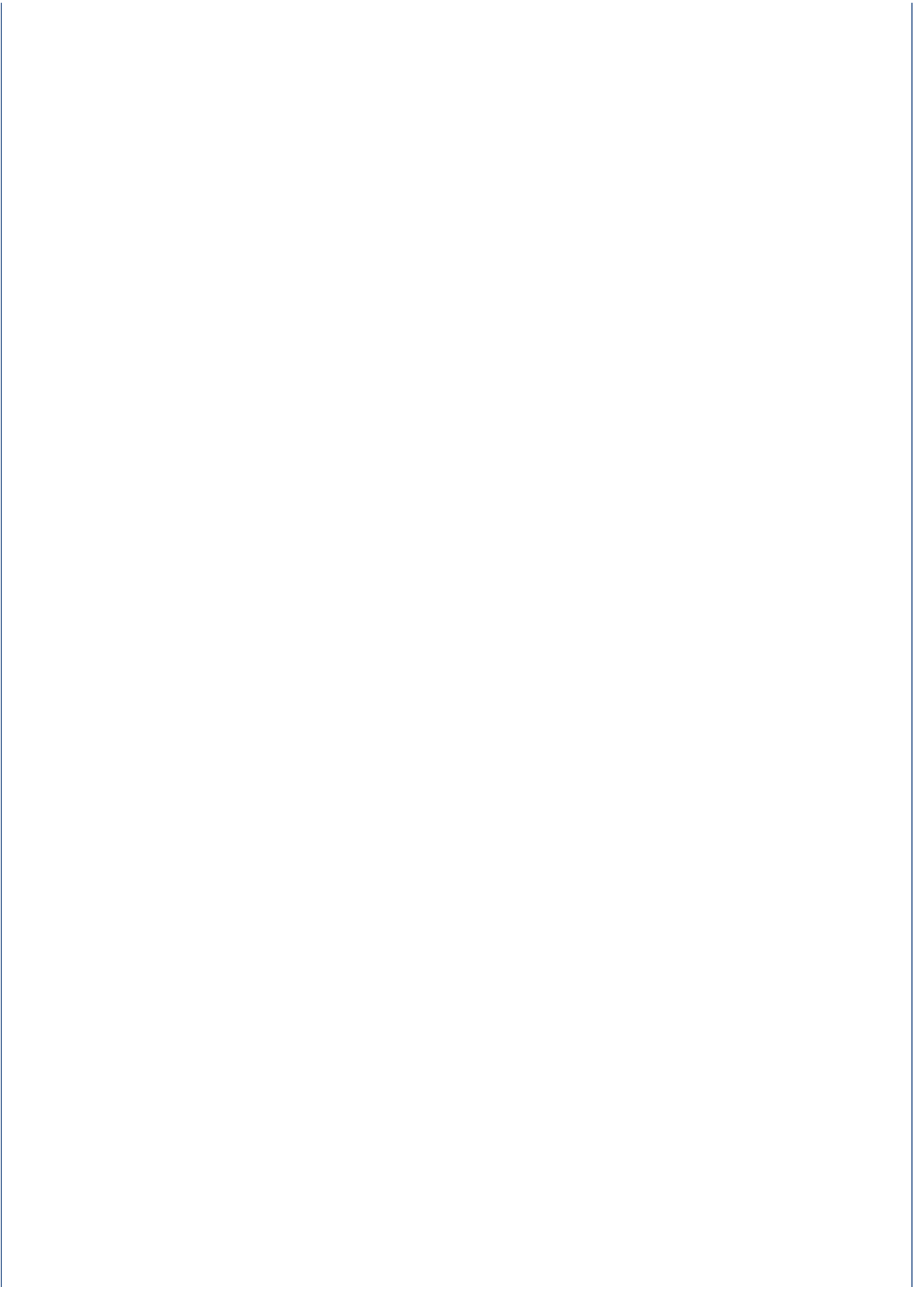
Finding true change agents in long-established organizations can pose unique challenges. General Motors (GM) expects its human resources (HR) managers to be change agents and its top HR executive to set the tone. Experts attributed some of the failed changes at GM to Kathleen Barclay’s stint as global HR vice president. GM next hired Mary Barra, a manufacturing executive they thought could bring about better changes. Barra seemed like a change agent, but even then-CEO Dan Akerson said, “It was the worst application of talent I’ve ever seen.” Barra was later named as GM’s new CEO, displacing Akerson.¹⁴ For the top HR spot, GM next selected Cynthia Brinkley, who supposedly had the right combination of skills to be a change agent. Yet she had no HR background¹⁵ and was replaced shortly afterward by John Quattrone. Quattrone has over 25 years of experience in HR (and over 40 years of tenure with GM).¹⁶ Time will tell.

Many change agents fail because organizational members resist change. In the next section, we discuss resistance to change and what managers can do about it.

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

17.1.1 Proactive situations call for which type of change?



- ☐ planned
- ☐ reactionary
- ☐ scripted
- ☐ both A and B

Check answer

Reset

17.1.2 Consumers now meet and share information in chat rooms and blogs. This is an example of changes in the _____.

- ☐ competition
- ☐ nature of the workforce
- ☐ social trends
- ☐ world politics

Check answer

Reset

Resistance to Change

17-2 Describe ways to overcome resistance to change.

Our egos are fragile, and we often see change as threatening. Even when employees are shown data that suggest they need to change, they latch onto whatever data they can find that suggest they are okay and don't need to change.¹⁷ Employees who feel negatively toward a change cope by not thinking about it, increasing their use of sick time, or quitting. All these reactions can sap the organization of vital energy when it is most needed.¹⁸ Resistance to change doesn't come only from lower levels of the organization. In many cases, higher-level managers resist changes proposed by subordinates, especially if these leaders are focused on immediate performance. Conversely, when leaders are more focused on mastery and exploration, they are more willing to hear and adopt subordinates' suggestions for change.¹⁹

Resistance to change can be positive if it leads to open discussion and debate.²⁰ These responses are usually preferable to apathy or silence and can indicate that members of the organization are engaged in the process, providing change agents an opportunity to explain the change effort. Change agents can also monitor the resistance to modify the change to fit the preferences of members of the organization.

Resistance doesn't necessarily surface in standardized ways. It can be overt, implicit, immediate, or deferred.²¹ It's easiest for management to deal with overt and immediate resistance such as complaints, a work slowdown, or a strike threat. The greater challenge is managing resistance that is implicit or deferred because these responses—loss of loyalty or motivation, increased errors or absenteeism—are more subtle and more difficult to recognize for what they are. Deferred actions also cloud the link between the change and the reaction to it, sometimes surfacing weeks, months, or even years later. Or a single change of little inherent impact may be the straw that breaks the camel's back because resistance to earlier changes has been deferred and stockpiled.

Exhibit 17-2 summarizes major forces for resistance to change, categorized by their sources. Individual sources reside in human characteristics such as perceptions, personalities, and needs. Organizational sources reside in the structural makeup of organizations themselves.

It's worth noting that not all change is good. Rapid, transformational change is risky, so

change agents need to think through the full implications carefully. Speed can lead to bad decisions, and sometimes those initiating change fail to realize the full magnitude of the effects or their true costs.

Exhibit 17-2 Sources of Resistance to Change

Individual Sources

Habit—To cope with life's complexities, we rely on habits or programmed responses. But when confronted with change, this tendency to respond in our accustomed ways becomes a source of resistance.

Security—People with a high need for security are likely to resist change because it threatens their feelings of safety.

Economic factors—Changes in job tasks or established work routines can arouse economic fears if people are concerned that they won't be able to perform the new tasks or routines to their previous standards, especially when pay is closely tied to productivity.

Fear of the unknown—Change substitutes ambiguity and uncertainty for the unknown.

Selective information processing—Individuals are guilty of selectively processing information in order to keep their perceptions intact. They hear what they want to hear, and they ignore information that challenges the world they've created.

Organizational Sources

Structural inertia—Organizations have built-in mechanisms—such as their selection processes and formalized regulations—to produce stability. When an organization is confronted with change, this structural inertia acts as a counterbalance to sustain stability.

Limited focus of change—Organizations consist of a number of interdependent subsystems. One can't be changed without affecting the others. So limited changes in subsystems tend to be nullified by the larger system.

Group inertia—Even if individuals want to change their behavior, group norms may act as a constraint.

Threat to expertise—Changes in organizational patterns may threaten the expertise of specialized groups.

Threat to established power relationships—Any redistribution of decision-making

authority can threaten long-established power relationships within the organization.

Overcoming Resistance to Change

Eight tactics can help change agents deal with resistance to change.²² Let's review them briefly.



Communication Communication is more important than ever in times of change.

One study of German companies revealed changes are most effective when a company communicates a rationale that balances the interests of various stakeholders (shareholders, employees, community, customers) rather than those of shareholders only.²³ Other research on a changing organization in the Philippines found that formal information sessions decreased employees' anxiety about the change, while providing high-quality information about the change increased their commitment to it.²⁴

Participation It's difficult to resist a change decision in which we've participated. Assuming participants have the expertise to make a meaningful contribution, their involvement can reduce resistance, obtain commitment, and increase the quality of the change decision.²⁵ However, these advantages sometimes come with potential negatives: the potential for a poor solution and a great consumption of time.

Building Support and Commitment When managers or employees have low emotional commitment to change, they resist it and favor the status quo.²⁶ Employees are also more accepting of changes when they are committed to the organization as a whole.²⁷ Motivating employees and emphasizing their commitment to the organization overall can help them commit emotionally to the change rather than embrace the status quo. When employees' fear and anxiety are high, counseling and therapy, new-skills training, or a short paid leave of absence may facilitate adjustment to change.



The Ohio Department of Natural Resources used participation, shown here, as an effective tactic for overcoming resistance to change. Faced with the tough task of reducing the use of time and resources, the cash-strapped department involved employees in a continuous improvement process to find better ways to work more efficiently.

Source: Kilchiro Sato/AP Images



Develop Positive Relationships People are more willing to accept changes if they trust the managers implementing them and see them as legitimate.²⁸ One study surveyed 235 employees from a large housing corporation in the Netherlands that was experiencing a merger. Those who had a more positive relationship with their supervisor, and who felt that the work environment supported development, were much more positive about the change process.²⁹ Underscoring the importance of social context, other work shows that even individuals who are generally resistant to change will be more willing to accept new and different ideas (and can even experience less stress) when they feel supported by their coworkers and believe the environment is safe for taking risks.³⁰ Another set of studies found that individuals who usually resisted change felt more positive about it if they trusted the change agent.³¹ This research suggests that if managers are able to facilitate positive relationships, they may be able to overcome resistance to change even among those who ordinarily don't like changes.



Implementing Changes Fairly One way organizations can minimize negative impact is to make sure change is implemented fairly. As we saw in Chapter 7, procedural

fairness is especially important when employees perceive an outcome as negative, so it's crucial that employees see the reason for the change, are kept informed about its progress, and perceive its implementation as consistent and fair.³² However, research on 26 large-scale planned change projects in the Netherlands reveals that change recipients are not always self-interested: They focus on the impact that change has on their coworkers, the organization, and other parties.³³ Some resistance might be inevitable, particularly when the change affects the employees' freedoms, although fairness perceptions still help alleviate this resistance.³⁴

Manipulation and Cooptation *Manipulation* refers to covert influence attempts.³⁵

Twisting facts to make them more attractive, withholding information, and creating false rumors to get employees to accept change are all examples of manipulation. If management threatens to close a manufacturing plant whose employees are resisting an across-the-board pay cut, and if the threat is actually unfounded, management is using manipulation.

Cooptation, on the other hand, combines manipulation and participation.³⁶ It seeks to buy off the leaders of a resistance group by giving them a key role, seeking their advice not to find a better solution but to get their endorsement. Both manipulation and cooptation are relatively inexpensive ways to gain the support of adversaries, but they can backfire if the targets become aware that they are being tricked or used. Once that's discovered, the change agent's credibility may drop to zero.



Selecting People Who Accept Change Research suggests the ability to accept and

adapt easily to *change* is related to personality—some people are simply more receptive to change.³⁷ Individuals who are emotionally stable, have high core self-evaluations, are willing to take risks, and are flexible in their behavior are prime candidates.³⁸ This seems to be universal. One study of managers in the United States, Europe, and Asia found those with a positive self-concept and high risk tolerance coped better with organizational change.³⁹ Individuals higher in general mental ability are also better able to learn and to adapt to changes in the workplace.⁴⁰ In sum, an impressive body of evidence shows organizations can facilitate change by selecting people predisposed to accept it.

Besides selecting individuals who are willing to accept changes, it is also possible to select teams that are more adaptable. In general, teams that are strongly motivated by learning about and mastering tasks, are high in cognitive ability, and have collectivistic values are better able to adapt to changing environments.⁴¹ It may thus be necessary to

consider not just individual motivation but also group motivation when trying to implement changes. A meta-analytic review of hundreds of teams suggests that teams whose members are high in cognitive ability and motivated to master their tasks tend to be the most adaptable.⁴²

Coercion Last on the list of tactics is *coercion*, the application of direct threats or force on the resisters.⁴³ If management is determined to close a manufacturing plant whose employees don't acquiesce to a pay cut, the company is using coercion. Other examples include threatening employees with transfers, blocked promotions, negative performance evaluations, and poor letters of recommendation. Coercion is most effective when some force or pressure is enacted on at least some resisters—for instance, if an employee is publicly refused a promotion request, the threat of blocked promotions will become a real possibility in the minds of other employees. The advantages and drawbacks of coercion are approximately the same as for manipulation and cooptation.

The Politics of Change

No discussion of resistance would be complete without a brief mention of the politics of change.⁴⁴ Because change invariably threatens the status quo, it inherently implies political activity.

Politics suggests the impetus for change is more likely to come from outside change agents, employees new to the organization (who have less invested in the status quo), or managers slightly removed from the main power structure. Managers who have spent a long time with an organization and who have achieved a senior position in the hierarchy are often major impediments to change. For them, change can be a very real threat to their status and position. Yet they may be expected to implement changes to demonstrate they're not merely caretakers. By acting as change agents, they can convey to stockholders, suppliers, employees, and customers that they are addressing problems and adapting to a dynamic environment. Of course, as you might guess, when forced to introduce change, these longtime power holders tend to implement incremental changes. Radical change is often considered too threatening. This explains why boards of directors that recognize the imperative for rapid and radical change frequently turn to outside candidates for new leadership.⁴⁵

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

17.2.1 Which of the following is an example of a source of individual resistance?

- ☐ limited focus of change
- ☐ product orientation
- ☐ fear of the unknown
- ☐ structural inertia

Check answer

Reset

17.2.2 Which of the following reactions from employees is preferable as a response to change?

- ☐ silence
- ☐ apathy
- ☐ resignation
- ☐ open discussion

Check answer

Reset

Approaches to Managing Organizational Change

17-3 Compare the four main approaches to managing organizational change.

We now turn to several approaches to managing change: Lewin's classic three-step model of the change process, Kotter's eight-step plan, action research, and organizational development.

Lewin's Three-Step Model of the Change Process

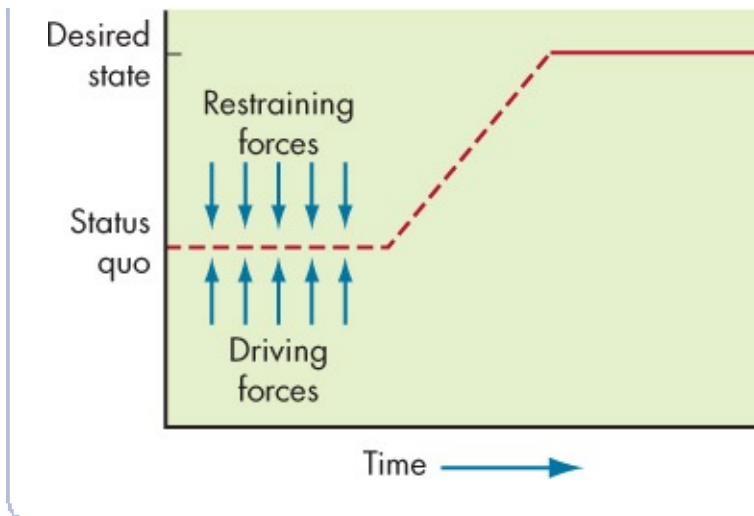
Kurt Lewin argued that successful change in organizations should follow three steps: *unfreezing* the status quo, *movement* to a desired end state, and *refreezing* the new change to make it permanent⁴⁶ (see Exhibit 17-3).

By definition, status quo is an equilibrium state. To move from equilibrium—to overcome the pressures of both individual resistance and group conformity—unfreezing must happen in one of three ways (see Exhibit 17-4). For one, the **driving forces** ⓘ, which direct behavior away from the status quo, can be increased. For another, the **restraining forces** ⓘ, which hinder movement away from equilibrium, can be decreased. A third alternative is to combine the first two approaches. Companies that have been successful in the past are likely to encounter restraining forces because people question the need for change.⁴⁷

Exhibit 17-3 Lewin's Three-Step Change Model



Exhibit 17-4 Unfreezing the Status Quo



Once the movement stage begins, it's important to keep the momentum going. Organizations that build up to change do less well than those that get to and through the movement stage quickly. When change has been implemented, the new situation must be refrozen so it can be sustained over time. Without this last step, change will likely be short-lived and employees will attempt to revert to the previous equilibrium state. The objective of refreezing, then, is to stabilize the new situation by balancing the driving and restraining forces.

Kotter's Eight-Step Plan

John Kotter of Harvard Business School built on Lewin's three-step model to create a more detailed approach for implementing change.⁴⁸ Kotter began by listing common mistakes managers make when trying to initiate change. They may fail to create a sense of urgency about the need for change, a coalition for managing the change process, and a vision for change, and they may fail to communicate effectively about it and/or to anchor the changes into the organization's culture. They also may fail to remove obstacles that could impede the vision's achievement and/or provide short-term and achievable goals. Finally, they may declare victory too soon.

Kotter established eight sequential steps to overcome these problems. They are listed in Exhibit 17-5.

Exhibit 17-5 Kotter's Eight-Step Plan for Implementing Change

1. Establish a sense of urgency by creating a compelling reason for why change is needed.
2. Form a coalition with enough power to lead the change.
3. Create a new vision to direct the change and strategies for achieving the vision.
4. Communicate the vision throughout the organization.
5. Empower others to act on the vision by removing barriers to change and encouraging risk taking and creative problem solving.
6. Plan for, create, and reward short-term “wins” that move the organization toward the new vision.
7. Consolidate improvements, reassess changes, and make necessary adjustments in the new programs.
8. Reinforce the changes by demonstrating the relationship between new behaviors and organizational success.

Sources: Based on J. Kotter, *Leading Change* (Boston, MA: Harvard Business School, 1996).

Notice how Kotter’s first four steps essentially extrapolate Lewin’s unfreezing stage. Steps 5, 6, and 7 represent movement, and the final step works on refreezing. So Kotter’s contribution lies in providing managers and change agents with a more detailed guide for successfully implementing change.

Action Research

Action research ⓘ is a change process based on the systematic collection of data and selection of a change action based on what the analyzed data indicate.⁴⁹ Its value is in providing a scientific methodology for managing planned change. Action research consists of five steps (note how they closely parallel the scientific method): diagnosis, analysis, feedback, action, and evaluation.

The change agent, often an outside consultant in action research, begins by gathering information about problems, concerns, and needed changes from members of the organization. This *diagnosis* is analogous to the physician’s search to find specifically what ails a patient. In action research, the change agent asks questions, reviews records, and interviews employees by actively listening to their concerns.

Diagnosis is followed by *analysis*. What problems do people focus on? What patterns do these problems seem to take? The change agent synthesizes this information into primary concerns, problem areas, and possible actions.

Action research requires the people who will participate in a change program to help identify the problem and determine the solution. So the third step—*feedback*—requires sharing with employees what has been found from the first and second steps. The employees, with the help of the change agent, develop action plans for bringing about needed change.

Now the *action* part of action research is set in motion. The employees and the change agent carry out the specific actions they have identified to correct the problem.

The final step, consistent with the scientific underpinnings of action research, is *evaluation* of the action plan's effectiveness, using the initial data gathered as a benchmark.

Action research provides at least two specific benefits. First, it's problem-focused. The change agent objectively looks for problems, and the type of problem determines the type of change action. This is a process that makes intuitive sense. Unfortunately, in reality, change activities can become solution-centered and therefore erroneously predetermined. The change agent has a favorite solution—for example, implementing flextime, teams, or a process reengineering program—and then seeks out problems that the solution fits.

A second benefit of action research is the lowering of resistance. Because action research engages employees so thoroughly in the process, it reduces resistance to change. Once employees have actively participated in the feedback stage, the change process typically takes on a momentum of its own.

Organizational Development

Organizational development (OD) ⓘ is a collection of change methods that try to improve organizational effectiveness and employee well-being.⁵⁰ OD methods value human and organizational growth, collaborative and participative processes, and a spirit of inquiry.⁵¹ Contemporary OD borrows heavily from postmodern philosophy in placing heavy emphasis on the subjective ways people see and make sense of their work environment. The change agent may take the lead in OD, but there is a strong emphasis on collaboration.

What are some OD techniques or interventions for bringing about change? Here are six.

Sensitivity Training A variety of names—for example, **sensitivity training** ⓘ, laboratory training, encounter groups, and training groups (T-groups)—all refer to an early method of

changing behavior through unstructured group interaction.⁵² Current organizational interventions such as diversity training, executive coaching, and team-building exercises are descendants of this early OD intervention technique.

In classic sensitivity training, members were brought together in a free and open environment in which participants discussed themselves and their interactive processes; they were loosely directed by a professional behavioral scientist who created the opportunity to express ideas, beliefs, and attitudes without taking any leadership role. The group was process-oriented, which means that individuals learned through observing and participating rather than being told. With all forms of OD, caution must be taken so the unstructured groups are not intimidating, chaotic, and damaging to work relationships.

Survey Feedback One tool for assessing the attitudes of organizational members, identifying discrepancies among member perceptions, and solving differences is the **survey feedback**  approach.⁵³

Everyone in an organization can participate in survey feedback, but of key importance is the organizational “family”—the manager of any given unit and the employees who report directly to him or her. All usually complete a questionnaire about their perceptions and attitudes on a range of topics, including decision-making practices; communication effectiveness; coordination among units; and satisfaction with the organization, job, peers, and immediate supervisor.

Data from questionnaires are tabulated along with data pertaining to an individual’s specific organizational “family” and the entire organization, and then distributed to employees. These data become the springboard for identifying problems and clarifying issues that may be creating difficulties for people. Particular attention is given to encouraging discussion and ensuring it focuses on issues and ideas, not on attacking individuals. For instance, are people listening? Are new ideas being generated? Can decision making, interpersonal relations, or job assignments be improved? Answers should lead the group to commit to various remedies for the problems.

The survey feedback approach can be helpful to keep decision makers informed about the attitudes of employees toward the organization. However, individuals are influenced by many factors when they respond to surveys, which may make some findings unreliable. Managers who use the survey feedback approach should therefore monitor their organization’s current events and employee response rates.

Process Consultation Managers often sense that their unit's performance can be improved but are unable to identify what to improve and how. The purpose of **process consultation (PC)** ⓘ is for an outside consultant to assist a client, usually a manager, through crafting "a relationship through a continuous effort of 'jointly deciphering what is going on' ... to make coauthored choices about how to go on."⁵⁴ These events might include workflow, informal relationships among unit members, and formal communication channels.

PC is similar to sensitivity training in assuming we can improve organizational effectiveness by dealing with interpersonal problems and in emphasizing involvement. But PC is more task-directed, and consultants do not solve the organization's problems but rather guide or coach the client to solve his or her own problems after *jointly* diagnosing what needs improvement. The client develops the skill to analyze processes within his or her unit and can therefore use the skill long after the consultant is gone. Because the client actively participates in both the diagnosis and the development of alternatives, he or she arrives at a greater understanding of the process and the remedy, and becomes less resistant to the action plan chosen.

Team Building We've noted throughout this text that organizations increasingly rely on teams to accomplish work tasks. **Team building** ⓘ uses high-interaction group activities to increase trust and openness among team members, improve coordination efforts, and increase team performance.⁵⁵ Here, we emphasize the intragroup level, meaning within organizational families (command groups) as well as committees, project teams, self-managed teams, and task groups.

Team building typically includes goal setting, development of interpersonal relations among team members, role analysis to clarify each member's role and responsibilities, and team process analysis. It may emphasize or exclude certain activities, depending on the purpose of the development effort and the specific problems the team is confronting. Basically, however, team building uses high interaction among members to increase trust and openness. In these times when organizations increasingly rely on teams, team building is an important topic.

Intergroup Development A major area of concern in OD is dysfunctional conflict among groups. **Intergroup development** ⓘ seeks to change groups' attitudes, stereotypes, and perceptions about each other.⁵⁶ Here, training sessions closely resemble diversity training,

except rather than focusing on demographic differences, they focus on differences among occupations, departments, or divisions within an organization.

In one organization, for example, the engineers saw the accounting department as composed of shy and conservative types, and the HR department as having a bunch of “ultra-liberals more concerned that some protected group of employees might get their feelings hurt than with the company making a profit.” Such stereotypes can have an obvious negative impact on coordination efforts among departments.



A team of U.S. marines with Company C, 6th Engineer Support battalion, participate in a team-building activity with British commandos from the 131 Commando Squadron Royal Engineers during a simulation of a raid of an urban compound at Fort Indiantown Gap. These types of training exercises give the marines and commandos an opportunity to exchange tactics and build working relationships across group lines.

Source: PJF Military Collection/Alamy Stock Photo

Among several approaches for improving intergroup relations, a popular one emphasizes problem solving.⁵⁷ Each group meets independently to list its perceptions of itself and another group and how it believes the other group perceives it. The groups then share their lists, discuss similarities and differences, and look for causes of disparities. Are the groups' goals at odds? Are the perceptions distorted? On what basis were stereotypes formulated? Have some differences been caused by a misunderstanding of intentions? Have words and concepts been defined differently by each group? Answers to questions like these clarify the

exact nature of the conflict.

Once they have identified the causes of discrepancies, the groups move to the integration phase—developing solutions to improve relations between them. Subgroups of members from each of the conflicting groups can conduct further diagnoses and formulate alternative solutions.

Appreciative Inquiry Most OD approaches are problem-centered. They identify a problem or set of problems, then look for a solution. **Appreciative inquiry (AI)**  instead accentuates the positive. Rather than looking for problems to fix, it seeks to identify the unique qualities and special strengths of an organization, which members can build on to improve performance.⁵⁸ That is, AI focuses on an organization's successes rather than its problems.

The AI process consists of four steps—discovery, dreaming, design, and destiny—often played out in a large-group meeting over 2 to 3 days and overseen by a trained change agent. *Discovery* sets out to identify what people think are the organization's strengths. Employees recount times they felt the organization worked best or when they specifically felt most satisfied with their jobs. In *dreaming*, employees use information from the discovery phase to speculate on possible futures, such as what the organization will be like in 5 years. In *design*, participants find a common vision of how the organization will look in the future and agree on its unique qualities. For the fourth step, participants seek to define the organization's *destiny* or how to fulfill their dream, and they typically write action plans and develop implementation strategies.

AI has proven to be an effective change strategy in organizations such as GTE, Roadway Express, American Express, and the U.S. Navy.⁵⁹ American Express used AI to revitalize its culture during a lean economy. In workshops, employees described how they already felt proud of working at American Express and were encouraged to create a change vision by describing how the company could be better in the future. The efforts led to some concrete improvements. Senior managers were able to use employees' information to better their methods of making financial forecasts, improve information technology (IT) investments, and create new performance-management tools for managers. The end result was a renewed culture focused on winning attitudes and behaviors.⁶⁰

If your professor has assigned this activity, go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management to complete the Mini Sim.

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

17.3.1 Which of the following is the first step in Kotter's eight-step plan for implementing change?

- ☐ Create a new vision to direct the change and strategies for achieving the vision.
- ☐ Establish a sense of urgency by creating a compelling reason for why change is needed.
- ☐ Plan for, create, and reward short-term “wins” that move the organization toward the new vision.
- ☐ Form a coalition with enough power to lead the change.

Check answer

Reset

17.3.2 Rather than looking for problems, _____ seeks to identify the unique qualities and special strengths of an organization, which can then be built upon to improve performance.

- ☐ appreciative inquiry
- ☐ action research
- ☐ team building
- ☐ process consultation

Check answer

Reset

Creating a Culture for Change

17-4 Demonstrate three ways of creating a culture for change.

We've considered how organizations can *adapt* to change. But recently, some OB scholars have focused on a more proactive approach—how organizations can *embrace* change by transforming their cultures. In this section, we review three approaches: managing paradox, stimulating an innovative culture, and creating a learning organization. We also address the issue of organizational change and stress.

Managing Paradox

In a *paradox* situation, we are required to balance tensions across various courses of action. There is a constant process of finding a balancing point, a dynamic equilibrium, among shifting priorities over time.⁶¹ Think of riding a bicycle: You must maintain forward momentum or you'll fall over. From this perspective, there is no such thing as a separate discipline of “change management” because all management is dealing with constant change and adaptation.

The idea of paradox sounds abstract, but more specific concepts have begun to emerge from a growing body of research.⁶² Several key paradoxes have been identified. *Learning* is a paradox because it requires building on the past while rejecting it at the same time. *Organizing* is a paradox because it calls for setting direction and leading while requiring empowerment and flexibility. *Performing* is a paradox between creating organization-wide goals to concentrate effort and recognizing the diverse goals of stakeholders inside and outside the organization. And finally, *belonging* is a paradox between establishing a sense of collective identity and acknowledging our desire to be recognized and accepted as unique individuals.

Managers can learn a few lessons from **paradox theory** ⓘ,⁶³ which states that the key paradox in management is that there is no final optimal status for an organization.⁶⁴ The first lesson is that, as the environment and members of the organization change, different elements take on more or less importance. For example, sometimes a company needs to acknowledge past success and learn how it worked, while at other times looking backward only hinders

progress. There is some evidence that managers who think holistically and recognize the importance of balancing paradoxical factors are more effective, especially in generating adaptive and creative behavior in those they are managing.⁶⁵

Stimulating a Culture of Innovation

How can an organization become more innovative? An excellent model is W. L. Gore & Associates, the \$2.9-billion-per-year company best known as the maker of Gore-Tex fabric.⁶⁶ Gore has developed a reputation as one of the most innovative U.S. companies by developing a stream of diverse products—including guitar strings, vacuum cleaner filters, industrial sealants, and fuel cell components.

What's the secret of Gore's success? What can other organizations do to duplicate its track record for innovation? Gore pioneered a flat, unique, lattice-type organizational structure (now termed an open allocation structure)⁶⁷ run by employees (associates) working in self-organized project groups.⁶⁸ Gore also allocates 10 percent of each employee's day to creative tasks and idea generation.⁶⁹ Although there is no guaranteed formula, certain characteristics surface repeatedly when researchers study innovative organizations. They are structural, cultural, and human resources characteristics. Change agents should consider introducing these characteristics into their organizations to create cultures and climate for innovation and creativity. Let's start by clarifying what we mean by innovation.

Definition of Innovation We said change refers to making things different. **Innovation** ⓘ, a specialized kind of change, is applied to initiating or improving a product, process, or service, in other words, a better solution.⁷⁰ So all innovations imply change, but not all changes introduce new ideas or lead to significant improvements. Innovations can range from incremental improvements, such as tablets, to radical breakthroughs, such as Nissan's electric Leaf car.



Tech company Atlassian has very clear corporate values. Co-founder Mike Cannon-Brookes (centre right) believes that the company has created a fair set of values, supportive and strong, with the notion that the business has their employees' backs and that they are all in it together.

Source: Trevor Collens/Alamy Stock Photo

Sources of Innovation *Structural variables* are one potential source of innovation.⁷¹ A comprehensive review of the structure–innovation relationship leads to the following conclusions:

1. **Organic structures positively influence innovation.** Because they're lower in vertical differentiation, formalization, and centralization, organic organizations facilitate the flexibility, adaptation, and cross-fertilization that make the adoption of innovations easier.⁷²
2. **Innovation-contingent rewards positively influence innovation.** When creativity is rewarded, firms tend to become more innovative—especially when employees are given feedback on their performance in addition to autonomy in doing their jobs.⁷³
3. **Innovation is nurtured when there are slack resources.** Having an abundance of resources, including an equal distribution of wealth, allows an organization to afford to purchase or develop innovations, bear the cost of instituting them, and absorb failures.⁷⁴
4. **Interunit communication is high in innovative organizations.** These organizations are heavy users of committees, task forces, cross-functional teams, and other

mechanisms that facilitate interaction across departmental lines.⁷⁵

Context and Innovation Innovative organizations tend to have similar *cultures*. They encourage experimentation and reward both successes and failures. They celebrate mistakes.⁷⁶ Unfortunately, in too many organizations, people are rewarded for the absence of failures rather than for the presence of successes. Such cultures extinguish risk taking and innovation.⁷⁷ Innovative organizations tend to share a common vision as well as underlying goals. They have a shared sense of purpose.⁷⁸ Innovative organizations also tend to be cohesive, mutually supportive, and encouraging of innovation.⁷⁹



Within the *human resources* category, innovative organizations actively promote the training and development of their members so they keep current, offer high job security so employees don't fear getting fired for making mistakes, and encourage individuals to become champions of change.⁸⁰ A study of organizations in the manufacturing sector in the United Kingdom looked at the relationship between teamwork and organizational innovation and the moderating role of HRM systems. It was found that widespread use of teamwork increases innovation and that HRM systems can act to facilitate or constrain teams in organizations.⁸¹

Idea Champions and Innovation Once a new idea has been developed, **idea champions**  actively and enthusiastically promote it, build support, overcome resistance, and ensure it is implemented.⁸² Champions often have similar personality characteristics:⁸³ extremely high self-confidence, persistence, energy, and a tendency to take risks. They usually display traits associated with transformational leadership—they inspire and energize others with their vision of an innovation's potential and their strong personal conviction about their mission. Situations can also influence the extent to which idea champions are forces for change. For example, passion for change among entrepreneurs is greatest when work roles and the social environment encourage them to put their creative identities forward. On the flip side, work roles that push creative individuals to do routine management and administration tasks diminish both the passion for and implementation of change.⁸⁴ Idea champions are good at gaining the commitment of others, and their jobs should provide considerable decision-making discretion. This autonomy helps them introduce and implement innovations⁸⁵ when the context is supportive.



Do successful idea champions do things differently in varied cultures? Yes, they do.⁸⁶ Generally, people in collectivist cultures prefer appeals for cross-functional support for innovation efforts; people in high power-distance cultures prefer champions to work closely with those in authority to approve innovative activities before work is begun; and the higher the uncertainty avoidance of a society, the more champions should work within the organization's rules and procedures to develop the innovation. These findings suggest that effective managers alter their organization's innovation strategies to reflect cultural values. For instance, although idea champions in Russia might succeed by ignoring budgetary limitations and working around confining procedures, idea champions in Austria, Denmark, Germany, or other cultures high in uncertainty avoidance will be more effective by closely following budgets and procedures.



Sergio Marcchione, CEO of Fiat-Chrysler, originally acted as an idea champion for the single objective of updating the company's product pipeline. To facilitate the change, he radically dismantled the bureaucracy, tearing up Chrysler's organization chart and introducing a flatter structure with himself at the head. As a result, the company introduced a more innovative line of vehicles and planned to redesign or substantially refresh 75 percent of its lineup in 2010 alone.⁸⁷ In 2014, Marchionne announced an ambitious plan to significantly increase the company's U.S. auto sales through innovations in the product line. The organization is struggling to make his dreams a reality by 2018, but they remain committed to his goals. "We've always had something that came out of left field and made us very, very uncomfortable," Marcchione said—the rallying cry for any idea champion.⁸⁸

Creating a Learning Organization

Another way an organization can proactively manage change is to make continuous growth part of its culture—to become a learning organization.⁸⁹

What Is a Learning Organization? Just as individuals learn, so too do organizations. A **learning organization** ⓘ has developed the continuous capacity to adapt and change. The Dimensions of the Learning Organization Questionnaire (DLOQ) has been adopted and adapted internationally to assess the degree of commitment to learning organization principles.⁹⁰

Exhibit 17-6 Characteristics of a Learning Organization

1. There exists a shared vision that everyone agrees on.
2. People discard their old ways of thinking and the standard routines they use for solving problems or doing their jobs.
3. Members think of all organizational processes, activities, functions, and interactions with the environment as part of a system of interrelationships.
4. People openly communicate with each other (across vertical and horizontal boundaries) without fear of criticism or punishment.
5. People sublimate their personal self-interest and fragmented departmental interests to work together to achieve the organization's shared vision.

Sources: Based on P. M. Senge, *The Fifth Discipline: The Art and Practice of the Learning Organization*, 2nd ed. (New York: Random House, 2006).

Exhibit 17-6 summarizes the five basic characteristics of a learning organization—one in which people put aside their old ways of thinking, learn to be open with each other, understand how their organization really works, form a plan or vision everyone can agree on, and work together to achieve that vision.⁹¹

Proponents of the learning organization envision it as a remedy for three fundamental problems of traditional organizations: fragmentation, competition, and reactivity.⁹² First, *fragmentation* based on specialization creates “walls” and “chimneys” that separate different functions into independent and often warring fiefdoms. Second, an overemphasis on *competition* often undermines collaboration. Managers compete over who is right, who knows more, or who is more persuasive. Divisions compete when they ought to cooperate and share knowledge. Team leaders compete to show who the best manager is. And third, *reactiveness* misdirects management's attention to solving problems rather than creating. The problem solver tries to make something go away, while a creator tries to bring something new into being. An emphasis on reactivity to problems pushes out innovation and continuous improvement and, in its place, encourages people to concentrate on quick fixes as problems emerge.

Managing Learning What can managers do to make their firms learning organizations? Here are some suggestions:

- ***Establish a strategy.*** Management needs to make explicit its commitment to change, innovation, and continuous improvement.
- ***Redesign the organization's structure.*** The formal structure can be a serious impediment to learning. Flattening the structure, eliminating or combining departments, and increasing the use of cross-functional teams reinforce interdependence and reduce boundaries.
- ***Reshape the organization's culture.*** Managers must demonstrate by their actions that taking risks and admitting failures are desirable. This means rewarding people who take chances and make mistakes. They also need to encourage functional conflict.

Organizational Change and Stress

Think about the times you have felt stressed during your work life. Look past the everyday stress factors that can spill over to the workplace, like a traffic jam that makes you late for work or a broken coffee machine that keeps you from your morning java. What were your more memorable and lasting stressful times at work? For many people, these were caused by organizational change.

Researchers are increasingly studying the effects of organizational change on employees. We are interested in determining the specific causes and mitigating factors of stress to learn how to manage organizational change effectively.⁹³ The overall findings are that organizational changes that incorporate OB knowledge of how people react to stressors may yield more effective results than organizational changes that are managed only objectively through goal-setting plans.⁹⁴

Not surprisingly, we also find that the role of leadership is critical. One study indicated that transformational leaders can help shape employee affect so employees stay committed to the change and do not perceive it as stressful.⁹⁵ Other research indicated that a positive orientation toward change *before* new initiatives are planned decreases employees' stress when they go through organizational changes and increases their positive attitudes.⁹⁶ Managers can be continually working to increase employees' self-efficacy, change-related attitudes, and perceived control over the situation to create this positive change orientation. For instance, they can use role clarification and continual rewards to increase self-efficacy,

and they can enhance employees' perceived control and positive attitudes toward change by including them from the planning stages to the application of new processes. Another study added the need for increasing the amount of communication to employees during change, assessing and enhancing employees' psychological resilience through offering social support, and training employees in emotional self-regulation techniques.⁹⁷ Through these methods, managers can help employees keep their stress levels low and their commitment high.

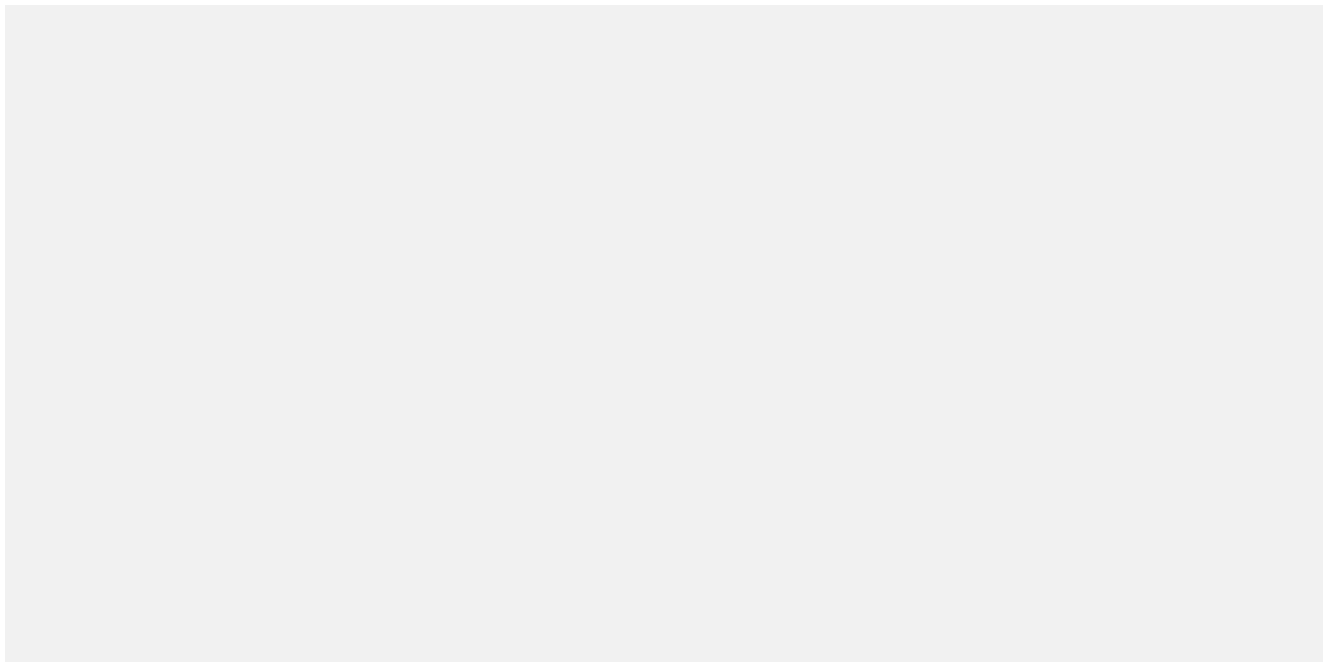
Often, organizational changes are stressful because some employees perceive aspects of the changes as threatening. These employees are more likely to quit, partially in reaction to their stress. To reduce the perception of threat, employees need to perceive the organizational changes as fair. Research indicates that those who have a positive change orientation before changes are planned are less likely to perceive changes as unfair or threatening.

MyLab Management Watch It

If your professor has assigned this activity, go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management to complete the video exercise.

East Haven Fire Department Managing Stress

Watch it video.



Watch it video.

A **transcript** of this video is available [here](#).

Transcript

East Haven Fire Department Managing Stress

>> On this particular storm

>> I watched the weather very diligently

>> and I came to the conclusion that we were in trouble.

>> And I would expect that we were going to get

>> a lot of damage from this storm and it might exceed

>> anything that I've dealt with in the past.

>> I'm Doug Jackson, Fire chief,

>> Emergency Management Director

>> of the East Haven Fire Department.

>> In the days before, actually, I made sure

>> that I called in extra shifts of fire men,

>> let everybody in on the plan I had.

>> I put together a pretty solid plan

>> as to what we expected to happen

>> and how we were going to deal with it.

>> Prior to the storm actually hitting

>> we were stationed in our fire headquarters,

>> which is remote from the shoreline.

>> My name is Fred Parlato.

>> I work for the East Haven Fire Department.

>> I'm a fire fighter

>> and I'm cross trained as an EMT.

>> As a volunteer I worked for eight years

>> and I'm in my 20th year as a career fire fighter.

>> I can compare it only to the other job that I've ever had

>> and I still have as a electrician

>> and It's definitely a much higher stress environment

>> that we're put into on a regular basis.

>> But, believe it or not, you get used to it.

>> The decision for the mandatory evacuation,

>> the actual order comes out from the mayor.

>> I had it in my mind, like 12 hours in advance,

>> maybe a little bit more.

>> The firemen usually have a very good rapport

>> with the public to start with,

>> they're an ideal candidate to send out

>> door to door for that stuff.

>> The public still has a good deal of trust for us.

>> They explain things,

>> they're polite and we didn't pull any of the tricks that,

>> what's your social security number,

>> all that kind of stuff, we just avoided all of that.

>> We told them, listen, we just want you to understand

>> during the height of the storm we will most likely

>> be unable to do anything for you,

>> if you can contact us.

>> I don't know if scared is the right word.

>> I was confident that the weather people got it right this time.

>> By Saturday night at 6 o'clock

>> we had double crews in all the stations

>> and we were pretty much just waiting for it to happen.

>> The first call we responded to was a report

>> of a car floating in the water with people in it.

>> There are times when I find that the environment

>> is not as familiar as something I've had in the past

>> and I guess you could attribute it to being nervous,

>> it's more of an unknown,

>> trying to rely back on the training that I've had

>> to mitigate whatever situation I'm in.

>> The stress level was, I had to leave the EOC

>> because we were getting spread so thin.

>> I came down to check on an incident down here

>> and I ended up never leaving from that point.

>> I wasn't back at the emergency operation center at all.

>> When I was standing over there helping with the rescue

>> and I saw the waves hitting

>> the second floor of the homes right in this area,

>> I knew we were going to deal with devastation.

>> I've never seen anything like that before.

>> That went a little beyond what I expected.

>> Well, once we saw the damage

>> and houses lifted off their foundations,

>> that brings you right to open gas lines,

>> the power issues when,

>> there was still power in a lot of sections at that point,

>> we don't know what was de-energized and what was not.

>> There's all kinds of hazards that don't normally exist

>> and we just kind of locked down the entire area.

>> We didn't make a lot of residents happy.

>> Everyone wants to get in and see exactly what's left,

>> how bad did I get it, that kind of stuff.

>> I understand that but we had a bigger purpose at that point.

>> I had to make sure that there was nobody left behind.

>> I called in a USAR team.

>> I had, like, 375 people here from USAR,

>> search dogs and all the teams.

>> It definitely is stressful to engage people that are not cooperating

>> with what our basic premise is life safety.

>> They had their own reasoning for that

>> and I had to try and understand their side of the situation,

>> however, I would try and plead with them

>> that their life probably was in danger

>> and that was our main focus,

>> so, property can always be replaced.

>> We work with the public at the worst times in their life.

>> It's nice when you're collecting for MDA and stuff

>> when you deal with the public, it's nice when

>> you're doing all these other good guy things

>> but most of the time we're at a fire,

>> a car accident, a medical call,

>> we have to give them horrible news when we aren't successful

>> in saving one of their immediate family.

>> We're used to dealing with that kind of stuff.

>> My guys are very highly trained

>> and it's just experience that you really can't,

>> I don't know what would shake me at this point

>> from what I've seen and it kind of goes downhill from there.

>> We stand fast on a scene, we do everything that we can,

>> we aim for instant stabilization in any type of incident,

>> and if we're excited, that just exponentially gets worse

>> with everyone we're dealing with so we just don't do that.

>> I worked a total of 40 hours straight.

>> At the end of the 40 hours I was pretty much spent,

>> there wasn't much more that I could have done

>> effectively at that point.

>> After we got into some excessive hours

>> I tried to keep them down to 24 hours on a shift,

>> before, we usually don't work 24s

>> but 24, we worked our way up to 36,

>> then I was trying to rotate them in and out.

>> I had a shelter set up, besides the public shelter,

>> I had another shelter set up for the firefighters

>> and if they had any immediate family

>> that they couldn't leave alone,

>> they were in an endangered area,

>> I had supplies and stuff set ahead for them there

>> because you can't expect someone to come to work

>> and have 100% of their thought process with them

>> if they're wondering if their family is in

>> the same situation as other people,

>> so, you take that out of the equation

>> and you get a lot more out of your people.

>> East Haven's 12 square miles,

>> we're just a small town, about 30,000 population,

>> and for some reason, as calls and stuff,

>> we're extremely busy for our size.

>> We're up over 5,500 calls a year for fire service,

>> just for the fire department,

>> between medicals and fires and all that stuff.

>> So, we're a busy little town.

>> We have an EAP for all town employees.

>> We've had it a long time at the fire department.

>> We use a peer to peer process.

>> There's a group that takes care of that within the fire services.

>> Firemen talk best to firemen.

>> It's all private.

>> I know how many people go a month.

>> That's about all I know, that's all I want to know.

>> I just make it available to them

>> and if I see somebody that's hurting,

>> we know each other very well

>> or one of the other guys tips me off or something,

>> we just take them aside and say, listen,

>> this is available to you if you chose to do it.

>> You air them out.

>> Just by the camaraderie that we deal with,

>> we're generally never alone in any one situation.

>> There's usually a group of us

>> and we sort of have a de-stress period after that

>> amongst ourselves and that's pretty effective.

>> I have an effective group.

>> I really feel we did a good job on this one here

>> and from what I heard feedback, it sounds like we did,

>> so, whatever we have to do to keep these guys going,

>> I'm nothing without the guys

>> so we have to keep the guys running.

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

17.4.1 Which of the following actions can extinguish risk-taking and innovation?

- ☐ long tenure in management
- ☐ encouraging experimentation
- ☐ rewarding for the absence of failures rather than for the presence of successes
- ☐ using organic organizational structures

Check answer

Reset

17.4.2 Which of the following characteristics is not attributed to idea champions?

- ☐ high self-confidence
- ☐ high persistence
- ☐ high resistance
- ☐ high energy

Check answer

Reset

Stress at Work

17-5 Identify the potential environmental, organizational, and personal sources of stress at work and the role of individual and cultural differences.

Friends say that they're stressed from greater workloads and longer hours because of downsizing at their organizations. Parents worry about the lack of job stability and reminisce about a time when a job with a large corporation implied lifetime security. Employees complain about the stress of trying to balance work and family responsibilities. Harris, Rothenberg International, a leading provider of employee assistance programs (EAPs), finds that employees are having mental breakdowns and needing professional help at higher rates than ever.⁹⁸ Indeed, as Exhibit 17-7 shows, work is a major source of stress in most people's lives. What are the causes and consequences of stress, and how can individuals and organizations reduce it?

What Is Stress?

Do you feel stressed? If so, join the crowd (see OB Poll). **Stress** ⓘ is a dynamic condition in which an individual is confronted with an opportunity, demand, or resource related to what the individual desires and for which the outcome is perceived to be both uncertain and important.⁹⁹ This is a complicated definition. Let's look at its components more closely.

Exhibit 17-7 Work Is One of the Top Sources of Stress

What area of your life causes you the most stress?

Area	Causes Most Stress
Financial worries	64%
Work	60%
Family responsibilities	47%
Health concerns	46%

Source: Based on "Stress in America: Paying with Our Health," American Psychological Association, February 4, 2015,

Although stress is typically discussed in a negative context, it also has a positive purpose.¹⁰⁰ In response to stress, your nervous system, hypothalamus, pituitary, and adrenal glands supply you with stress hormones to cope. Your heartbeat and breathing accelerate to increase oxygen, while your muscles tense for action.¹⁰¹ This is a time when stress offers potential gain. Consider, for example, the superior performance that an athlete or stage performer gives in a clutch situation. Such individuals often use stress positively to rise to the occasion and perform at their maximum. Similarly, many professionals see the pressures of heavy workloads and deadlines as positive challenges that enhance the quality of their work and the satisfaction they get from their job. However, when the situation is negative, stress is harmful and may hinder your progress by elevating your blood pressure uncomfortably and creating an erratic heart rhythm as you struggle to speak and think logically.¹⁰²



Source: Based on J. Hudson, “High Stress Has Employees Seeking Both Wellness and Employee Assistance Help,” ComPsych Corporation press release, November 12, 2014, <http://www.compsych.com/press-room/press-releases-2014/818-nov-12-2014>.

Stressors Researchers have argued that **challenge stressors** ⓘ—or stressors associated with workload, pressure to complete tasks, and time urgency—operate quite differently from **hindrance stressors** ⓘ—or stressors that keep you from reaching your goals (for example, red tape, office politics, confusion over job responsibilities).¹⁰³ Evidence suggests that both challenge and hindrance stressors lead to strain, although hindrance stressors lead to

increased levels of strain.¹⁰⁴ Challenge stressors lead to more motivation, engagement, and performance than hindrance stressors.¹⁰⁵ Hindrance stressors, on the other hand, appear to have more of a negative effect on safety compliance and participation, employee engagement, job satisfaction, organizational commitment, performance, and withdrawal than do challenge stressors.¹⁰⁶

Researchers have sought to clarify the conditions under which each type of stress exists. It appears that time pressure and learning demands both act as challenge stressors that can help employees learn and thrive in organizations.¹⁰⁷ Hindrances (e.g., a lack of resources to complete your job) serve to block goal attainment and should be distinguished from threats, which can result in personal harm (e.g., corrections officers fearing harm from inmates).¹⁰⁸

Demands and Resources More typically, stress is associated with demands and resources.

Demands ⓘ are responsibilities, pressures, obligations, and uncertainties that individuals face in the workplace. **Resources** ⓘ are factors within an individual's control that he or she can use to resolve the demands. Let's discuss what this demands–resources model means.¹⁰⁹



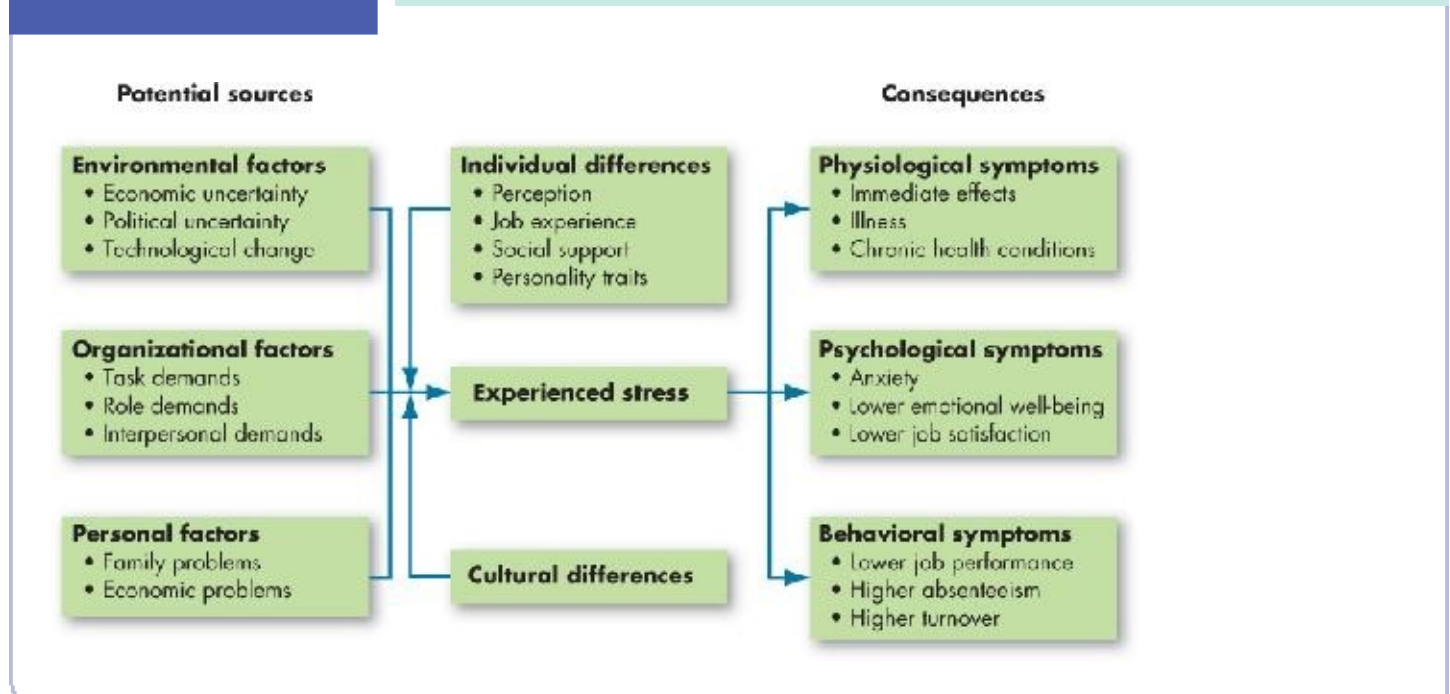
When you take a test at school or undergo your annual performance review at work, you feel stress because you confront opportunities and performance pressures. A good performance review may lead to a promotion, greater responsibilities, and a higher salary. A poor review may prevent you from getting a promotion. An extremely poor review might even result in your being fired. To the extent you can apply resources to the demands on you—such as preparing for the review, putting the review in perspective (it's not the end of the world), or obtaining social support—you will feel less stress. In fact, this last resource—social support—may be more important on an ongoing basis than anything else. According to recent research on Dutch elementary school teachers, when school principals exhibit transformational leadership behaviors (see Chapter 12), their teachers' engagement is sustained in the presence of challenge stressors and buffered from negative effects when hindrance demands are present.¹¹⁰ Overall, under the demands–resources perspective, having resources to cope with stress is just as important in offsetting stress as demands are in increasing it.¹¹¹

Allostasis The discussion so far may give you the impression that individuals are seeking a steady state in which demands match resources perfectly. While early research tended to emphasize such a *homeostatic*, or balanced, equilibrium perspective, it has now become clear

that no single ideal state exists. Instead, it's more accurate to talk about *allostatic* models in which demands shift, resources shift, and systems of addressing imbalances shift.¹¹² By **allostasis** ⓘ, we work to find stability by changing our behaviors and attitudes. It all depends on the allostatic load, or the cumulative effect of stressors on us given the resources we draw upon.¹¹³ For example, if you're feeling especially confident in your abilities and have lots of support from others, you may increase your willingness to experience strain and be better able to mobilize coping resources. This would be a situation where the allostatic load was not too great; in other cases where the allostatic load is too great and too prolonged, we may experience psychological or physiological stress symptoms.

Stress preferences change in cycles. You've experienced this when you sometimes just feel like relaxing and recovering, while at other times you welcome more stimulation and challenge. Much like organizations are in a constant state of change and flux, we respond to stress processes by continually adapting to both internal and external sources, and our stability is constantly redefined.

Exhibit 17-8 A Model of Stress



Potential Sources of Stress at Work

What causes stress? Let's examine the model in Exhibit 17-8.

Environmental Factors Just as environmental uncertainty influences the design of an organization's structure, it also influences stress levels among employees in that organization. Indeed, uncertainty is the biggest reason people have trouble coping with organizational changes.¹¹⁴ There are three main types of environmental uncertainty: economic, political, and technological.



Changes in the business cycle create *economic uncertainties*. When the economy is contracting, for example, people become increasingly anxious about their job security. *Political uncertainties* don't tend to create stress among U.S. citizens and Canadians as much as they do for employees in countries such as Haiti or Venezuela. The obvious reason is that the United States and Canada have more stable political systems, in which change is typically implemented in an orderly manner. Yet political threats and changes in all countries can induce stress. Because innovations can make an employee's skills and experience obsolete in a very short time, keeping up with new computer programs, robotics, automation, and similar forms of *technological change* is an additional challenge for many people at work that causes them stress.

Organizational Factors There is no shortage of factors within an organization that can cause stress. Pressures to avoid errors or complete tasks in a limited time, work overload, a demanding and insensitive boss, and unpleasant coworkers are a few examples. We've categorized these factors around task, role, and interpersonal demands.

Task demands relate to a person's job. They include the design of the job (including its degree of autonomy, task variety, and automation), working conditions, and the physical work layout. One factor consistently related to stress in the workplace is the amount of work that needs to be done, followed closely by the presence of looming deadlines.¹¹⁵ Working in an overcrowded room or a visible location where noise and interruptions are constant can also increase anxiety and stress.¹¹⁶

Role demands relate to pressures placed on a person as a function of the particular role he or she plays in the organization.¹¹⁷ Role conflicts create expectations that may be hard to reconcile or satisfy. Role overload occurs when the employee is expected to take on too much. Role ambiguity means role expectations are not clearly understood and the employee is not sure what to do. Unfortunately, individuals who face high situational constraints by their roles (such as fixed work hours or demanding job responsibilities) are less able to

engage in the proactive coping behaviors, like taking a break, that reduce stress levels.¹¹⁸ When faced with problems at work, they not only have higher levels of distress at the time, but they are also less likely to take steps to eliminate stressors in the future.

Interpersonal demands are pressures created by other employees. Some pressures are expected, but a rapidly growing body of research has shown that negative coworker and supervisor behaviors, including fights, bullying, incivility, abusive supervision, and racial/sexual harassment, are very strongly related to stress at work.¹¹⁹ Interpersonal mistreatment can have effects at a physiological level, with one study finding that unfair treatment in a controlled setting triggered the release of cortisol, a hormone involved in the stress-reaction process.¹²⁰

Career OBjectives

How can I bring my team's overall stress level down?

My coworkers and I are under a lot of pressure because we have a huge deadline coming up. We're working a lot of extra hours, and tensions are starting to ramp up to arguments. Is there any way I can get my team to chill out?

— *Hakim*

Dear Hakim:

It sounds like you're facing some of the core issues that produce stress at work: high demands, critical outcomes, and time pressure. There's no question tempers can start to flare under these conditions. While it may not even be desirable to get your team to relax, or chill out as you say, lowering your team's aggregate stress level will increase your group's effectiveness. Fortunately, there are some well-established ways to help lower stress in groups. Some of the most effective are directly related to getting people to recommit to the team:

- ***To help minimize infighting, get the group to focus on a common goal.*** Shared objectives are one of the most effective ways to reduce conflict in times of stress, and they remind everyone that cooperation is key.
- ***Review what the team has done and what steps toward the goal remain.*** When the team can see how much work they have accomplished, they will naturally feel

better.

- ***When the team feels most tense, take a collective temporary break.*** It can be difficult to step away from a project with heavy time demands, but working at a point of maximum tension and conflict is often counterproductive. A chance to stop and gain perspective helps everyone recharge and focus.

Remember that minimizing team stress shouldn't happen through lowering standards and accepting lower-quality work but through reducing counterproductive organizational behavior. A positive work environment with high member engagement will do a lot to move the group forward. A combination of focus, progress, and perspective will ultimately be the best approach to limiting your stress.

Sources: Based on P. M. Poortvliet, F. Anseel, and F. Theuwis, "Mastery-Approach and Mastery-Avoidance Goals and Their Relation with Exhaustion and Engagement at Work: The Roles of Emotional and Instrumental Support," *Work & Stress* 29 (April 2015): 150–70; J. P. Trougakos, D. J. Beal, B. H. Cheng, I. Hideg, and D. Zweig, "Too Drained to Help: A Resource Depletion Perspective on Daily Interpersonal Citizenship Behaviors," *Journal of Applied Psychology* 100 (2015): 227–36; and J. P. Trougakos, I. Hideg, B. H. Cheng, and D. J. Beal, "Lunch Breaks Unpacked: The Role of Autonomy as a Moderator of Recovery during Lunch," *Academy of Management Journal* 57 (2014): 405–21.

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Individuals who believe they are experiencing a social climate of discrimination from multiple sources over time have higher levels of psychological strain, even after accounting for differing baseline levels of well-being.¹²¹ Social exclusion, perhaps as a form of interpersonal mistreatment, can also be a significant source of psychological strain. One study found that experiences of ostracism may have even more negative effects than experiences of interpersonal conflict.¹²²

Personal Factors The typical individual may work between 40 and 50 hours a week. But

the experiences and problems people encounter in the other 120-plus hours can spill over to the job. The final category of sources of stress at work includes factors of an employee's personal life: family issues and personal economic problems.

National surveys consistently show that people hold family and personal relationships dear.¹²³ *Family issues*, even good ones, can cause stress that has a significant impact on individuals.¹²⁴ Family issues are often closely related to work–life conflict. The relationship becomes a vicious cycle: Work–life conflict affects stress levels, which in turn affect work–life conflict.¹²⁵

Regardless of income level, some people are poor money managers or have wants that exceed their earning capacity. People who make \$100,000 per year seem to have as much trouble handling their finances as those who earn \$20,000, although recent research indicates that those who make under \$50,000 per year do experience more stress.¹²⁶ The *personal economic problems* of overextended financial resources create stress and siphon attention away from work.

Stressors Are Additive When we review stressors individually, it's easy to overlook that stress is an additive phenomenon—it builds up.¹²⁷ Each new and persistent stressor adds to an individual's stress level. So a single stressor may be relatively unimportant in and of itself, but if added to an already high level of stress, it can be too much. To appraise the total amount of stress an individual is under, we have to add all of the sources and severity levels of that person's stress. Because this cannot be easily quantified or observed, managers should remain aware of the potential stress loads from organizational factors in particular. Many employees are willing to express their perceived stress load at work to a caring manager.

Individual Differences

Some people thrive on stressful situations, while others are overwhelmed by them. What differentiates people in terms of their ability to handle stress? What individual variables moderate the relationship between *potential* stressors and *experienced* stress? At least four are relevant—perception, job experience, social support, and personality traits.

Perception In Chapter 6, we demonstrated that employees react in response to their perception of reality rather than to reality itself. *Perception* moderates the relationship between a potential stress condition and an employee's reaction to it. Layoffs may cause one

person to fear losing his job, while another sees an opportunity to get a large severance allowance and start her own business. Those who perceive a stressful event as a small blip in an otherwise long timeline (and who take to heart phrases such as “this, too, shall pass” and “time heals all wounds”) tend to cope better than those who focus on immediate circumstances.¹²⁸ So stress potential doesn’t lie in objective conditions; rather, it lies in an employee’s interpretation of those conditions.

Job Experience *Experience* on the job tends to be negatively related to work stress. Why? Two explanations have been offered.¹²⁹ First is selective withdrawal. Voluntary turnover is more probable among people who experience more stress. Therefore, people who remain with an organization longer are those with more stress-resistant traits or those more resistant to the stress characteristics of the organization. Second, people eventually develop coping mechanisms to deal with stress. Because this takes time, senior members of the organization are more likely to be fully adapted and should experience less stress.



DentalPlans.com employee Kristen Reineke celebrates after scoring a point while playing foosball in the employee lounge. In giving its employees the opportunity to form collegial relationships by playing games like foosball and Wii, DentalPlans.com provides them with the social support that can lessen the impact of on-the-job stress.

Source: Charles Trainor Jr./MCT/Newscom

Social Support *Social support*—collegial relationships with coworkers or supervisors—can buffer the impact of stress.¹³⁰ This is among the best-documented relationships in the stress literature. Social support acts as a palliative, mitigating the negative effects of even high-strain jobs.

Personality Traits Stress symptoms expressed on the job may originate in the person's personality.¹³¹ Perhaps the most widely studied *personality trait* in research on stress is neuroticism, which we discussed in Chapter 5. As you might expect, neurotic individuals are more prone to experience psychological strain.¹³² Evidence suggests that neurotic individuals are more likely to find stressors in their work environments, so they believe their environments are more threatening. They also tend to select less adaptive coping mechanisms, relying on avoidance as a way of dealing with problems rather than attempting to resolve them.¹³³

Workaholism is another personal characteristic related to stress levels.¹³⁴ Workaholics are people obsessed with their work; they put in an enormous number of hours, think about work even when not working, and create additional work responsibilities to satisfy an inner compulsion to work more. In some ways, they might seem like ideal employees. That's probably why, when most people are asked in interviews what their greatest weakness is, they reflexively say, "I just work too hard." However, there is a difference between working hard and working compulsively. Workaholics are not necessarily more productive than other employees, despite their extreme efforts. The strain of putting in such a high level of work effort eventually begins to wear on the person, leading to higher levels of work–life conflict and psychological burnout.¹³⁵

Cultural Differences



Research suggests that the job conditions that cause stress show some differences across cultures. One study revealed that, whereas U.S. employees were stressed by a lack of control, Chinese employees were stressed by job evaluations and lack of training.¹³⁶ It doesn't appear that personality effects on stress are different across cultures, however. One study of employees in Hungary, Italy, the United Kingdom, Israel, and the United States found Type A personality traits (see Chapter 5) predicted stress equally well across countries.¹³⁷ A study of over 5,000 managers from 20 countries found individuals from

individualistic countries such as the United States, Canada, and the United Kingdom experienced higher levels of stress due to work interfering with family than did individuals from collectivist countries in Asia and Latin America.¹³⁸ The authors proposed that this may occur because, in collectivist cultures, working extra hours is seen as a sacrifice to help the family, whereas in individualistic cultures, work is seen as a means of personal achievement that takes away from the family.

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

17.5.1 _____ is a dynamic condition in which an individual is confronted with an opportunity, demand, or resource related to what the individual desires and for which the outcome is perceived to be both uncertain and important.

- ☐ Change
- ☐ Stress
- ☐ Innovation
- ☐ Stimulation

Check answer

Reset

17.5.2 Paul is stressed with the new corporate reorganization. He now reports to a foreign office that has usurped many of his responsibilities, including the contract labor for his projects, therefore he's working with less qualified and new contractors with whom he doesn't have a relationship. However, the managers of the other departments find themselves in the same boat and every day they are able to laugh over lunch about their new managerial impotence. _____ is helping Paul handle his stress.

- ☐ Emotional contagion
- ☐ Cognitive dissonance
- ☐ Social support
- ☐ Time management

Check answer

Reset

Consequences of Stress at Work

17-6 Identify the physiological, psychological, and behavioral symptoms of stress at work.

Stress shows itself in a number of ways, such as high blood pressure, ulcers, irritability, difficulty making routine decisions, changes in appetite, accident proneness, and the like. Refer back to Exhibit 8-8. These symptoms fit under three general categories: physiological, psychological, and behavioral symptoms.

Physiological Symptoms Most early concern with stress was directed at physiological symptoms because most researchers were specialists in the health and medical sciences. Their work led to the conclusion that stress could create changes in metabolism, increase heart and breathing rates and blood pressure, bring on headaches, and induce heart attacks.¹³⁹



Evidence now clearly suggests stress may have other harmful physiological effects, including backaches, headaches, eye strain, sleep disturbances, dizziness, fatigue, loss of appetite, and gastrointestinal problems.¹⁴⁰ A study of hourly care workers showed that negative interactions with their supervisors led to heightened blood pressure and poor recovery from work (in other words, an inability to “re-charge” after work).¹⁴¹ Still another study conducted with Canadian day-shift workers found that higher levels of psychological demands and overcommitment were related to significantly increased variation in cortisol levels.¹⁴² Many other studies have shown similar results linking work stress to a variety of indicators of poor health.

The effects of stress and strain on sleep (see also Myth or Science?) have piqued the interests of researchers in particular, with the majority of studies suggesting that strain has a moderate impact on job attitudes (especially when it comes to sleep quality over quantity).¹⁴³ A variety of different types of work-related stressors have been shown to impair sleep quality; such stressors include unfinished work tasks. Social stressors and conflict between part-time work demands and school demands can have a great impact on sleep for college students.¹⁴⁴ Additional research suggests that, beyond the obvious solution of getting more, good-quality sleep, physical activity and recovery experiences with social support groups can

help.¹⁴⁵

Psychological Symptoms Job dissatisfaction is an obvious cause of stress. But stress shows itself in other psychological states—for instance, tension, anxiety, irritability, boredom, and procrastination. One study that tracked physiological responses of employees over time found that stress due to high workloads was related to lower emotional well-being.¹⁴⁶



Jobs that make multiple and conflicting demands or that lack clarity about the employee's duties, authority, and responsibilities increase both stress and dissatisfaction.¹⁴⁷ Similarly, the less control people have over the pace of their work, the greater their stress and dissatisfaction, a finding that has been replicated across 63 countries.¹⁴⁸ Jobs that provide a low level of variety, significance, autonomy, feedback, and identity appear to create stress and reduce satisfaction and involvement in the job.¹⁴⁹ Not everyone reacts to autonomy in the same way, however. For those with an external locus of control, increased job control increases the tendency to experience stress and exhaustion.¹⁵⁰

Myth or Science?

When You're Working Hard, Sleep Is Optional

This statement is false. Individuals who do not get enough sleep are unable to perform well on the job. One study found that sleeplessness costs U.S. employers \$63.2 billion per year, almost \$2,300 per employee, partially due to decreased productivity and increased safety issues. Sleep deprivation has been cited as a contributing factor in heart disease, obesity, stroke, and cancer. It can also lead to disastrous accidents. For example, U.S. military researchers report that sleep deprivation is one of the top causes of friendly fire (when soldiers mistakenly fire on their own troops), and 20 percent of auto accidents are due to drowsy drivers. More than 160 people on Air India Flight 812 from Dubai to Mangalore were killed when pilot Zlatko Glusica awoke from a nap and, suffering from sleep inertia, overshot the runway in one of India's deadliest air crashes.

Sleeplessness affects the performance of millions of workers. According to research, one-third of U.S. employees in most industries, and more than one-quarter of workers in the finance and insurance industry, are sleep deprived, getting fewer than 6 hours of sleep per night (7 to 9 are recommended). More than 50 percent of U.S. adults age 19 to 29, 43 percent age 30 to 45, and 38 percent age 46 to 64 report that they rarely or never get a good night's sleep on weekdays.

Research has shown that lack of sleep impairs our ability to learn skills and find solutions, which may be part of the reason law enforcement organizations, Super Bowl-winning football teams, and half the Fortune 500 companies employ so-called fatigue management specialists as performance consultants.

Along with sleeplessness, insomnia has been a growing problem. Recent research in Norway indicated that up to 34 percent of motor vehicle deaths during the 14-year study period might have been prevented if the people involved in the crashes hadn't displayed insomnia symptoms. Managers and employees increasingly take prescription sleep aids, attend sleep labs, and consume caffeine in efforts to either sleep better or reduce the effects of sleeplessness on their performance. These methods often backfire. Studies indicate that prescription sleep aids increase sleep time by only 11 minutes and cause short-term memory loss. The effects of sleep labs may not be helpful after the sessions are over. And the diminishing returns of caffeine, perhaps the most popular method of fighting sleep deprivation (74 percent of U.S. adults consume caffeine every day), require the ingestion of increasing amounts to achieve alertness, which can make users jittery before the effect wears off and leave them exhausted.

When you're working hard, it's easy to consider using sleep hours to get the job done and to think that the stress and adrenaline from working will keep you alert. It's also easy to consider artificial methods in attempts to counteract the negative impact of sleep deprivation. However, research indicates that when it comes to maximizing performance and reducing accidents, we are not good at assessing our impaired capabilities when we are sleep deprived. In the end, there is no substitute for a solid night's sleep.

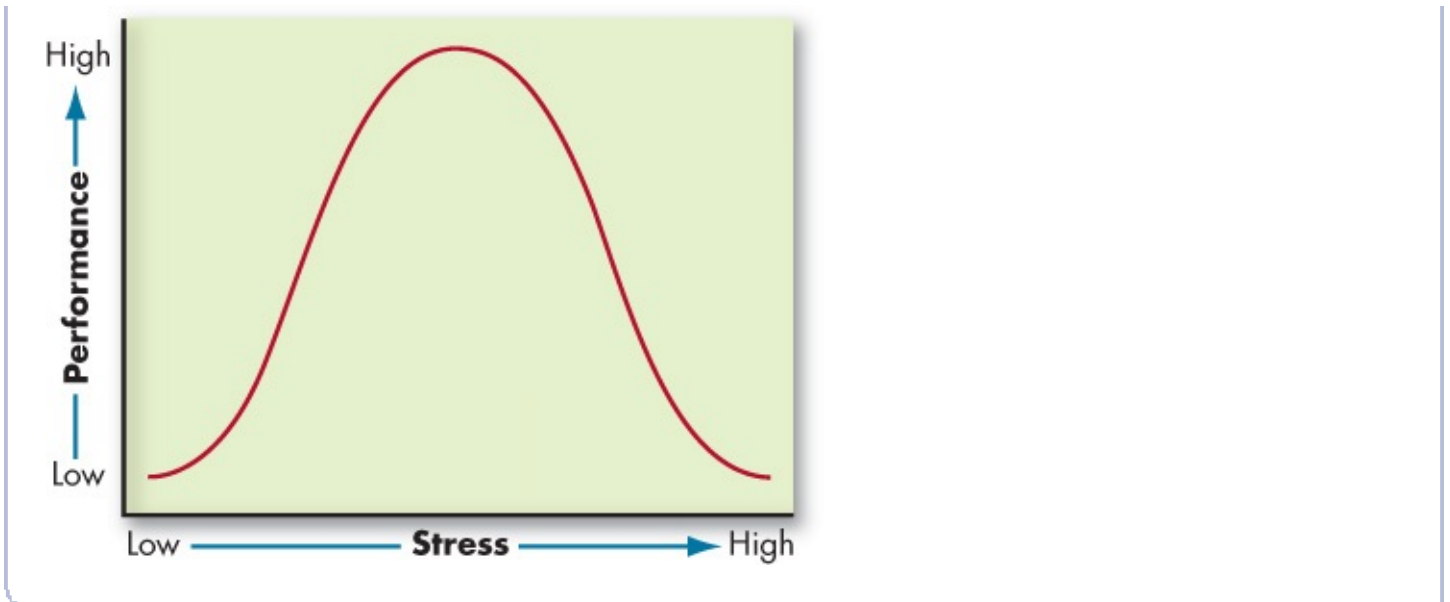
Sources: Based on M. J. Breus, "Insomnia Could Kill You—By Accident," *The Huffington Post*, May 9, 2015, http://www.huffingtonpost.com/dr-michael-j-breus/insomnia-could-kill-you-by-accident_b_7235264.html; D. K. Randall, "Decoding the Science of Sleep," *The Wall Street Journal*, August 4–5, 2012, C1–C2; M. Sallinen, J.

Onninen, K. Tirkkonen, M.-L. Haavisto, M. Harma, T. Kubo, et al., “Effects of Cumulative Sleep Restriction on Self-Perceptions While Multitasking,” *Journal of Sleep Research* (June 2012): 273–81; and P. Walker, “Pilot Was Snoring before Air India Crash,” *The Guardian*, November 17, 2010, www.guardian.co.uk/world/2010/nov/17/sleepy-pilot-blamed-air-india-crash.

Behavioral Symptoms Research on behavior and stress has been conducted across several countries and over time, and the relationships appear relatively consistent. Behavior-related stress symptoms include reductions in productivity; increases in absences, safety incidents, and turnover; changes in eating habits; increased smoking or consumption of alcohol; rapid speech; fidgeting; and sleep disorders.¹⁵¹

A significant amount of research has investigated the stress–performance relationship. One proposed pattern of this relationship is the inverted U shown in Exhibit 17-9.¹⁵² The logic underlying the figure is that low to moderate levels of stress stimulate the body and increase its ability to react. Individuals may perform tasks better, more intensely, or more rapidly. But too much stress places unattainable demands on a person, which result in lower performance. In spite of its popularity and intuitive appeal, the inverted-U model hasn’t earned a lot of empirical support.¹⁵³ Maybe the model misses links between stressors and felt stress and job performance, meaning that sometimes there are reasons we could be stressed but we feel fine because of positive moderating factors. We may be able to avoid letting stress affect our job performance.¹⁵⁴ For example, one study indicated that individuals with high emotional intelligence (EI; discussed in Chapter 4) may be able to mitigate the effects of job stress on performance.¹⁵⁵ Therefore, this model may be a good, neutral starting point from which to study differences.

Exhibit 17-9 **The Proposed Inverted-U Relationship between Stress and Job Performance**



As we mentioned earlier, researchers have begun to differentiate challenge and hindrance stressors, showing that these two forms of stress have opposite effects on job behaviors, especially job performance. A meta-analysis of responses from more than 35,000 individuals showed role ambiguity, role conflict, role overload, job insecurity, environmental uncertainty, and situational constraints were all consistently and negatively related to job performance.¹⁵⁶ There is also evidence that challenge stress improves job performance in a supportive work environment, whereas hindrance stress reduces job performance in all work environments.¹⁵⁷

Managing Stress

17-7 Describe individual and organizational approaches to managing stress at work.

What should we do about stress? Should we do anything? Because low to moderate levels of stress can be functional and lead to higher performance, management may not be concerned when employees experience them; however, employees are likely to perceive even low levels of stress as undesirable. It's not unlikely, therefore, that employees and management have different notions of what constitutes an acceptable level of stress on the job. What management may consider to be "a positive stimulus that keeps the adrenaline running" is very likely to be seen as "excessive pressure" by the employee. Regardless, stress can lead to poor outcomes that even managers should be aware of; for example, research on over 4,000 caregivers across 35 different hospitals suggested that during a typical 12-hour shift without breaks, hand-washing and safety compliance reduced by 8.7 percent.¹⁵⁸ Keep this example in mind as we discuss individual and organizational approaches toward managing stress.¹⁵⁹

Individual Approaches

An employee can and should take personal responsibility for reducing stress levels. Individual strategies that have proven effective include time management techniques, physical exercise, relaxation techniques, and social support networks.¹⁶⁰

Many people manage their time poorly. The well-organized employee, like the well-organized student, may very well accomplish twice as much as the person who is poorly organized. A few of the best-known *time management techniques* are: (1) maintaining to-do lists; (2) scheduling activities based on priorities, not what you can accomplish; (3) doing the hard tasks first; and (4) scheduling distraction-free time to accomplish tasks. These time management skills can help minimize procrastination by focusing efforts on immediate goals and boosting motivation even in the face of tasks that are less enjoyable.¹⁶¹

Physicians have recommended noncompetitive *physical exercise*, such as aerobics, walking, jogging, swimming, and riding a bicycle, as a way to deal with excessive stress levels. These activities decrease the detrimental physiological responses to stress and allow us to recover from stress more quickly.¹⁶²

Individuals can teach themselves to reduce tension through *relaxation techniques* such as meditation, mindfulness, and deep breathing.¹⁶³ The objective is to reach a state of deep physical relaxation in which you focus all your energy on the release of muscle tension.¹⁶⁴ Deep relaxation for 20 minutes a day, twice a day, releases strain; provides a pronounced sense of peacefulness; and produces significant changes in heart rate, blood pressure, and other physiological factors.¹⁶⁵

A growing body of research shows that simply taking breaks from work at routine intervals (e.g., lunch breaks, walks in the park) can facilitate psychological recovery, can reduce stress significantly, and may improve job performance, and these effects are even greater if relaxation techniques are employed.¹⁶⁶ Even very short *microbreaks* have been demonstrated to have an effect on employee stress relief and energy.¹⁶⁷ You might be tempted to think that complete detachment from work, or stiff boundaries between your work and leisure life, is good; however, research suggests that those who are *recovering ponderers*, or who do not completely detach and ponder over problems they need to resolve at work (but still engage in relaxation activities), tend to be *both* engaged *and* experience a substantial decrease in stress.¹⁶⁸

As we have noted, friends, family, or work colleagues can provide an outlet when stress levels become excessive.¹⁶⁹ Expanding your *social support network* enables you to find someone to hear your problems and offer a more objective perspective on a stressful situation. Sometimes, however, these networks produce the opposite effect: If you do not try to expand your network and instead ruminate with similarly stressed friends, you can get caught in a vicious cycle.¹⁷⁰ That's why it is so important to be proactive and try to address your stress head on. But apart from rumination, support from family, friends, or spouses who help you recover from stressful work experiences can be mutually beneficial.¹⁷¹

Organizational Approaches

Several organizational factors that cause stress—particularly task and role demands—can be controlled by management. Strategies to consider include improved employee selection and job placement, training, goal setting, redesign of jobs, increased organizational communication, employee involvement, employee sabbaticals, and corporate wellness programs.

Selection and Placement, and Training Certain jobs are more stressful than others but, as

we've seen, individuals differ in their response to stressful situations. We know individuals with little experience or an external locus of control tend to be more prone to stress. *Selection and placement* decisions should consider these factors. Obviously, management shouldn't hire only experienced individuals with an internal locus, but such individuals may adapt better to high-stress jobs and perform those jobs more effectively. Unfortunately, temporary employees who have the possibility of being hired are often at risk for experiencing heightened levels of stress associated with uncertainty and role ambiguity, which can in turn affect their chances of being hired.¹⁷² Employees in these situations would do well to manage their impressions and develop a tolerance for ambiguity. Similarly, *training* can increase an individual's self-efficacy and thus lessen job strain in these situations.

An Ethical Choice

Manager and Employee Stress during Organizational Change

When organizations are in a state of change, employees feel the stress. In fact, a recent study indicated that job pressures, often due to downsizing and other organizational changes, are the second-leading cause of stress. Dealing with that stress was previously the domain of workers alone, who could turn to constructive (counselors, health professionals, support networks) or destructive (alcohol, gossip, counterproductive work behaviors) options as coping mechanisms. Employees who couldn't cope with stress suffered job burnout and headed to the unemployment line.

Beneficent employers provided employee assistance programs (EAPs) through subcontracted counselors or in-house HR departments to counsel employees dealing with stress. Managers simply steered individuals toward these resources when workplace problems indicated a need for intervention. This help often arrived too late to mitigate the negative outcomes of stress such as lost productivity and burnout—and sometimes it arrived too late to save the employee's job. Research suggests that continually occurring job stressors, such as when organizations are in the midst of change, reduce employee engagement because workers are deprived of recovery periods. Employee stress thus needs to be addressed proactively at the manager level if

it is to be effective, before negative work outcomes appear.

Are managers ethically obligated to alleviate employee stress? On the one hand, managers are responsible for maximizing productivity and realize that organizations increase profitability when fewer employees produce and perform more. On the other hand, overwork will increase employee stress, particularly when the organization is in a state of change due to downsizing or growth. Managers who keep head count low and workloads high may realize short-term gains from lower workforce costs but long-term losses from negative stress outcomes, such as increased turnover and lowered productivity. Experts recommend that managers consider hiring the workers they need to keep employee workloads reasonable, adding reward programs to keep top employees engaged, and cutting nonworkforce costs to maintain profitability. Less conspicuous methods, such as teaching employees stress reduction techniques and creating a greenery room for a nature retreat from the office environment, can also be helpful. Managers must make the ethical choice between spending more money now on labor costs and stress reduction methods versus spending it later on the more hidden but salient costs of employee stress.

As research increasingly indicates, when employees react to stress, they and their organizations suffer the consequences. Therefore, managers must consider their opportunity to help alleviate the stress before it's too late.

Sources: Based on E. Fraumenheim, "Stressed & Pressed," *Workforce Management* (January 2012): 18–22; J. B. Oldroyd and S. S. Morris, "Catching Falling Stars: A Human Resource Response to Social Capital's Detrimental Effect of Information Overload on Star Employees," *Academy of Management Review* 37 (2012): 396–418; and S. Sonnentag, E. J. Mojza, E. Demerouti, and A. B. Bakker, "Reciprocal Relations between Recovery and Work Engagement: The Moderating Role of Job Stressors," *Journal of Applied Psychology* 97 (2012): 842–53.

Goal Setting We discussed *goal setting* in Chapter 7. Individuals perform better when they have specific and challenging goals and receive feedback on their progress toward these goals. Goals can reduce stress as well as provide motivation.¹⁷³ Employees who are highly committed to their goals and who see purpose in their jobs experience less stress because they are more likely to perceive stressors as challenges rather than hindrances. The type of goal also matters: When given a developmental, learning goal after negative feedback,

employees tend to experience less tension and better performance than when they are given a performance target goal.¹⁷⁴ The employees' personality also matters: Goal setting and goal-focused leadership tend to be more successful in reducing stress for the conscientious but not for those who are low on emotional stability.¹⁷⁵

Redesigning Jobs *Redesigning jobs* to give employees more responsibility, more meaningful work, more autonomy, and increased feedback can reduce stress because these factors give employees greater control over work activities and lessen dependence on others. But as we noted in our discussion of work design, not all employees want enriched jobs. The right redesign for employees with a low need for growth might include less responsibility and increased specialization. If individuals prefer structure and routine, reducing skill variety should reduce uncertainties and stress levels. Organizations should be careful when deciding to structure work and organizations so that employees are on call 24 hours a day: Research suggests that workplace telepressure can impede the effectiveness of employee recovery experiences and increase stress.¹⁷⁶

Employee Involvement Role stress is detrimental to a large extent because employees feel uncertain about goals, expectations, how they'll be evaluated, and the like. By giving employees a voice in the decisions that directly affect their job performance, management can increase employee control and reduce role stress. Thus, managers should consider increasing *employee involvement* in decision making because evidence clearly shows that increases in employee involvement and empowerment practices reduce psychological strain.¹⁷⁷

Organizational Communication Increasing formal *organizational communication* with employees reduces uncertainty by lessening role ambiguity and role conflict.¹⁷⁸ Given the importance that perceptions play in moderating the stress–response relationship, management can also use effective communications as a means to shape employee perceptions. Remember that what employees categorize as demands, threats, or opportunities at work is an interpretation and that interpretation can be affected by the symbols and actions communicated by management.

Employee Sabbaticals Some employees need an occasional escape from the frenetic pace of their work. Companies including Genentech, the Container Store, Recreational Equipment

Inc. (REI), PricewaterhouseCoopers (PwC), Goldman Sachs, The Cheesecake Factory Inc., VMware, and Adobe Systems have begun to provide extended voluntary leaves.¹⁷⁹ These *sabbaticals*—ranging in length from a few weeks to several months—allow employees to travel, relax, or pursue personal projects that consume time beyond normal vacations. One study of university faculty members suggests that sabbaticals increase job resources and well-being, especially when they have greater autonomy in how they spend their sabbatical.¹⁸⁰

Wellness Programs Our final suggestion is organizationally supported [wellness programs](#) ⓘ. These typically provide workshops to help people quit smoking, control alcohol use, lose weight, eat better, and develop a regular exercise program; they focus on the employee’s total physical and mental condition.¹⁸¹ Some programs help employees improve their psychological health as well. A meta-analysis of 36 programs designed to reduce stress (including wellness programs) showed that interventions to help employees reframe stressful situations and use active coping strategies appreciably reduced stress levels.¹⁸² Wellness programs that help employees focus on developing the “good” kind of stress and becoming challenged through their work have also been introduced.¹⁸³ Most wellness programs assume that employees need to take personal responsibility for their physical and mental health and that the organization is merely a means to that end.



Kingfisher B&Q employees undertake compulsory motivational exercises before the store opens. These last for around 20 minutes and have been brought in across the whole of the superstore network.

Sources: 67photo/Alamy Stock Photo

Most firms that have introduced wellness programs have found significant benefits. Johnson & Johnson reported that their wellness program has saved the organization \$250 million on health care costs in 10 years, and research indicated that effective wellness programs significantly decreased turnover rates for most organizations.¹⁸⁴ Other research sponsored by the U.S. Department of Labor and Department of Health and Human Services indicated that organizational wellness programs create healthier employees with fewer health risk factors.¹⁸⁵

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

17.7.1 Which of the following is not an example of a hindrance stressor?

- ☐ red tape
- ☐ office politics
- ☐ role ambiguity
- ☐ time urgency

Check answer

Reset

17.7.2 Which of the following statements is true regarding stress?

- Employees with an external locus of control tend to be less prone to stress.
- Training tends to decrease job stress.
- Highly experienced employees tend to be more prone to stress.

- ☐ Employees who are highly committed to their goals experience more stress.

Check answer

Reset

Summary

The need for change has been implied throughout this text. For instance, think about attitudes, motivation, work teams, communication, leadership, organizational structures, HR practices, and organizational cultures. Change was an integral part in our discussion of each. If environments were perfectly static, if employees' skills and abilities were always up to date and incapable of deteriorating, and if tomorrow were always exactly the same as today, organizational change would have little or no relevance to managers. But the real world is turbulent, requiring organizations and their members to undergo dynamic change if they are to perform at competitive levels. Coping with all these changes can be a source of stress, but with effective management, challenge can enhance engagement and fulfillment, leading to the high performance that is one major goal of the study of organizational behavior (OB), as you've discovered in this text.

Implications for Managers

- Consider that, as a manager, you are a change agent in your organization. The decisions you make and your role-modeling behaviors will help shape the organization's change culture.
- Your management policies and practices will determine the degree to which the organization learns and adapts to changing environmental factors.
- Some stress is good. Increasing challenges brought by autonomy and responsibility at work will lead to some stress, but they will also increase feelings of accomplishment and fulfillment. Hindrance stressors like bureaucracy and interpersonal conflicts, on the other hand, are entirely negative and should be eliminated.
- You can help alleviate harmful workplace stress for your employees by accurately matching workloads to employees, providing employees with stress-coping resources, and responding to employees' concerns.
- You can identify extreme stress in your employees when performance declines, turnover increases, health-related absenteeism increases, and engagement declines. By the time these symptoms are visible, however, it may be too late to be helpful, so stay

alert for early indicators and be proactive.



MyLab Management **Personal Inventory Assessments**

Go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management to complete the Personal Inventory Assessment related to this chapter.

Companies Should Encourage Stress Reduction

Point

Companies make substantial investments in their employees, so the health and well-being of the workforce is a central concern. One of the most direct ways to provide assistance to employees is to engage in one of the stress-reduction interventions. One major financial benefit of stress reduction programs is a reduction in health-related costs. Workplace stress leads to dozens of negative and expensive health-related consequences. Stress weakens the immune system, leading to increased illness and sick days. If employees feel extreme stress related to work, they may be more likely to come to work when they are contagious, leading to sickness for many others. Over the longer run, stress levels can also contribute to conditions like heart disease, which ultimately result in very expensive medical treatments. These medical treatments increase employer health insurance expenses.

Reductions in employee stress can facilitate job performance. Employees who are overburdened have difficulty concentrating, can lose energy and motivation at work, and find it difficult to think of new and creative ideas. Stress can also create conflicts with coworkers and lead to rude or hostile treatment of clients or customers. Ultimately, employees who are experiencing high levels of stress may leave, so all the costs of turnover are incurred.

Stress reduction programs also have an ethical component. The workplace generates a great deal of stress for many employees, so employers have a certain responsibility to offset its negative consequences. Stress reduction programs are a direct way to help employees feel better. When employers show concern for employees by helping reduce stress, employees feel more committed.

Counterpoint

While employers may have a direct financial interest in certain elements of stress reduction, it's worth asking whether investing in stress reduction programs is actually a good idea.

The first problem is operational. Some stress reduction interventions are expensive, requiring professional facilitators or exercise equipment. These can take a long time to show financial returns, and the up-front costs of researching, designing, and implementing them are substantial. A growing number of corporations report that the expected returns on investment in wellness programs have failed to materialize. And the time employees spend in stress reduction interventions is time they spend not working.

Another problem is that stress reduction programs are invasive. Should your boss or other individuals in the workplace tell you how you're supposed to feel? Many stress reduction programs step even further into employees' personal lives by encouraging open discussions about sources of stress. Do you really want your manager and coworkers to know why you're experiencing stress? The more that sensitive topics related to stress are discussed, the harder it is to keep work relationships professional.

A final concern is that it is too hard to draw the line between stress from work and general life stress. A company's stress reduction program may try to target problems of work overload or social conflict, but these issues often affect other areas of life. How should a stress reduction program operate when the reasons for employee stress come, say, from a sick relative or conflicts with family members?

Organizations often mean well, but it may be more important to let employees keep their private lives private.

Sources: Based on L. Vanderkam, "The Dark Side of Corporate Wellness Programs," *Fast Company*, June 8, 2015,

<http://www.fastcompany.com/3047115/the-dark-side-of-corporate-wellness-programs>; D. R. Stover and J. Wood, "Most

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<http://www.gallup.com/businessjournal/181481/company-wellness-programs-bust.aspx>; and A. Frakt and A. E. Carroll, “Do

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<http://www.nytimes.com/2014/09/12/upshot/do-workplace-wellness-programs-work-usually-not.html>.

Chapter Review

MyLab Management Discussion Questions

Go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management to complete the problems marked with this icon .

Questions for Review

- 17-1** What are the differences between the forces for change and planned change?
- 17-2** How can resistance to change be overcome?
- 17-3** What are the four main approaches to managing organizational change?
- 17-4** How can managers create a culture for change?
- 17-5** What are the potential environmental, organizational, and personal sources of stress at work and the role of individual and cultural differences?
- 17-6** What are the physiological, psychological, and behavioral symptoms of stress at work?
- 17-7** What are the individual and organizational approaches to managing stress?

Application and Employability

In this chapter, you were introduced to the many ways in which change affects organizations, including the development of employee stress and strain. You learned about several techniques to manage your stress levels. Understanding organizational change can help you become more employable because change is a constant in organizations. Learning to adapt and manage change can help you progress and succeed at work. One day, you may be behind

a major organizational change effort. If you find yourself in that position, you can draw on your knowledge of organizational change management efforts to make sure that the change is implemented smoothly. Knowing how to manage your stress levels can help you become more employable because you will be able to be productive in spite of the stress. Also, challenging stressors and goals can help motivate you and lead to great accomplishments. If you find yourself managing people someday, you have learned a variety of options for helping your employees manage their stress levels. In this chapter, you have improved your social responsibility skills by becoming aware of the dangers of a lack of sleep, considered how to handle team stress and conflict, learned how to manage stress during organizational change, and debated whether or not companies should be involved in stress reduction efforts. In the next section, you will continue to build these skills, along with your critical thinking and knowledge application and analysis skills, by reflecting on major events at work and how they influence your understanding of business, considering the negative effects of presenteeism, learning how organizations can improve employee stress levels, and becoming aware of the adverse effects of employee loneliness and what to do about it.

Experiential Exercise Making Employees Less Resistant to Change

As mentioned in this chapter, employees are often resistant to change as they are afraid of losing the status quo and the privileges accumulated over the course of their career. Now, let us suppose that your team, which has several years of experience in change management, has been hired by a leading business school that is facing an imminent merger with one of its competitors, located 500 miles away from the historical campus site.

The management of the school told you that the merger is essential to survive and compete in the market of higher education due to increasing competition and greater mobility of students who encounter fewer and fewer barriers to studying abroad. After some informal meetings with professors and other staff, you realized that professors have mixed feelings about the merger. Some are worried about the possibility that the school management will ask them to move or teach in the other campus. Many others are excited about the merger as they have already developed research relationships with colleagues in the other university. In general, your team feels that it won't be a problem to convince the others to support the change, and you have picked out two or three influential professors who can help you convince all the others.

The staff worries you more, as it is generally more negative about the change and, in several instances, they consciously acted to sabotage the merger. Many are afraid of losing their job, especially those holding positions of responsibility, as these positions are already filled in the other institution, and most think that the merger will cause extra work since new procedures need to be developed or old ones updated. Many people are skeptical about the reasons for the change and complain about the lack of information received so far. For example, many do not understand why a change is needed right now given that the number of students has been increasing year after year. Some have told you they have no faith in the management and believe the merger is just a way to scale and reduce costs. A general concern is that all managerial positions will be assigned to new people or those coming from the other institution.

Your team is worried about the success of the merger, but you believe that, with the right actions and choices, the staff's resistance can be won. On the basis of what you have read in this chapter and your experience of change in life, think of a possible plan to communicate to

the management of the business school how they can make employees more willing to embrace the changes to come. Make a list of interventions, dividing them on the basis of priority and necessary people involved.

Questions

- 17-8.** Was it easy for your team to reach a consensus about the recommendations to propose to the management of the business school? Which were the elements on which you disagreed, if any? How did you handle such disagreement?
- 17-9.** How do you think organizations can train their employees to be less resistant to change? Why do you think faculty members are more willing to change than administrative staff?
- 17-10.** Staff complained about the lack of information from the management before and during the merger process. How can managers of organizations involved in such delicate operations balance the need to inform employees and the need to maintain confidentiality?

Ethical Dilemma The Fear of Redundancy and Ceasing Operations

Leading universities in the United Kingdom (including the University of Manchester and the University of Birmingham), renowned charter and low-cost airlines in Europe (such as Monarch, Air Berlin, and EasyJet), colossal banks (such as the HSBC), iconic department stores (such as the British Home Stores), and the Sheffield-based Outokumpu steel company in the United Kingdom all have faced financial troubles and strains on their existence. As the companies have struggled, so have the people who worked for them. This is because some of these companies have ceased operations and trading while others have announced massive redundancies in anticipation of economic struggles and uncertainty, political instability or industry decline, or even unexpected increase in operating costs, all of which have led to employee layoffs.

In the cases of EasyJet, Manchester University, Birmingham University, and Outokumpu, thousands of employees were made redundant within a short period of time. Some of these were introduced as planned and incremental changes, but most of these changes were abrupt, drastic, and rather forced, acting as a shock to the workforce staff. Situations like this constitute a stressful situation for both the management and the employees, as they can challenge trust relations and jeopardize individual and group performance as well as disrupt and confuse the group dynamics in many ways. Redundancy can also impede motivation for the staff remaining in their posts and generate stress for both those being made redundant as well as those who have to pick up after the former—not an easily accepted situation for those leaving or those remaining. In the new responsibilities and the workload, the remaining staff are also left worrying about their own future. In both cases, the stress created needs to be managed in the best possible manner. Support, mentoring, and consultations are vital for enhancing the skills and knowledge required in the new state of affairs as well as enhancing employee morale. Additionally, change needs to be planned and prepared for to the extent possible, rather than carrying it out abruptly and at the expense of employees.

Questions

17-11. Which were the main forces for change in the organizations presented above? How could these changes have been managed? How could the companies have resisted

change?

- 17-12.** How could Appreciative Inquiry be applied in the case of a redundancy period to motivate and improve performance of the remaining staff?
- 17-13.** What type of stressors could be created in a redundancy scenario, and where are these generated? Discuss how a company that is undergoing redundancy procedures can manage the stress generated for all affected parties.

Sources: Alan Tovey, "Steel Industry Suffers New Blow with More Job Cuts in Sheffield," *The Telegraph*, March 16, 2016, <http://www.telegraph.co.uk/business/2016/03/14/steel-industry-suffers-new-blow-with-more-job-cuts-in-sheffield/>; James Field "Birmingham Cuts Jobs ahead of REF 2021," *Research Fortnight*, March 9, 2016, <http://www.researchresearch.com/news/article/?articleId=1358723>; Phillip Inman, "HSBC Starts Laying Off 840 IT Staff in UK," *The Guardian*, May 16, 2016, <https://www.theguardian.com/business/2016/may/16/hsbc-job-losses-840-it-staff-uk>; Dan Milmo, "Easyjet Cuts Luton East Midlands Flights," *The Guardian*, September 3, 2009, <https://www.theguardian.com/business/2009/sep/03/easyjet-cuts-luton-east-midlands-flights>; ITV News, "Thousands of BHS Staff to Be Told of Redundancies," July 26, 2017, <http://www.itv.com/news/2016-07-25/thousands-of-bhs-staff-to-be-told-of-redundancies/>; BBC News, "Monarch Flights Cancelled as Airline Ceases Trading," October 2, 2017, <http://www.bbc.co.uk/news/business-41464934>; Ravender Sembhy, "EasyJet Confirms Acquisition of Air Berlin Assets," *The Independent*, December 18, 2017, <http://www.independent.co.uk/news/business/news/easyjet-air-berlin-deal-buy-tegel-airport-operations-flying-crew-landing-slots-bankrupt-airline-a8116046.html>; Frances Perraudin, "Manchester University Professors Sign Letter of No Confidence Over Cuts," *The Guardian*, June 5, 2017, <https://www.theguardian.com/education/2017/jun/05/manchester-university-job-cuts-professors-sign-letter-no-confidence>.

Case Incident 1 Sprucing Up Walmart

For more than half a century, Walmart has prided itself on providing value to customers by being a low-price leader. But the consumer mindset is changing. Now “value” also means convenience, ease of finding what you want, and the ability to get exactly what you want when you want it. Nationwide dollar-store chains often have lower prices than Walmart, so that point of competitive advantage is fading. And thanks to Amazon.com and other online retailers, consumers can shop from home whenever they like, compare prices, and know immediately what is available.

Contrast this with the experience many Walmart shoppers previously had when they entered a store—low inventory, disorganized aisles, unhelpful staff, and an overall depressing atmosphere. The company’s online presence was about the same. The site was difficult to navigate, and attempts to search for products were frustrating at best and more often fruitless.

Named Walmart’s CEO in 2014, Doug McMillon set out to change this situation. “What people think about the company is important,” he noted. And at the moment, people weren’t thinking about value and low prices when they thought about Walmart. McMillon enacted a number of changes. First, the company had earned a reputation of treating its store employees poorly—low wages, few benefits—while profits were in the billions of dollars, so Walmart announced it would increase its minimum wage.

Second, the company asked for and paid more attention to employee feedback. Recurring issues included the dress code, store music, and even store temperatures. So clothing rules were relaxed, more variety in music was introduced, and thermostats were adjusted. The company hopes improving employee morale will translate into a better experience for customers, thereby changing some of the negative images.

Walmart’s Web presence was another target for big changes. Amazon is the store’s biggest competitor, and McMillon wanted to offer customers more items, pickup options, and ways to meet their needs and demands—for example, an online grocery ordering service. This means a new way of thinking about marketing and inventory across the board.

McMillon was able to see how consumers have changed not only what they want but also the way they want it—whether from the hands of happy employees or with the simple click of a mouse. The question remains: Will his actions be enough to change the way consumers see Walmart?

Questions ★

17-14. What key factors do you think prompted Walmart to change? Do these factors exemplify the change pressures discussed in the chapter? Why or why not?

17-15. What results from Walmart's changes do you predict?

17-16. Describe how McMillon acted as a change agent in this situation.

Sources: Based on S. Halzack, "Why Walmart Is Ditching Its Celine Dion Soundtrack and Getting a DJ," *Washington Post*, June 3, 2015, <http://www.washingtonpost.com/news/business/wp/2015/06/03/why-Walmart-is-ditching-its-celine-dion-soundtrack-and-getting-a-deejay/>; B. Ritholtz, "Walmart Learns to Live without Everyday Poverty Wages," *Bloomberg View*, June 11, 2015, <http://www.bloombergview.com/articles/2015-06-11/Walmart-lives-without-everyday-poverty-wages>; and B. O'Keefe, "The Man Who's Reinventing Walmart," *Fortune*, June 4, 2015, <http://fortune.com/2015/06/04/walmart-ceo-doug-mcmillon/>.

Case Incident 2 Sweat the Stress

According to a 2016 report by the Health and Safety Executive, a public body in the United Kingdom, stress, depression, and anxiety cost UK industries £12.5 million in lost sick days. This accounted for 49 percent of all days lost due to ill health, and the trend is rising. The Institute of Directors, another British organization, reports that 98 percent of business leaders believe that good mental health is important to the performance of their organization. With 54 percent of its members saying that they been approached by staff suffering from mental ill health, it is clear that organizations need to develop new ways to address this increasing problem.

Like many large employers, the University of Leeds takes the health and well-being of its staff very seriously, providing a range of support services aimed at improving their psychological health. However, a new Wellness Programme aims to provide a different type of support. The pilot scheme, based in the Faculty of Engineering, offers employees a 12-week program that provides one-on-one support with exercises, stress management, sleep management, and healthy lifestyle management. Those on the program have access to on-site gym facilities and bespoke training programs followed by a further six-month premium gym membership.

The more commonly known impacts of stress are on our psychological health, leading to a number of problems such as tension or anxiety. However, it can also lead to physiological problems, ranging from loss of appetite to heart attacks. The benefits of exercise to those suffering from mental health issues are well documented. The Mayo Clinic has touted the stress-busting benefits of exercise, and a review by the Society of Occupational Medicine found that workplace physical activity programs can have a positive impact on anxiety, symptoms of depression, and stress.

The targeted Wellness Programme at the University of Leeds aims to tackle the issues of stress at the earliest stage, before the negative effects are felt by the individual or the business. Heather Swinsco, the human resources professional who proposed the program, sees the issue of mental health as something which needs to be taken seriously. In a recent survey, the mental health charity Mind found that 30 percent of staff would not feel comfortable talking to a line manager about being stressed, while 14 percent said they had resigned as a result of stress, with a worrying further 42 percent saying they had considered

it. The inability to talk about stress may result in still higher levels of sickness as the issues are not being addressed, and staying at work may have a negative impact on other employees, who now have to deal with their stressed co-worker. Swinsco felt that identifying individuals at this earlier stage and making direct referrals to the Wellness Programme would limit these negative effects.

Referral to the program was based on certain criteria, such as the length of time that the individual was expected to experience mental ill-health and whether they were willing and able to engage with the activities. Members of the pilot program will be monitored during the initial 12 weeks and after to assess the impact of the exercise on their mental wellbeing. Initial reports are encouraging, and overall positive outcomes may lead to the program being taken up by other areas of the University.

Questions

- 17-17.** To what extent is this Wellness Programme tackling the causes of stress? How should employees be selected for this type of program? What issues might this cause?
- 17-18.** Do you see any challenges in a full implementation of this sort of Wellness Programme for the organization? Explain your answer.
- 17-19.** This type of program aims to reduce stress across the organization. What issues may impact successful uptake by staff?

Source: Health and Safety Executive, “Work-related Stress, Depression or Anxiety Statistics in Great Britain 2017,” November 2017, <http://www.hse.gov.uk/statistics/causdis/stress/stress.pdf>; A. H. Y. Chu, D. Koh, F. M. Moy, and F. Müller-Riemenschneider, “Do Workplace Physical Activity Interventions Improve Mental Health Outcomes?,” *Occupational Medicine* 64, no. 4, June 1, 2014: pp. 235–45, retrieved from <https://academic.oup.com/occmed/article/64/4/235/1465341>; Mayo Clinic Staff, “Exercise and Stress: Get moving to Manage Stress,” Mayo Foundation for Medical Education and Research, March 8, 2018, <https://www.mayoclinic.org/healthy-lifestyle/stress-management/in-depth/exercise-and-stress/art-20044469>; Mind, “Taking Care of Your Staff,” <https://www.mind.org.uk/workplace/mental-health-at-work/taking-care-of-your-staff/>; Director magazine, “Mental health: IoD calls for ‘a little more conversation,’” March 2, 2017, <https://www.director.co.uk/news-mental-health-iod-calls-little-conversation-2386/>.

MyLab Management Writing Assignments

If your instructor has assigned this activity, go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management

for the following assisted-graded writing assignments:

17-20. Refer again to Case Incident 1. Have you ever felt pressured to work when you were ill? How did you respond? How might you respond now?

17-21. Refer again to Case Incident 2. HR departments are increasingly taking a proactive approach to ensuring that stress, depression, and anxiety are minimized in the workplace. As an HR professional, suggest how you might frame an all-encompassing program to combat these ills.

17-22. MyLab Management only—additional assisted-graded writing assignment.

Endnotes

¹ A. Chowdhry, “Apple Surpassed Samsung as Global Phone Market Leader, Says Report,” *Forbes*, March 3, 2015, <http://www.forbes.com/sites/amitchowdhry/2015/03/04/apple-passes-samsung/>.

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⁶ N. Fligstein and A. Goldstein, “The Roots of the Great Recession,” in D. B. Grusky, B. Western, and C. Wimer (eds.), *The Great Recession* (New York, NY: Russell Sage Foundation, 2011): 21–56; and R. Rich, “The Great Recession,” *Federal Reserve History*, November 22, 2013, https://www.federalreservehistory.org/essays/great_recession_of_200709.

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⁹ P. Mohan, “Clone Wars: Why Instagram Will Legally Get Away with Copying Snapchat Stories,” *Fast Company*, August 5, 2016, <https://www.fastcompany.com/3062593/clone-wars-why-instagram-will-legally-get-away-with-copying-snapchat-stories>.

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End of Chapter Quiz

Test Your Understanding

1 Organizations are increasingly adjusting their processes and positioning their products as environment-friendly and sustainable in order to increase their appeal to consumers. This is a response to changes in _____.

- ☐ demographic trends
- ☐ social trends
- ☐ cultural trends
- ☐ economic shocks

Check answer

Reset

2 Which of the following resistance to change is implicit?

- ☐ strike
- ☐ increased error
- ☐ resignation
- ☐ complaint

Check answer

Reset

3 Selective information processing is a major force for resistance to change. It indicates that _____.

- changes in organizational patterns may threaten the expertise of specialized groups, so these groups tend to resist change
- individuals hear what they want to hear and they ignore information that challenges the world they've created
- limited changes in subsystems tend to be nullified by the larger system
- groups in the organization that control sizable resources often resist

change

Check answer

Reset

4 Which one of the following is not listed as a tactic for dealing with resistance to change?

- ☐ acceleration
- ☐ manipulation
- ☐ participation
- ☐ cooptation

Check answer

Reset

5 You have threatened to eliminate positions and even to close down the company if your employees don't change their attitudes. The method for overcoming resistance that you have chosen is _____.

- ☐ communication
- ☐ participation
- ☐ negotiation
- ☐ coercion

Check answer

Reset

6 Which of the following tactics for overcoming resistance to change is most likely to be beneficial when employees' fear and anxiety are high?

- ☐ education
- ☐ building support and commitment
- ☐ participation
- ☐ implementing changes fairly

Check answer

Reset

7 Who built on Lewin's three-step model to create a more detailed approach for implementing change?

- John Kotter
- David McClelland

☐ Douglas Surber

☐ Lawrence Summers

Check answer

Reset

8 _____ is a collection of change methods that seek to improve organizational effectiveness and employee well-being.

- ☐ Organizational development
- ☐ Appreciative inquiry
- ☐ Groupthink
- ☐ Action research

Check answer

Reset

9 What is the correct order within the action research process?

- ☐ analysis, feedback, action, evaluation, and diagnosis
- ☐ feedback, action, evaluation, diagnosis, and analysis
- ☐ action, evaluation, diagnosis, analysis, and feedback
- ☐ diagnosis, analysis, feedback, action, and evaluation

Check answer

Reset

10 Idea champions display characteristics associated with _____ leadership.

- ☐ narcissistic
- ☐ transformational
- ☐ autocratic
- ☐ transactional

Check answer

Reset

11 Which of the following has been the most studied potential source of

innovation?

- psychological factors

- ☐ structural variables
- ☐ human resource factors
- ☐ cultural variables

Check answer

Reset

12 Which of the following resources should you seek when emotional demands are stressing you?

- ☐ computer support
- ☐ information support
- ☐ social support
- ☐ cross-functional support

Check answer

Reset

13 Which of the following statements is true regarding the effects of stress?

- ☐ Challenge stressors tend to produce more strain than hindrance stressors.
- ☐ When challenge stress increases, those with high levels of organizational support have higher role-based performance.
- ☐ Hindrance stress improves job performance in a supportive work environment.
- ☐ Employees who have a stronger affective commitment to their organization perform worse under stress as compared to those who have low levels of commitment.

Check answer

Reset

14 Which of the following types of jobs is least likely to create stress and reduce satisfaction?

- jobs that make multiple and conflicting demands
- jobs that provide a high level of feedback
- jobs that lack clarity about the incumbent's duties

- ☐ jobs that provide the incumbents with less control over the pace of their work

Check answer

Reset

15 How does redesigning jobs help reduce stress?

- It helps individuals with an internal locus of control adapt better to high-stress jobs.
- It seeks to buy off the leaders of a resistance group by giving them a key role.
- It gives individuals greater control over work activities and lessens dependence on others.
- It reduces uncertainty by lessening role ambiguity and role conflict.

Check answer

Reset



Source: Ronen Zvullan/Reuters/Alamy Stock Photo

Learning Objectives

After studying this chapter, you should be able to:

- 18-1** Describe the three types of conflict and the three loci of conflict.
- 18-2** Outline the conflict process.
- 18-3** Contrast distributive and integrative bargaining.
- 18-4** Apply the five steps of the negotiation process.
- 18-5** Show how individual differences influence negotiations.

18-6 Assess the roles and functions of third-party negotiations.

Employability Skills Matrix (ESM)

	Myth or Science?	Career Objectives	An Ethical Choice	Point/Counterpoint	Experiential Exercise	Ethic Dilemma
Critical Thinking				✓	✓	✓
Communication	✓	✓			✓	
Collaboration	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓
Knowledge Application and Analysis		✓		✓	✓	✓
Social Responsibility			✓			✓

MyLab Management Chapter Warm Up

If your professor has assigned this activity, go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management to complete the video exercise.

Bargaining Chips

What gives someone the ability to negotiate? Power? Money? Relationships? Can someone with seemingly no power, little access to the outside world, and almost no economic resources still have the power to bargain? Yes.

Derrick Houston seemed to have nothing to negotiate with. The Mississippi inmate was serving a sentence for armed robbery at a state prison in Leakesville, Mississippi, in April 2017. His sentence would last for over two decades. But with such a long sentence, Houston knew he could not live in the inhumane conditions offered by the prison. While state officials claimed that conditions in the prisons were meant to maintain security because of gang activity, many residents of the prison felt they were being subjected to cruel treatment. Many inmates were kept in lockdown for days at a time, despite laws that require at least five hours of recreational activity a week. At the same time, limits on visitors meant that many inmates could rarely see family and friends.

Physical conditions also needed to be improved in the facility. Many of the inmates had serious mental health issues and would throw feces and urine in their cells. This led to unsanitary conditions, including infestations of roaches, rats, spiders, and flies. On top of this, the prison did not have air conditioning, which could be dangerous for inmates when temperatures reached the triple digits in the summer.

One inmate commented, “If a citizen left their dog or pet in the outside heat of a condemned dog house where [the] temperature is 130 degrees, they would be arrested for animal cruelty and the pet would be taken away. So why should humans be treated worse than animals?” The inmates tried to negotiate by using the only bargaining chip they had: their stomachs. The inmates began refusing to eat, knowing that health problems from starvation would draw press and state officials’ attention. The tactic proved successful. By the end of the month, Houston and the rest of the protesting inmates were transferred to a prison with better conditions.

Wendy, Derrick Houston’s wife, was very relieved. “[We] have been trying to get my husband transferred from Southern Mississippi Correctional Institution (SMCI) for over a year. If we had known a hunger strike would get him transferred, then he should have gotten on it a year ago,” she wrote in an e-mail to a reporter.

A hunger strike may seem extreme, but it is a relatively common strategy when prisoners want to negotiate better conditions. They occur frequently in American prisons. The same month that Houston and many other inmates were striking in Mississippi, hundreds of inmates were also taking part in a hunger strike in Northwest Detention Center in Tacoma, Washington. Inmates at the Washington prison were especially vulnerable because they were undocumented immigrants without the same legal rights as the prisoners in Mississippi. Like Houston, they complained about conditions as well as incredibly low prison wages that they

felt violated antislavery laws.

Around the globe, the same tactic was being used by Palestinian inmates in Israeli prisons. Unlike the strikes in American prisons, the Palestinian hunger strike was especially political in nature. Led by a prominent Palestinian figure, Marwan Barghouti, the strike was meant to draw attention to persecution of Palestinian citizens in Israel. Besides leading the hunger strike, Barghouti was also punished for smuggling essays on Palestinian resistance to the *New York Times*.

Hunger strikes highlight many of the concepts we will cover in this chapter. First, they highlight a response to conflict. In the cases above, the conflicts between inmates and prison officials were dysfunctional. As you will learn from this text, however, some conflict is beneficial, and even necessary, because it enhances creativity and drives change in organizations. Second, the negotiation process tended to alleviate the conflict. By using their health as a bargaining tool, inmates in Mississippi were able to gain better conditions. Would the same tactic always be successful in every context? Not necessarily. We will also explain many factors, from emotions to personality, that influence the success of negotiation techniques across situations.

Sources: Based on I. Fisher, “Over 1,000 Palestinian Prisoners in Israel Stage Hunger Strike,” *New York Times*, April 17, 2017, <https://www.nytimes.com/2017/04/17/world/middleeast/marwan-barghouti-hunger-strike-israel.html>; J. Amy, “Mississippi Corrections Says Prison Hunger Strike Over,” *The Clarion-Ledger*, April 12, 2017, <http://www.clarionledger.com/story/news/2017/04/12/mississippi-prison-hunger-strike/100365860/>; J. Mitchell, “Inmates Say They’re On Hunger Strike to Protest Leakesville Prison Conditions,” *USA Today*, April 4, 2017, <https://www.usatoday.com/story/news/2017/04/04/hunger-strike-enters-third-day-at-leakesville-prison/100026768/>; and S. Bernard, “Detainees Launch New Hunger Strike at Northwest Detention Center,” *Seattle Weekly*, April 10, 2017, <http://www.seattleweekly.com/news/detainees-launch-new-hunger-strike-at-northwest-detention-center/>.

A Definition of Conflict

18-1 Describe the three types of conflict and the three loci of conflict.

There has been no shortage of definitions for the word *conflict*,¹ but common to most is the idea that conflict is a perception. If no one is aware of a conflict, then it is generally agreed no conflict exists. Also needed to begin the conflict process are opposition or incompatibility, and interaction.

We define **conflict** ⓘ broadly as a process that begins when one party perceives that another party has affected or is about to negatively affect something the first party cares about. Conflict describes the point in ongoing activity when interaction becomes disagreement. People experience a wide range of conflicts in organizations over an incompatibility of goals, differences in interpretations of facts, disagreements over behavioral expectations, and the like. Our definition covers the full range of conflict levels, from overt and violent acts to subtle forms of disagreement.

There is no consensus over the role of conflict in groups and organizations. In the past, researchers tended to argue about whether conflict was uniformly good or bad. Such simplistic views eventually gave way to approaches recognizing that not all conflicts are the same and that different types of conflict have different effects.²

Contemporary perspectives differentiate types of conflict based on their effects.

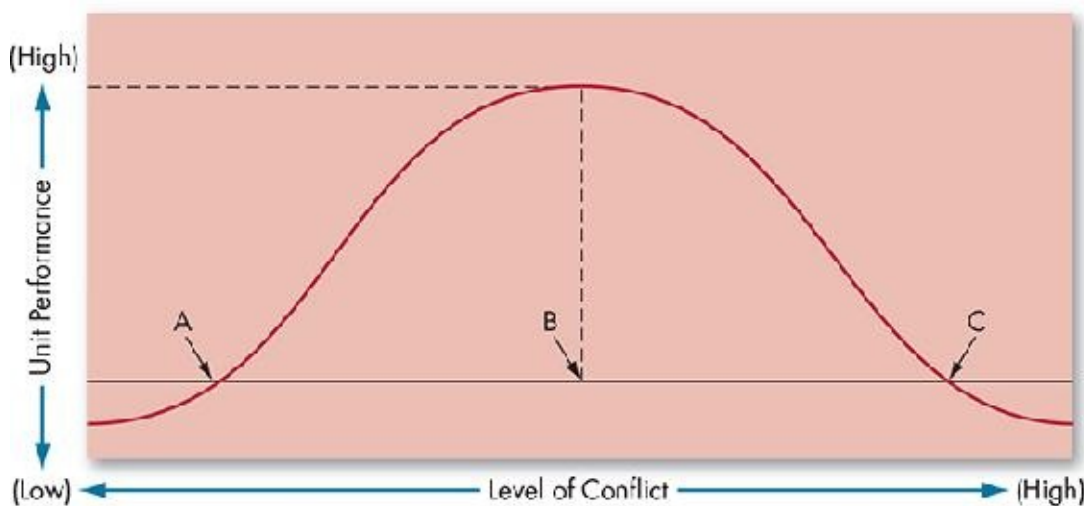
Functional conflict ⓘ supports the goals of the group, improves its performance, and is thus a constructive form of conflict.³ For example, a debate among members of a work team about the most efficient way to improve production can be functional if unique points of view are discussed and compared openly. Conflict that hinders group performance is destructive or **dysfunctional conflict** ⓘ.⁴ A highly personal struggle for control in a team that distracts from the task at hand is dysfunctional. Exhibit 18-1 provides an overview depicting the effect of levels of conflict. To understand different types of conflict, we will discuss next the *types* of conflict and the *loci* of conflict.

Types of Conflict

One means of understanding conflict is to identify the *type* of disagreement, or what the

conflict is about. Is it a disagreement about goals? Is it about people who just do not get along well with one another? Or is it about the best way to get things done? Although each conflict is unique, researchers have classified conflicts into three categories: task, relationship, or process. **Task conflict** ⓘ relates to the content and goals of the work. **Relationship conflict** ⓘ focuses on interpersonal relationships. **Process conflict** ⓘ is about how the work gets done.⁵

Exhibit 18-1 Conflict and Unit Performance



Situation	Level of Conflict	Type of Conflict	Unit's Internal Characteristics	Unit Performance Outcome
A	Low or none	Dysfunctional	Apathetic Stagnant Nonresponsive to change Lack of new ideas	Low
B	Optimal	Functional	Viable Selfcritical Innovative	High
C	High	Dysfunctional	Disruptive Chaotic Uncooperative	Low

Studies demonstrate that relationship conflicts, at least in work settings, are almost always dysfunctional⁶ (although they may improve creativity under some circumstances).⁷ Why? It appears that the friction and interpersonal hostilities inherent in relationship conflicts increase personality clashes and decrease mutual understanding, which hinders the completion of organizational tasks. Of the three types, relationship conflicts also appear to be the most psychologically exhausting for individuals.⁸ This type of conflict can also be very problematic for employees who are new to the organization because newcomers rely on coworkers to learn information about the job.⁹ Because they tend to revolve around personalities, you can see how relationship conflicts can become destructive. After all, we can't expect to change our coworkers' personalities, and we would generally take offense at criticisms directed at who we *are* as opposed to how we behave.



While scholars agree that relationship conflict is dysfunctional, there is considerably less agreement about whether task and process conflicts are functional. Early research suggested that task conflict within groups correlated to higher group performance, but a review of 116 studies found that generalized task conflict was essentially unrelated to group performance. However, there were factors of the conflict that could create a relationship between conflict and performance.¹⁰ One such factor was whether the conflict included top management or occurred lower in the organization. Task conflict among top management teams was positively associated with performance, whereas conflict lower in the organization was negatively associated with group performance, perhaps because people in top positions may not feel as threatened in their organizational roles by conflict. This review also found that it mattered whether other types of conflict were occurring at the same time. If task and relationship conflict occurred together, task conflict was more likely negative, whereas if task conflict occurred by itself, it more likely was positive. Also, some scholars have argued that the strength of conflict is important—if task conflict is very low, people aren't really engaged or addressing the important issues. If task conflict is too high, however, infighting quickly degenerates into relationship conflict. Moderate levels of task conflict may thus be optimal. Supporting this argument, one study in China found that moderate levels of task conflict in the early development stage increased creativity in groups, but high levels decreased team performance.¹¹

The personalities of the teams appear to matter. One study demonstrated that teams of individuals who are, on average, high in openness and emotional stability are better able to

turn task conflict into increased group performance.¹² The reason may be that open and emotionally stable teams can put task conflict in perspective and focus on how the variance in ideas can help solve the problem rather than letting it degenerate into relationship conflicts.

What about process conflict? Researchers found that process conflicts are about delegation and roles. Conflicts over delegation often revolve around the perception of some members as shirking, and conflicts over roles can leave some group members feeling marginalized. Thus, process conflicts often become highly personalized and quickly devolve into relationship conflicts. It's also true, of course, that arguing about how to do something takes time away from actually doing it. We've all been part of groups in which the arguments and debates about roles and responsibilities seem to go nowhere.

Loci of Conflict

Another way to understand conflict is to consider its *locus*, or the framework within which the conflict occurs. Here, too, there are three basic types. **Dyadic conflict** ⓘ is conflict between two people. **Intragroup conflict** ⓘ occurs *within* a group or team. **Intergroup conflict** ⓘ is conflict *between* groups or teams.¹³



Nearly all the literature on task, relationship, and process conflict considers intragroup conflict (within the group). That makes sense given that groups and teams often exist only to perform a particular task. However, it doesn't necessarily tell us all we need to know about the context and outcomes of conflict. For example, research has found that for intragroup task conflict to influence performance within the team positively, it is important that the team has a supportive climate in which mistakes aren't penalized and every team member "[has] the other's back."¹⁴ Similarly, the personal needs of group members may determine when task conflict has a positive impact on performance. In a study of Korean work groups, task conflict was beneficial for performance when members were high on the need for achievement.¹⁵

But is this concept applicable to the effects of intergroup conflict? Think about, say, the teams in the National Football League (NFL). As we said, for a team to adapt and improve, perhaps a certain amount of intragroup conflict (but not too much) is good for team performance, especially when the team members support one another. But would we care whether members from one NFL team supported members from another team? Probably not.

In fact, if groups are competing with one another so that only one team can “win,” interteam conflict seems almost inevitable. Still, it must be managed. Intense intergroup conflict can be quite stressful to group members and might well affect the way they interact. One study found, for example, that high levels of conflict between teams caused individuals to focus on complying with norms within their teams.¹⁶



Under the leadership of George Zimmer, the founder and CEO of Men’s Warehouse (MW) and its advertising spokesperson, the retailer grew into a multimillion-dollar firm with 1,143 stores. After retiring as CEO, Zimmer served as executive chairman of MW’s board until an intragroup conflict between him and other members resulted in his removal from the board.

Source: Patrick Fallon/Bloomberg/Getty Images

It may surprise you that individuals become most important in intergroup conflicts. One study that focused on intergroup conflict found an interplay between an individual’s position within a group and the way that individual managed conflict between groups. Group members who were relatively peripheral in their own group were better at resolving conflicts between their group and another one. But this happened only when those peripheral members were still accountable to their group.¹⁷ Thus, being at the core of your work group does not necessarily make you the best person to manage conflict with other groups.

Another intriguing question about loci is whether conflicts interact with or buffer one

another. Assume, for example, that Jia and Marcus are on the same team. What happens if they don't get along interpersonally (dyadic conflict) *and* their team also has high task conflict? Progress might be halted. What happens to their team if two other team members, Shawna and Justin, do get along well? The team might still be dysfunctional, or the positive relationship might prevail.

Thus, understanding functional and dysfunctional conflict requires not only that we identify the type of conflict; we also need to know where it occurs. It's possible that while the concepts of task, relationship, and process conflict are useful in understanding intragroup or even dyadic conflict, they are less useful in explaining the effects of intergroup conflict. But how do we make conflict as productive as possible? A better understanding of the conflict process, discussed next, will provide insight about potential controllable variables.

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

18.1.1 _____ is defined as a process that begins when one party perceives another party has or is about to negatively affect something the first party cares about.

- ☐ Problem solving
- ☐ Assessment
- ☐ Conflict
- ☐ Negotiation

Check answer

Reset

18.1.2 You are a marketing director for a large food manufacturer. Lately, you have noticed that you are spending a great deal more time at work, sometimes 14 hours a day, because your best friend, who is head of product development, continues to ask you to serve on taste test panels for new products. Which type(s) of conflict are you experiencing?

- ☐ task
- ☐ relationship
- ☐ process
- ☐ both A and B

Check answer

Reset

The Conflict Process

18-2 Outline the conflict process.

The **conflict process** ⓘ has five stages: potential opposition or incompatibility, cognition and personalization, intentions, behavior, and outcomes (see Exhibit 18-2).¹⁸

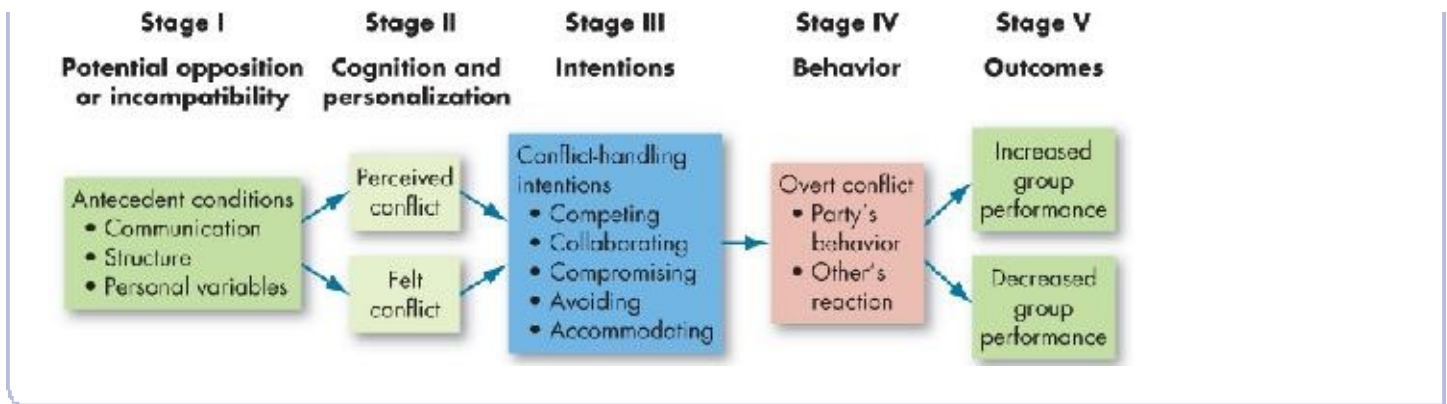
Stage I: Potential Opposition or Incompatibility

The first stage of conflict is the appearance of conditions—causes or sources—that create opportunities for it to arise. These conditions may *not* lead directly to conflict, but one of them is necessary if it is to surface. We group the conditions into three general categories: communication, structure, and personal variables.

Communication Susan had worked in supply chain management at Bristol-Myers Squibb for three years. She enjoyed her work largely because her manager, Harry, was a great boss. Then Harry was promoted and Chuck took his place. Six months later, Susan says her job is frustrating. “Harry and I were on the same wavelength. It’s not that way with Chuck. He tells me something, and I do it. Then he tells me I did it wrong. I think he means one thing but says something else. It’s been like this since the day he arrived. I don’t think a day goes by when he isn’t yelling at me for something. You know, there are some people you just find it easy to communicate with. Well, Chuck isn’t one of those!”

Susan’s comments illustrate that communication can be a source of conflict.¹⁹ Her experience represents the opposing forces that arise from semantic difficulties, misunderstandings, and “noise” in the communication channel (see Chapter 11). These factors, along with jargon and insufficient information, can be barriers to communication and may be potential antecedent conditions to conflict. The potential for conflict has also been found to increase with too little or *too much* communication. Communication is functional up to a point, after which it is possible to overcommunicate, increasing the potential for conflict.

Exhibit 18-2 The Conflict Process



Structure Charlotte is a salesperson and Mercedes is the company credit manager at Portland Furniture Mart, a large discount furniture retailer. The women have known each other for years and have much in common: They live two blocks apart, and their oldest daughters attend the same middle school and are best friends. If Charlotte and Mercedes had different jobs, they might be friends, but at work they constantly disagree. Charlotte's job is to sell furniture, and she does it well. Most of her sales are made on credit. Because Mercedes's job is to minimize credit losses, she regularly has to turn down the credit applications of Charlotte's customers. It's nothing personal between the women; the requirements of their jobs just bring them into conflict.

The conflicts between Charlotte and Mercedes are structural in nature. The term *structure* in this context includes variables such as the size of the group, degree of specialization in tasks assigned to group members, jurisdictional clarity, member–goal compatibility, leadership styles, reward systems, and degree of dependence between groups. The larger the group and the more specialized its activities, the greater the likelihood of conflict. Tenure and conflict are inversely related, meaning that the longer a person stays with an organization, the less likely conflict becomes. Therefore, the potential for conflict is greatest when group members are younger and when turnover is high.

Personal Variables Have you ever met someone you immediately disliked? Perhaps you disagreed with most of his opinions. Even insignificant characteristics—his voice, facial expressions, or word choice—may have annoyed you. Sometimes our impressions are negative. When you have to work with people you don't like, the potential for conflict arises.



Our last category of potential sources of conflict is personal variables, which include personality, emotions, and values. People high in the personality traits of disagreeableness, neuroticism, or self-monitoring (see Chapter 5) are prone to tangle with

other people more often—and to react poorly when conflicts occur.²⁰ Emotions can cause conflict even when they are not directed at others. An employee who shows up to work irate from her hectic morning commute may carry that anger into her workday, which can result in a tension-filled meeting.²¹ Differences in preferences and values can generate higher levels of conflict. For example, a study in Korea found that when group members didn't agree about their desired achievement levels, there was more task conflict; when group members didn't agree about their desired interpersonal closeness, there was more relationship conflict; and when group members didn't have similar desires for power, there was more conflict over status.²²

Stage II: Cognition and Personalization

If the conditions cited in Stage I negatively affect something one party cares about, then the potential for opposition or incompatibility becomes actualized in the second stage.

As we noted in our definition of conflict, one or more of the parties must be aware that antecedent conditions exist. However, just because a disagreement is a **perceived conflict** ⓘ does not mean it is personalized. It is at the **felt conflict** ⓘ level, when individuals become emotionally involved, that they experience anxiety, tension, frustration, or hostility.

Stage II is important because it's where conflict issues tend to be defined, where the parties decide what the conflict is about.²³ The definition of conflict is important because it delineates the set of possible settlements. Most evidence suggests that people tend to default to cooperative strategies in interpersonal interactions unless there is a clear signal that they are faced with a competitive person. However, if our salary disagreement is a zero-sum situation (the increase in pay you want means there will be that much less in the raise pool for me), I am going to be far less willing to compromise than if I can frame the conflict as a potential win-win situation (the dollars in the salary pool might be increased so both of us could get the added pay we want).

Second, emotions play a major role in shaping perceptions.²⁴ Negative emotions allow us to oversimplify issues, lose trust, and put negative interpretations on the other party's behavior.²⁵ In contrast, positive feelings increase our tendency to see potential relationships among elements of a problem, take a broader view of the situation, and develop innovative solutions.²⁶

Stage III: Intentions

Intentions ⓘ intervene between people's perceptions and emotions, and their overt behavior. They are decisions to act in a given way.²⁷

Intentions are a distinct stage because we have to infer the other's intent to know how to respond to behavior. Many conflicts escalate simply because one party attributes the wrong intentions to the other. There is slippage between intentions and behavior, so behavior does not always reflect a person's intentions accurately.

We can also think of conflict-handling intentions as falling along two dimensions. These two dimensions—*assertiveness* (the degree to which one party attempts to satisfy his or her own concerns) and *cooperativeness* (the degree to which one party attempts to satisfy the other party's concerns)—can help us identify five conflict-handling intentions: *competing* (assertive and uncooperative), *collaborating* (assertive and cooperative), *avoiding* (unassertive and uncooperative), *accommodating* (unassertive and cooperative), and *compromising* (midrange on both assertiveness and cooperativeness).²⁸

Competing When one person seeks to satisfy his or her own interests regardless of the impact on the other parties in the conflict, that person is **competing** ⓘ. We are more apt to compete when resources are scarce.

Collaborating When parties in conflict each desire to fully satisfy the concerns of all parties, there is cooperation and a search for a mutually beneficial outcome. In **collaborating** ⓘ, parties intend to solve a problem by clarifying differences rather than by accommodating various points of view. If you attempt to find a win–win solution that allows both parties' goals to be completely achieved, that's collaborating.

Avoiding A person may recognize that a conflict exists and want to withdraw from or suppress it. Examples of **avoiding** ⓘ include trying to ignore a conflict and keeping away from others with whom you disagree.

Accommodating A party who seeks to appease an opponent may be willing to place the opponent's interests above his or her own, sacrificing to maintain the relationship. We refer to this intention as **accommodating** ⓘ. Supporting someone else's opinion despite your reservations about it, for example, is accommodating.

Compromising In **compromising** ⓘ, there is no winner or loser. Rather, there is a willingness to rationalize the object of the conflict and accept a solution with incomplete satisfaction of both parties' concerns. The distinguishing characteristic of compromising therefore is that each party intends to give up something.

Stage IV: Behavior

When most people think of conflict, they tend to focus on Stage IV because this is where conflicts become visible. The behavior stage includes statements, actions, and reactions made by conflicting parties, usually as overt attempts to implement their own intentions. As a result of miscalculations or unskilled enactments, overt behaviors sometimes deviate from original intentions.²⁹

Exhibit 18-3 Conflict-Intensity Continuum



Sources: Based on S. P. Robbins, *Managing Organizational Conflict: A Nontraditional Approach* (Upper Saddle River, NJ: Prentice Hall, 1974): 93–97; and F. Glasi, “The Process of Conflict Escalation and the Roles of Third Parties,” in G. B. J. Bomers and R. Peterson (eds.), *Conflict Management and Industrial Relations* (Boston: Kluwer–Nijhoff, 1982): 119–40.

Stage IV is a dynamic process of interaction. For example, you make a demand on me, I respond by arguing, you threaten me, I threaten you back, and so on. Exhibit 18-3 provides a way of visualizing conflict behavior. All conflicts exist somewhere along this continuum. At the lower end are conflicts characterized by subtle, indirect, and highly controlled forms of tension, such as a student challenging a point the instructor has made. Conflict intensities escalate as they move upward along the continuum until they become highly destructive.

Strikes, riots, and wars clearly fall in this upper range. Conflicts that reach the upper range of the continuum are almost always dysfunctional. Functional conflicts are typically confined to the lower range of the continuum.

Intentions that are brought into a conflict are eventually translated into behaviors. *Competing* brings out active attempts to contend with team members, and more individual effort to achieve ends without working together. *Collaborating* creates investigation of multiple solutions with other members of the team and trying to find a solution that satisfies all parties as much as possible. *Avoidance* is seen in behavior like refusals to discuss issues and reductions in effort toward group goals. People who *accommodate* put their relationships ahead of the issues in the conflict, deferring to others' opinions and sometimes acting as a subgroup with them. When people *compromise*, they both expect to (and do) sacrifice parts of their interests, hoping that if everyone does the same, an agreement will emerge.

A review that examined the effects of the four sets of behaviors across multiple studies found that openness and collaborating were both associated with superior group performance, whereas avoiding and competing strategies were associated with significantly worse group performance.³⁰ These effects were nearly as large as the effects of relationship conflict. Collaboration may be especially effective for tasks that require innovation, but it can lead to mistrust and conflict when groups are splintered into smaller groups of two or three based on task.³¹ Individuals who have been assigned power tend to have a more difficult time using collaborative strategies.³² This further demonstrates that it is not just the existence of conflict or even the type of conflict that creates problems but rather the ways people respond to conflict and manage the process once conflicts arise.

If a conflict is dysfunctional, what can the parties do to deescalate it? Or, conversely, what options exist if conflict is too low to be functional and needs to be increased? This brings us to techniques of **conflict management** ⓘ. Exhibit 18-4 lists the major resolution and stimulation techniques that allow managers to control conflict levels. We have already described several as conflict-handling intentions. Under ideal conditions, a person's intentions should translate into comparable behaviors.

Exhibit 18-4 Conflict Management Techniques

Conflict- Resolution

Techniques

<i>Problem solving</i>	Meeting face to face for the purpose of identifying the problem and resolving it through open discussion.
<i>Superordinate goals</i>	Creating a shared goal that cannot be attained without the cooperation of each of the conflicting parties.
<i>Expansion of resources</i>	Expanding the supply of a scarce resource (for example, money, promotion, opportunities, office space).
<i>Avoidance</i>	Withdrawing from or suppressing the conflict.
<i>Smoothing</i>	Playing down differences while emphasizing common interests between the conflicting parties.
<i>Compromise</i>	Having each party to the conflict give up something of value.
<i>Authoritative command</i>	Letting management use its formal authority to resolve the conflict and then communicating its desires to the parties involved.
<i>Altering the human variable</i>	Using behavioral change techniques such as human relations training to alter attitudes and behaviors that cause conflict.
<i>Altering the structural variables</i>	Changing the formal organization structure and the interaction patterns of conflicting parties through job redesign, transfers, creation of coordinating positions, and the like.

Conflict-Stimulation Techniques

<i>Communication</i>	Using ambiguous or threatening messages to increase conflict levels.
<i>Bringing in outsiders</i>	Adding employees to a group whose backgrounds, values, attitudes, or managerial styles differ from those of present members.
<i>Restructuring the organization</i>	Realigning work groups, altering rules and regulations, increasing interdependence, and making similar structural changes to disrupt the status quo.
<i>Appointing a devil's advocate</i>	Designating a critic to purposely argue against the majority positions held by the group.

Stage V: Outcomes

The action–reaction interplay between conflicting parties creates consequences. As our model demonstrates (see Exhibit 18-1), these outcomes may be functional if the conflict improves the group’s performance, or dysfunctional if it hinders performance.

Functional Outcomes How might conflict act as a force to increase group performance? It is hard to visualize a situation in which open or violent aggression could be functional. But it’s possible to see how low or moderate levels of conflict could improve group effectiveness. Note that all our examples focus on task and process conflicts and exclude the relationship variety.

Conflict is constructive when it improves the quality of decisions, stimulates creativity and innovation, encourages interest and curiosity among group members, provides the medium for problems to be aired and tensions released, and fosters self-evaluation and change. Mild conflicts also may generate energizing emotions so members of groups become more active, energized, and engaged in their work.³³



Lean production, pioneered by Toyota, creates a sense of creative tension within the workforce. They have to be creative in order to solve complex problems and address challenges, driving the success, productivity, and profitability of the business.

Source: jeremy sutton-hibbert/Alamy Stock Photo

Dysfunctional Outcomes The destructive consequences of conflict on the performance of a group or an organization are generally well known: Uncontrolled opposition breeds discontent, which acts to dissolve common ties and eventually leads to the destruction of the group. And, of course, a substantial body of literature documents how dysfunctional conflicts can reduce group effectiveness.³⁴ Among the undesirable consequences are poor communication, reductions in group cohesiveness, and subordination of group goals to the primacy of infighting among members. All forms of conflict—even the functional varieties—appear to reduce group member satisfaction and trust.³⁵ When active discussions turn into open conflicts between members, information sharing between members decreases significantly.³⁶ At the extreme, conflict can bring group functioning to a halt and threaten the group's survival.

Managing Functional Conflict If managers recognize that conflict can be beneficial in some situations, what can they do to manage conflict effectively in their organizations? In addition to knowing the principles of conflict motivation we just discussed, there are some practical guidelines for managers.

First, one of the keys to minimizing counterproductive conflicts is recognizing when there really is a disagreement. Many apparent conflicts are due to people using different verbiage to discuss the same general course of action. For example, someone in marketing might focus on “distribution problems,” while someone from operations will talk about “supply chain management” to describe essentially the same issue. Successful conflict management recognizes these different approaches and attempts to resolve them by encouraging open, frank discussion focused on interests rather than issues.

Another approach is to have opposing groups pick parts of the solution that are most important to them and then focus on how each side can get its top needs satisfied. Neither side may get exactly what it wants, but each side will achieve the most important parts of its agenda.³⁷

Third, groups that resolve conflicts successfully discuss differences of opinion openly and are prepared to manage conflict when it arises.³⁸ The most disruptive conflicts are those that are never addressed directly. An open discussion makes it much easier to develop a shared perception of the problems at hand; it also allows groups to work toward a mutually acceptable solution.

Fourth, managers need to emphasize shared interests in resolving conflicts so groups that disagree with one another don’t become too entrenched in their points of view and start to take the conflicts personally. Groups with cooperative conflict styles and a strong underlying identification with the overall group goals are more effective than groups with a competitive style.³⁹



Differences across countries in conflict resolution strategies may be based on collectivistic tendencies and motives.⁴⁰ Collectivist cultures see people as deeply embedded in social situations, whereas individualist cultures see them as autonomous. As a result, collectivists are more likely to seek to preserve relationships and promote the good of the group as a whole. They avoid the direct expression of conflict, preferring indirect methods for resolving differences of opinion. Collectivists may also be more interested in demonstrations of concern and working through third parties to resolve disputes, whereas

individualists are more likely to confront differences of opinion directly and openly.



Some research supports this theory. Compared to collectivist Japanese negotiators, their more individualist U.S. counterparts are more likely to see offers as unfair and to reject them. Another study revealed that, whereas U.S. managers were more likely to use competing tactics in the face of conflicts, compromising and avoiding were the most preferred methods of conflict management in China.⁴¹ Interview data suggest, however, that top management teams in Chinese high-technology firms prefer collaboration even more than compromising and avoiding.⁴²



Cross-cultural negotiations can also create issues of trust.⁴³ One study of Indian and U.S. negotiators found that respondents reported having less trust in their cross-culture negotiation counterparts. The lower level of trust was associated with less discovery of common interests between parties, which occurred because cross-culture negotiators were less willing to disclose and solicit information. Another study found that both U.S. and Chinese negotiators tended to have an ingroup bias, which led them to favor negotiating partners from their own cultures. For Chinese negotiators, this was particularly true when accountability requirements were high.

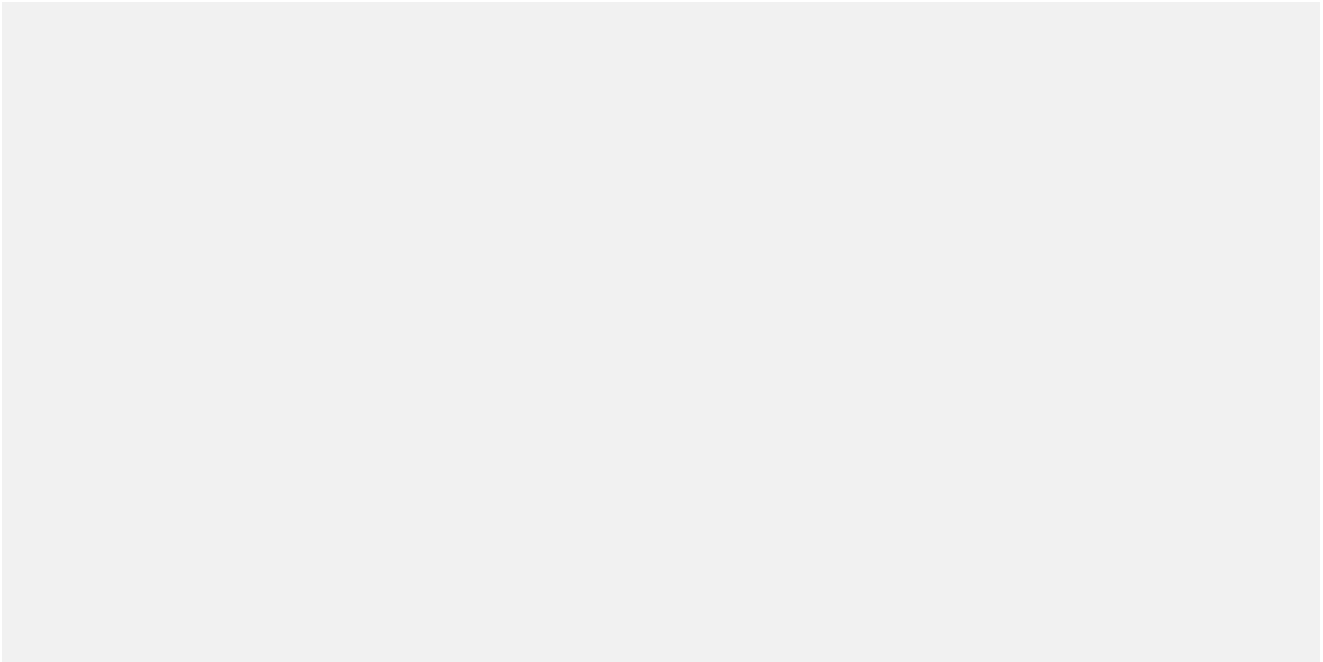
Having considered conflict—its nature, causes, and consequences—we now turn to negotiation, which often resolves conflict.

MyLab Management Watch It

If your professor has assigned this activity, go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management to complete the video exercise.

Gordon Law Group Conflict and Negotiation

Watch it video.



Watch it video.

A **transcript** of this video is available [here](#).

Transcript

Gordon Law Group Conflict and Negotiation

>> A conflict often times is really just

>> a change in circumstance that wasn't expected.

>> My name is Philip Gordon.

>> I'm the managing partner of Gordon Law Group.

>> Our law firm represents employees in all aspects

>> of their employment relationship, so from the start,

>> getting into employment,

>> as well as things that happen during your employment,

>> as well as the end of your employment.

>> And then hope fully getting new employment.

>> Conflict itself is really just some kind of change

>> that comes from a different set of expectations.

>> The negotiation is really are solution mechanism

>> and that's all it is.

>> So it's not mediation or arbitration or litigation,

>> it's negotiation.

>> It's the earliest form of resolution that we have in our tool chest

>> if you will, or our tool box, of things that we can use

>> to resolve a conflict among two people

>> or among an organization and its employees.

>> At any moment a human interaction has the ability

>> to be a wild conflict or a positive experience

>> or some sort of neutral unmemorable event, right.

>> Whether its buying a cup of coffee

>> or having someone cut you off on the highway.

>> Any number of things, right?

>> My name is Charles P. Wagner,

>> and I'm a partner at the Boston firm of Gordon Law Group.

>> So when you're at work of course

>> you want to try to avoid conflict

>> but the reality is that in the American work place

>> if you walk around people pleasing all the time

>> you're not likely going to advance very well in your organization.

>> And you're not going to be identified as someone

>> who's got leadership potential

>> and someone who is a go-getter and a star.

>> You're not going to do that by just avoiding conflict.

>> Most often conflicts between employers and employees

>> come up in the business environment

>> when something happens in the business work place.

>> So usually it happens because

>> there's employee-to-employee conflict.

>> Because one employee has run into a problem

>> with another employee and they're usually personally based.

>> We're creating conflict by being good at what we do.

>> We are creating conflict by being successful

>> and trying to get ourselves into positions

>> where we can actually shine

>> and feel excited about what we are working on,

>> because it's always a competition with somebody.

>> So we have to I guess, be responsible and adult about

>> which conflicts are worth the risk and which ones are not

>> like anything else in the world.

>> One employee thinks another employee

>> isn't pulling their fair share of the load.

>> Or one employee has a relationship

>> with another employee out of the office,

>> and they've brought that external relationship

>> and the issues involved

>> in that external relationship into the office

>> because they can't separate the two.

>> And some kind of mediation between the two of them,

>> some kind of negotiation to result in some kind of resolution

>> so the employees can continue to work together.

>> Or they can be separated so they can now work apart.

>> Once there's lawyers involved and something

>> is not going between an employee and employer,

>> the idea is, resolve the conflict.

>> Here's where psychology comes in

>> both in terms of how you're going to act on behalf of this employee,

>> on behalf of your client as an attorney

>> and engage with the other lawyer.

>> And the other piece of course is the psychology

>> about what's driving the dispute.

>> So I think one of the greatest ways in which lawyers

>> solve problems actually is being able to come together

>> and come up with ideas to help the other side,

>> and back and forth, help each other solve the problems.

>> What are the ways in which-

>> does this employee need to leave?

>> Can this employee stay?

>> What other ways can we accomplish these ideas?

>> And that's what conflict resolution is.

>> It's figuring out, you're not going to win, it's not litigation,
>> it's not a "I'm right and you're wrong."
>> It's a how are we going to negotiate,
>> like you would in any other business transaction.
>> Then when the conflict happens
>> then we have to decide as people,
>> and in our world as the lawyers we have to help employees
>> decide what battles are worth fighting and what aren't
>> with respect to how that conflict is going,
>> and who to work it out with.
>> So, if our client really had an opportunity to shine.
>> But in order to shine our client had to step ahead
>> of somebody else who felt more entitled to that face time
>> with the district manager or the senior vice president
>> of whatever department of the company.
>> So now there's a conflict between the person
>> that lost out on that project
>> and our client who advanced, for example.
>> Now there's conflict.
>> And maybe allegations about sexual harassment
>> or race discrimination or gender discrimination that
>> now get put on the table as a way in which somebody
>> who didn't get ahead feels like they should have.
>> And that the person who did get ahead

>> had some sort of unfair advantage

>> or engaged in some sort of unfair tactic at work

>> in order to do so.

>> So now we're back to that psychology, conflict resolution.

>> So do we stand, do we help that employee stand

>> on their right to be free from this sort of attack and wage war.

>> Or do we help them actually think about

>> what's the more successful way to make sure

>> that that person's complaints are not so important,

>> and that the people who thought you were really great

>> for having stood up and put yourself at risk by,

>> working extra hours on this new innovative way

>> to address this issue at work.

>> We want those people to be supporting you.

>> Especially when the reason the conflict is there

>> is because our client invested themselves

>> so much in what they were doing at work,

>> and so, that still needs to be the center piece is that

>> how does that persons dignity and accomplishments

>> compliment what it is they are trying to achieve

>> in this conflict resolution,

>> as opposed to standing on every principle,

>> or every moment where there could be an argument.

>> How do we find the common ground to allow this person

>> to continue to succeed and thrive at work.

>> And have the right people see that that's what's going on.

>> And negotiating a resolution so that all parties can work together

>> and continue to go on their path.

>> That's just a mechanism to solve whatever conflict has arisen

>> and it works very well.



MyLab Management **Personal Inventory Assessments**

Go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management to complete the Personal Inventory Assessment related to this chapter.

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

18.2.1 Conditions that can create conflicts can be classified into three categories. Which of the following is one of these three categories that includes variables such as jurisdictional clarity, member–goal compatibility, and leadership styles?

- ☐ communication
- ☐ structure
- ☐ personal variables
- ☐ group interactions

Check answer

Reset

18.2.2 Leah has found some ethical problems with the healthcare policy of her organization. She knows she is right in considering this as a vital issue to her organization's welfare. She finds that others are taking advantage of her noncompetitive behavior. Which conflict-handling strategy should Leah select in this situation?

- ☐ competition
- ☐ collaboration
- ☐ avoidance
- ☐ accommodation

Check answer

Reset

Negotiation

18-3 Contrast distributive and integrative bargaining.

Negotiation permeates the interactions of almost everyone in groups and organizations. There's the obvious: Labor bargains with management. There's the not-so-obvious: Managers negotiate with employees, peers, and bosses; salespeople negotiate with customers; purchasing agents negotiate with suppliers. And there's the subtle: An employee agrees to cover for a colleague for a few minutes in exchange for a future benefit. In today's loosely structured organizations, in which members work with colleagues over whom they have no direct authority and with whom they may not even share a common boss, negotiation skills are critical.

We can define **negotiation** ⓘ as a process that occurs when two or more parties decide how to allocate scarce resources.⁴⁴ Although we commonly think of the outcomes of negotiation in one-shot economic terms, like negotiating over the price of a car, every negotiation in organizations also affects the relationship between negotiators and the way negotiators feel about themselves.⁴⁵ Depending on how much the parties are going to interact with one another, sometimes maintaining the social relationship and behaving ethically will be just as important as achieving an immediate outcome of bargaining. Note that we use the terms *negotiation* and *bargaining* interchangeably.

Bargaining Strategies

There are two general approaches to negotiation—*distributive bargaining* and *integrative bargaining*.⁴⁶ As Exhibit 18-5 shows, they differ in their goal and motivation, focus, interests, information sharing, and duration of relationship. Let's define each and illustrate the differences.

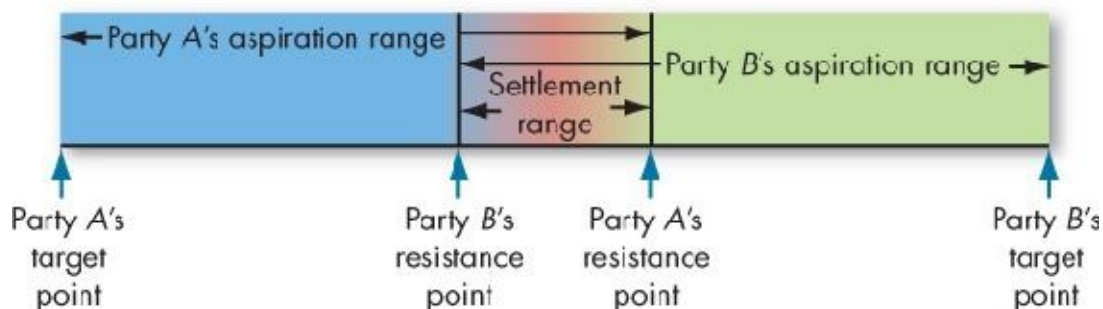
Exhibit 18-5 Distributive versus Integrative Bargaining

Bargaining	Distributive Bargaining	Integrative Bargaining
Characteristic		

Goal	Get as much of the pie as possible	Expand the pie so that both parties are satisfied
Motivation	Win–lose	Win–win
Focus	Positions (“I can’t go beyond this point on this issue.”)	Interests (“Can you explain why this issue is so important to you?”)
Interests	Opposed	Congruent
Information sharing	Low (Sharing information will only allow other party to take advantage.)	High (Sharing information will allow each party to find ways to satisfy interests of each party.)
Duration of relationship	Short term	Long term

Distributive Bargaining You see a used car advertised for sale online that looks great. You go see the car. It’s perfect, and you want it. The owner tells you the asking price. You don’t want to pay that much. The two of you negotiate. The negotiating strategy you’re engaging in is called **distributive bargaining** ⓘ. Its identifying feature is that it operates under zero-sum conditions—that is, any gain I make is at your expense, and vice versa. Every dollar you can get the seller to cut from the car’s price is a dollar you save, and every dollar the seller can get from you comes at your expense. The essence of distributive bargaining is negotiating over who gets what share of a fixed pie. By **fixed pie** ⓘ, we mean a set amount of goods or services to be divvied up. When the pie is fixed, or the parties believe it is, they tend to engage in distributive bargaining.

Exhibit 18-6 Staking Out the Bargaining Zone



The essence of distributive bargaining is depicted in Exhibit 18-6. Parties A and B represent two negotiators. Each has a *target point* that defines what he or she would like to achieve. Each also has a *resistance point*, which marks the lowest acceptable outcome—the point beyond which the party would break off negotiations rather than accept a less favorable settlement. The area between these two points makes up each party’s *aspiration range*. As long as there is some overlap between A’s and B’s aspiration ranges, there exists a settlement range in which each one’s aspirations can be met.

When you are engaged in distributive bargaining, one of the best things you can do is make the first offer, and make it an aggressive one. Making the first offer shows power; individuals in power are much more likely to make initial offers, speak first at meetings, and thereby gain the advantage. Another reason this is a good strategy is the anchoring bias, mentioned in Chapter 6. People tend to fixate on initial information. Once that anchoring point has been set, they fail to adequately adjust it based on subsequent information. A savvy negotiator sets an anchor with the initial offer, and scores of negotiation studies show that such anchors greatly favor the person who sets them.⁴⁷

Say that you have a job offer, and your prospective employer asks you what sort of starting salary you want. You’ve just been given a gift—you have a chance to set the anchor, meaning you should ask for the highest salary you think the employer could reasonably offer. Asking for a million dollars is only going to make most of us look ridiculous, which is why we suggest being on the high end of what you think is *reasonable*. Too often, we err on the side of caution, afraid of scaring off the employer and thus settling for far too little. It is possible to scare off an employer, and it’s true employers don’t like candidates to be assertive in salary negotiations, but liking isn’t the same as doing what it takes to hire or retain someone.⁴⁸ What happens much more often is that we ask for less than we could have obtained.

Integrative Bargaining Jake was a Chicago luxury boutique owned by Jim Wetzel and Lance Lawson. In the early days of the business, Wetzel and Lawson moved millions of dollars of merchandise from many up-and-coming designers. They developed such a good rapport that many designers would send allotments to Jake without requiring advance payment. When the economy soured in 2008, Jake had trouble selling inventory, and designers were not being paid for what they had shipped to the store. Despite the fact that many designers were willing to work with the store on a delayed payment plan, Wetzel and

Lawson stopped returning their calls. Lamented one designer, Doo-Ri Chung, “You kind of feel this familiarity with people who supported you for so long. When they have cash-flow issues, you want to make sure you are there for them as well.”⁴⁹ Chung’s attitude shows the promise of **integrative bargaining** ⓘ. In contrast to distributive bargaining, integrative bargaining assumes that one or more of the possible settlements can create a win–win solution. Of course, as the Jake example shows, both parties must be engaged for integrative bargaining to work.



Officials of General Motors and United Auto Workers participate in the ceremonial handshake that opens new contract negotiations. They are committed to integrative bargaining and work toward negotiating win–win settlements that boost GM’s competitiveness. From left are GM CEO Mary Barra, UAW president Dennis Williams, GM VP Cathy Clegg, and UAW VP Cindy Estrada.

Source: Paul Sancya/AP Images

Exhibit 18-7 illustrates how the two bargaining strategies can be utilized within the same negotiation episode. Early on in the episode, integrative strategies can be used, while later in the episode, distributive strategies can be used. Continuing with the previous example, if Wetzel and Lawson agreed to work with Chung to resolve their inventory dilemma, Chung could first clarify her needs to Wetzel and Lawson then articulate her interests in maintaining their relationship, all while trying to not come to a compromise right away. Once all of the

needs and interests are established for both parties, she could then switch to a distributive strategy where she sets goals aligned with her needs and interests and attempts to maximize the extent to which these goals are met.

Exhibit 18-7 Integration of Two Bargaining Strategies Within a Negotiation Episode



In terms of intraorganizational behavior, integrative bargaining is preferable to distributive bargaining because the former builds long-term relationships. Integrative bargaining bonds negotiators and allows them to leave the bargaining table feeling they have achieved a victory. Distributive bargaining, however, leaves one party a loser. It tends to build animosity and deepen divisions when people have to work together on an ongoing basis. Research shows that, over repeated bargaining episodes, a losing party who feels positively about the negotiation outcome is much more likely to bargain cooperatively in subsequent negotiations.

Why, then, don't we see more integrative bargaining in organizations? The answer lies in the conditions necessary for it to succeed, including opposing parties who are open with information and candid about concerns, are sensitive to the other's needs and trust, and maintain flexibility.⁵⁰ Because these conditions seldom exist in organizations, negotiations often take a win-at-any-cost dynamic. Employees' personal characteristics and perceived accountability also play a role in whether negotiators come to an integrative solution. The use and effectiveness of negotiation strategies may depend on the regulatory focus of the parties involved (i.e., promotion or prevention focus; see Chapter 7) and accountability to a third party, such as a supervisor. Individuals are also more likely to use integrative bargaining when the other party expresses emotional ambivalence.⁵¹

Myth or

Teams Negotiate Better Than Individuals in Collectivistic Cultures

According to a recent study, this statement appears to be false. In general, the literature has suggested that teams negotiate more effectively than individuals negotiating alone. Some evidence indicates that team negotiations create more ambitious goals, and that teams communicate more with each other than individual negotiators do.

Common sense suggests that if this is indeed the case, it is especially true in collectivistic cultures, where individuals are more likely to think of collective goals and be more comfortable working in teams. A study of the negotiation of teams in the United States and in Taiwan, however, suggests that this common sense is wrong. The researchers conducted two studies comparing two-person teams with individual negotiators. They defined negotiating effectiveness as the degree to which the negotiation produced an optimal outcome for both sides. U.S. teams did better than solo individuals in both studies. In Taiwan, solo individuals did better than teams.

Why did this happen? The researchers determined that, in Taiwan, norms respecting harmony already exist, and negotiating in teams only amplifies that tendency. This poses a problem because teams “satisfice” (settle for a satisfactory but less than optimal solution) to avoid conflict when norms for cooperation are exceptionally high. When Taiwanese individuals negotiate solo, at least they can clearly represent their own interests. In contrast, because the United States is individualistic, solo negotiators may focus on their own interests, which makes reaching integrative solutions more difficult. When Americans negotiate in teams, they become less inclined to focus on individual interests and therefore can reach solutions.

Overall, these findings suggest that negotiating individually works best in collectivistic cultures, and negotiating in teams works best in individualistic cultures.

Sources: Based on M. J. Gelfand, et al., “Toward a Culture-by-Context Perspective on Negotiation: Negotiating Teams in the United States and Taiwan,” *Journal of Applied Psychology* 98 (2013): 504–13; and A. Graf, S. T. Koeszegi, and E.-M. Pesendorfer, “Electronic Negotiations in Intercultural Interfirm Relationships,” *Journal of*

Compromise may be your worst enemy in negotiating a win–win agreement. Compromising reduces the pressure to bargain integratively. After all, if you or your opponent caves in easily, no one needs to be creative to reach a settlement. People then settle for less than they could have obtained if they had been forced to consider the other party's interests, trade off issues, and be creative.⁵² Consider a classic example in which two siblings are arguing over who gets an orange. Unknown to them, one sibling wants the orange to drink the juice, whereas the other wants the orange peel to bake a cake. If one capitulates and gives the other the orange, they will not be forced to explore their reasons for wanting the orange, and thus they will never find the win–win solution: They could *each* have the orange because they want different parts.

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

18.3.1 Which of the following terms best describes the process that occurs when two or more parties decide how to allocate scarce resources?

- ☐ mediation
- ☐ conflict management
- ☐ negotiation
- ☐ unionization

Check answer

Reset

18.3.2 You have decided to try to find a win–win situation to help labor and management resolve their differences. You are attempting to engage in _____.

- integrative bargaining
- conciliation

- ☐ mediation
- ☐ distributive bargaining

Check answer

Reset

The Negotiation Process

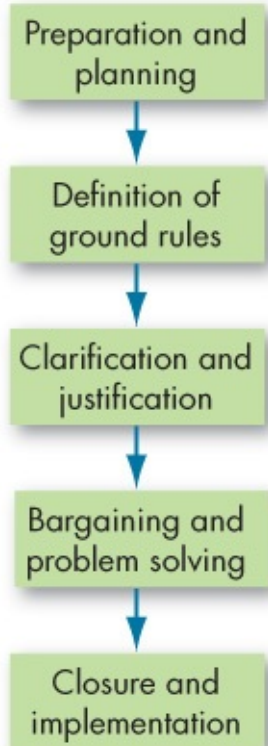
18-4 Apply the five steps of the negotiation process.

Exhibit 18-8 provides a simplified model of the negotiation process. It views negotiation as made up of five steps: (1) preparation and planning, (2) definition of ground rules, (3) clarification and justification, (4) bargaining and problem solving, and (5) closure and implementation.⁵³

Preparation and Planning Before you start negotiating, do your homework. What's the nature of the conflict? What's the history leading up to this negotiation? Who's involved and what are their perceptions of the conflict? What do you want from the negotiation? What are *your* goals? If you're a supply manager at Dell Computer, for instance, and your goal is to get a significant cost reduction from your keyboard supplier, make sure this goal stays paramount in discussions and doesn't get overshadowed by other issues. It helps to put your goals in writing and develop a range of outcomes—from “most hopeful” to “minimally acceptable”—to keep your attention focused.

You should also assess what you think are the other party's goals. What is he or she likely to ask? How entrenched is his or her position likely to be? What intangible or hidden interests may be important to him or her? On what might he or she be willing to settle? When you can anticipate your opponent's position, you are better equipped to counter arguments with facts and figures that support your position.

Exhibit 18-8 The Negotiation



Relationships change as a result of negotiation, so take that into consideration. If you could “win” a negotiation but push the other side into resentment or animosity, it might be wiser to pursue a more compromising style. If preserving the relationship will make you seem easily exploited, you may consider a more aggressive style. As an example of how the tone of a relationship in negotiations matters, people who feel good about the *process* of a job offer negotiation are more satisfied with their jobs and are less likely to leave the job a year later regardless of their actual *outcomes* from these negotiations.⁵⁴

Once you’ve gathered your information, develop a strategy. You should determine your and the other side’s best alternative to a negotiated agreement (**BATNA** ⓘ). Your BATNA determines the lowest value acceptable to you for a negotiated agreement. Any offer you receive that is higher than your BATNA is better than an impasse.

In nearly all cases, the party with superior alternatives will do better in a negotiation, so experts advise negotiators to solidify their BATNA prior to any interaction. There is an interesting exception to this general rule—negotiators with absolutely no alternative to a negotiated agreement sometimes “go for broke” because they don’t even consider what would happen if the negotiation falls through.⁵⁵ Think carefully about what the other side is willing to give up. People who underestimate their opponent’s willingness to give on key issues before the negotiation even starts end up with lower outcomes.⁵⁶ Conversely, you

shouldn't expect success in your negotiation effort unless you're able to make the other side an offer it finds more attractive than its BATNA.

Definition of Ground Rules Once you've done your planning and developed a strategy, you're ready to define with the other party the ground rules and procedures of the negotiation itself. Who will do the negotiating? Where will it take place? What time constraints, if any, will apply? To what issues will negotiation be limited? Will you follow a specific procedure if an impasse is reached? During this phase, the parties will exchange their initial proposals or demands.

Clarification and Justification When you have exchanged initial positions, you and the other party will explain, amplify, clarify, bolster, and justify your original demands. This step needn't be confrontational. Rather, it's an opportunity for educating each other on the issues, why they are important, and how you arrived at your initial demands. Provide the other party with any documentation that supports your position.

Bargaining and Problem Solving The essence of the negotiation process is the actual give-and-take in trying to hash out an agreement. This is where both parties need to make concessions.

Closure and Implementation The final step in the negotiation process is formalizing your agreement and developing procedures necessary for implementing and monitoring it. For major negotiations—from labor–management negotiations to bargaining over lease terms—this requires hammering out the specifics in a formal contract. For other cases, closure of the negotiation process is nothing more formal than a handshake.

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

18.4.1 In which of the five steps of the negotiation process do both parties have to

undoubtedly make concessions?

- ☐ accommodating
- ☐ compromising
- ☐ bargaining
- ☐ clarifying

Check answer

Reset

18.4.2 Carisa is negotiating for the labor union. Today, she is presenting the evidence and papers that demonstrate the average wages in the area, the cost of health care for the average worker, and a pie graph demonstrating how these costs affect the new salary request. Which phase of the negotiation process is Carisa currently in?

- ☐ preparation and planning
- ☐ definition of ground rules
- ☐ clarification and justification
- ☐ bargaining and problem solving

Check answer

Reset

Individual Differences in Negotiation Effectiveness

18-5 Show how individual differences influence negotiations.

Are some people better negotiators than others? The answer is complex. Four factors influence how effectively individuals negotiate: personality, mood/emotions, culture, and gender.

Personality Traits in Negotiations Can you predict an opponent's negotiating tactics if you know something about his or her personality? Because personality and negotiation outcomes are related but only weakly, the answer is, at best, sort of.⁵⁷ Most research has focused on the Big Five trait of agreeableness, for obvious reasons—agreeable individuals are cooperative, compliant, kind, and conflict-averse. We might think such characteristics make agreeable individuals easy prey in negotiations, especially distributive ones. The evidence suggests, however, that overall agreeableness is weakly related to negotiation outcomes. Why is this so?

It appears that the degree to which agreeableness, and personality more generally, affects negotiation outcomes depends on the situation. The importance of being extraverted in negotiations, for example, very much depends on how the other party reacts to someone who is assertive and enthusiastic. One complicating factor for agreeableness is that it has two facets: The tendency to be cooperative and compliant is one, but so is the tendency to be warm and empathetic.⁵⁸ It may be that while the former is a hindrance to negotiating favorable outcomes, the latter helps. Empathy, after all, is the ability to take the perspective of another person and gain insight into and an understanding of him or her. We know perspective taking benefits integrative negotiations, so perhaps the null effect for agreeableness is due to the two tendencies pulling against one another. If this is the case, then the best negotiator is a competitive but empathetic one, and the worst is a gentle but empathetic one. Recent research also suggests that personality traits such as agreeableness and extraversion do have an effect, but the effect depends on personality similarity between parties, not overall levels. For example, if both parties are disagreeable, they will negotiate with each other more effectively than if one party was disagreeable and the other were agreeable.⁵⁹

The type of negotiations may matter as well. In one study, agreeable individuals reacted more positively and felt less stress (measured by their cortisol levels) in integrative negotiations than in distributive ones. Low levels of stress, in turn, made for more effective negotiation outcomes.⁶⁰ Similarly, in hard-edged distributive negotiations, where giving away information leads to a disadvantage, extraverted negotiators do less well because they tend to share more information than they should.⁶¹

Self-efficacy is one individual-difference variable that seems to relate consistently to negotiation outcomes.⁶² This is a fairly intuitive finding—it isn't too surprising to hear that those who believe they will be more successful in negotiation situations tend to perform more effectively. Maybe individuals who are more confident stake out stronger claims, are less likely to back down from their positions, and exhibit confidence that intimidates others. Although the exact mechanism is not yet clear, it does seem that negotiators may benefit from trying to get a boost in confidence before going to the bargaining table.

Research suggests intelligence predicts negotiation effectiveness, but, as with personality, the effects aren't especially strong.⁶³ In a sense, these weak links mean you're not severely disadvantaged, even if you're an agreeable extravert, when it's time to negotiate. We all can learn to be better negotiators.⁶⁴

Moods and Emotions in Negotiations Do moods and emotions influence negotiation? They do, but the way they work depends on the emotion as well as the context. A negotiator who shows anger can induce concessions, for instance, because the other negotiator believes no further concessions from the angry party are possible. One factor that governs this outcome, however, is power—you should show anger in negotiations only if you have at least as much power as your counterpart. If you have less, showing anger actually seems to provoke hardball reactions from the other side.⁶⁵ Evoking emotions, such as sympathy, or expressing other emotions like sadness may also be used to persuade others.⁶⁶

Career OBjectives

How can I get a better job?

I feel like my career is at a standstill, and I want to talk to my boss about getting a more developmental assignment. How can I negotiate effectively for a better job

Dear Wei:

You're certainly starting out on the right foot. A lot of people focus on salary as a way to achieve success and negotiate for the best short-run offer. There's obviously an advantage to this strategy in the short run, but sustained career growth has better payoffs in the long run. Developing skills can help put you on track for multiple salary increases. A strong skill set from developmental assignments will also give you a better position for future negotiations because you will have more career options.

Long-term career negotiations based on developmental assignments are also often easier to bring up with a supervisor. That's because salary negotiations are often a zero-sum situation, but career development negotiations can bring positive outcomes to both sides. When negotiating for a developmental assignment, make sure you emphasize a few points with your supervisor:

- *When it comes to salary negotiations, either you get the money, or the company keeps the money.* Given that, your interests and the interests of your managers are directly opposed. On the other hand, negotiating for developmental assignments usually means finding ways to improve not just your skills but also your contribution to the company's bottom line. You can, in complete honesty, frame the discussion around these mutual benefits.
- *Let your supervisor know that you are interested in getting better at your job and that you are motivated to improve through a developmental assignment.* Asking your supervisor for opportunities to grow is a clear sign that you are an employee worth investing in.
- *Be open to creative solutions.* It's possible that there are some idiosyncratic solutions (also called I-deals) for enhancing both your interests and those of your supervisor. One of the best things about an integrative bargaining situation like this is that you and your negotiation partner can find novel solutions that neither would have imagined separately.

Think strategically about your career, and you'll likely find you can negotiate not just for a better paycheck tomorrow but for a paycheck that keeps increasing in the years to come.

Sources: Based on Y. Rofcanin, T. Kiefer, and K. Strauss, “How I-Deals Build Resources to Facilitate Reciprocation: Mediating Role of Positive Affective States,” *Academy of Management Proceedings* (August 2014), doi:10.5465/AMBPP.2014.16096abstract; C. Liao, S. J. Wayne, and D. M. Rousseau, “Idiosyncratic Deals in Contemporary Organizations: A Qualitative and Meta-Analytical Review,” *Journal of Organizational Behavior* (October 16, 2014), doi:10.1002/job.1959; and V. Brenninkmeijer and M. Hekkert-Koning, “To Craft or Not to Craft,” *Career Development International* 20 (2015): 147–62.

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Another factor is how genuine your anger is—“faked” anger, or anger produced from surface acting (see Chapter 4), is not effective, but showing anger that is genuine (deep acting) is.⁶⁷ It also appears that having a history of showing anger, rather than sowing the seeds of revenge, actually induces more concessions because the other party perceives the negotiator as tough.⁶⁸ Finally, culture seems to matter. For instance, one study found that when East Asian participants showed anger, it induced more concessions than when the negotiator expressing anger was from the United States or Europe, perhaps because of the stereotype of East Asians as refusing to show anger.⁶⁹



Another relevant emotion is disappointment. Generally, a negotiator who perceives disappointment from his or her counterpart concedes more. In one study, Dutch students were given 100 chips to bargain over. Negotiators who expressed disappointment were offered 14 more chips than those who didn’t. In a second study, showing disappointment yielded an average concession of 12 chips. Unlike a show of anger, the relative power of the negotiators made no difference in either study.⁷⁰

**An Ethical
Choice**

Using Empathy to Negotiate More Ethically

You may have noticed that much of our advice for negotiating effectively depends on understanding the perspective and goals of the person with whom you are negotiating. Preparing checklists of your negotiation partner's interests, likely tactics, and BATNA have all been shown to improve negotiation outcomes. Can these steps make you a more ethical negotiator as well? Studies suggest that they might.

Researchers asked respondents to indicate how much they tended to think about other people's feelings and emotions and to describe the types of tactics they engaged in during a negotiation exercise. More empathetic individuals consistently engaged in fewer unethical negotiation behaviors like making false promises and manipulating information and emotions.

When considering how to improve your ethical negotiation behavior, follow these guidelines:

- 1. Try to understand your negotiation partner's perspective.** This isn't accomplished just by understanding cognitively what the other person wants but by empathizing with the emotional reaction he or she will likely have to the possible outcomes.
- 2. Be aware of your own emotions because many moral reactions are fundamentally emotional.** One study found that engaging in unethical negotiation strategies increased feelings of guilt so, by extension, feeling guilty in a negotiation may mean you are engaging in behavior you'll regret later.
- 3. Beware of empathizing so much that you work against your own interests.** Just because you try to understand the motives and emotional reactions of the other side does not mean you have to assume the other person is going to be honest and fair in return. So be on guard.

Sources: Based on T. R. Cohen, "Moral Emotions and Unethical Bargaining: The Differential Effects of Empathy and Perspective Taking in Deterring Deceitful Negotiation," *Journal of Business Ethics* 94, no. 4 (2010): 569–79; and R. Volkema, D. Fleck, and A. Hofmeister, "Predicting Competitive-Unethical Negotiating Behavior and Its Consequences," *Negotiation Journal* 26, no. 3 (2010): 263–86.

Anxiety also appears to have an impact on negotiation. For example, one study found that individuals who experienced more anxiety about a negotiation used more deceptions in dealing with others.⁷¹ Another study found that anxious negotiators expect lower outcomes, respond to offers more quickly, and exit the bargaining process more quickly, leading them to obtain worse outcomes.⁷²



People generally negotiate more effectively within cultures than between them. Politeness and positivity characterize the typical conflict-avoidant negotiations in Japan, such as with labor union leader Hidekazu Kitagawa (right), shown here presenting wage and benefits demands to Ikuo Mori, president of Fuji Heavy Industries, which makes Subaru vehicles.
*Source: */Kyodo/Newscom*

As you can see, emotions—especially negative ones—matter to negotiation. Even emotional unpredictability affects outcomes; researchers have found that negotiators who express positive and negative emotions in an unpredictable way extract more concessions because this behavior makes the other party feel less in control.⁷³ As one negotiator put it, “Out of the blue, you may have to react to something you have been working on in one way, and then something entirely new is introduced, and you have to veer off and refocus.”⁷⁴

Culture in Negotiations Do people from different cultures negotiate differently? The simple answer is the obvious one: Yes, they do. However, there are many nuances in the way this works. It isn’t as simple as “these negotiators are the best”; indeed, success in negotiations depends on the context.



So what can we say about culture and negotiations? First, it appears that people generally negotiate more effectively within cultures than between them. For example, a Colombian is apt to do better negotiating with a Colombian than with a Sri Lankan. Second, it appears that in cross-cultural negotiations, it is especially important that the negotiators be high in openness. This suggests a good strategy is to choose cross-cultural negotiators who are high on openness to experience, and to avoid factors such as time pressure that tend to inhibit learning about the other party.⁷⁵ Third, people are more likely to use certain negotiation strategies depending on what culture they belong to. For example, people from China and Qatar are more likely to use a competitive negotiation strategy than do people from the United States.⁷⁶



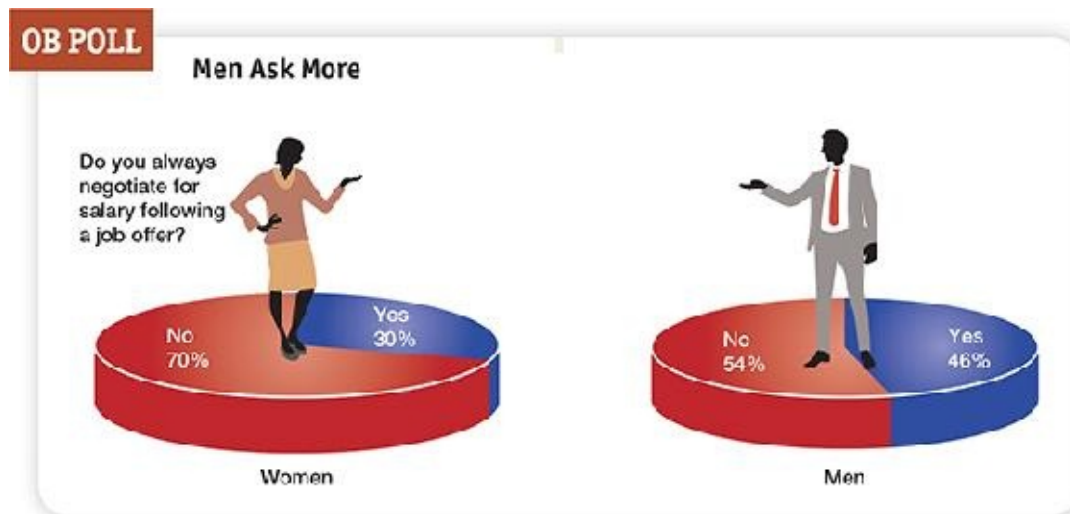
Because emotions are culturally sensitive, negotiators need to be especially aware of the emotional dynamics in cross-cultural negotiation. One study, for example, explicitly compared how U.S. and Chinese negotiators reacted to an angry counterpart. Chinese negotiators increased their use of distributive negotiating tactics, whereas U.S. negotiators decreased their use of these tactics. That is, Chinese negotiators began to drive a harder bargain once they saw that their negotiation partner was becoming angry, whereas U.S. negotiators capitulated somewhat in the face of angry demands. Why the difference? It may be that individuals from East Asian cultures feel that using anger to get their way in a negotiation is not a legitimate tactic, so they refuse to cooperate when their opponents become upset.⁷⁷

Gender Differences in Negotiations There are many areas of organizational behavior (OB) in which men and women are not that different. Negotiation is not one of them. It seems fairly clear that men and women negotiate differently, men and women are treated differently by negotiation partners, and these differences affect outcomes (see OB Poll).

A popular stereotype is that women are more cooperative and pleasant in negotiations than men. Though this is controversial, there is some merit to it. Men tend to place a higher value on status, power, and recognition, whereas women tend to place a higher value on compassion and altruism. Women do tend to value relationship outcomes more than men, and men tend to value economic outcomes more than women.⁷⁸

These differences affect both negotiation behavior and negotiation outcomes. Compared to men, women tend to behave in a less assertive, less self-interested, and more accommodating

manner. As one review concluded, women “are more reluctant to initiate negotiations, and when they do initiate negotiations, they ask for less, are more willing to accept [the] offer, and make more generous offers to their negotiation partners than men do.”⁷⁹ A study of MBA students at Carnegie-Mellon University found that the male students took the step of negotiating their first offer 57 percent of the time, compared to 4 percent for the female students. The net result? A \$4,000 difference in starting salaries.⁸⁰



Source: Based on A. Gouveia, “Why Americans Are Too Scared to Negotiate Salary,” *San Francisco Chronicle*, April 3, 2013, downloaded May 30, 2013, from <http://www.sfgate.com/jobs/>.

One comprehensive literature review suggests that the tendency for men to receive better negotiation outcomes in some situations does not cover *all* situations.⁸¹ Indeed, evidence suggested women and men bargained more equally in certain situations, women sometimes outperformed men, and men and women obtained more nearly equal outcomes when negotiating on behalf of someone else. In other words, everyone was better at advocating for others than they were at advocating for themselves. Another review of 123 studies found that gender differences are smaller when negotiators have experience with negotiating. Women also perform better in situations with low role incongruity.⁸²

Factors that increased the predictability of negotiations also tended to reduce gender differences. When the range of negotiation settlements was well defined, men and women were more equal in outcomes. When more experienced negotiators were at the table, men and women were also more nearly equivalent. The study authors proposed that when situations are more ambiguous, with less well-defined terms and less experienced negotiators, stereotypes may have stronger effects, leading to larger gender differences in outcomes.

So what can be done to change this troublesome state of affairs? First, organizational culture plays a role. If an organization, even unwittingly, reinforces gender-stereotypic behaviors (men negotiating competitively, women negotiating cooperatively), it will negatively affect negotiations when anyone goes against stereotype. Men and women need to know that it is acceptable for each to show a full range of negotiating behaviors. Thus, a female negotiator who behaves competitively and a male negotiator who behaves cooperatively need to know that they are not violating expectations. Making sure negotiations are designed to focus on well-defined and work-related terms also has promise for reducing gender differences by minimizing the ambiguous space for stereotypes to operate. This focus on structure and work relevance also obviously helps focus negotiations on factors that improve the organization's performance.

Research is less clear on whether women can improve their outcomes by showing some gender-stereotypic behaviors. Researchers Laura Kray and colleagues suggested that female negotiators who were instructed to behave with "feminine charm" (be animated in body movements, make frequent eye contact with their partners, smile, laugh, be playful, and frequently compliment their partners) did better in negotiations than women not so instructed. These behaviors didn't work for men.⁸³

Other researchers disagree and argue that what can best benefit women is to break down gender stereotypes for the individuals who hold them.⁸⁴ It's possible this is a short-term/long-term situation: In the short term, women can gain an advantage in negotiation by being both assertive and charming, but in the long term, their interests are best served by eliminating these sorts of sex role stereotypes.

Evidence suggests women's own attitudes and behaviors hurt them in negotiations. Managerial women demonstrate less confidence than men in anticipation of negotiating and are less satisfied with their performance afterward, even when their performance and the outcomes they achieve are similar to those for men.⁸⁵ Women are also less likely to see an ambiguous situation as an opportunity for negotiation. Women may unduly penalize themselves by failing to engage in negotiations that would be in their best interests. Some research suggests that women are less aggressive in negotiations because they are worried about backlash from others.

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

18.5.1 Which of the following is not an individual factor that influences the effectiveness of a negotiator?

- ☐ personality
- ☐ mood
- ☐ gender
- ☐ age

Check answer

Reset

18.5.2 Studies have shown that there are some cultural differences in negotiation styles. Negotiators of which country are reported to have less trust in their negotiation counterparts?

- ☐ United States
- ☐ Japan
- ☐ Hong Kong
- ☐ India

Check answer

Reset

Negotiating in a Social Context

18-6 Assess the roles and functions of third-party negotiations.

We have been mostly discussing negotiations that occur among parties that meet only once and in isolation from other individuals. In organizations, however, many negotiations are open-ended and public. When you are trying to figure out who in a work group should do a tedious task, negotiating with your boss to get a chance to travel internationally, or asking for more money for a project, there's a social component to the negotiation. You are probably negotiating with someone you already know and will work with again, and the negotiation and its outcome are likely to be topics people will talk about. To understand negotiations in practice, then, we must consider the social factors of reputation and relationships.

Reputation

Your reputation is the way other people think and talk about you. When it comes to negotiation, having a reputation for being trustworthy matters. In short, trust in a negotiation process opens the door to many forms of integrative negotiation strategies that benefit both parties.⁸⁶ The most effective way to build trust is to behave in an honest way across repeated interactions. Then others will feel more comfortable making open-ended offers with many different outcomes. This helps to achieve win-win outcomes because both parties can work to achieve what is most important to themselves while still benefitting the other party.

Sometimes we either trust or distrust people based on word of mouth about a person's characteristics. What type of characteristics help a person develop a trustworthy reputation? A combination of competence and integrity.⁸⁷ Negotiators higher in self-confidence and cognitive ability are seen as more competent by negotiation partners.⁸⁸ They are also considered better able to describe accurately a situation and their own resources, and they are more credible when they make suggestions for creative solutions to impasses. Individuals who have a reputation for integrity can also be more effective in negotiations.⁸⁹ They are seen as more likely to keep their promises and present information accurately, so others are more willing to accept their promises as part of a bargain. This opens many options for the negotiator that wouldn't be available to someone who is not seen as trustworthy. Finally,

individuals who have more solid reputations are better liked and have more friends and allies—in other words, they have more social resources, which may give them more implicit power in negotiations.

Relationships

There is more to repeated negotiations than just reputation. The social, interpersonal component of relationships with repeated negotiations means that individuals go beyond valuing what is simply good for themselves and instead start to think about what is best for the other party and the relationship as a whole.⁹⁰ Repeated negotiations built on a foundation of trust also broaden the range of options because a favor or concession today can be offered in return for some repayment further down the road.⁹¹ Repeated negotiations also facilitate integrative problem solving. This occurs partly because people begin to see their negotiation partners in a more personal way over time and come to share emotional bonds.⁹² Repeated negotiations also make integrative approaches more workable because a sense of trust and reliability has been built up.⁹³

In sum, it's clear that an effective negotiator needs to think about more than just the outcomes of a single interaction. Negotiators who consistently act in a way that demonstrates competence, honesty, and integrity usually have better outcomes in the long run.

Third-Party Negotiations

Until this point, we've discussed bargaining in terms of direct negotiations. Occasionally, however, individuals or group representatives reach a stalemate and are unable to resolve their differences through direct negotiations. In such cases, they may turn to a third party to help them find a solution. There are three basic third-party roles: mediator, arbitrator, and conciliator.

A **mediator** ⓘ is a neutral third party who facilitates a negotiated solution by using reasoning and persuasion, suggesting alternatives, and the like. Mediators are widely used in labor–management negotiations and in civil court disputes. Their overall effectiveness is fairly impressive. For example, the Equal Employment Opportunity Commission (EEOC) reported a settlement rate through mediation at 72.1 percent.⁹⁴ But the situation is the key to whether mediation will succeed; the conflicting parties must be motivated to bargain and resolve their conflict. In addition, conflict intensity can't be too high; mediation is most

effective under moderate levels of conflict. Finally, perceptions of the mediator are important; to be effective, the mediator must be perceived as neutral and noncoercive.

An **arbitrator** ⓘ is a third party with the authority to dictate an agreement. Arbitration can be voluntary (requested by the parties) or compulsory (forced on the parties by law or contract). The big plus of arbitration over mediation is that it always results in a settlement. Whether there is a downside depends on how heavy-handed the arbitrator appears. If one party is left feeling overwhelmingly defeated, that party is certain to be dissatisfied and the conflict may resurface at a later time.

A **conciliator** ⓘ is a trusted third party who provides an informal communication link between the negotiator and the opponent. This role was made famous by Robert Duval in the first *Godfather* film. As Don Corleone's adopted son and a lawyer by training, Duval acted as an intermediary between the Corleones and the other Mafioso families. Comparing conciliation to mediation in terms of effectiveness has proven difficult because the two overlap a great deal. In practice, conciliators typically act as more than mere communication conduits. They also engage in fact finding, interpret messages, and persuade disputants to develop agreements.

Now test your understanding of what you have just read by attempting the questions below.

Test Your Understanding

18.6.1 When both parties are open to resolving their conflict, and the conflict intensity is not too high, which of the following is the most appropriate third-party to use?

- ☐ mediator
- ☐ arbitrator
- ☐ conciliator
- ☐ both A and B

Check answer

Reset

18.6.2 Which of the third-party negotiators has legitimate power?

- ☐ mediator
- ☐ arbitrator
- ☐ conciliator
- ☐ both A and B

Check answer

Reset

Summary

While many people assume conflict lowers group and organizational performance, this assumption is frequently incorrect. Conflict can be either constructive or destructive to the functioning of a group or unit. Levels of conflict can be either too high or too low to be constructive. Either extreme hinders performance. An optimal level is one that prevents stagnation, stimulates creativity, allows tensions to be released, and initiates the seeds of change without being disruptive or preventing the coordination of activities.

Implications for Managers

- Choose an authoritarian management style in emergencies, when unpopular actions need to be implemented (such as cost cutting, enforcement of unpopular rules, discipline), and when the issue is vital to the organization's welfare. Be certain to communicate your logic when possible to make certain others remain engaged and productive.
- Seek integrative solutions when your objective is to learn, when you want to merge insights from people with different perspectives, when you need to gain commitment by incorporating concerns into a consensus, and when you need to work through feelings that have interfered with a relationship.
- You can build trust by accommodating others when you find you're wrong, when you need to demonstrate reasonableness, when other positions need to be heard, when issues are more important to others than to yourself, when you want to satisfy others and maintain cooperation, when you can build social credits for later issues, to minimize loss when you are outmatched and losing, and when others should learn from their own mistakes.
- Consider compromising when goals are important but not worth potential disruption, when opponents with equal power are committed to mutually exclusive goals, and when you need temporary settlements to complex issues.
- Distributive bargaining can resolve disputes, but it often reduces the satisfaction of one or more negotiators because it is confrontational and focused on the short term.

Integrative bargaining, in contrast, tends to provide outcomes that satisfy all parties and build lasting relationships.

Nonunion Positions and the Gig Economy Are Bad for Workers

Point

What do Uber, Etsy, and Amazon Turk all have in common? All of these platforms are fuel for short-term freelance work, and a reflection of what economists have dubbed the gig economy. Fifty years ago, employers expected workers to stay with a company for 30 years. In exchange for their loyalty, employees were given more opportunities and a pension. Unlike the labor market of today, companies promoted from within. As this practice fell by the wayside, employers hired employees for shorter and shorter periods. Now, many new jobs are not long-term or even short-term positions: They're gigs. Employees work as independent contractors, using third-party platforms to connect to clients. Because these employees do not have a traditional employment contract, they have complete flexibility: They can work as much or as little as they want.

Unfortunately, many of these platforms have a dirty secret. Unlike regular employment, people who are employed primarily through gigs do not have the benefits of a traditional job. Because they're considered self-employed, they do not get paid for overtime, do not receive benefits, and have no collective bargaining power. There's also evidence that they're replacing rather than supplementing more stable employment. For example, Uber and Lyft drivers tripled in Silicon Valley from 2012 to 2014, while payrolled cab and limo jobs decreased by 31 percent in the same time period.

Without the ability to collectively bargain, the labor market is akin to the Wild West. That's why many freelancers on these platforms are trying to unionize. In New York and Seattle, labor unions are trying to allow gig employees that work as rideshare drivers, house cleaners, and delivery persons the ability to create collective bargaining units. Doing so will allow employees to demand health benefits and overtime. It will also

ensure that these employees make a living hourly wage, which is rare for gig employees based on recent research. Many employees, despite working 60 hours a week, still do not make as much as a traditional employee.

Yes, it's great for employers to sell younger generations on the flexibility of these positions. But in exchange for flexibility, they are also losing the power to negotiate for fair working conditions. Let's stop pretending that freelance work platforms like Uber are good for the economy, and leave the gig economy trend at the curb.

Counterpoint

While the gig economy has its drawbacks, these platforms exist for a reason. Employers and employees alike are fed up with traditional employment. Yes, some people who work through freelance apps use it as a primary source of income. But there are just as many, if not more, who just want a flexible second job to get a little extra cash. If these positions were like the services they are replacing (e.g., cab companies), then gig employees would have to agree to specific policies regarding sick days and work a set schedule.

I'm also skeptical of this idea that freelancers are replacing traditional employment. Yes, some city-level data shows that gig-based jobs increased while payroll jobs decreased. But there are also more data from 2010 to 2014 that suggest that contractor and payroll jobs have increased in most sectors that support freelance platforms. For example, while use of freelance platforms like Airbnb increased over four years, payroll jobs in hospitality also increased. The same is true for the transportation industry over the same time period. If anything, the reason these freelance platforms have been so successful is because these industries are growing. It's not that they're replacing traditional services—they're meeting the demand that traditional services cannot fulfill.

The benefits of having a collective bargaining agreement may also be exaggerated. Whenever a group tries to create a collective bargaining agreement, it causes conflict. A 2016 poll indicates that most employees (80 percent) believe leaders will not protect the interests of the group as a whole. Instead, leaders usually use their power in numbers to protect their own self-interests in negotiations.

Collective bargaining doesn't just hurt businesses—it also hurts the public. For example, the International Civil Aviation Organization has been trying to put cameras in

commercial airline cockpits. These cameras would allow authorities and employers to monitor pilots on the job. These videos can help piece together why plane crashes occur. Yet pilots have been using collective bargaining techniques to fight the initiative on grounds that it violates airline pilots' privacy. They also insist that it could be used to "lead investigators away from accurate conclusions" regarding employees' performance.

Yes, traditional employment allows employees to bargain for rights as a group. But this also leads to concessions and conflict that do not benefit employees or their employers.

Sources: Based on A. Nunes, "Unions Are Hurting Public Safety," *Forbes*, April 10, 2017, <https://www.forbes.com/sites/ashleynunes/2017/04/10/unions-are-hurting-public-safety/2/#396682da516e>; Rasmussen Polling, "Most Say Union Leaders Out of Touch with Members," Rasmussen Reports, August 10, 2016, http://www.rasmussenreports.com/public_content/politics/general_politics/august_2016/most_say_union_leaders_out_of_tou; D. DeMay, "Driver Union, for Lyft, Uber, Forces Seattle to Ask Tough Questions about 'Gig' Economy," *Seattle Post-Intelligencer*, December 19, 2016, <http://www.seattlepi.com/local/transportation/article/Driver-union-for-Lyft-Uber-forces-Seattle-to-10797019.php>; M. Murro, "The Gig Economy: Complement or Cannibal?," *Brookings*, November 17, 2016, <https://www.brookings.edu/blog/the-avenue/2016/11/17/the-gig-economy-complement-or-cannibal/>; Reuters, "Unions and the Gig Economy Are Gearing Up for Battle in This State," *Fortune*, November 28, 2016, <http://fortune.com/2016/11/28/unions-gig-economy-new-york/>; and K. Kokalitcheva, "Uber Lost Hundreds of Millions in the Most Recent Quarter," *Fortune*, December 19, 2016, <http://fortune.com/2016/12/19/uber-financials-2016/>.

Chapter Review

MyLab Management Discussion Questions

Go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management to complete the problems marked with this icon .

Questions for Review

- 18-1** What are the three types of conflict and the three loci of conflict?
- 18-2** What are the steps in the conflict process?
- 18-3** What are the differences between distributive and integrative bargaining?
- 18-4** What are the five steps in the negotiation process?
- 18-5** How do individual differences influence negotiations?
- 18-6** What are the roles and functions of third-party negotiations?

Application and Employability

Conflict is an inevitable part of every workplace. As you learned in this chapter, conflict is also beneficial in certain contexts. You also learned about negotiation, and how and when certain negotiation and conflict resolution strategies may be used. While exploring these topics, you used many skills that can help you be more employable. You learned collaboration while exploring why collectivist teams are not better negotiators, learned how to use concepts from the chapter to move forward in your career, and assessed how to be a more empathetic negotiator. You also applied your knowledge of bargaining to America's growing gig economy. In the next section, you will develop these skills further while also using your critical thinking skills to evaluate the pros and cons of unions, resolve a conflict

between coworkers, assess how to deal with an overly assertive employee, and take part in a negotiation role play.

Experiential Exercise A Negotiation Role Play

You will consider two scenarios for this case: One is more distributive, the other more integrative. Form pairs, with one of you taking the role of the engineering director, and the other taking the role of the marketing director. Read only your own side's specific information for the two negotiation processes. The overall situation is the same for both scenarios, but the priorities and outlook for the parties change depending on whether you are negotiating the "contested resources" scenario or the "combined future" scenario.

The Case

Cytrix develops integrated bicycle and running performance systems. Runners and bikers wear the Cytrix watch, which uses GPS signals to identify their location and the distance they've covered. This information can then be uploaded to the Cytrix Challenge website, where users record their performance over time. Social media tools also allow them to compare their performance relative to that of friends. The majority of users are either amateur student athletes or committed adult hobbyists like marathon runners.

The organization needs to determine how to allocate a fixed pool of resources for future development between the marketing and engineering groups. Rather than making an executive decision about resource allocation, the top management team has asked the respective teams to allocate \$30 million for planned future development and decide who will run different parts of the project.

Specific Information for the Marketing Group

Only the marketing manager should read this section.

The marketing group has been tracking the major areas of sales and has come to the conclusion that Cytrix has saturated the market. New sources of customers, especially general consumers who are interested in health but are not committed athletes, will need to be considered for future growth. Research into sales of competitive products and areas where competitors are failing to meet consumer demands is needed. The marketing group's primary goal is to allocate sufficient resources to finance the research. The group also wants to retain control over which new products will be developed. Marketing would prefer to see engineering act in a consulting role, determining how best to manufacture the devices that fit the needs identified above.

Specific Information for the Engineering Group

Only the engineering manager should read this section.

The engineering group has recently been tracking the development of new hardware that will improve the accuracy of distance and speed estimates in remote areas. Several other companies are already experimenting with similar designs. To realize this improvement fully, engineering believes it will be necessary to develop the technology further so it is both lightweight and inexpensive to produce. The engineering group's primary goal is to allocate sufficient resources to develop these new technologies. The engineers would prefer to see marketing act in a consulting role, determining how best to advertise and deliver the new devices.

Contested Resources Scenario

The marketing and engineering departments are locked in a struggle for power. Your side (either marketing or engineering) should try to direct the largest possible proportion of both money and authority toward your proposed program. You still need to think of a solution in which the other side ultimately agrees to assist you in implementing the program. If you can't reach an agreement for shared resources, the CEO will appoint new directors for both groups.

Combined Future Scenario

The marketing and engineering departments are eager to find a positive solution. Both sides should try to see that the company's future needs are met. You know that to achieve success everyone needs to work together, so you'd like to find a way to divide the money and resources that benefits both marketing and engineering. Plans can incorporate multiple techniques for sharing and collaborating with resources.

The Negotiation

At the start of the negotiation, the instructor randomly assigns half the groups to the contested resources scenario and the other half to the combined future scenario. Begin the process by outlining the goals and resources for your side of the negotiation. Then negotiate over the terms described in your scenario, attempting to advocate for a solution that matches your perspective.

Debriefing

Afterward, you will get together with the other students to discuss the processes used. Especially consider the differences in outcomes between the contested resources and combined future scenarios. Either scenario could arise in a real work environment, so think about how different negotiation situations give rise to different strategies, tactics, and outcomes.

Ethical Dilemma The Case of the Overly Assertive Employee

In this chapter, we learned about several conflict-handling intentions. Each of these intentions involved two dimension—assertiveness (the degree to which one party attempts to satisfy his or her own concerns) and cooperativeness (the degree to which one party attempts to satisfy the other party’s concerns). Consider these dimensions, and then put yourself in the shoes of the manager described below.

Tom is a manager at a small copy supply firm. Their marketing team consists mainly of two employees: Janna and Kim. Kim is incredibly assertive, while Janna is incredibly cooperative. Though you are their manager, they sometimes have the discretion to negotiate with each other over who is responsible for which task in a project. You notice that Janna seems always to do the most tedious, unpleasant tasks. When you’ve asked Janna in the past if she is happy with what she contributes to projects, she meekly replies, “I don’t mind. I don’t want to make any waves.”

You sense that Janna is unhappy but also scared of a confrontation with Kim. Kim is getting more recognition and compliments from the CEO because she does high-profile work. You know this puts Janna at a disadvantage in her career. On the other hand, Kim is overly assertive. You know that if you ask her to be more cooperative, it could cause more conflict in the office.

As we learned about relationship conflict, it’s almost never beneficial. Yes, it may be unfair to Janna, but you don’t want to disrupt the team by bringing conflict into the office. You also know that conflict tends to spread in the office—if Kim and Janna are at odds with each other, it may distract people on other teams.

Questions

- 18-7.** If Tom does nothing, is that ethical? Does he have a responsibility to Janna to make sure her concerns are addressed?
- 18-8.** In this chapter, you learned about mediators, arbitrators, and conciliators. Is it possible for Tom to act in one of these roles? Why or why not?
- 18-9.** If Tom does nothing in this situation, how do you think the situation between Janna and Kim will play out? Do you think there will be problems with conflict?

Case Incident 1 Disorderly Conduct

The sound of Matt and Peter's arguing is familiar to everyone in the office by now. In an effort to make the best use of space and ensure a free flow of discussion and ideas, the founder of Markay Design had decided to convert the one-floor office of the company to an open plan with no walls between workers. The goal of such a layout is to eliminate boundaries and enhance creativity. But for Matt and Peter, the new arrangement creates a growing sense of tension.

The argument boils down to the question of workspace order and organization. Peter prefers to keep his desk completely clean and clear, and he keeps a stack of cleaning wipes in a drawer to eliminate any dust or dirt. Matt, on the other hand, likes to keep all his work visible on his desk, so sketches, plans, magazines, and photos are scattered everywhere, alongside boxes of crackers and coffee cups. Peter finds it hard to concentrate when he sees Matt's piles of materials everywhere, while Matt feels he can be more creative and free flowing when he's not forced to clean and organize constantly. Many of Matt and Peter's coworkers wish they'd just let the issue drop. The men enjoyed a good working relationship in the past, with Peter's attention to detail and thorough planning serving to rein in some of Matt's wild inspirations. But of late, their collaborations have been derailed in disputes.

Everyone knows it's not productive to engage in conflicts over every small irritant in the workplace. However, completely avoiding conflict can be equally negative. An emerging body of research has examined so-called conflict cultures in organizations. The findings suggest having a culture that actively avoids and suppresses conflicts is associated with lower levels of creativity. Cultures that push conflict underground but do not succeed in reducing the underlying tensions can become passive-aggressive, marked by underhanded behavior against other coworkers.

Ultimately, finding a way through the clutter dispute is probably going to be an ongoing process to find a balance between perspectives. Both Matt and Peter worry that if they can't find a solution, their usually positive work relationship will be too contentious to bear. And that would be a real mess.

Questions ★

18-10. Describe some of the factors that led this situation to become an open conflict.

- 18-11.** Do you think this is an issue worth generating conflict over? What are the potential costs and benefits of Matt and Peter having an open discussion of the issues?
- 18-12.** How can Matt and Peter develop an active problem-solving discussion to resolve this conflict? What could effectively be changed, and what is probably going to remain a problem?

Sources: Based on S. Shellenbarger, “Clashing over Office Clutter,” *Wall Street Journal*, March 19, 2014, <http://www.wsj.com/articles/SB10001424052702304747404579447331212245004>; S. Shellenbarger, “To Fight or Not to Fight? When to Pick Workplace Battles,” *Wall Street Journal*, December 17, 2014, <http://www.wsj.com/articles/picking-your-workplace-battles-1418772621>; and M. J. Gelfand, J. R. Harrington, and L. M. Leslie, “Conflict Cultures: A New Frontier for Conflict Management Research and Practice,” in N. M. Ashkanasy, O. B. Ayoko, and K. A. Jehn (eds.), *Handbook of Conflict Management Research* (Northampton, MA: Edward Elgar, 2014): 109–35.

Case Incident 2 Rubber Rooms and Collective Bargaining

U.S. labor unions have seen a dramatic decline in membership in the private sector, where only 6.5 percent of the employees are unionized. The situation is very different in the public sector, however, where 40 percent of government employees are unionized. These numbers are the result of very different trends—in the 1950s, the situation was approximately reversed, with roughly 35 percent of private-sector workers and 12 percent of public-sector employees belonging to unions.

Research suggests two core reasons public-sector unions have grown. First, changes in state and national labor laws have made it easier for public-sector unions to organize. Some also argue that enforcement agencies have tolerated antiunion actions in the private sector. Second, the location of private-sector jobs has changed; high-paying union jobs in the manufacturing sector, the steel industry, and other former bastions of private-sector unionization have mostly gone overseas or to the South, where it's harder to organize workers. On the other hand, it's difficult to move government jobs away from the communities they serve. A Philadelphia school, for example, couldn't just decide it was going to relocate its teachers to Atlanta. Also, public-sector labor forces tend to be more static than in the private sector. More plants than post offices have closed.

Are these trends problems? Though this is partly a political question, let's look at it objectively in terms of pluses and minuses.

On the positive side, by negotiating as a collective, unionized workers are able to earn, on average, roughly 15 percent more than their nonunion counterparts. Unions can also protect the rights of workers against capricious actions by employers. Consider the following example:

Lydia criticized the work of five of her coworkers. They were not amused and posted angry messages on a Facebook page. Lydia complained to her supervisor that the postings violated the employer's zero tolerance policy against bullying and harassment. The employer investigated and, agreeing that its policy had been violated, fired the five. However, the National Labor Relations Board ruled this an unfair labor practice and ordered them reinstated.

Most of us would probably prefer not to be fired for Facebook posts. This is a protection unions can provide.

On the negative side, public-sector unions at times have been able to negotiate

employment arrangements that are hard to sustain. For more than 25 years, the union that represents California's prison guards—the California Correctional Peace Officers Association (CCPOA)—has lobbied to increase the number of prisons and to increase sentences (through primarily the three-strikes initiatives). The lobbying has worked; additional prisons have been built, the prison population has exploded, and thousands of new prison personnel have been hired. With its membership at almost 30,000 and with millions of dollars for skillful lobbying, the power of the CCPOA would now be difficult to overestimate. As a result, an entry-level corrections officer can earn up to \$65,000 in base salary with generous benefits, plus over \$100,000 in overtime and bonuses, after just 4 months of free training. All this is at the expense of taxpayers in a state where the budget is “precariously balanced and faces the prospect of deficits in succeeding years.”

It is often extremely difficult to fire a member of a public-sector union, even if performance is exceptionally poor. Aryeh Eller, a former music teacher at Hillcrest High School in Queens, New York, was pulled from the classroom for repeated sexual harassment of female students, a charge to which he admitted. While in the so-called rubber room, where union members unfit to work are paid their full wage just to sit, Eller's salary increased to \$85,000 due to automatic seniority increases under the teachers' union contract. Such protections exist for teachers in nearly every state, sheltering even those arrested for having sex with minors and giving minors drugs. Teachers are not alone. There are rubber rooms for many types of union jobs.

Reasonable people can disagree about the pros and cons of unions and whether they help or hinder an organization's ability to be successful. There isn't any dispute, however, that they often figure prominently in the study of workplace conflict and negotiation strategies.

Questions ★

- 18-13.** Labor–management negotiations might be characterized as more distributive than integrative. Do you agree? Why do you think this is the case? What, if anything, would you do about it?
- 18-14.** If unions have negotiated unreasonable agreements, what responsibility does management or the administration bear for agreeing to these terms? Why do you think they do agree to such terms?
- 18-15.** Assume that you are advising union and management representatives about how to negotiate an agreement. Drawing on the concepts in this chapter, what would you tell

them?

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MyLab Management Writing Assignments

If your instructor has assigned this activity, go to www.pearson.com/mylab/management for the following assisted-graded writing assignments:

- 18-16.** Refer again to Case Incident 1. How do you think modern, open workspaces contribute to or inhibit employee conflicts?
- 18-17.** From your reading of Case Incident 2 and the text, how do you think unions have changed organizational negotiation practices?
- 18-18. MyLab Management only**—additional assisted-graded writing assignment.

Endnotes

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End of Chapter Quiz

Test Your Understanding

1 Which of the following would be an example of a functional conflict within an organization?

- ☐ two coworkers trying to decide where to eat lunch
- ☐ two coworkers trying to decide where to hold the staff retreat
- ☐ two coworkers each trying to get the open managerial position
- ☐ two coworkers who were married getting a divorce

Check answer

Reset

2 With reference to the interactionist view of conflict, conflict that relates to the content and goals of work is called _____ conflict.

- ☐ job
- ☐ task
- ☐ relationship
- ☐ process

Check answer

Reset

3 Which of the following statements is true regarding conflict?

- The smaller the group, the greater the likelihood of conflict.
- The less specialized the activities of the group, the greater the likelihood of conflict.
- People low in the personality traits of disagreeableness, neuroticism, or self-monitoring are more likely to engage in a conflict.
- Diversity of goals among groups is a major source of conflict.

Check answer

Reset

4 The conflict-handling intention of collaborating is _____.

- ☐ assertive and uncooperative
- ☐ assertive and cooperative
- ☐ unassertive and uncooperative
- ☐ unassertive and cooperative

Check answer

Reset

5 Which of the following outcomes is not a dysfunctional consequence of conflict?

- ☐ dissolution of common ties
- ☐ reassessment of group goals
- ☐ destruction of the group
- ☐ poor communication

Check answer

Reset

6 _____ is an antidote for groupthink.

- ☐ Politics
- ☐ Distributive bargaining
- ☐ Conflict
- ☐ Integrative bargaining

Check answer

Reset

7 Which of the following is a characteristic of distributive bargaining?

- win-win solution
- long-term focus
- good interpersonal relationships

☐ opposed interests

Check answer

Reset

8 Which of the following statements is a condition necessary for integrative bargaining to succeed in organizations?

- ☐ Opposing parties must not be guarded about their concerns.
- ☐ Opposing parties must not be sensitive to others' needs.
- ☐ Opposing parties must not trust each other.
- ☐ Opposing parties must not be open to sharing information.

Check answer

Reset

9 Emma is the labor union negotiator. Today, she is meeting with management to discuss the new five-year contract, including wages and benefits. This example of labor-management negotiations over wages exemplifies _____.

- ☐ integrative bargaining
- ☐ arbitration
- ☐ distributive bargaining
- ☐ mediation

Check answer

Reset

10 During a negotiation, making an initial offer leads to the _____ bias.

- ☐ self-serving
- ☐ framing
- ☐ attributional
- ☐ anchoring

Check answer

Reset

11 Your _____ determines the lowest value acceptable to you for a negotiated agreement.

- BATNA
- margin of error

- ☐ bid price
- ☐ asking price

Check answer

Reset

12 In a negotiation process, which of the following activities is most likely to be included in the 'definition of ground rules' step?

- ☐ determining your best alternative to a negotiated agreement
- ☐ determining time constraints, if any, applicable to negotiation
- ☐ justifying your original demands
- ☐ formalizing the agreement that has been worked out

Check answer

Reset

13 Playbill, Inc. is a company that hires culturally diverse people to perform Shakespearean plays for high school students. The company employs actors and actresses from all over the world. The actors and actresses have joined together to ask Playbill for higher salaries. The employees are struggling over deciding who will negotiate for them. Which of the following statements is true pertaining to the effect of individual differences on negotiations?

- ☐ Women tend to negotiate better outcomes than men.
- ☐ Extroverts tend to be very successful in distributive bargaining.
- ☐ People who are highly interested in having positive relationships with other people are poor negotiators.
- ☐ Individuals who score high on the agreeableness dimension tend to be very successful in distributive bargaining.

Check answer

Reset

14 Those who believe they will be more successful in negotiation situations tend to _____.

- ☐ perform more effectively
- ☐ perform well but not great
- ☐ overestimate their abilities and fail
- ☐ underestimate their opponent and fail

Check answer

Reset

15 _____ in a negotiation process opens the door to many forms of integrative negotiation strategies that benefit both parties.

- ☐ Knowledge
- ☐ Trust
- ☐ Communication skills
- ☐ Secret information

Check answer

Reset

Appendix Research in Organizational Behavior

A number of years ago, a friend of mine was excited because he had read about the findings from a research study that finally, once and for all, resolved the question of what it takes to make it to the top in a large corporation. I doubted there was any simple answer to this question but, not wanting to dampen his enthusiasm, I asked him to tell me about what he had read. The answer, according to my friend, was *participation in college athletics*. To say I was skeptical of his claim is a gross understatement, so I asked him to tell me more.

The study encompassed 1,700 successful senior executives at the 500 largest U.S. corporations. The researchers found that half of these executives had played varsity-level college sports.¹ My friend, who happens to be good with statistics, informed me that since fewer than 2 percent of all college students participate in intercollegiate athletics, the probability of this finding occurring by mere chance is less than 1 in 10 million! He concluded his analysis by telling me that, based on this research, I should encourage my management students to get into shape and to make one of the varsity teams.

My friend was somewhat perturbed when I suggested that his conclusions were likely to be flawed. These executives were all males who attended college in the 1940s and 1950s. Would his advice be meaningful to females in the twenty-first century? These executives also weren't your typical college students. For the most part, they had attended elite private colleges such as Princeton and Amherst, where a large proportion of the student body participates in intercollegiate sports. And these "jocks" hadn't necessarily played football or basketball; many had participated in golf, tennis, baseball, cross-country running, crew, rugby, and similar so-called minor sports. Moreover, maybe the researchers had confused the

direction of causality. That is, maybe individuals with the motivation and ability to make it to the top of a large corporation are drawn to competitive activities like college athletics.

My friend was guilty of misusing research data. Of course, he is not alone. We are all continually bombarded with reports of experiments that link certain substances to cancer in mice and surveys that show changing attitudes toward sex among college students, for example. Many of these studies are carefully designed, with great caution taken to note the implications and limitations of the findings. But some studies are poorly designed, making their conclusions at best suspect, and at worst meaningless.

Rather than attempting to make you a researcher, the purpose of this appendix is to increase your awareness as a consumer of behavioral research. A knowledge of research methods will allow you to appreciate more fully the care in data collection that underlies the information and conclusions presented in this text. Moreover, an understanding of research methods will make you a more skilled evaluator of the OB studies you will encounter in business and professional journals. So, an appreciation of behavioral research is important because (1) it's the foundation on which the theories in this text are built, and (2) it will benefit you in future years when you read reports of research and attempt to assess their value.

Purposes of Research

Research is concerned with the systematic gathering of information. Its purpose is to help us in our search for the truth. Although we will never find ultimate truth—in our case, that would be to know precisely how any person or group would behave in any organizational context—ongoing research adds to our body of OB knowledge by supporting some theories, contradicting others, and suggesting new theories to replace those that fail to gain support.

Research Terminology

Researchers have their own vocabulary for communicating among themselves and with outsiders. The following briefly defines some of the more popular terms you're likely to encounter in behavioral science studies.²

Variable

A *variable* is any general characteristic that can be measured and that changes in amplitude, intensity, or both. Some examples of OB variables found in this textbook are job satisfaction, employee productivity, work stress, ability, personality, and group norms.

Hypothesis

A tentative explanation of the relationship between two or more variables is called a *hypothesis*. My friend's statement that participation in college athletics leads to a top executive position in a large corporation is an example of a hypothesis. Until confirmed by empirical research, a hypothesis remains only a tentative explanation.

Dependent Variable

A *dependent variable* is a response that is affected by an independent variable. In terms of the hypothesis, it is the variable that the researcher is interested in explaining. Referring back to our opening example, the dependent variable in my friend's hypothesis was executive succession. In organizational behavior research, the most popular dependent variables are productivity, absenteeism, turnover, job satisfaction, and organizational commitment.³

Independent Variable

An *independent variable* is the presumed cause of some change in the dependent variable. Participating in varsity athletics was the independent variable in my friend's hypothesis. Popular independent variables studied by OB researchers include intelligence, personality, job satisfaction, experience, motivation, reinforcement patterns, leadership style, reward allocations, selection methods, and organization design.

You may have noticed that we said that job satisfaction is frequently used by OB researchers as both a dependent and an independent variable. This is not an error. It merely reflects that the label given to a variable depends on its place in the hypothesis. In the statement "Increases in job satisfaction lead to reduced turnover," job satisfaction is an independent variable. However, in the statement "Increases in money lead to higher job satisfaction," job satisfaction becomes a dependent variable.

Moderating Variable

A *moderating variable* abates the effect of the independent variable on the dependent variable. It might also be thought of as the contingency variable: If X (independent variable), then Y (dependent variable) will occur, but only under conditions Z (moderating variable). To translate this into a real-life example, we might say that if we increase the amount of direct supervision in the work area (X), then there will be a change in worker productivity (Y), but this effect will be moderated by the complexity of the tasks being performed (Z).

Causality

A hypothesis, by definition, implies a relationship. That is, it implies a presumed cause and effect. This direction of cause and effect is called *causality*. Changes in the independent variable are assumed to cause changes in the dependent variable. In behavioral research, however, it's possible to make an incorrect assumption of causality when relationships are found. For example, early behavioral scientists found a relationship between employee satisfaction and productivity. They concluded that a happy worker was a productive worker. Follow-up research has supported the relationship, but disconfirmed that high productivity leads to satisfaction rather than the other way around.

Correlation Coefficient

It's one thing to know that there is a relationship between two or more variables. It's another to know the *strength* of that relationship. The term *correlation coefficient* is used to indicate that strength, and it is expressed as a number between -1.00 (a perfect negative relationship) and +1.00 (a perfect positive correlation).

When two variables vary directly with one another, the correlation will be expressed as a positive number. When they vary inversely—that is, one increases as the other decreases—the correlation will be expressed as a negative number. If the two variables vary independently of each other, we say that the correlation between them is zero.

For example, a researcher might survey a group of employees to determine the satisfaction of each with his or her job. Then, using company absenteeism reports, the researcher could correlate the job satisfaction scores against individual attendance records to determine whether employees who are more satisfied with their jobs have better attendance records than

their counterparts who indicated lower job satisfaction. Let's suppose the researcher found a correlation coefficient of +0.50 between satisfaction and attendance. Would that be a strong association? There is, unfortunately, no precise numerical cutoff separating strong and weak relationships. A standard statistical test would need to be applied to determine whether the relationship was a significant one.

A final point needs to be made before we move on: A correlation coefficient measures only the strength of association between two variables. A high value does *not* imply causality. The length of women's skirts and stock market prices, for instance, have long been noted to be highly correlated, but one should be careful not to infer that a causal relationship between the two exists. In this instance, the high correlation is more happenstance than predictive.

Theory

The final term we introduce in this section is *theory*. Theory describes a set of systematically interrelated concepts or hypotheses that purports to explain and predict phenomena. In OB, theories are also frequently referred to as *models*. We use the two terms interchangeably.

There are no shortages of theories in OB. For instance, we have theories to describe what motivates people, the most effective leadership styles, the best way to resolve conflicts, and how people acquire power. In some cases, we have half a dozen or more separate theories that purport to explain and predict a given phenomenon. In such cases, is one right and the others wrong? No! They tend to reflect science at work—researchers testing previous theories; modifying them; and, when appropriate, proposing new models that may prove to have higher explanatory and predictive powers. Multiple theories attempting to explain common phenomena merely attest to the fact that OB is an active discipline, still growing and evolving.

Evaluating Research

As a potential consumer of behavioral research, you should follow the dictum of *caveat emptor*—let the buyer beware! In evaluating any research study, you need to ask three questions.⁴

Is it valid? Is the study actually measuring what it claims to be measuring? A number of psychological tests have been discarded by employers in recent years because they have not

been found to be valid measures of the applicants' ability to do a given job successfully. But the validity issue is relevant to all research studies. So, if you find a study that links cohesive work teams with higher productivity, you want to know how each of these variables was measured and whether it is actually measuring what it is supposed to be measuring.

Is it reliable? Reliability refers to consistency of measurement. If you were to have your height measured every day with a wooden yardstick, you'd get highly reliable results. On the other hand, if you were measured each day by an elastic tape measure, there would probably be considerable disparity between your height measurements from one day to the next. Your height, of course, doesn't change from day to day. The variability is due to the unreliability of the measuring device. So, if a company asked a group of its employees to complete a reliable job satisfaction questionnaire and then repeat the questionnaire six months later, we'd expect the results to be very similar—provided nothing changed in the interim that might significantly affect employee satisfaction.

Is it generalizable? Are the results of the research study generalizable to groups of individuals other than those who participated in the original study? Be aware, for example, of the limitations that might exist in research that uses college students as subjects. Are the findings in such studies generalizable to full-time employees in real jobs? Similarly, how generalizable to the overall work population are the results from a study that assesses job stress among 10 nuclear power plant engineers in the hamlet of Mahone Bay, Nova Scotia?

Research Design

Doing research is an exercise in trade-offs. Richness of information typically comes with reduced generalizability. The more a researcher seeks to control for confounding variables, the less realistic his or her results are likely to be. High precision, generalizability, and control almost always translate into higher costs. When researchers make choices about whom they'll study, where their research will be done, the methods they'll use to collect data, and so on, they must make some concessions. Good research designs are not perfect, but they do carefully reflect the questions being addressed. Keep these facts in mind as we review the strengths and weaknesses of five popular research designs: case studies, field surveys, laboratory experiments, field experiments, and aggregate quantitative reviews.

Case Study

You pick up a copy of Soichiro Honda's autobiography. In it he describes his impoverished childhood; his decisions to open a small garage, assemble motorcycles, and eventually build automobiles; and how this led to the creation of one of the largest and most successful corporations in the world. Or you're in a business class and the instructor distributes a 50-page handout covering two companies: Walmart and Kmart. The handout details the two firms' histories; describes their corporate strategies, management philosophies, and merchandising plans; and includes copies of their recent balance sheets and income statements. The instructor asks the class members to read the handout, analyze the data, and determine why Walmart has been so much more successful than Kmart in recent years.

Soichiro Honda's autobiography and the Walmart and Kmart handouts are case studies. Drawn from real-life situations, case studies present an in-depth analysis of one setting. They are thorough descriptions, rich in details about an individual, a group, or an organization. The primary source of information in case studies is obtained through observation, occasionally backed up by interviews and a review of records and documents.

Case studies have their drawbacks. They're open to the perceptual bias and subjective interpretations of the observer. The reader of a case is captive to what the observer/case writer chooses to include and exclude. Cases also trade off generalizability for depth of information and richness of detail. Because it's always dangerous to generalize from a sample of one, case studies make it difficult to prove or reject a hypothesis. On the other hand, you can't ignore the in-depth analysis that cases often provide. They are an excellent device for initial exploratory research and for evaluating real-life problems in organizations.

Field Survey

A lengthy questionnaire was created to assess the use of ethics policies, formal ethics structures, formalized activities such as ethics training, and executive involvement in ethics programs among billion-dollar corporations. The public affairs or corporate communications office of all Fortune 500 industrial firms and 500 service corporations were contacted to get the name and address of the "officer most responsible for dealing with ethics and conduct issues" in each firm. The questionnaire, with a cover letter explaining the nature of the study, was mailed to these 1,000 officers. Of the total, 254 returned a completed questionnaire, for a response rate just above 25 percent. The results of the survey found, among other things, that 77 percent had formal codes of ethics and 54 percent had a single officer specifically

assigned to deal with ethics and conduct issues.⁵

The preceding study illustrates a typical field survey. A sample of respondents (in this case, 1,000 corporate officers in the largest U.S. publicly held corporations) was selected to represent a larger group that was under examination (billion-dollar U.S. business firms). The respondents were then surveyed using a questionnaire or interviewed to collect data on particular characteristics (the content and structure of ethics programs and practices) of interest to the researchers. The standardization of response items allows for data to be easily quantified, analyzed, and summarized, and for the researchers to make inferences from the representative sample about the larger population.

The field survey provides economies for doing research. It's less costly to sample a population than to obtain data from every member of that population. (There are, for instance, more than 5,000 U.S. business firms with sales in excess of a billion dollars, and since some of these are privately held and don't release financial data to the public, they are excluded from the *Fortune* list.) Moreover, as the ethics study illustrates, field surveys provide an efficient way to find out how people feel about issues or how they say they behave. These data can then be easily quantified.

But the field survey has a number of potential weaknesses. First, mailed questionnaires rarely obtain 100 percent returns. Low response rates call into question whether conclusions based on respondents' answers are generalizable to nonrespondents. Second, the format is better at tapping respondents' attitudes and perceptions than behaviors. Third, responses can suffer from social desirability, that is, people saying what they think the researcher wants to hear. Fourth, because field surveys are designed to focus on specific issues, they're a relatively poor means of acquiring depth of information. Finally, the quality of the generalizations is largely a factor of the population chosen. Responses from executives at Fortune 500 firms, for instance, tell us nothing about small- or medium-sized firms or nonprofit organizations. In summary, even a well-designed field survey trades off depth of information for breadth, generalizability, and economic efficiencies.

Laboratory Experiment

The following study is a classic example of the laboratory experiment. A researcher, Stanley Milgram, wondered how far individuals would go in following commands. If subjects were placed in the role of a teacher in a learning experiment and told by an experimenter to

administer a shock to a learner each time that learner made a mistake, would the subjects follow the commands of the experimenter? Would their willingness to comply decrease as the intensity of the shock was increased?

To test these hypotheses, Milgram hired a set of subjects. Each was led to believe that the experiment was to investigate the effect of punishment on memory. Their job was to act as teachers and administer punishment whenever the learner made a mistake on the learning test.

Punishment was administered by an electric shock. The subject sat in front of a shock generator with 30 levels of shock—beginning at zero and progressing in 15-volt increments to a high of 450 volts. The demarcations of these positions ranged from “Slight Shock” at 15 volts to “Danger: Severe Shock” at 450 volts. To increase the realism of the experiment, the subjects received a sample shock of 45 volts and saw the learner—a pleasant, mild-mannered man about 50 years old—strapped into an “electric chair” in an adjacent room. Of course, the learner was an actor, and the electric shocks were phony, but the subjects didn’t know this.

Taking his seat in front of the shock generator, the subject was directed to begin at the lowest shock level and to increase the shock intensity to the next level each time the learner made a mistake or failed to respond.

When the test began, the shock intensity rose rapidly because the learner made many errors. The subject got verbal feedback from the learner: At 75 volts, the learner began to grunt and moan; at 150 volts, he demanded to be released from the experiment; at 180 volts, he cried out that he could no longer stand the pain; and at 300 volts, he insisted that he be let out, yelled about his heart condition, screamed, and then failed to respond to further questions.

Most subjects protested and, fearful they might kill the learner if the increased shocks were to bring on a heart attack, insisted they could not go on with their job. Hesitations or protests by the subject were met by the experimenter’s statement, “You have no choice; you must go on! Your job is to punish the learner’s mistakes.” Of course, the subjects did have a choice. All they had to do was stand up and walk out.

The majority of the subjects dissented. But dissension isn’t synonymous with disobedience. Sixty-two percent of the subjects increased the shock level to the maximum of 450 volts. The average level of shock administered by the remaining 38 percent was nearly 370 volts.⁶

In a laboratory experiment such as that conducted by Milgram, an artificial environment is

created by the researcher. Then the researcher manipulates an independent variable under controlled conditions. Finally, because all other things are held equal, the researcher is able to conclude that any change in the dependent variable is due to the manipulation or change imposed on the independent variable. Note that, because of the controlled conditions, the researcher is able to imply causation between the independent and dependent variables.

The laboratory experiment trades off realism and generalizability for precision and control. It provides a high degree of control over variables and precise measurement of those variables. But findings from laboratory studies are often difficult to generalize to the real world of work. This is because the artificial laboratory rarely duplicates the intricacies and nuances of real organizations. In addition, many laboratory experiments deal with phenomena that cannot be reproduced or applied to real-life situations.

Field Experiment

The following is an example of a field experiment. The management of a large company is interested in determining the impact that a 4-day workweek would have on employee absenteeism. To be more specific, management wants to know if employees working four 10-hour days have lower absence rates than similar employees working the traditional 5-day week of 8 hours each day. Because the company is large, it has a number of manufacturing plants that employ essentially similar workforces. Two of these are chosen for the experiment, both located in the greater Cleveland area. Obviously, it would not be appropriate to compare two similar-sized plants if one is in rural Mississippi and the other is in urban Copenhagen because factors such as national culture, transportation, and weather might be more likely to explain any differences found than changes in the number of days worked per week.

In one plant, the experiment was put into place—workers began the 4-day week. At the other plant, which became the control group, no changes were made in the employees' 5-day week. Absence data were gathered from the company's records at both locations for a period of 18 months. This extended time period lessened the possibility that any results would be distorted by the mere novelty of changes being implemented in the experimental plant. After 18 months, management found that absenteeism had dropped by 40 percent at the experimental plant, and by only 6 percent in the control plant. Because of the design of this study, management believed that the larger drop in absences at the experimental plant was

due to the introduction of the compressed workweek.

The field experiment is similar to the laboratory experiment except it is conducted in a real organization. The natural setting is more realistic than the laboratory setting, and this enhances validity but hinders control. In addition, unless control groups are maintained, there can be a loss of control if extraneous forces intervene—for example, an employee strike, a major layoff, or a corporate restructuring. Maybe the greatest concern with field studies has to do with organizational selection bias. Not all organizations are going to allow outside researchers to come in and study their employees and operations. This is especially true of organizations that have serious problems. Therefore, because most published studies in OB are done by outside researchers, the selection bias might work toward the publication of studies conducted almost exclusively at successful and well-managed organizations.

Our general conclusion is that, of the four research designs we've discussed to this point, the field experiment typically provides the most valid and generalizable findings and, except for its high cost, trades off the least to get the most.⁷

Aggregate Quantitative Reviews

What's the overall effect of organizational behavior modification (OB Mod) on task performance? There have been a number of field experiments that have sought to throw light on this question. Unfortunately, the wide range of effects from these various studies makes it hard to generalize.

To try to reconcile these diverse findings, two researchers reviewed all the empirical studies they could find on the impact of OB Mod on task performance over a 20-year period.⁸ After discarding reports that had inadequate information, had nonquantitative data, or didn't meet all conditions associated with principles of behavioral modification, the researchers narrowed their set to 19 studies that included data on 2,818 individuals. Using an aggregating technique called *meta-analysis*, the researchers were able to synthesize the studies quantitatively and to conclude that the average person's task performance will rise from the 50th percentile to the 67th percentile after an OB Mod intervention.

The OB Mod–task performance review done by these researchers illustrates the use of meta-analysis, a quantitative form of literature review that enables researchers to look at validity findings from a comprehensive set of individual studies and then to apply a formula to them to determine if they consistently produced similar results.⁹ If results prove to be

consistent, it allows researchers to conclude more confidently that validity is generalizable. Meta-analysis is a means for overcoming the potentially imprecise interpretations of qualitative reviews and to synthesize variations in quantitative studies. In addition, the technique enables researchers to identify potential moderating variables between an independent and a dependent variable.

In the past 25 years, there has been a surge in the popularity of this research method. Why? It appears to offer a more objective means for doing traditional literature reviews. Although the use of meta-analysis requires researchers to make a number of judgment calls, which can introduce a considerable amount of subjectivity into the process, there is no denying that meta-analysis reviews have now become widespread in the OB literature.

Ethics in Research

Researchers are not always tactful or candid with subjects when they do their studies. For instance, questions in field surveys may be perceived as embarrassing by respondents or as an invasion of privacy. Also, researchers in laboratory studies have been known to deceive participants about the true purpose of their experiment “because they felt deception was necessary to get honest responses.”¹⁰

The “learning experiments” conducted by Stanley Milgram, which were conducted more than 30 years ago, have been widely criticized by psychologists on ethical grounds. He lied to subjects, telling them his study was investigating learning, when, in fact, he was concerned with obedience. The shock machine he used was a fake. Even the “learner” was an accomplice of Milgram’s who had been trained to act as if he were hurt and in pain. Yet ethical lapses continue. For instance, in 2001, a professor of organizational behavior at Columbia University sent out a common letter on university letterhead to 240 New York City restaurants in which he detailed how he had eaten at this restaurant with his wife in celebration of their wedding anniversary, how he had gotten food poisoning, and that he had spent the night in his bathroom throwing up.¹¹ The letter closed with: “Although it is not my intention to file any reports with the Better Business Bureau or the Department of Health, I want you to understand what I went through in anticipation that you will respond accordingly. I await your response.” The fictitious letter was part of the professor’s study to determine how restaurants responded to complaints. But it created culinary chaos among many of the restaurant owners, managers, and chefs as they reviewed menus and produce

deliveries for possibly spoiled food, and questioned kitchen workers about possible lapses. A follow-up letter of apology from the university for “an egregious error in judgment by a junior faculty member” did little to offset the distress it created for those affected.

Professional associations like the American Psychological Association, the American Sociological Association, and the Academy of Management have published formal guidelines for the conduct of research. Yet the ethical debate continues. On one side are those who argue that strict ethical controls can damage the scientific validity of an experiment and cripple future research. Deception, for example, is often necessary to avoid contaminating results. Moreover, proponents of minimizing ethical controls note that few subjects have been appreciably harmed by deceptive experiments. Even in Milgram’s highly manipulative experiment, only 1.3 percent of the subjects reported negative feelings about their experience. The other side of this debate focuses on the rights of participants. Those favoring strict ethical controls argue that no procedure should ever be emotionally or physically distressing to subjects, and that, as professionals, researchers are obliged to be completely honest with their subjects and to protect the subjects’ privacy at all costs.

Summary

The subject of organizational behavior is composed of a large number of theories that are research based. Research studies, when cumulatively integrated, become theories, and theories are proposed and followed by research studies designed to validate them. The concepts that make up OB, therefore, are only as valid as the research that supports them.

The topics and issues in this book are for the most part research-derived. They represent the result of systematic information gathering rather than merely hunch, intuition, or opinion. This doesn’t mean, of course, that we have all the answers to OB issues. Many require far more corroborating evidence. The generalizability of others is limited by the research methods used. But new information is being created and published at an accelerated rate. To keep up with the latest findings, we strongly encourage you to review regularly the latest research in organizational behavior. More academic work can be found in journals such as the *Academy of Management Journal*, *Academy of Management Review*, *Administrative Science Quarterly*, *Human Relations*, *Journal of Applied Psychology*, *Journal of Management*, *Journal of Organizational Behavior*, and *Leadership Quarterly*. For more practical interpretations of OB research findings, you may want to read the *California*

Management Review, Harvard Business Review, Organizational Dynamics, and the Sloan Management Review.

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Comprehensive Cases

Case 1

Managing Motivation in a Difficult Economy

Learning Goals

In this case, you'll have an opportunity to assess a motivational program designed to reenergize a troubled company's workforce. Acting on behalf of the company's executive board, you'll evaluate the board's current strategy based on survey data. You'll also advise board members about improving the effectiveness of this program based on what you've learned about goal setting and motivation in organizations.

Major Topic Areas

- Changing nature of work
- Diversity and age
- Goal setting
- Organizational downsizing
- Organizational justice

The Scenario

Morgan-Moe's drugstores are in trouble. As a major regional player in the retail industry, the company has hundreds of stores in the upper Midwest. Unfortunately, a sharp decline in the

region's manufacturing economy has put management in a serious financial bind. Revenues have been consistently dwindling. Customers spend less, and the stores have had to switch their focus to very low-margin commodities, such as milk and generic drugs, rather than the high-margin impulse-buy items that used to be the company's bread and butter. The firm has closed quite a few locations, reversing its expansion plans for the first time since it incorporated.

Because this is uncharted territory for the company, Jim Claussen, vice president for human relations, had been struggling with how to address the issue with employees. As the company's fortunes worsened, he could see that employees were becoming more and more disaffected. Their job insecurity was taking a toll on their job attitudes. The company's downsizing was big news, and the employees didn't like what they were hearing.

Media reports of Morgan-Moe's store closings have focused on the lack of advance notice or communication from the company's corporate offices, as well as the lack of severance payments for departing employees. In the absence of official information, rumors and gossip have spread like wildfire among the remaining employees. A few angry blogs developed by laid-off employees, like IHateMorganMoe.blogspot.com, have made the morale and public relations picture even worse.

Morgan-Moe is changing in other ways as well. The average age of its workforce is increasing rapidly. A couple of factors have contributed to this shift. First, fewer qualified young people are living in the area because many families have moved away to find jobs. Second, stores have been actively encouraged to hire older workers, such as retirees looking for supplemental income. Managers are very receptive to these older workers because they are more mature, miss fewer days of work, and do not have child care responsibilities. They are also often more qualified than younger workers because they have more experience, sometimes in the managerial or executive ranks.

These older workers have been a great asset to the company in troubled times, but they are especially likely to leave if things get bad. If these older workers start to leave the company, taking their hard-earned experience with them, it seems likely that Morgan-Moe will sink deeper toward bankruptcy.

The System

Claussen wasn't sure how to respond to employees' sense of hopelessness and fear until a

friend gave him a book entitled *Man's Search for Meaning*. The book was written by a psychologist named Victor Frankl, who survived the concentration camps at Auschwitz. Frankl found that those who had a clear sense of purpose, a reason to live, were more likely to persevere in the face of nearly unspeakable suffering. Something about this book, and its advocacy of finding meaning and direction as a way to triumph over adversity, really stuck with Claussen. He thought he might be able to apply its lessons to his workforce. He proposed the idea of a new direction for management to the company's executive committee, and they reluctantly agreed to try his suggestions.

Over the last 6 months, stores throughout the company have used a performance management system that, as Claussen says, "gets people to buy into the idea of performing so that they can see some real results in their stores. It's all about seeing that your work serves a broader purpose. I read about how some companies have been sharing store performance information with employees to get them to understand what their jobs really mean and participate in making changes, and I thought that was something we'd be able to do."

The human resources (HR) team came up with five options for the management system. Corporate allowed individual managers to choose the option they thought would work best with their employees so that managers wouldn't feel too much like a rapid change was being forced on them. Program I is opting out of the new idea, continuing to stay the course and providing employees with little to no information or opportunities for participation. Program II tracks employee absence and sick leave data and shares that information with individual employees, giving them feedback about things they can control. Management takes no further action. Program III tracks sales and inventory replacement rates across shifts. As in Program II, information is shared with employees, but without providing employee feedback about absence and sick leave data. Program IV, the most comprehensive, tracks the same information as Programs II and III. Managers communicate it in weekly brainstorming sessions, during which employees try to determine what they can do better in the future and make suggestions for improving store performance. Program V keeps the idea of brainstorming but doesn't provide employees with information about their behavior or company profits.

Since implementing the system, Claussen has spoken with several managers about what motivated them to choose the program they did. Artie Washington, who chose Program IV, said, "I want to have my employees' input on how to keep the store running smoothly. Everybody worries about their job security in this economy. Letting them know what's going

on and giving them ways to change things keeps them involved.”

Betty Alvarez couldn't disagree more. She selected Program I. “I would rather have my employees doing their jobs than going to meetings to talk about doing their jobs. That's what management is for.” Michael Ostremski, another proponent of Program I, added, “It's okay for the employees to feel a little uncertain—if they think we're in the clear, they'll slack off. If they think we're in trouble, they'll give up.”

Cal Martins also questions the need to provide information to the whole team, but he chose Program II. “A person should know where he or she stands in the job, but they don't have to know about everyone else. It creates unnecessary tension.”

This is somewhat similar to Cindy Ang's reason for picking Program V. “When we have our brainstorming meetings, I learn what they [the employees] think is most pressing, not what some spreadsheet says. It gives me a better feel for what's going on in my store. Numbers count, of course, but they don't tell you everything. I was also a little worried that employees would be upset if they saw that we aren't performing well.”

Results to Date

Claussen is convinced that the most elaborate procedure (Program IV) is the most effective, but not everyone in the executive committee is won over by his advocacy. Although they have supported the test implementation of the system because it appears to have relatively low costs, others on the committee want to see results. CEO Jean Masterson has asked for a complete breakdown of the performance of the various stores over the past 4 years. She's especially interested in seeing how sales figures and turnover rates have been affected by the new program.

The company has been collecting data in spreadsheets on sales and turnover rates, and it prepared the following report, which also estimates the dollar cost of staff time taken up in each method. These costs are based on the number of hours employees spend working on the program multiplied by their wage rate. Estimates of turnover, profit, and staff time are collected per store. Profit and turnover data include means and standard deviations across locations; profit is net of the monthly time cost. Turnover information refers to the percentage of employees who either quit or are terminated in a month.

To see if any patterns emerged in managers' selection of programs, the company calculated relationships between program selection and various attributes of the stores.

Program I was selected most frequently by the oldest stores and those in the most economically distressed areas. Programs II and III were selected most frequently by stores in urban areas and in areas where the workforce was younger on average. Programs IV and V were selected most frequently in stores in rural areas, and especially where the workforce is older on average.

Program	Methods	Number of Stores	Average Turnover	Weekly Profit per Month	Monthly Staff Time Cost
Program I	Traditional management	83	Mean = 30% SD = 10%	Mean = \$5,700 SD = \$3,000	None
Program II	Share absence and sick leave	27	Mean = 23% SD = 14%	Mean = \$7,000 SD = \$5,800	\$1,960
Program III	Share sales and inventory	35	Mean = 37% SD = 20%	Mean = \$11,000 SD = \$2,700	\$2,440
Program IV	Share information and brainstorm	67	Mean = 17% SD = 20%	Mean = \$13,000 SD = \$3,400	\$3,420
Program V	Brainstorm without sharing information	87	Mean = 21% SD = 12%	Mean = \$14,000 SD = \$2,400	\$2,750

Your Assignment

Your task is to prepare a report for the company's executive committee on the effectiveness of these programs. Make certain it is in the form of a professional business document. Your audience won't necessarily know about the organizational principles you're describing, so make sure you provide detailed explanations that someone in a real business can understand.

When you write, make sure you touch on the following points:

- CC-1.** Consider the five management systems as variables in an experiment. Identify the independent and dependent variables, and explain how they are related to one another.
- CC-2.** Based on the discussion of independent and dependent variables in the text, is there anything else you'd like to measure as an outcome?
- CC-3.** Look over the data and decide which method of management appears most effective in generating revenues and reducing turnover, and why. Which methods appear least effective, and why?
- CC-4.** Are there any concerns you have about these data?
- CC-5.** Does a comparison of the number of stores using each method influence your conclusions at all?
- CC-6.** Does the fact that managers are selecting the specific program to use (including Program I, which continues the status quo) affect the inferences you can draw about program success?
- CC-7.** What are the advantages of randomly assigning different conditions to the stores instead of using this self-selection process?
- CC-8.** How does the changing nature of the workforce and the economy, described in your text and in the case, affect your conclusions about how to manage retail employees? Does the participation of a more experienced workforce help or hurt these programs? Why might these programs work differently in an economy that isn't doing so poorly?
- CC-9.** Claussen essentially designed the program on his own, with very little research into goal setting and motivation. Based on your text, how well has he done? Which parts of the program appear to fit well with research evidence on goal setting? What parts would you change to get more substantial improvements in employee motivation?
- CC-10.** Describe the feelings that employees might have when these systems are implemented that could help or hinder the program's success. What advice would you give managers about how to implement the programs so they match the principles of organizational justice described in your text?

Learning Goals

Companies often divide work as a way to improve efficiency, but specialization can lead to negative consequences. DrainFlow is a company that has effectively used specialization to reduce costs relative to its competitors' costs for years, but rising customer complaints suggest the firm's strong position may be slipping. After reading the case, you will suggest some ways it can create more interesting work for employees. You'll also tackle the problem of finding people qualified and ready to perform the multiple responsibilities required in these jobs.

Major Topic Areas

- Job design
- Job satisfaction
- Personality
- Emotional labor

The Scenario

DrainFlow is a large residential and commercial plumbing maintenance firm that operates around the United States. It has been a major player in residential plumbing for decades, and its familiar rhyming motto, "When Your Drain Won't Go, Call DrainFlow," has been plastered on billboards since the 1960s.

Lee Reynaldo has been a regional manager at Drain-Flow for about 2 years. She used to work for a newer competing chain, Lightning Plumber, which has been drawing more and more customers from DrainFlow. Although her job at DrainFlow pays more, Reynaldo isn't happy with the way things are going. She's noticed the work environment just isn't as vital or energetic as the environment she saw at Lightning.

Reynaldo thinks the problem is that employees aren't motivated to provide the type of customer service Lightning Plumber employees offer. She recently sent surveys to customers

to collect information about performance, and the data confirmed her fears. Although 60 percent of respondents said they were satisfied with their experience and would use DrainFlow again, 40 percent felt their experience was not good, and 30 percent said they would use a competitor the next time they had a plumbing problem.

Reynaldo is wondering whether DrainFlow's job design might be contributing to its problems in retaining customers. DrainFlow has about 2,000 employees in four basic job categories: plumbers, plumber's assistants, order processors, and billing representatives. This structure is designed to keep costs as low as possible. Plumbers make very high wages, whereas plumber's assistants make about one-quarter of what a licensed plumber makes. Using plumber's assistants is therefore a very cost-effective strategy that has enabled DrainFlow to undercut the competition easily when it comes to price. Order processors make even less than assistants but about the same as billing processors. All work is very specialized, but employees are often dependent on another job category to perform at their most efficient level.

Like most plumbing companies, DrainFlow gets business mostly from the Yellow Pages and the Internet. Customers either call in to describe a plumbing problem or submit an online request for plumbing services, receiving a return call with information within 24 hours. In either case, DrainFlow's order processors listen to the customer's description of the problem to determine whether a plumber or a plumber's assistant should make the service call. The job is then assigned accordingly, and a service provider goes to the location. When the job has been completed, a billing representative relays the fee to the service representative via cell phone, who presents a bill to the customer for payment. Billing representatives can take customers' credit card payments by phone, or they can e-mail an invoice for online payment.

The Problem

Although specialization does cut costs significantly, Reynaldo is worried about customer dissatisfaction. According to her survey, about 25 percent of customer contacts ended in no service call because customers were confused by the diagnostic questions the order processors asked and because the order processors did not have sufficient knowledge or skill to explain the situation. That means fully one in four people who call DrainFlow to hire a plumber are worse than dissatisfied: They aren't customers at all! The remaining 75 percent of calls that did end in a customer service encounter resulted in other problems.

The most frequent complaints Reynaldo found in the customer surveys were about response time and cost, especially when the wrong person was sent to a job. A plumber's assistant cannot complete a more technically complicated job. The appointment has to be rescheduled, and the customer's time and the staff's time have been wasted. The resulting delay often caused customers in these situations to decline further contact with DrainFlow—many of them decided to go with Lightning Plumber.

“When I arrive at a job I can't take care of,” says plumber's assistant Jim Larson, “the customer gets ticked off. They thought they were getting a licensed plumber, since they were calling for a plumber. Telling them they have to have someone else come out doesn't go over well.”

On the other hand, when a plumber responds to a job easily handled by a plumber's assistant, the customer is still charged at the plumber's higher pay rate. Licensed plumber Luis Berger also does not like being in the position of giving customers bad news. “If I get called out to do something like snake a drain, the customer isn't expecting a hefty bill. I'm caught between a rock and a hard place—I don't set the rates or make the appointments, but I'm the one who gets it from the customer.” Plumbers also resent being sent to do such simple work.

Susie McCarty is one of DrainFlow's order processors. She's frustrated too when the wrong person is sent to a job but feels she and the other order processors are doing the best they can. “We have a survey we're supposed to follow with the calls to find out what the problem is and who needs to take the job,” she explains. “The customers don't know that we have a standard form, so they think we can answer all their questions. Most of us don't know any more about plumbing than the caller. If they don't use the terms on the survey, we don't understand what they're talking about. A plumber would, but we're not plumbers; we just take the calls.”

Customer service issues also involve the billing representatives. They are the ones who have to keep contacting customers about payment. “It's not my fault the wrong guy was sent,” says Elizabeth Monty. “If two guys went out, that's two trips. If a plumber did the work, you pay plumber rates. Some of these customers don't get that I didn't take their first call, and so I get yelled at.” The billing representatives also complain that they see only the tail end of the process, so they don't know what the original call entailed. The job is fairly impersonal, and much of the work is recording customer complaints. Remember—40 percent of customers aren't satisfied, and it's the billing representatives who take the brunt of their

negative reactions on the phone.

As you can probably tell, all employees have to engage in emotional labor, as described in this text, and many lack the skills or personality traits to complete the customer interaction component of their jobs. They aren't trained to provide customer service, and they see their work mostly in technical, or mechanical, terms. Quite a few are actually anxious about speaking directly with customers. The office staff (order processors and billing representatives) realize customer service is part of their job, but they also find dealing with negative feedback from customers and coworkers taxing.

A couple of years ago a management consulting company was hired to survey DrainFlow worker attitudes. The results showed they were less satisfied than workers in other comparable jobs. The following table provides a breakdown of respondent satisfaction levels across a number of categories:

	DrainFlow Plumbers	DrainFlow Plumber's Assistants	DrainFlow Office Workers	Average Plumber	Average Office Worker
I am satisfied with the work that I am asked to do.	3.7	2.5	2.5	4.3	3.5
I am satisfied with my working conditions.	3.8	2.4	3.7	4.1	4.2
I am satisfied with my interactions with coworkers.	3.5	3.2	2.7	3.8	3.9
I am satisfied with my interactions with my supervisor.	2.5	2.3	2.2	3.5	3.4

The information about average plumbers and average office workers is taken from the management consulting company's records of other companies. They aren't exactly surprising, given some of the complaints DrainFlow employees have made. Top managers at

DrainFlow are worried about these results, but they haven't been able to formulate a solution. The traditional DrainFlow culture has been focused on cost containment, and the "soft stuff" like employee satisfaction hasn't been a major issue.

The Proposed Solution

The company is in trouble, and as revenues shrink and the cost savings that were supposed to be achieved by dividing work fail to materialize, a change seems to be in order.

Reynaldo is proposing using cash rewards to improve performance among employees. She thinks if employees were paid based on work outcomes, they'd work harder to satisfy customers. Because it's not easy to measure how satisfied people are with the initial call-in, Reynaldo would like to give the order processors a small reward for every 20 calls successfully completed. For the hands-on work, she'd like to have each billing representative collect information about customer satisfaction for each completed call. If no complaints are made and the job is handled promptly, a moderate cash reward would be given to the plumber or plumber's assistant. If the customer indicates real satisfaction with the service, a larger cash reward would be provided.

Reynaldo also wants to find people who are a better fit with the company's new goals. Current hiring procedure relies on unstructured interviews with each location's general manager, and little consistency is found in the way these managers choose employees. Most lack training in customer service and organizational behavior. Reynaldo thinks it would be better if hiring methods were standardized across all branches in her region to help managers identify recruits who can actually succeed in the job.

Your Assignment

Your task is to prepare a report for Reynaldo on the potential effectiveness of her cash reward and structured-interview programs. Make certain it is in the form of a professional business document that you'd actually give to an experienced manager at this level of a fairly large corporation. Reynaldo is very smart when it comes to managing finances and running a plumbing business, but she won't necessarily know about the organizational behavior principles you're describing. Because any new proposals must be passed through top managers, you should also address their concerns about cost containment. You'll need to

make a strong, evidence-based financial case that changing the management style will benefit the company.

When you write, make sure you touch on the following points:

- CC-11.** Although it's clear employees are not especially satisfied with their work, do you think this is a reason for concern? Does research suggest satisfied workers are actually better at their jobs? Are any other behavioral outcomes associated with job satisfaction?
- CC-12.** Using job characteristics theory, explain why the present system of job design may be contributing to employee dissatisfaction. Describe some ways you could help employees feel more satisfied with their work by redesigning their jobs.
- CC-13.** Reynaldo has a somewhat vague idea about how to implement the cash rewards system. Describe some of the specific ways you would make the reward system work better, based on the case.
- CC-14.** Explain the advantages and disadvantages of using financial incentives in a program of this nature. What, if any, potential problems might arise if people are given money for achieving customer satisfaction goals? What other types of incentives might be considered?
- CC-15.** Create a specific plan to assess whether the reward system is working. What are the dependent variables that should change if the system works? How will you go about measuring success?
- CC-16.** What types of hiring recommendations would you make to find people better suited for these jobs? Which Big Five personality traits would be useful for the customer service responsibilities and emotional labor?

Case 3 Building a Coalition

Learning Goals

Many of the most important organizational behavior challenges require coordinating plans and goals among groups. This case describes a multiorganizational effort, but the same principles of accommodation and compromise also apply when trying to work with multiple

divisions within a single organization. You'll create a blueprint for managing a complex development team's progress in order to steer team members away from negative conflicts and toward productive discussion. You'll also be asked to help create a new message for executives so they can lead effectively.

Major Topic Areas

- Group dynamics
- Maximizing team performance
- Organizational culture
- Integrative bargaining

The Scenario

The Woodson Foundation, a large nonprofit social service agency, is teaming up with the public school system in Washington, D.C., to improve student outcomes. There's ample room for improvement. The schools have problems with truancy, low student performance, and crime. New staff members quickly burn out as their initial enthusiasm for helping students is blunted by the harsh realities they encounter in the classroom. Turnover among new teachers is very high, and many of the best and brightest are the most likely to leave for schools that aren't as troubled.

The plan is to create an experimental after-school program that will combine the Woodson Foundation's skills of raising private money and coordinating community leaders with the educational expertise of school staff. Ideally, the system will be financially self-sufficient, which is important because less money is available for schools than in the past. After several months of negotiation, the leaders of the Woodson Foundation and the school system have agreed that the best course is to develop a new agency that will draw on resources from both organizations. The Woodson Foundation will provide logistical support and program development and measurement staff; the school system will provide classrooms and teaching staff.

The first stage in bringing this new plan to fruition is the formation of an executive development team. This team will span multiple functional areas and establish the operating

plan for improving school performance. Its cross-organizational nature means representatives from both the Woodson Foundation and the school district must participate. The National Coalition for Parental Involvement in Education (NCPIE) is also going to be a major partner in the program, acting as a representative for parents on behalf of the PTA.

Conflict and Agreement in the Development Team

While it would be perfect if all the groups could work together easily to improve student outcomes, there is little doubt some substantive conflicts will arise. Each group has its own interests, and, in some cases, these are directly opposed to one another.

School district representatives want to ensure that the new jobs will be unionized and will operate in a way that is consistent with current school board policies. They are very concerned that if Woodson assumes too dominant a role, the school board won't be able to control the operations of the new system. The complexity of the school system has led to the development of a highly complex bureaucratic structure over time, and administrators want to make sure their policies and procedures will still hold for teachers in these programs even outside the regular school day. They also worry that jobs going into the new system will take funding from other school district jobs.

Woodson, founded by entrepreneur Theodore Woodson around 1910, still bears the hallmarks of its founder's way of doing business. Woodson emphasized efficiency and experimentation in everything he did. Many of the foundation's charities have won awards for minimizing costs while still providing excellent services. Their focus on using hard data to measure performance for all their initiatives is not consistent with the school district culture.

Finally, the NCPIE is driven by a mission to increase parental control. The organization believes that when communities are able to drive their own educational methods, students and parents are better able to achieve success together. The organization is strongly committed to celebrating diversity along racial, gender, ethnic, and disability status categories. Its members are most interested in the process by which changes are made, ensuring that everyone has the ability to weigh in.

Some demographic diversity issues complicate the team's situation. Most of the students served by the Washington, D.C., school district are African American, along with large populations of Caucasians and Hispanics. The NCPIE makeup generally matches the

demographic diversity of the areas served by the public schools. The Woodson Foundation, based in northern Virginia, is predominantly staffed by Caucasian professionals. There is some concern that this new group that will be so involved in this major change in educational administration does not understand the demographic concerns of the community. The leadership of the new program will have to be able to present an effective message for generating enthusiasm for the program across diverse stakeholder groups.

Although the groups differ in important ways, it's also worth considering what they have in common. All are interested in meeting the needs of students. All would like to increase student learning. The school system does benefit from anything that increases student test scores. The Woodson Foundation and NCPIE are united in their desire to see more parents engaged in the system.

Candidates for the Development Team

The development team will consist of three individuals—an HR representative from the Woodson Foundation, one from the school system, and one from the NCPIE—who have prepared the following list of potential candidates for consideration.

Victoria Adams is the superintendent of schools for Washington, D.C. She spearheaded the initial communication with the Woodson Foundation and has been building support among teachers and principals. She thinks the schools and the foundation need to have larger roles than the parents and communities. “Of course, we want their involvement and support, but as professionals, we should have more say when it comes to making decisions and implementing programs. We don’t want to shut anyone out, but we have to be realistic about what the parents can do.”

Duane Hardy has been a principal in the Washington area for more than 15 years. He also thinks the schools should have the most power. “We’re the ones who work with these kids every day. I’ve watched class sizes get bigger, and scores and graduation rates go down. Yes, we need to fix this, but these outside groups can’t understand the limitations we’re dealing with. We have the community, the politicians, the taxpayers—everyone watching what we’re doing, everyone thinking they know what’s best. The parents, at least, have more of a stake in this.”

“The most important thing is the kids,” says second-year teacher Ari Kaufman, who is well liked by his students but doesn’t get along well with other faculty members. He’s seen as

a “squeaky wheel.” “The schools need change so badly. And how did they get this way? From too little outside involvement.”

Community organizer Mason Dupree doesn’t like the level of bureaucracy either. He worries that the school’s answer to its problems is to throw more money at them. “I know these kids. I grew up in these neighborhoods. My parents knew every single teacher I had. The schools wanted our involvement then. Now all they want is our money. And I wouldn’t mind giving it to them if I thought it would be used responsibly, not spent on raises for people who haven’t shown they can get the job done.”

Meredith Watson, with the Woodson Foundation, agrees the schools have become less focused on the families. A former teacher, she left the field of education after being in the classroom for 6 years. “There is so much waste in the system,” she complains. “Jobs are unnecessarily duplicated, change processes are needlessly convoluted. Unless you’re an insider already, you can’t get anything done. These parents want to be involved. They know their kids best.”

Unlike her NCPIE colleagues, Candace Sharpe thinks the schools are doing the best they can. She is a county social worker, relatively new to the D.C. area. “Parents say they want to be involved but then don’t follow through. We need to step it up, we need to lead the way. Lasting change doesn’t come from the outside, it comes from the home.”

Victor Martinez has been at the Woodson Foundation for 10 years, starting as an intern straight out of college. “It’s sometimes hard to see a situation when you’re in the thick of it,” he explains. “Nobody likes to be told they’re doing something wrong, but sometimes it has to be said. We all know there are flaws in the system. We can’t keep the status quo. It just isn’t cutting it.”

Strategies for the Program Team

Once the basic membership and principles for the development team have been established, the program team would also like to develop a handbook for those who will be running the new program. Ideally, this set of principles can help train new leaders to create an inspirational message that will facilitate success. The actual content of the program and the nature of the message will be hammered out by the development team, but it is still possible to generate some overriding principles for the program team in advance of these decisions.

Your Assignment

The Woodson Foundation, the NCPIE, and the schools have asked you to provide some information about how to form teams effectively. They would like your response to explain what should be done at each step of the way, from the selection of appropriate team members to setting group priorities and goals, setting deadlines, and describing effective methods for resolving conflicts that arise. After this, they'd like you to prepare a brief set of principles for leaders of the newly established program. That means you will have two audiences: the development team, which will receive one report on how it can effectively design the program, and the program team, which will receive one report on how it can effectively lead the new program.

The following points should help you form a comprehensive message for the development team:

- CC-17.** The development team will be more effective if members have some idea about how groups and teams typically operate. Review the dominant perspectives on team formation and performance from the chapters in the text for the committee so it can know what to expect.
- CC-18.** Given the profiles of candidates for the development team, provide suggestions for who would likely be a good group member and who might be less effective in this situation. Be sure you are using the research on groups and teams in the text to defend your choices.
- CC-19.** Using principles from the chapters on groups and teams, describe how you will advise the team to manage conflict effectively.
- CC-20.** Describe how integrative negotiation strategies might achieve joint goals for the development team.

The following points should help you form a message for the program team:

- CC-21.** Leaders of the new combined organization should have a good idea of the culture of the school district, the NCPIE, and the Woodson Foundation because they will need to manage relationships with all three groups on an ongoing basis. How would you describe the culture of these various stakeholder organizations? Use concepts from the chapter on organizational culture to describe how they differ and how they are similar.

- CC-22.** Consider how leaders of the new program can generate a transformational message and encourage employee and parent trust. Using material from the chapter on leadership, describe how you would advise leaders to accomplish these ends.
- CC-23.** Given the potential for demographic faultlines in negotiating these changes, what would you advise as a strategy for managing diversity issues for program leaders?

Case 4

Boundaryless Organizations

Learning Goals

The multinational organization is an increasingly common and important part of the economy. This case takes you into the world of a cutting-edge music software business seeking success across three very different national and organizational cultures. Its managers need to make important decisions about how to structure work processes so employees can be satisfied and productive doing very different tasks.

Major Topic Areas

- Organizational structure and boundaryless organizations
- Organizational culture
- Human resources
- Organizational socialization

The Scenario

Newskool Grooves is a transnational company developing music software. The software is used to compose music, play music in clubs, and produce albums. Founder and CEO Gerd Finger is, understandably, the company's biggest fan. "I started this company from nothing, from just me, my ideas, and my computer. I love music—love playing music, love writing programs for making music, love listening to music—and the money is nice, too." Finger says he never wanted to work for someone else, to give away his ideas and let someone else

profit from them. He wanted to keep control over them, and their image. “Newschool Grooves is always ahead of the pack. In this business, if you can’t keep up, you’re out. And we are the company everyone else must keep up with. Everyone knows when they get something from us, they’re getting only the best and the newest.”

The company headquarters are in Berlin, the nerve center for the organization, where new products are developed and the organizational strategy is established. Newskool outsources a great deal of its coding work to programmers in Kiev, Ukraine. Its marketing efforts are increasingly based in its Los Angeles offices. This division of labor is at least partially based on technical expertise and cost issues. The German team excels at design and production tasks. Because most of Newskool’s customers are English speakers, the Los Angeles office has been the best group to write ads and market products. The Kiev offices are filled with outstanding programmers who don’t require the very high rates of compensation you’d find in German or U.S. offices. The combination of high-tech software, rapid reorganization, and outsourcing makes Newskool the very definition of a boundaryless organization.

Finger also makes the final decision on hiring every employee for the company and places a heavy emphasis on independent work styles. “Why would I want to put my company in the hands of people I can’t count on?,” he asks with a laugh. “They have to believe in what we’re doing here, really understand our direction and be able to go with it. I’m not the babysitter, I’m not the school master handing out homework. School time is over. This is the real world.”

The Work Culture

Employees want to work at this company because it’s cutting edge. Newskool’s software is used by a number of electronic dance music (EDM) DJs, who have been the firm’s core market, seeing it as a relatively expensive but very high-quality and innovative brand. Whenever the rest of the market for music software goes in one direction, it seems like Newskool heads in a completely different direction in an effort to keep itself separate from the pack. This strategy has tended to pay off. While competitors develop similar products and therefore need to lower their prices continually to compete with one another, Newskool has kept revenues high by creating completely new types of products that don’t face this type of price competition.

Unfortunately, computer piracy has eroded Newskool’s ability to make money with just

software-based music tools, and it has had to move into the production of hardware, such as drum machines and amplifiers that incorporate its computer technology. Making this massive market change might be challenging for some companies, but for an organization that reinvents itself every 2 or 3 years like Newskool does, the bigger fight is a constant war against stagnation and rigidity.

The organization has a very decentralized culture. With only 115 employees, the original management philosophy of allowing all employees to participate in decision making and innovation is still the lifeblood of the company's culture. One developer notes, "At Newskool, they want you to be part of the process. If you are a person who wants to do what you're told at work, you're in trouble. Most times, they can't tell you what they want you to do next—they don't even know what comes next! That's why they hire employees who are creative, people who can try to make the next thing happen. It's challenging, but a lot of us think it's very much an exciting environment."

The Boundaryless Environment

Because so much of the work can be performed on computers, Finger decided early to allow employees to work outside the office. The senior management in Berlin and Los Angeles are both quite happy with this arrangement. Because some marketing work does require face-to-face contact, the Los Angeles office has weekly in-person meetings. Employees who like Newskool are happiest when they can work through the night and sleep most of the day, firing up their computers to get work done at the drop of a hat. Project discussions often happen via social networking on the company's intranet.

The Kiev offices have been less eager to work with the boundaryless model. Managers say their computer programmers find working with so little structure rather uncomfortable. They are more used to the idea of a strong leadership structure and well-defined work processes.

"When I started," says one manager, "Gerd said getting in touch with him would be no problem, getting in touch with L.A. would be no problem. We're small, we're family, he said. Well, it is a problem. When I call L.A., they say to wait until their meeting day. I can't always wait until they decide to get together. I call Gerd—he says, 'Figure it out.' Then when I do, he says it isn't right and we have to start again. If he just told me in the first place, we would have done it."

Some recent events have also shaken up the company's usual way of doing business.

Developers in the corporate offices had a major communications breakdown about their hardware DJ controller, which required many hours of discussion to resolve. It seems that people who seldom met face-to-face had all made progress—but had moved in opposite directions. To test and design the company’s hardware products, employees apparently need to do more than send each other code; sometimes they need to collaborate face to face. Some spirited disagreements have been voiced within the organization about how to move forward in this new environment.

The offices are experiencing additional difficulties. Since the shift to newer products, Sandra Pelham in the Los Angeles office has been more critical of the company. “With the software, we were more limited in the kinds of advertising media we could access. So now, with the hardware—real instruments—we finally thought, ‘All right, this is something we can work with!’ We had a whole slate of musicians and DJs and producers to contact for endorsements, but Gerd said, ‘No way.’ He didn’t want customers who only cared that a celebrity liked us. He scrapped the whole campaign. He says we’re all about creativity and doing our own thing—until we don’t want to do things his way.”

Although the organization is not without problems, there is little question Newschool has been a standout success in the computer music software industry. While many are shuttering their operations, Newschool is using its market power to push forward the next generation of electronic music-making tools. As Gerd Finger puts it, “Once the rest of the industry has gotten together and figured out how they’re all going to cope with change, they’ll look around and see that we’re already three miles ahead of them down the road to the future.”

Your Assignment

Finger has asked for your advice on how to keep his organization successful. He wants to have some sort of benchmark for how other boundaryless organizations in the tech sector stay competitive despite the challenge of so many workers heading in so many different directions. You will need to prepare a report for the company’s executive committee. Your report should read like a proposal to a corporate executive who has a great deal of knowledge about the technical aspects of his company but might not have much knowledge of organizational behavior.

When you write, make sure you touch on the following points:

CC-24. Identify some of the problems likely to occur in a boundaryless organization like

Newskool Grooves. What are the advantages of boundaryless organizations?

- CC-25.** Consider some of the cultural issues that will affect a company operating in such different parts of the world and whose employees may not be representative of the national cultures of each country. Are the conflicts you observe a function of the different types of work people have to perform?
- CC-26.** Based on what you know about motivation and personality, what types of people are likely to be satisfied in each area of the company? Use concepts from job characteristics theory and the emerging social relationships perspective on work to describe what might need to change to increase employee satisfaction in all areas.
- CC-27.** What types of human resources practices need to be implemented in this sort of organization? What principles of selection and hiring are likely to be effective? Which Big Five traits and abilities might Newskool supervisors want to use for selection?
- CC-28.** What kind of performance measures might you want to see for each office?
- CC-29.** How can the company establish a socialization program that will maximize employee creativity and independence? Do employees in all its locations need equal levels of creativity?

Case 5 **The Stress of Caring**

Learning Goals

One of the most consistent changes in the structure of work over the past few decades has been a shift from a manufacturing economy to a service economy. More workers are now engaged in jobs that include providing care and assistance, especially in education and medicine. This work is satisfying for some people, but it can also be highly stressful. In the following scenario, consider how a company in the nursing care industry is responding to the challenges of the new environment.

Major Topic Areas

- Stress
- Organizational change
- Emotions
- Leadership

The Scenario

Parkway Nursing Care is an organization facing a massive change. The company was founded in 1972 with just two nursing homes in Phoenix, Arizona. The company was very successful, and throughout the 1980s it continued to turn a consistent profit while slowly acquiring or building 30 more units. This low-profile approach changed forever in 1993 when venture capitalist Robert Quine decided to make a major investment in expanding Parkway in return for a portion of its profits over the coming years. The number of nursing homes exploded, and Parkway was operating 180 homes by the year 2000.

The company now has 220 facilities in the southwestern United States, with an average of 115 beds per facility and a total of nearly 30,000 employees. In addition to health care facilities, it also provides skilled in-home nursing care. Parkway is seen as one of the best care facilities in the region, and it has won numerous awards for its achievements in the field.

As members of the baby boom generation become senior citizens, the need for skilled care will only increase. Parkway wants to make sure it is in a good position to meet this growing need. This means the company must continue expanding rapidly.

The pressure for growth is one significant challenge, but it's not the only one. The nursing home industry has come under increasing government scrutiny following investigations that turned up widespread patient abuse and billing fraud. Parkway has always had outstanding patient care, and no substantiated claim of abuse or neglect in any of its homes has ever been made, but the need for increased documentation will still affect the company. As the federal government tries to trim Medicare expenses, Parkway may face a reduction in funding.

The Problem

As growth continues, Parkway has remained committed to maintaining the dignity and health of all residents in its facilities. The board of directors wants to see renewed commitment to

the firm's mission and core values, not a diffusion of its culture. Its members are worried there might be problems to address. Interviews with employees suggest there's plenty to worry about.

Shift leader Maxine Vernon has been with Parkway for 15 years. "Now that the government keeps a closer eye on our staffing levels, I've seen management do what it can to keep positions filled, and I don't always agree with who is hired. Some of the basic job skills can be taught, sure, but how to *care* for our patients—a lot of these new kids just don't pick up on that."

"The problem isn't with staff—it's with Parkway's focus on filling the beds," says nurse's aide Bobby Reed. "When I started here, Parkway's reputation was still about the service. Now it's about numbers. No one is intentionally negligent—there just are too many patients to see."

A recent college graduate with a B.A. in psychology, Dalton Manetti is more stressed than he expected he would be. "These aren't the sweet grannies you see in the movies. Our patients are demanding. They complain about everything, even about being called patients, probably because most of them think they shouldn't be here in the first place. A lot of times, their gripes amount to nothing, but we have to log them in anyway."

Carmen Frank has been with Parkway almost a year and is already considering finding a new job. "I knew there were going to be physical parts to this job, and I thought I'd be able to handle that. It's not like I was looking for a desk job, you know? I go home after every shift with aches all over—my back, my arms, and my legs. I've never had to take so much time off from a job because I hurt. And then when I come back, I feel like the rest of the staff thinks I'm weak."

Year	Number of Patients	Injuries per Staff Member	Incidents per Patient	Certified Absences per Staff Member	Other Absences per Staff Member	Turnover Rate
2000	21,200	3.32	4.98	4.55	3.14	0.31
2001	22,300	3.97	5.37	5.09	3.31	0.29
2002	22,600	4.87	5.92	4.71	3.47	0.28
2003	23,100	4.10	6.36	5.11	3.61	0.35

2004	23,300	4.21	6.87	5.66	4.03	0.31
2005	23,450	5.03	7.36	5.33	3.45	0.28
2006	23,600	5.84	7.88	5.28	4.24	0.36
2007	24,500	5.62	8.35	5.86	4.06	0.33
2008	24,100	7.12	8.84	5.63	3.89	0.35
2009	25,300	6.95	9.34	6.11	4.28	0.35

“I started working here right out of high school because it was the best-paid of the jobs I could get,” says Niecey Wilson. “I had no idea what I was getting myself into. Now I really like my job. Next year I’m going to start taking some night classes so I can move into another position. But some of the staff just think of this as any other job. They don’t see the patients as people, more like inventory. If they want to work with inventory, they should get a job in retail.”

Last month, the company’s human resources department pulled the above information from its records at the request of the board of directors. The numbers provide some quantitative support for the concerns voiced by staff.

Injuries to staff occur mostly because of back strain from lifting patients. Patient incidents reflect injuries due to slips, falls, medication errors, or other accidents. Certified absences are days off from work due to medically verified illnesses or injuries. Other absences are days missed that are not due to injuries or illnesses; these are excused absences (unexcused absences are grounds for immediate firing).

Using Organizational Development to Combat Stress and Improve Performance

The company wants to use organizational development methods such as appreciative inquiry (AI) to create change and reenergize its sense of mission. As the chapter on organizational change explains, AI procedures systematically collect employee input and then use this information to create a change message everyone can support. The human resources

department conducted focus groups, asking employees to describe some of their concerns and suggestions for the future. The focus groups highlighted a number of suggestions, although they don't all suggest movement in the same direction.

Many suggestions concerned schedule flexibility. One representative comment was this: "Most of the stress on this job comes because we can't take time off when we need it. The LPNs [licensed practical nurses, who do much of the care] and orderlies can't take time off when they need to, but a lot of them are single parents or primary caregivers for their own children. When they have to leave for child care responsibilities, the work suffers and there's no contingency plan to help smooth things over. Then everyone who is left has to work extra hard. The person who takes time off feels guilty, and there can be fights over taking time off. If we had some way of covering these emergency absences, we'd all be a lot happier, and I think the care would be a lot better."

Other suggestions proposed better methods for communicating information across shifts. Most of the documentation for shift work is done in large spiral notebooks. When a new shift begins, staff members say they don't have much time to check on what happened in the previous shift. Some younger caregivers would like to have a method that lets them document patient outcomes electronically because they type faster than they can write. The older caregivers are more committed to the paper-based process, in part because they think switching systems would require a lot of work. (Government regulations on health care reporting require that any documentation be made in a form that cannot be altered after the fact, to prevent covering up abuse, so specialized software systems must be used for electronic documentation.)

Finally, the nursing care staff believes its perspectives on patient care are seldom given an appropriate hearing. "We're the ones who are with the patients most of the time, but when it comes to doing this the right way, our point of view gets lost. We really could save a lot of money by eliminating some of these unnecessary routines and programs, but it's something management always just says it will consider."

Staff members seem to want some way to provide suggestions for improvement, but it isn't clear what method they would prefer.

Your Assignment

Parkway has taken some initial steps in this new direction, but clearly it has a lot of work left

to do. You've been brought in as a change management consultant to help the company change its culture and respond to the stress that employees experience. Remember to create your report as if for the leadership of a major corporation.

When you write your recommendations, make sure you touch on the following points:

- CC-30.** What do the data on employee injuries, incidents, absences, and turnover suggest to you? Is there reason for concern about the company's direction?
- CC-31.** The company is going to be making some significant changes based on the AI process, and most change efforts are associated with resistance. What are the most common forms of resistance, and which would you expect to see at Parkway?
- CC-32.** Given the board of directors' desire to reenergize the workforce, what advice would you provide for creating a leadership strategy? What leader behaviors should nursing home directors and nurse supervisors demonstrate?
- CC-33.** What are the major sources of job stress at Parkway? What does the research on employee stress suggest you should do to help minimize the experience of psychological strain for employees? Create a plan for how to reduce stress among employees.
- CC-34.** Based on the information collected in the focus groups, design a survey to hand out to employees. What sort of data should the survey gather? What types of data analysis methods would you like to employ for these data?

Glossary

ability An individual's capacity to perform the various tasks in a job.

abusive supervision Supervision that is hostile both verbally and nonverbally.

accommodating The willingness of one party in a conflict to place the opponent's interests above his or her own.

action research A change process based on systematic collection of data and then selection of a change action based on what the analyzed data indicate.

affect A broad range of feelings that people experience.

affect intensity Individual differences in the strength with which individuals experience their emotions.

affective component The emotional or feeling segment of an attitude.

affective events theory (AET) A model suggesting that workplace events cause emotional reactions on the part of employees, which then influence workplace attitudes and behaviors.

agreeableness A personality dimension that describes someone who is good natured, cooperative, and trusting.

allostasis Working to change behavior and attitudes to find stability.

anchoring bias A tendency to fixate on initial information, from which one then fails to adjust adequately for subsequent information.

anthropology The study of societies to learn about human beings and their activities.

appreciative inquiry (AI) An approach that seeks to identify the unique qualities and special strengths of an organization, which can then be built on to improve performance.

arbitrator A third party to a negotiation who has the authority to dictate an agreement.

assessment centers Off-site locations where candidates are given a set of performance-simulation tests designed to evaluate their managerial potential.

attitudes Evaluative statements or judgments concerning objects, people, or events.

attribution theory An attempt to explain the ways we judge people differently, depending on the meaning we attribute to a behavior, such as determining whether an individual's behavior is internally or externally caused.

attribution theory of leadership A leadership theory stating that leadership is merely an attribution that people make about other individuals.

authentic leaders Leaders who know who they are, know what they believe in and value, and act on those values and beliefs openly and candidly.

authority The rights inherent in a managerial position to give orders and to expect the orders to be obeyed.

automatic processing A relatively superficial consideration of evidence and information making use of heuristics.

autonomy The degree to which a job provides substantial freedom and discretion to the individual in scheduling the work and in determining the procedures to be used in carrying it out.

availability bias The tendency for people to base their judgments on information that is readily available to them.

avoiding The desire to withdraw from or suppress a conflict.

BATNA The **b**est **a**lternative **t**o a **n**egotiated **a**greement; the least a party in a negotiation should accept.

behavioral component An intention to behave in a certain way toward someone or something.

behavioral ethics Analyzing how people behave when confronted with ethical dilemmas.

behavioral theories of leadership Theories proposing that specific behaviors differentiate leaders from nonleaders.

behaviorally anchored rating scales (BARS) Scales that combine major elements from the critical incident and graphic rating scale approaches. The appraiser rates employees based on items along a continuum, but the points are examples of actual behavior on the given job rather than general descriptions or traits.

behaviorism A theory stating that behavior follows stimuli in a relatively unthinking manner.

Big Five Model A personality assessment model that describes five basic dimensions of personality.

biographical characteristics Personal characteristics—such as age, gender, race, and length of tenure—that are objective and easily obtained from personnel records. These

characteristics are representative of surface-level diversity.

bonus A pay plan that rewards employees for recent performance rather than historical performance.

boundary spanning Individuals forming relationships outside their formally assigned groups.

bounded rationality A process of making decisions by constructing simplified models that extract the essential features from problems without capturing all their complexity.

brainstorming An idea-generation process that specifically encourages any and all alternatives while withholding any criticism of those alternatives.

bureaucracy An organizational structure with highly routine operating tasks achieved through specialization, very formalized rules and regulations, tasks that are grouped into functional departments, centralized authority, narrow spans of control, and decision making that follows the chain of command.

centralization The degree to which decision making is concentrated at a single point in an organization.

chain of command The unbroken line of authority that extends from the top of the organization to the lowest echelon and clarifies who reports to whom.

challenge stressors Stressors associated with workload, pressure to complete tasks, and time urgency.

change Making things different.

change agents Persons who act as catalysts and assume the responsibility for managing change activities.

channel richness The amount of information that can be transmitted during a communication episode.

charismatic leadership theory A leadership theory stating that followers make attributions of heroic or extraordinary leadership abilities when they observe certain behaviors in others.

circular structure An organizational structure in which executives are at the center, spreading their vision outward in rings grouped by function (managers, then specialists, then workers).

citizenship Actions that contribute to the psychological environment of the organization, such as helping others when not required.

coercive power A power base that depends on fear of the negative results from failing to comply.

cognitive component The opinion or belief segment of an attitude.

cognitive dissonance Any incompatibility between two or more attitudes or between behavior and attitudes.

cognitive evaluation theory A version of self-determination theory in which allocating extrinsic rewards for behavior that had been previously intrinsically rewarding tends to decrease the overall level of motivation if the rewards are seen as controlling.

cohesiveness The degree to which group members are attracted to each other and are motivated to stay in the group.

collaborating A situation in which the parties to a conflict each desire to satisfy fully the concerns of all parties.

collectivism A national culture attribute that describes a tight social framework in which people expect others in groups of which they are a part to look after them and protect them.

communication The transfer and the understanding of meaning.

communication apprehension Undue tension and anxiety about oral communication, written communication, or both.

communication process The steps between a source and a receiver that result in the transfer and understanding of meaning.

competing A desire to satisfy one's interests, regardless of the impact on the other party to the conflict.

compromising A situation in which each party to a conflict is willing to give up something to resolve the conflict.

conceptual skills The mental ability to analyze and diagnose complex situations.

conciliator A trusted third party who provides an informal communication link between the negotiator and the opponent.

confirmation bias The tendency to seek out information that reaffirms past choices and to discount information that contradicts past judgments.

conflict A process that begins when one party perceives that another party has negatively affected or is about to negatively affect something that the first party cares about.

conflict management The use of resolution and stimulation techniques to achieve the desired level of conflict.

conflict process A process that has five stages: potential opposition or incompatibility, cognition and personalization, intentions, behavior, and outcomes.

conformity The adjustment of one's behavior to align with the norms of the group.

conscientiousness A personality dimension that describes someone who is responsible, dependable, persistent, and organized.

consideration The extent to which a leader has job relationships that are characterized by mutual trust, respect for subordinates' ideas, and regard for their feelings.

contingency variables Situational factors or variables that moderate the relationship between two or more variables.

contrast effect Evaluation of a person's characteristics that is affected by comparisons with other people recently encountered who rank higher or lower on the same characteristics.

controlled processing A detailed consideration of evidence and information relying on facts, figures, and logic.

controlling Monitoring activities to ensure that they are being accomplished as planned and correcting any significant deviations.

core self-evaluation (CSE) Bottom-line conclusions individuals have about their capabilities, competence, and worth as a person.

core values The primary or dominant values that are accepted throughout the organization.

corporate social responsibility (CSR) An organization's self-regulated actions to benefit society or the environment beyond what is required by law.

cost-minimization strategy A strategy that emphasizes tight cost controls, avoidance of unnecessary innovation or marketing expenses, and price cutting.

counterproductive work behavior (CWB) Actions that actively damage the organization, including stealing, behaving aggressively toward coworkers, or being late or absent.

creativity The ability to produce novel and useful ideas.

critical incidents A way of evaluating an employee's behaviors that are key in making the difference between executing a job effectively and executing it ineffectively.

cross-functional teams Employees from about the same hierarchical level but from

different work areas who come together to accomplish a task.

Dark Triad A constellation of negative personality traits consisting of Machiavellianism, narcissism, and psychopathy.

decisions Choices made from among two or more alternatives.

deep acting Trying to modify one's true feelings based on display rules.

deep-level diversity Differences in values, personality, and work preferences that become progressively more important for determining similarity as people get to know one another better.

defensive behaviors Reactive and protective behaviors to avoid action, blame, or change.

demands Responsibilities, pressures, obligations, and even uncertainties that individuals face in the workplace.

deonance A perspective in which ethical decisions are made because you "ought to" in order to be consistent with moral norms, principles, standards, rules, or laws.

departmentalization The basis by which jobs in an organization are grouped together.

dependence *B*'s relationship to *A* when *A* possesses something that *B* requires.

deviant workplace behavior Voluntary behavior that violates significant organizational norms and, in so doing, threatens the well-being of the organization or its members. Also called antisocial behavior or workplace incivility.

discrimination Noting of a difference between things; often we refer to unfair discrimination, which means making judgments about individuals based on stereotypes regarding their demographic group.

displayed emotions Emotions that are organizationally required and considered appropriate in a given job.

distributive bargaining Negotiation that seeks to divide up a fixed amount of resources; a win-lose situation.

distributive justice Perceived fairness of the amount and allocation of rewards among individuals.

diversity The extent to which members of a group are similar to, or different from, one another.

diversity management The process and programs by which managers make everyone more aware of and sensitive to the needs and differences of others.

divisional structure An organizational structure that groups employees into units by product, service, customer, or geographical market area.

dominant culture A culture that expresses the core values that are shared by a majority of the organization's members.

driving forces Forces that direct behavior away from the status quo.

dyadic conflict Conflict that occurs between two people.

dysfunctional conflict Conflict that hinders group performance.

effectiveness The degree to which an organization meets the needs of its clientele or customers.

efficiency The degree to which an organization can achieve its ends at a low cost.

emotional contagion The process by which peoples' emotions are caused by the emotions of others.

emotional dissonance Inconsistencies between the emotions people feel and the emotions they project.

emotional intelligence (EI) The ability to detect and to manage emotional cues and information.

emotional labor A situation in which an employee expresses organizationally desired emotions during interpersonal transactions at work.

emotional stability A personality dimension that characterizes someone as calm, self-confident, and secure (positive) versus nervous, depressed, and insecure (negative).

emotions Intense, discrete, and short-lived feeling experiences that are often caused by a specific event.

employee engagement An employee's involvement with, satisfaction with, and enthusiasm for the work he or she does.

employee involvement and participation (EIP) A participative process that uses the input of employees to increase employee commitment to organizational success.

employee recognition program A plan to encourage specific employee behaviors by formally appreciating specific employee contributions.

employee stock ownership plan (ESOP) A company-established benefits plan in which employees acquire stock, often at below-market prices, as part of their benefits.

encounter stage The stage in the socialization process in which a new employee sees what the organization is really like and confronts the possibility that expectations and reality may diverge.

environment Forces outside an organization that potentially affect the organization's structure.

equity theory A theory stating that individuals compare their job inputs and outcomes with those of others and then respond to eliminate any inequities.

escalation of commitment An increased commitment to a previous decision despite negative information.

ethical culture The shared concept of right and wrong behavior in the workplace that reflects the true values of the organization and shapes the ethical decision making of its members.

ethical dilemmas and ethical choices Situations in which individuals are required to define right and wrong conduct.

evidence-based management (EBM) Basing managerial decisions on the best available scientific evidence.

exit Dissatisfaction expressed through behavior directed toward leaving the organization.

expectancy theory A theory stating that the strength of a tendency to act in a certain way depends on the strength of an expectation that the act will be followed by a given outcome and on the attractiveness of that outcome to the individual.

expert power Influence based on special skills or knowledge.

extraversion A personality dimension describing someone who is sociable, gregarious, and assertive.

faultlines The perceived divisions that split groups into two or more subgroups based on individual differences such as sex, race, age, work experience, and education.

feedback The degree to which carrying out the work activities required by a job results in the individual obtaining direct and clear information about the effectiveness of his or her performance.

felt conflict Emotional involvement in a conflict that creates anxiety, tenseness, frustration, or hostility.

felt emotions An individual's actual emotions.

femininity A national culture attribute that indicates little differentiation between male and female roles; a high rating indicates that women are treated as the equals of men in all aspects of the society.

Fiedler contingency model The theory that effective groups depend on a proper match between a leader's style of interacting with subordinates and the degree to which the situation gives control and influence to the leader.

filtering A sender's manipulation of information so that it will be seen more favorably by the receiver.

fixed pie The belief that there is only a set amount of goods or services to be divided up between or among the parties.

flexible benefits A benefits plan that allows each employee to put together a benefits package tailored to his or her own needs and situation.

flextime Flexible work hours.

forced comparison Method of performance evaluation where an employee's performance is made in explicit comparison to others (e.g., an employee may rank third out of 10 employees in her work unit).

formal channels Communication channels established by an organization to transmit messages related to the professional activities of members.

formal group A designated work group defined by an organization's structure.

formalization The degree to which jobs within an organization are standardized.

full range of leadership model A model that depicts seven management styles on a continuum: laissez-faire, management by exception, contingent reward leadership, individualized consideration, intellectual stimulation, inspirational motivation, and idealized influence.

functional conflict Conflict that supports the goals of the group and improves its performance.

functional structure An organizational structure that groups employees by their similar specialties, roles, or tasks.

fundamental attribution error The tendency to underestimate the influence of external factors and overestimate the influence of internal factors when making judgments about the behavior of others.

general mental ability (GMA) An overall factor of intelligence, as suggested by the positive correlations among specific intellectual ability dimensions.

goal-setting theory A theory stating that specific and difficult goals, with feedback, lead to higher performance.

grapevine An organization's informal communication network.

graphic rating scale An evaluation method in which the evaluator rates performance factors on an incremental scale.

group Two or more individuals, interacting and interdependent, who have come together to achieve particular objectives.

group cohesion The extent to which members of a group support and validate one another while at work.

group functioning The quantity and quality of a group's work output.

group order ranking An evaluation method that places employees into a particular classification, such as quartiles.

groupthink A phenomenon in which the norm for consensus overrides the realistic appraisal of alternative courses of action.

halo effect The tendency to draw a positive general impression about an individual based on a single characteristic.

heredity Factors determined at conception; one's biological, physiological, and inherent psychological makeup.

hierarchy of needs Abraham Maslow's hierarchy of five needs—physiological, safety, social, esteem, and self-actualization—in which, as each need is substantially satisfied, the next need becomes dominant.

high-context cultures Cultures that rely heavily on nonverbal and subtle situational cues in communication.

high-performance work system (HPWS) A group of human resources practices that work together and reinforce one another to improve organizational outcomes.

hindrance stressors Stressors that keep you from reaching your goals, for example, red tape, office politics, and confusion over job responsibilities.

hindsight bias The tendency to believe falsely, after an outcome of an event is actually known, that one would have accurately predicted that outcome.

horns effect The tendency to draw a negative general impression about an individual based on a single characteristic.

human capital resources The capacities of a work unit derived from the collective knowledge, skills, abilities, and other resources of the organization's workforce.

human skills The ability to work with, understand, and motivate other people, both individually and in groups.

hygiene factors Factors—such as company policy and administration, supervision, and salary—that, when adequate in a job, placate workers. When these factors are adequate, people will not be dissatisfied.

idea champions Individuals who take an innovation and actively and enthusiastically promote the idea, build support, overcome resistance, and ensure that the idea is implemented.

idea evaluation The process of creative behavior involving the evaluation of potential solutions to problems to identify the best one.

idea generation The process of creative behavior that involves developing possible solutions to a problem from relevant information and knowledge.

illusory correlation The tendency of people to associate two events when in reality there is no connection.

imitation strategy A strategy that seeks to move into new products or new markets only after their viability has already been proven.

impression management (IM) The process by which individuals attempt to control the impressions that others form of them.

individual ranking An evaluation method that rank-orders employees from best to worst.

individualism A national culture attribute that describes the degree to which people prefer to act as individuals rather than as members of groups.

informal channels Communication channels that are created spontaneously and that emerge as responses to individual choices.

informal group A group that is neither formally structured nor organizationally determined; such a group appears in response to the need for social contact.

information gathering The stage of creative behavior when possible solutions to a problem incubate in an individual's mind.

information overload A condition in which information inflow exceeds an individual's processing capacity.

informational justice The degree to which employees are provided truthful explanations for decisions.

ingroup favoritism Perspective in which we see members of our ingroup as better than other people, and people not in our group as all the same.

initiating structure The extent to which a leader defines and structures his or her role and those of the subordinates to facilitate goal attainment.

innovation A new idea applied to initiating or improving a product, process, or service.

innovation strategy A strategy that emphasizes the introduction of major new products and services.

inputs Variables that lead to processes.

institutionalization A condition that occurs when an organization takes on a life of its own, apart from any of its members.

institutions Cultural factors, especially those factors that might not lead to adaptive consequences, that lead many organizations to have similar structures.

instrumental values Preferable modes of behavior or means of achieving one's terminal values.

integrative bargaining Negotiation that seeks one or more settlements that can create a win-win solution.

intellectual abilities The capacity to do mental activities—thinking, reasoning, and problem solving.

intentions Decisions to act in a given way.

interacting groups Typical groups in which members interact with each other face-to-face.

intergroup conflict Conflict between different groups or teams.

intergroup development Organizational development (OD) efforts to change the attitudes, stereotypes, and perceptions that groups have of each other.

interpersonal justice The degree to which employees are treated with dignity and respect.

interrole conflict A situation in which the expectations of an individual's different, separate groups are in opposition.

intragroup conflict Conflict that occurs within a group or team.

intuition An instinctive feeling not necessarily supported by research.

intuitive decision making An unconscious process created out of distilled experience.

job characteristics model (JCM) A model proposing that any job can be described in terms of five core job dimensions: skill variety, task identity, task significance, autonomy, and feedback.

job design The way the elements in a job are organized.

job engagement The investment of an employee's physical, cognitive, and emotional energies into job performance.

job enrichment Adding high-level responsibilities to a job to increase intrinsic motivation.

job involvement The degree to which a person identifies with a job, actively participates in it, and considers performance important to self-worth.

job rotation The periodic shifting of an employee from one task to another.

job satisfaction A positive feeling about one's job resulting from an evaluation of its characteristics.

job sharing An arrangement that allows two or more individuals to split a traditional 40-hour-a-week job.

leader-member exchange (LMX) theory A theory that supports leaders' creation of ingroups and outgroups; subordinates with ingroup status have higher performance ratings, less turnover, and greater job satisfaction.

leader-member relations The degree of confidence, trust, and respect that subordinates have in their leader.

leader-participation model A leadership theory that provides a set of rules to determine the form and amount of participative decision making in different situations.

leadership The ability to influence a group toward the achievement of a vision or set of goals.

leading A function that includes motivating employees, directing others, selecting the most effective communication channels, and resolving conflicts.

learning organization An organization that has developed the continuous capacity to adapt and change.

least preferred coworker (LPC) questionnaire An instrument that purports to measure whether a person is task- or relationship-oriented.

legitimate power The power a person receives as a result of his or her position in the formal hierarchy of an organization.

long-term orientation A national culture attribute that emphasizes the future, thrift, and persistence.

low-context cultures Cultures that rely heavily on words to convey meaning in communication.

loyalty Dissatisfaction expressed by passively waiting for conditions to improve.

Machiavellianism The degree to which an individual is pragmatic, maintains emotional distance, and believes that ends can justify means.

management by objectives (MBO) A program that encompasses specific goals, participatively set, for an explicit time period, with feedback on goal progress.

manager An individual who achieves goals through other people.

masculinity A national culture attribute that describes the extent to which the culture favors traditional masculine work roles of achievement, power, and control. Societal values are characterized by assertiveness and materialism.

material symbols What conveys to employees who is important, the degree of egalitarianism top management desires, and the kinds of behavior that are appropriate.

matrix structure An organizational structure that creates dual lines of authority and combines functional and product departmentalization.

McClelland's theory of needs A theory that states achievement, power, and affiliation are three important needs that help explain motivation.

mechanistic model A structure characterized by extensive departmentalization, high formalization, a limited information network, and centralization.

mediator A neutral third party who facilitates a negotiated solution by using reasoning, persuasion, and suggestions for alternatives.

mental model Team members' knowledge and beliefs about how the work gets done by the team.

mentor A senior employee who sponsors and supports a less-experienced employee, called a protégé.

merit-based pay plan A pay plan based on performance appraisal ratings.

metamorphosis stage The stage in the socialization process in which a new employee changes and adjusts to the job, work group, and organization.

mindfulness Reception, attention, and awareness of the present moment, events, and experiences.

model An abstraction of reality, a simplified representation of some real-world phenomenon.

moods Feelings that tend to be longer-lived and less intense than emotions and that lack a contextual stimulus.

moral emotions Emotions that have moral implications.

motivating potential score (MPS) A predictive index that suggests the motivating potential in a job.

motivation The processes that account for an individual's intensity, direction, and persistence of effort toward attaining a goal.

multiteam system A collection of two or more interdependent teams that share a superordinate goal; a team of teams.

Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI) A personality test that taps four characteristics and classifies people into one of 16 personality types.

narcissism The tendency to be arrogant, have a grandiose sense of self-importance, require excessive admiration, and possess a sense of entitlement.

need for achievement (nAch) The drive to excel, to achieve in relationship to a set of standards, and to strive to succeed.

need for affiliation (nAff) The desire for friendly and close interpersonal relationships.

need for cognition A personality trait of individuals depicting the ongoing desire to think and learn.

need for power (nPow) The need to make others behave in a way in which they would not have behaved otherwise.

negative affect A mood dimension that consists of emotions such as nervousness, stress, and anxiety at the high end.

neglect Dissatisfaction expressed through allowing conditions to worsen.

negotiation A process in which two or more parties exchange goods or services and attempt to agree on the exchange rate for them.

neutralizers Attributes that make it impossible for leader behavior to make any difference to follower outcomes.

nominal group technique A group decision-making method in which individual members meet face-to-face to pool their judgments in a systematic but independent fashion.

norms Acceptable standards of behavior within a group that are shared by the group's members.

openness to experience A personality dimension that characterizes someone in terms of imagination, sensitivity, and curiosity.

organic model A structure that is flat, uses cross-hierarchical and cross-functional teams, has low formalization, possesses a comprehensive information network, and relies on participative decision making.

organization A consciously coordinated social unit, composed of two or more people, that functions on a relatively continuous basis to achieve a common goal or set of goals.

organizational behavior (OB) A field of study that investigates the impact that individuals, groups, and structure have on behavior within organizations for the purpose of applying such knowledge toward improving an organization's effectiveness.

organizational citizenship behavior (OCB) Discretionary behavior that contributes to the psychological and social environment of the workplace.

organizational climate The shared perceptions that organizational members have about their organization and work environment.

organizational commitment The degree to which an employee identifies with a particular organization and its goals and wishes to maintain membership in the organization.

organizational culture A system of shared meaning held by an organization's members that distinguishes the organization from others.

organizational demography The degree to which members of a work unit share a common demographic attribute, such as age, sex, race, educational level, or length of service in an organization, and the impact of this attribute on turnover.

organizational development (OD) A collection of planned change interventions, built on humanistic–democratic values, that seeks to improve organizational effectiveness and

employee well-being.

organizational justice An overall perception of what is fair in the workplace, composed of distributive, procedural, informational, and interpersonal justice.

organizational structure The way in which job tasks are formally divided, grouped, and coordinated.

organizational survival The degree to which an organization is able to exist and grow over the long term.

organizing Determining what tasks are to be done, who is to do them, how the tasks are to be grouped, who reports to whom, and where decisions are to be made.

outcomes Key factors that are affected by other variables.

outgroup The inverse of an ingroup, which can mean everyone outside the group but is more usually an identified other group.

panel interviews Structured interviews conducted with a candidate and a number of panel members in a joint meeting.

paradox theory The theory that the key paradox in management is that there is no final optimal status for an organization.

participative management A process in which subordinates share a significant degree of decision-making power with their immediate superiors.

path-goal theory A theory stating that it is the leader's job to assist followers in attaining their goals and to provide the necessary direction and/or support to ensure that their goals are compatible with the overall objectives of the group or organization.

perceived conflict Awareness by one or more parties of the existence of conditions that create opportunities for conflict to arise.

perceived organizational support (POS) The degree to which employees believe an organization values their contribution and cares about their well-being.

perception A process by which individuals organize and interpret their sensory impressions to give meaning to their environment.

personality The sum of ways in which an individual reacts to and interacts with others.

personality-job fit theory A theory that identifies six personality types and proposes that the fit between personality type and occupational environment determines satisfaction and turnover.

personality traits Enduring characteristics that describe an individual's behavior.

person–organization fit A theory that people are attracted to and selected by organizations that match their values, and leave when there is no compatibility.

physical abilities The capacity to do tasks that demand stamina, dexterity, strength, and similar characteristics.

piece-rate pay plan A pay plan in which workers are paid a fixed sum for each unit of production completed.

planned change Change activities that are intentional and goal-oriented.

planning A process that includes defining goals, establishing strategy, and developing plans to coordinate activities.

political behavior Activities that are not required as part of a person's formal role in the organization but that influence, or attempt to influence, the distribution of advantages and disadvantages within the organization.

political skill The ability to influence others so that one's objectives are attained.

position power Influence derived from one's formal structural position in the organization; includes the power to hire, fire, discipline, promote, and give salary increases.

positive affect A mood dimension that consists of specific positive emotions such as excitement, enthusiasm, and elation at the high end.

positive diversity climate In an organization, an environment of inclusiveness and an acceptance of diversity.

positive organizational culture A culture that emphasizes building on employee strengths, rewards more than punishes, and emphasizes individual vitality and growth.

positive organizational scholarship An area of OB research that studies how organizations develop human strengths, foster vitality and resilience, and unlock potential.

positivity offset The tendency of most individuals to experience a mildly positive mood at zero input (when nothing in particular is going on).

power The capacity that *A* has to influence the behavior of *B* so that *B* acts in accordance with *A*'s wishes.

power distance The degree to which people in a country accept that power in institutions and organizations is distributed unequally.

power tactics Ways in which individuals translate power bases into specific actions.

prearrival stage The period of learning in the socialization process that occurs before a new employee joins the organization.

prevention focus A self-regulation strategy that involves striving for goals by fulfilling duties and obligations.

proactive personality People who identify opportunities, show initiative, take action, and persevere until meaningful change occurs.

problem A discrepancy between the current state of affairs and some desired state.

problem formulation The stage of creative behavior that involves identifying a problem or opportunity requiring a solution that is yet unknown.

problem-solving teams Groups of 5 to 12 employees from the same department who meet for a few hours each week to discuss ways of improving quality, efficiency, and the work environment.

procedural justice The perceived fairness of the process used to determine the distribution of rewards.

process conflict Conflict over how work gets done.

process consultation (PC) A meeting in which a consultant assists a client in understanding process events with which he or she must deal and identifying processes that need improvement.

processes Actions that individuals, groups, and organizations engage in as a result of inputs and that lead to certain outcomes.

productivity The combination of the effectiveness and efficiency of an organization.

profit-sharing plan An organization-wide program that distributes compensation based on some established formula designed around a company's profitability.

promotion focus A self-regulation strategy that involves striving for goals through advancement and accomplishment.

psychological contract An unwritten agreement that sets out what a manager expects from an employee, and vice versa.

psychological empowerment Employees' belief in the degree to which they affect their work environment, their competence, the meaningfulness of their job, and their autonomy in their work.

psychology The science that seeks to measure, explain, and sometimes change the behavior of humans and other animals.

psychopathy The tendency for a lack of concern for others and a lack of guilt or remorse when actions cause harm.

punctuated-equilibrium model A set of phases that temporary groups go through that involves transitions between inertia and activity.

randomness error The tendency of individuals to believe that they can predict the outcome of random events.

rational Characterized by making consistent, value-maximizing choices within specified constraints.

rational decision-making model A decision-making model that describes how individuals should behave to maximize some outcome.

realistic job previews Substantive selection tests that are job tryouts to assess talent versus experience.

reference groups Important groups to which individuals belong or hope to belong and with whose norms individuals are likely to conform.

referent power Influence based on identification with a person who has desirable resources or personal traits.

reflexivity A team characteristic of reflecting on and adjusting the master plan when necessary.

reinforcement theory A theory suggesting that behavior is a function of its consequences.

relational job design Constructing jobs so employees see the positive difference they can make in the lives of others directly through their work.

relationship conflict Conflict based on interpersonal relationships.

representative participation A system in which workers participate in organizational decision making through a small group of representative employees.

resources Factors within an individual's control that can be used to resolve demands.

restraining forces Forces that hinder movement from the existing equilibrium.

reward power Compliance achieved based on the ability to distribute rewards that others view as valuable.

risk aversion The tendency to prefer a sure gain of a moderate amount over a riskier outcome, even if the riskier outcome might have a higher expected payoff.

rituals Repetitive sequences of activities that express and reinforce the key values of the organization, which goals are most important, which people are important, and which are expendable.

role A set of expected behavior patterns attributed to someone occupying a given position in a social unit.

role conflict A situation in which an individual is confronted by divergent role expectations.

role expectations How others believe a person should act in a given situation.

role perception An individual's view of how he or she is supposed to act in a given situation.

selective perception The tendency to choose to interpret what one sees based on one's interests, background, experience, and attitudes.

self-concordance The degree to which people's reasons for pursuing goals are consistent with their interests and core values.

self-determination theory A theory of motivation that is concerned with the beneficial effects of intrinsic motivation and the harmful effects of extrinsic motivation.

self-efficacy theory An individual's belief that he or she is capable of performing a task.

self-fulfilling prophecy A situation in which a person inaccurately perceives a second person and the resulting expectations cause the second person to behave in ways consistent with the original perception.

self-managed work teams Groups of 10 to 15 employees who take on responsibilities of their former supervisors.

self-monitoring A personality trait that measures an individual's ability to adjust his or her behavior to external, situational factors.

self-serving bias The tendency for individuals to attribute their own successes to internal factors and put the blame for failures on external factors.

sensitivity training Training that seeks to change behavior through unstructured group interaction.

servant leadership A leadership style marked by going beyond the leader's own self-interest and instead focusing on opportunities to help followers grow and develop.

sexual harassment Any unwanted activity of a sexual nature that affects an individual's employment and creates a hostile work environment.

short-term orientation A national culture attribute that emphasizes the present and accepts change.

simple structure An organizational structure characterized by a low degree of departmentalization, wide spans of control, authority centralized in a single person, and little formalization.

situation strength theory A theory indicating that the way personality translates into behavior depends on the strength of the situation.

situational judgment tests Substantive selection tests that ask applicants how they would perform in a variety of job situations; the answers are then compared to the answers of high-performing employees.

situational leadership theory (SLT) A contingency theory that focuses on followers' readiness to accomplish a specific task.

skill variety The degree to which a job requires a variety of different activities.

social identity theory Perspective that considers when and why individuals consider themselves members of groups.

social-learning theory The view that we can learn through both observation and direct experience.

social loafing The tendency for individuals to expend less effort when working collectively than when working individually.

social psychology An area of psychology that blends concepts from psychology and sociology to focus on the influence of people on one another.

socialization A process that adapts employees to the organization's culture.

socialized charismatic leadership A leadership concept stating that leaders convey values that are other-centered versus self-centered and who role-model ethical conduct.

sociology The study of people in relation to their social environment or culture.

span of control The number of subordinates that a manager can direct efficiently and effectively.

status A socially defined position or rank given to groups or group members by others.

status characteristics theory A theory stating that differences in status characteristics create status hierarchies within groups.

stereotype threat The degree to which we agree internally with the generally negative stereotyped perceptions of our groups.

stereotyping Judging someone based on one's perception of the group to which that person belongs.

stress An unpleasant psychological process that occurs in response to environmental pressures.

strong culture A culture in which the core values are intensely held and widely shared.

structured interviews Planned interviews designed to gather job-related information.

subcultures Minicultures within an organization, typically defined by department designations and geographical separation.

substitutes Attributes, such as experience and training, that can replace the need for a leader's support or ability to create structure.

surface acting Hiding one's feelings and forgoing emotional expressions in response to display rules.

surface-level diversity Differences in easily perceived characteristics, such as gender, race, ethnicity, age, or disability, that do not necessarily reflect the ways people think or feel but that may activate certain stereotypes.

survey feedback The use of questionnaires to identify discrepancies among member perceptions; discussion follows, and remedies are suggested.

sustainability Maintaining organization practices over a long period of time because the tools or structures that support them are not damaged by the processes.

systematic study Looking at relationships, attempting to attribute causes and effects, and drawing conclusions based on scientific evidence.

task conflict Conflict over content and goals of the work.

task identity The degree to which a job requires completion of a whole and identifiable piece of work.

task performance The combination of effectiveness and efficiency at doing core job tasks.

task significance The degree to which a job has a substantial impact on the lives or work of other people.

task structure The degree to which job assignments are regimented.

team building High interaction among team members to increase trust and openness.

team cohesion A situation when team members are emotionally attached to one another and motivated toward the team because of their attachment.

team efficacy A team's collective belief that they can succeed at their tasks.

team identity A team member's affinity for and sense of belongingness to his or her team.

team structure An organizational structure that replaces departments with empowered teams, and that eliminates horizontal boundaries and external barriers between customers and suppliers.

technical skills The ability to apply specialized knowledge or expertise.

technology The way in which an organization transfers its inputs into outputs.

telecommuting Working from home at least 2 days a week through virtual devices that are linked to the employer's office.

terminal values Desirable end-states of existence; the goals a person would like to achieve during his or her lifetime.

trait activation theory (TAT) A theory that predicts that some situations, events, or interventions "activate" a trait more than others.

trait theories of leadership Theories that consider personal qualities and characteristics that differentiate leaders from nonleaders.

transactional leaders Leaders who guide or motivate their followers in the direction of established goals by clarifying role and task requirements.

transformational leaders Leaders who inspire, act as role models, and intellectually stimulate, develop, or mentor their followers, thus having a profound and extraordinary effect on them.

trust A positive expectation that another will not act opportunistically.

trust propensity How likely an employee is to trust a leader.

two-factor theory A theory that relates intrinsic factors to job satisfaction and associates extrinsic factors with dissatisfaction. Also called motivation-hygiene theory.

uncertainty avoidance A national culture attribute that describes the extent to which a society feels threatened by uncertain and ambiguous situations and tries to avoid them.

unity of command The idea that a subordinate should have only one superior to whom he or she is directly responsible.

unstructured interviews Short, casual interviews made up of random questions.

utilitarianism An ethical perspective in which decisions are made to provide the greatest good for all.

value system A hierarchy based on a ranking of an individual's values in terms of their intensity.

values Basic convictions that a specific mode of conduct or end-state of existence is personally or socially preferable to an opposite or converse mode of conduct or end-state of existence.

variable-pay program A pay plan that bases a portion or all of an employee's pay on some individual and/or organizational measure of performance.

virtual structure A small, core organization that outsources major business functions.

virtual teams Teams that use computer technology to tie together physically dispersed members in order to achieve a common goal.

vision A long-term strategy for attaining a goal or goals.

vision statement A formal articulation of an organization's vision or mission.

voice Dissatisfaction expressed through active and constructive attempts to improve conditions.

wellness programs Organizationally supported programs that focus on the employee's total physical and mental condition.

whistle-blowers Individuals who report unethical practices by their employer to outsiders.

withdrawal behavior The set of actions employees take to separate themselves from the organization.

work group A group that interacts primarily to share information, make decisions, and help each group member perform within his or her area of responsibility.

work sample tests Hands-on simulations of part or all of the work that applicants for routine jobs must perform.

work specialization The degree to which tasks in an organization are subdivided into separate jobs.

work team A group whose individual efforts result in performance that is greater than the sum of the individual inputs.

workforce diversity The concept that organizations are becoming more heterogeneous in terms of gender, age, race, ethnicity, sexual orientation, and other characteristics.

workplace spirituality The recognition that people have an inner life that nourishes and is nourished by meaningful work that takes place in the context of community.

zero-sum approach An approach that treats the reward “pie” as fixed so that any gains by one individual are at the expense of another.

Name Index

A

Abbas, M., 403n64

Ablarracín, D., 120n4, 121n8

Abosch, Ken, 303

Adam, H., 685n69, 687n73

Adams, J. S., 266n78–79, 267

Adams, S., 295n37

Adler, N. J., 188n82

Agamy, Remy, 611

Agle, B. R., 487n154

Agneessens, F., 395n20

Aguinis, H., 37n7, 592n90

Ahmad, A. S., 89n73

Aime, F., 360n11, 365n31

Akerson, Dan, 623

Akhtar, S., 476n64

Akinci, C., 183n45

Akst, D., 465n14

Alarcon, G. M., 639n111

Alatorre, Shari, 293

Alberts, H. J. E. M., 155n99

Albrecht, S. L., 390n4

Aldrich, H., 512n41

Aldrick, R. J., 437

Ali, A. A., 582n26

Ali, F., 398n46–47

Allen, D. G., 186n66, 647n161

Allen, J. A., 431n30

Allen, N. J., 1159n136, 365n36, 373n77

Allen, O., 437n58

Allen, T. D., 143–144n45, 295n30n33, 485n147, 553n74, 604n129, 644n138

Allen, W. R., 589n75

Allendorfer, J. B., 84n34

Allison, C., 148n56

Almond, S., 86n63

Alpert, L. I., 521n77

Alsever, J., 585n49

Amanatullah, E. T., 684n61

Ambady, N., 86n57, 138n7

Ambrose, M. L., 262n72

Ames, D. R., 147n82, 463n3

Amiot, C. E., 329n39

Amstad, F. T., 642n124

Anand, G., 588n67

Anand, N., 516n59

Anand, S., 470n34

Anders, G., 579n8

Anderson, A. K., 139n11

Anderson, Cameron, 397n37, 414, 672n21, 674n32

Anderson, G., 194n104

Anderson, J. R., 49

Anderson, N., 194n101, 583n34, 601n117, 63n70, 634n75n78–80

Anderson, S. L., 260n64

Anderson, S. W., 257n35

Andersson, Bo, 521

Andreassen, C., 145n68

Andreessen, Marc, 83

Andrevski, G., 95n103

Andrews, M. C., 397n36, 407n71–72

Ang, D., 303n95

Ang, S., 118n31, 599n108

Angell, L. C., 368n47

Angermeier, I., 57

Angier, N., 143n29

Anseel, F., 479n86, 641

Anthony, Carmelo, 374

Anthony, S. D., 510n31

Antino, M., 339n98

Antonakis, J., 155n120, 471n42n45, 473n45n48, 478n75, 481n101

Antoni, C. H., 312, 477n72

Apfelbaum, E. P., 338n95

Apostel, E., 312, 477n72

Appelbaum, E., 509n22

Appelbaum, S. H., 331

Appleman, Jack, 440

Aquino, K., 480n94

Ardichvilli, A., 559n100

Arends, B., 147n50

Arends, L., 257n33n39

Ariely, Dan, 140n18, 193, 254, 304n102

Armeli, S., 113n16

Armenakis, A. A., 164

Arnaud, A., 143n28, 546n30–31, 547n35–36

Arnold, D., 559n103

Arnold, J. A., 1158n127

Arnold, T., 526n99, 646n157

Aronson, J., 111n87

Arthur, W. Jr., 552n69

Aryee, S., 190n86, 298n55, 432n34, 406n68

Asch, Solomon, 328–329

Asendorpf, J. B., 139n12

Ashforth, B. E., 149n61

Ashkanasy, N. M., 151n71

Aslani, S., 687n76

Assimakopoulos, D., 512n43

Atkin, R. S., 335n74

Atwater, L. E., 488n163, 596n97
Audi, R., 190n83
Audi, T., 88n72
Audia, P. G., 627n47
Austin, J. T., 254n20
Avalos, Julio, 504
Aven, B. L., 394n17
Avery, D. R., 84n52, 86n56–57, 94n99, 336n78
Avey, J. B., 197n131
Avolio, B. J., 479n82, 480n89
Axelrod, Beth, 462
Ayduk, O., 642n128

B

Baas, M., 157n117
Babbitt, L. G., 335n70
Babcock, L., 679n48, 689n85
Bacdayan, P., 589n75
Bachrach, D. G., 120n47, 407n73
Backaler, J., 524n94
Badal, J., 395n26
Badea, C., 335n69
Bae, Z.-T., 426n5
Baer, D., 83
Baer, M., 198n139–140
Bagsby, P. G., 153n86
Bailey, D. E., 469n34
Bailey, S., 345
Bailey, W., 56n58
Baker, A., 302n88
Baker, W. E., 690n91
Bakker, A. B., 477n71, 639n110, 645n149
Baldwin, T. T., 489n170

Balkundi, P., 361n16, 364n27

Ballmer, Steve, 507–508n15–16

Balluerka, N., 85n40

Balthazard, Michel, 127

Balthazard, P., 473n55

Bamberger, P., 333n53

Bamberger, P. A., 302n81–82

Banaji, Mahzarin, 199

Bandler, J., 550n53

Bandura, Albert, 260–261n58–59, 263n74

Bangerter, A., 408n82

Banks, C. G., 321n12

Banks, G. C., 144n55, 146n71–72, 600n111

Bansal, P., 547n42, 622n10

Barber, J., 165

Barber, Joseph, 164

Barber, L. K., 153n86, 649n176

Barber, N., 93n91

Barclay, Kathleen, 623

Barden, J., 446n76

Bardes, M., 56n59

Bardi, A., 398n43

Bareket-Bojmel, L., 304n102

Bargh, J. A., 321n1

Barghouti, Marwan, 666

Bar-Haim, A., 298n58

Barker, B., 56n55

Barley, S. R., 434n42

Barling, J., 335n63

Barnes, C. M., 173n2, 303n95, 362n17–18, 405n53, 603

Barnlund, D. C., 426n3

Baron, R. A., 185n50

Baron, R. S., 343n111

Barra, Mary, 680, 623

Barragan, R. C., 321n4

Barratt, C. L., 126n68

Barrett, F., 632n58

Barrett, L. F., 148n57

Barrick, M. R., 137n5, 142n25, 143n44, 359n6, 397, 408n83, 585n51, 586n55–56n58

Barron, David, 423

Barrs, David, 423

Barry, B., 678n46, 687n75

Barsade, S. G., 137n1–3, 551n57

Barsaloux, J., 335n71

Bartel, C. A., 297n46

Bartol, K. M., 301n79, 305n114, 306, 408n68

Bartram, D., 40n14

Bashshur, M. R., 427n10, 389n2

Bass, B. M., 488n164

Bassett-Jones, N., 252n9

Bastardo, N., 472n42n45

Bastien, B., 321n2

Basuil, D., 520n71, 521n76

Bateman, T. S., 148n85, 257n36–37

Bates, T. C., 321n13

Batt, R., 509n22

Battilana, J., 394n19, 626n36

Bauer, Billy, 112

Bauer, J., 641n120, 644n140

Bauer, T., 579n5

Bauer, T. N., 470n36, 668n9, 554n80n83, 648n172

Baumann, M. R., 340n100

Baumert, A., 121n58

Baun, W. B., 650n184

Bayazit, M., 81n14

Baynton, D., 588n66

Bayo-Moriones, A., 305n106

Baysinger, M. A., 331n46

Bazelon, Emily, 199

Bazerman, M. H., 182n35n37, 678n44

Bear, J. B., 469n33

Bechara, A., 158n128

Beck, J. W., 260n57

Becker, A. S., 115–116n24

Becker, D. V., 148n58

Becker, W. S., 638n100

Bednall, T. C., 600n116

Beehr, T. A., 82n16, 116n25, 118n33, 527n102, 641n119

Beer, A., 148

Beersma, B., 270n93

Behfar, K. J., 374n80, 671n19, 677n37

Beimel, S., 404n44

Bélanger, F., 295n38

Belkin, D., 52n44, 137n4

Bell, B. S., 86n61, 591n81

Bell, G. C., 451n91

Bell, J., 187n70, 463

Bell, S. T., 78n8, 95n102, 552n69

Bellot, J., 542

Belmi, P., 321n4

Belogolovsky, E., 302n81–82

Belschak, F. D., 144n57, 478n76

Belton, B., 295n39

Benabou, R., 342n106

Benard, S., 670n16

Bendersky, C., 334n62, 669n13

Benioff, Marc, 114

Benitez, Emilio, 549

Bennett, A. A., 647n168

Bennett, John, 194

Bennett, W., 593n91

Bennis, W., 468n25

Bentein, K., 558n86

Ben-Ze'ev, A., 140n13, 141n17, 323n16

Berdahl, J. L., 642n122

Bergeron, D. M., 256

Bergman, M. E., 546n26

Bernard, M. M., 152n111

Bernardin, H. J., 180n30

Bernerth, H. B., 582n23

Bernerth, J. B., 164, 582n22

Bernstein, E., 147n47n48, 173n1, 181n31, 192n98, 431n23n29, 435n45

Berry, C. M., 124n68, 142n27, 143n37, 584n40

Berry, L. L., 650n184

Bersin, J., 587n61

Berson, Y., 472n46, 549n49

Bertels, S., 547n37

Besner, Greg, 567

Betz, N. E., 260n64

Beus, J. M., 142n28, 546n26

Beyoncé, 392

Bezos, Jeff, 51, 369, 431

Bezrukova, K., 339n97

Bhappu, A. D., 469n36

Bhargava, S., 527n103

Bhaskar-Shrinivas, P., 96n106n109

Bhattacharya, C. B., 119n35

Bhave, D. B., 46n33, 153n83–84

Bian, L., 197n46

Bies, R. J., 269n90, 270n92

Bilton, N., 434n40

Bing, M. N., 137n9, 138, 144n48

Binnewies, C., 477n74, 647n166

Birkeland, S. A., 137n6

Biron, M., 333n53

Birtch, T., 271n105, 599n107

Birtel, M. D., 90

Blackman, A., 290

Blackwell, K. C., 148

Blair, C., 91n87

Blair, C. A., 120n48

Blankenship, K. L., 444n72

Blankenship, Mark, 125

Blankfein, Lloyd, 83

Blanton, Hart, 199

Blickle, G., 408n80

Bliese, P. D., 626n40

Bligh, M. C., 487n153n155

Bliss-Moreau, E., 148n57

Block, G. D., 145n36

Block, K., 321n9

Blonk, R. W. B., 645n151

Bloom, M., 197n137, 626n30

Bloom, N., 46n29

Blume, B. D., 489n170

Blumenthal, Neil, 571

Blumenthal, Richard, 136

Bobko, P., 84n35, 86n53, 584n42

Bockman, V. M., 251n8

Bodie, Graham, 431

Boer, D., 645n148

Boesler, M., 51n38

Boies, K., 474n59

Boitnott, J., 279

Bolino, M. C., 120n42, 267n80, 271n106, 408n79

Bommer, W. H., 469n27

Bond, M. H., 411

Bone, Lucia, 608

Bonner, B. L., 340n100

Bono, J. E., 37n5, 120n46, 154n95–96, 155n98, 157n122, 160n140, 146n77, 147n78, 255n24

Boothby, E. J., 321n1

Bootzin, R. R., 143n32

Borders, A., 188n77

Borre, Karen, 161

Bort, J., 504

Boss, A. D., 57, 271n103

Boss, J., 356

Boss, R. W., 57

Bosson, J. K., 429n16

Boster, F. J., 448n86

Boswell, W. R., 150n101n103, 2197n136, 555n84, 563, 597n101

Botsford, W., 85n39

Bottom, W., 684

Bouchard, T. J., 335n71

Bouwen, R., 630n54

Bowen, D. E., 633n65

Bowerman, Bill, 556

Bowler, W. M., 408n79

Bowles, H. R., 679n48

Bowling, N. A., 82n16, 116n25, 121n56, 124n64, 641n119

Boyar, S. L., 604n128

Boyce, A. S., 142n30, 550n52

Boyce, C. J., 150n102

Boyd, C. M., 639n108

Bozeman, B., 485n149

Bradford, D. L., 622n11, 629n50

Bradford, E. E. F., 382

Bradley, B. H., 360n8, 367n39, 373n78, 465, 476n66, 669n12n14

Bradlow, E. T., 4485n140

Brady, B., 509n23

Brady, D., 489n169

Brady, M. P., 342n110

Brady, Tom, 392

Brannick, M. T., 137n6

Branscombe, N. R., 642n121

Branson, Richard, 139, 171–172, 437, 474

Bratko, D., 138n10

Brauburger, A. L., 150n69

Braverman, Amy, 70

Bray, R. M., 335n74

Brazil, D. M., 470n29

Breaugh, J. A., 579n3

Breckler, S. J., 109n2

Brees, J. R., 481n105n107n109

Breevaart, K., 477n71, 639n110

Brehmer, B., 667n3–4

Bresch, Heather, 135–136

Breslin, M. M., 581n17

Brett, J., 6728n21, 687n76

Brett, J. F., 596n97

Breus, M. J., 645

Brief, A. P., 551n58

Briner, R. B., 80n11

Brinkley, Cynthia, 623

Briñol, P., 444n71, 446n76, 395n25

Brissette, I., 647n169

Brockner, J., 269n88

Brockway, J. H., 187n69

Brodebeck, F. C., 368n48

Brondolo, E. M., 145n59n60

Brooke, Beth, 90

Brooks, A. W., 686n72

Broschak, J. P., 122–123n59

Brower, H. H., 349

Brown, B., 510n31

Brown, D. F., 253n14

Brown, D. J., 124n66, 149n94, 331n50, 390n5

Brown, G., 365n30

Brown, J. D., 177n18

Brown, K. G., 262n71

Brown, M. E., 480n96–97

Brown, R. P., 188

Brown, S. P., 112n10

Browne, John, 89n78

Browning, L., 556n89

Bruce, B., 257n36–37

Bruch, H., 333n54

Bruehlman-Senecal, E., 642n128

Brummel, B. J., 145n61, 155n100

Brutus, S., 596n103

Bruursema, K., 166

Bryant, A., 365n32, 431n27n31, 491, 556n93, 586n54

Bryant, F. B., 187

Bryant, P., 186n67n69

Brynaert, Didier, 561

Buchanan, D. A., 389n1, 400n57

Buchanan, L., 36

Buckelew, Alan, 427

Buckingham, Marcus, 495, 560n107

Buckley, M. R., 180n30

Budhwar, P. S., 406n68

Buffett, Warren, 184, 462

Bui-Wrzosinska, L., 449n89

Bukowski, M., 689n84

Bulkley, N., 690n91
Burgert, Natasha, 441
Burke, D., 549n53
Burke, R. J., 643n135
Burke, W. W., 622n11, 629n50
Burkeman, O., 141n20
Burns, C., 90n83
Burns, G. N., 124n64
Burns, T., 522n84
Burnstein, E., 341n104
Burrough, B., 414
Burson, K. A., 185n49
Burt, R. S., 483n121, 393n16
Busch, H., 254n19
Buss, D., 635n88
Butalid, L., 145n38
Butler, R. J., 428n13
Butterfield, D. A., 85n50
Butts, M., 481n103, 649n177
Buyse, T., 584n46
Byrne, K. A., 145n67
Byron, K., 634n73

C

Cable, D. M., 554n77, 587n60
Cacioppo, J. T., 140n15
Cadsby, C. B., 306n116
Caetano, A., 591n83
Cai, Y., 372, 634–635n81
Cain, D. M., 120n43–45
Cain, Susan, 136
Calderwood, C., 647n168
Caldwell, D. F., 541n2, 544n14

Caleo, S., 270n99

Callison, K., 142n31

Callister, R. R., 151n74, 334n59

Caloyeras, J. P., 650n185

Campbell, E. M., 291n21

Campbell, S. M., 154n118

Campbell, W. K., 160

Campbell-Bush, E. M., 148n90

Campion, M. A., 289n9n12

Campos, B., 141n18

Camps, J., 600n109

Caniels, M. C. J., 392n14

Carbee, Marshall, 194

Cardon, M. S., 635n84

Cardona, P., 121n49

Carey, B., 161

Carlsmith, J. M., 110

Carlson, B. D., 121n54

Carlson, D. S., 4482n119

Carlson, K. A., 182n36

Carnevale, P. J., 175n11

Carney, D. R., 192n99

Carpenter, Ben, 653

Carpenter, N. C., 124n68

Carr, Evan, 138

Carr, J. C., 156n123

Carr, J. Z., 545n20

Carretta, T. R., 92n90

Carrico, A. R., 548n43

Carroll, S. A., 584n38

Carter, N. T., 142n30

Carver, C. S., 647n169

Casciaro, T., 394n19, 6626n36

Cascio, W. F., 291n17, 592n90

Case, J., 521n74

Casey-Campbell, M., 62n66

Casmir, Fred, 450

Casper, W. J., 78n8

Casselman, B., 85n43

Castano, E., 143n30

Castillo, E. J., 303n96

Castro, S. L., 406n67

Casuga, J.-A. B., 603n122

Catanzaro, D., 604n131

Caughron, J. J., 93n96

Caulkin, S., 633n68

Cavanaugh, T. M., 83n24

Caza, A., 479n87

Cerasoli, C. P., 255n23, 258n44

Cerne, M., 196n122, 635n86

Cha, A. E., 155

Cha, S. E., 477n73

Chai, C. A., 156n108

Chakraborty, A., 186n65

Chalfonte, B. L., 426

Chan, Steven, 130

Chand, M., 82n22

Chang, C. D., 258n46

Chang, C.-H., 118n34, 255n22n28

Chang, M., 374n82

Chang, S., 372n69, 634–635n81

Chang, Sophia, 76

Chao, G. T., 553n74

Chapman, B., 163

Chapman, H. A., 139n11

Charles, A. C., 596n97

Chatman, J. A., 331n42, 541n2, 544n14, 551n57

Chatterjee, A., 145n69

Chaturvedi, S., 51n39, 156n122

Chatzisrantis, N. K. D., 328n33, 333n56

Chau, S. L., 257n31

Chaxel, A.-S., 178n22

Chemezov, Sergei, 521

Chen, C., 410

Chen, C.-C., 156n120, 176–177n16

Chen, G., 96n107, 124n72, 148n90, 262n70, 291n21, 321n11

Chen, J., 644n137

Chen, S., 375n89

Chen, X.-P., 321, 484n133

Chen, Y., 551n62

Chen, Z., 470n30, 482n116, 406n68

Chen, Z. X., 298n55

Cheng, Z., 298n57

Chennault, Ken, 521

Cheraskin, L., 289n9n12

Cherniss, C., 156n106

Chesky, Brian, 459–460

Cheung, S., 195n113

Cheung, S.-Y., 148n91

Cheung, Y. H., 142n32

Chew, J., 553n73

Chi, N., 305n107, 338n87

Chi, S.-C. S., 155n102, 157n123

Chia, Lawrence, 551

Chiaburu, D. S., 121n50, 142n27, 143n37, 144n47, 476n69

Chiang, F. F. T., 271n105, 599n107

Chiang, T.-J., 484n133

Chien Farh, C. I. C., 151n76

Childs, Ted, 90

Chin, Cary, 300

Chin, J. L., 78n7

Chin, M. K., 331n41

Chiu, C., 120n7, 154

Chiva, R., 636n92

Chng, D. H. M., 408n77

Cho, Y., 397n38

Choi, J. N., 254n17, 338n89, 340n92n102, 669n15, 672n22, 591n88

Choi, S., 153n81

Choi Soon-sil, 387–388

Chou, E. Y., 668n8

Chowdhry, A., 621

Chowning, K., 188

Christ, Carol T., 4494

Christian, J., 326n21, 464n12, 626n42

Christian, M. S., 113n19, 272n109, 331n51, 626n42

Christie, A. M., 335n64

Christie, Chris, 303

Christini, A., 289n13

Christoforou, P. S., 117n61

Chuang, C. H., 375n89

Chuang, C. W., 375n89

Chuang, S.-C., 156n110

Chugh, D., 182n37, 183n39

Chun, J. S., 254n17, 338n89, 340n92n102, 669n15, 672n22

Chun, J. U., 145n65

Chun, N., 304n99

Chung, S.-H., 626n38

Churchill, Winston, 480

Cialdini, R. B., 328n35

Cianci, A. M., 648–649n174–175

Cikara, M., 327, 335n68, 341

Clark, D., 412n93, 621n8

Clark, M. S., 321n1

Clarke, R., 197n125

Clarke, S., 556n25, 639n106, 641n117, 649n178

Clegg, Cathy, 680

Clemens, A., 302n89

Clifton, D. O., 561n107

Clinton, Bill, 151, 472

Clinton, Hillary, 405

Cober, R. T., 149n94

Cocalis, Luke, 454

Cogliser, C. C., 365n35

Cohen, F., 473n50

Cohen, Roy L., 122

Cohen, Steve, 414

Cohendet, P., 514n49

Coker, D., 286

Colbert, A. E., 37n5, 465, 476n66

Cole, C., 46n30

Cole, M., 333n54, 579n5

Colella, A., 86n62

Coleman, M. D., 188n74

Coleman, Megan, 514

Collewaert, V., 479n85

Colley, L., 77n3

Collins, C. J., 554n78

Collins, D., 298n60

Collins, Kevin, 100

Collins, M. D., 326n22

Collins, R. W., 295n38

Colquitt, J. A., 267n83–84, 270n91n93n97, 483–484n125n128–129

Colvin, G., 136

Comaford, C., 108

Comen, E., 550n51

Comstock, Beth, 135–136

Conchie, Barry, 560

Conchie, S. M., 476n65, 483n126

Conlon, D. E., 186n59, 270n95, 681n51, 684n60

Connelly, C. E., 145n59n63, 581n16

Connery, H., 188n78

Contreras-Sweet, Maria, 365

Converse, P. D., 148n89

Cook, Tim, 90

Cooney, Susan, 119

Cooper, B. K., 546n23

Cooper, C. D., 485n135n139

Cooper, C. L., 560n106, 638n99, 649n183

Cooper, D., 339n99

Cooper, H., 142n33

Cooper, M. J., 154

Cooper, T., 547n38

Cooper, W. H., 335n72

Cooper-Hakim, A., 113n14

Cooper-Thomas, H. D., 554n79

Corley, K. G., 624n21, 625n28

Cortina, L. M., 82n15, 331n49, 399n52

Cosmides, L., 336n76

Côté, S., 152n79, 149n99, 464n11, 685n67

Cotton, J., 298n51

Courtright, S. H., 112n12, 359n6

Coutu, D., 368n49

Crain, T. L., 587n62

Crampton, D., 400

Crant, J. M., 148n85, 197n137, 626n30

Crawford, E. R., 113n18, 272n108n110–111, 376n93, 639n105, 642n129

Crawford, J., 543n9

Crawshaw, J. R., 160n138

Cray, D., 428n13
Credé, M., 464n10
Creswell, J., 187n71
Crites, S. L., 110n6
Croft, Robin, 293
Croon, M., 291n18
Cropanzano, R., 140n14
Cross, R., 512n43
Crossley, C., 149n100, 365n30
Crown, D. F., 258n41
Cruwys, T., 321n8
Cruz, Arcadio, 586
Csaszar, F. A., 505n1, 510n30
Cuban, Mark, 194–195
Cubías, P., 494
Cuddy, A. J. C., 85n45
Cullen, J. B., 191n91, 547n33–34
Cullen, K. L., 137n8
Cummings, A., 288n5
Cummins, D. D., 328n36, 329n37
Cunningham, Michael, 83
Curhan, J. R., 678n44, 682n53, 684n61n63, 690n90
Curhan, K. B., 141n19
Czukur, G., 81n14

D

Daft, R. L., 516n59
Dahling, J. J., 257n31, 397n35
Dai, H., 646n158
Dailey, S. L., 556n89
Dalal, D. K., 142n30
Dalal, R. S., 150n104–105, 151n106
Dalton, Jared, 296

Daly, M., 149n96, 150n102

Damasio, A. R., 158n128

Damast, A., 85n42

D'Amelio, A., 623n20

Dane, E., 155n100, 183n43

Daniels, D., 250n7

Daniels, M. A., 149n62

Daniels, Timothy, 263

Dansereau, F., 469n26

Danyo, Edward, 519

Dao, David, 532

Darr, W., 403n64

D'Art, D., 305n105

Dash, E., 187n71

Datta, D. K., 298n64, 520n71, 521n76

Daubenmier, J., 154n97

Daus, C. S., 151n71

Davidson, K. M., 188n78

Davidson, M. M., 321n6

Davidson, O. B., 649n180

Davies, P. G., 80n10, 178n23

Davis, J. H., 483n123

Davis, J. P., 674n31

Davis-Blake, A., 122–123n59

Davison, H. K., 138

Davison, R. B., 362n18

Dawson, K. M., 118n33

Day, A., 589n72

Day, D. V., 147n81n83, 583n31

Day, M. V., 180

Dean, K. L., 564n119

DeCelles, K. A., 398n44, 581n14

DeChurch, L. A., 372n73, 674n30

Deci, E., 255n21

De Clercq, B., 146n73n75

De Cremer, D., 479–480n88, 482n117

de Croon, E. M., 645n151

De Dreu, C. K. W., 157n117, 158n125, 195n111, 258n48, 667n2, 685n68, 690n92

De Fruyt, F., 146n73n75

DeGama, N., 262n69

DeGeest, D. S., 331n43, 367n40

DeGrassi, S. W., 408n83, 586n56

DeGroot, T., 153n81

De Hoe, R., 554n79

De Hoogh, A. H. B., 472n43

de Jesus, S. N., 196n119

De Jong, B. A., 364n29, 483n127

de Jong, J. P. J., 195n111

DeJoy, D. M., 649n177

Dekker, H. C., 257n35

Delaney, L., 149n96

De La Torre, H., 649n181

de Lemus, S., 689n84

Delgado, M. R., 187n68

Delobbe, N., 554n79

Delton, A. W., 336n76

DeLuca, Fred, 253

de Luque, M. S., 466n16

Delvaux, E., 328n34

de Melo, C. M., 175n11

DeNeve, K. M., 142n33

Den Hartog, D. N., 289n7, 472n43, 478n76

Denis, A. R., 323n17

Denissen, J. J. A., 145n38

Dennehy, T. C., 323n16

den Nieuwenboer, N. A., 123–124n61

Dennis, A. R., 335n72

Densten, I. L., 487n152

De Pater, I. E., 640n115, 644n146

DePaul-Haddock, A. M., 148n89

DePaulo, B. M., 448n87

Depenbrock, F., 647n163

Derks, D., 446n75

Deros, E., 581n13

DeRue, D. S., 143n39, 360n11, 3463n2, 475n60–61, 478n79, 490n171, 398n44, 684n59

De Ruiter, M., 626n32

DeShon, R. P., 341n105

De Simone, S., 89n81, 91n86

Desivilya, H. S., 677n39

Deutschman, A., 621n5

Devaro, J., 291n20, 360n9

Devine, K., 521n83

de Vries, G., 313

de Vries, T. A., 372n68, 512n42

Dewe, P. J., 638n99

Dewey, Lisa, 120

de Wit, F. R. C., 668n6, 669n10

Dhanani, L. Y., 142n28

Dhar, Ravi, 254

Diaz-Garcia, C., 368

DiazGranados, D., 183n44

DiCaprio, Leonardo, 92

Diefendorff, J. M., 149n60n62

Diehn, E. W., 96n108

Diekmann, C., 408n80

Diekmann, K. A., 269n88

Diener, E., 142n22, 143n31, 157n112n114

Dierdorff, E. C., 262n71

Diestel, S., 114n65n69, 150n67

Dietz, J., 551n58

Dill, K., 604n127

Dimon, Jamie, 558

Dimotakis, N., 684n60, 640n115, 644n146

Dineen, B. R., 260n56

Dionne, S. D., 488n163

Dippong, J., 333n57

Dirks, K. T., 364n28–29, 483n127, 485n135, 689n86

Dirks, Nicholas, 494

Dixon-Fowler, H. R., 547n41

D’Mello, S. D., 84n38

Dobbins, G. H., 392n11

Dodson, J. D., 645n152

Donald, I. J., 483n126

Donavan, D. T., 121n54

Dong, Y., 476n68

Donohoe, Thomas, 57

Doo-Ri Chung, 679–680

Dorfman, P. W., 466n16

Doty, D., 674n30

Douglas, C., 395n23

Douglas, S. C., 160n137

Douglass, A., 514n51

Dovidio, J. F., 175n8, 370n56

Drach-Zahavy, A., 2196n120

Dragoni, L., 41n17

Drauden, G., 335n71

Drucker, Peter, 259n50, 481, 560

Drummond, H., 186n61

Drury, S., 326n30

Dryer, ZoAnn, 292

Du, S., 119n35

Dubb, S., 306n115

Dubner, S. J., 192n100
Dubner, Stephen, 67
Duffy, M. K., 154n95–96, 155n98, 481n104
Duggan, Kris, 431
Duguid, M. M., 331n42
Dulebohn, J. H., 118n31
Dulye, L., 430n22
Duncan, M. J., 147
Dunford, B. B., 57, 271n103
Dunford, R., 186n67
Dunn, Elizabeth, 290
Dunn, J., 681n51
Dunnette, M. D., 38n11, 92n89
Dunning, Kitty, 395
Durand, P., 644n142
Durlach, P., 673n24–25
Dust, S. B., 476n63
Dutcher, E. G., 297n47
Dutton, J., 56n55
Dvir, T., 549n49
Dvorak, P., 427n6
Dwoskin, E., 45n26, 46n31, 137n3
Dwyer, J., 174n3
Dyck, B., 522n85n87
Dyer, D. Alexandra, 172
Dyer, J. H., 631n55
Dyer, W. G., 631n55
Dyer, W. W. G., 631n55
Dyson, Sir James, 171–172
Dysvik, A., 196n122, 591n87

E

Eagly, A. H., 78n7, 487n159

Easterlin, Richard, 290

Eberhardt, J. L., 178n23

Eberly, M. B., 484n133

Eby, E. T., 485n147

Eby, L. T., 485n148, 553n74

Eckman, Paul, 163–164

Eden, D., 649n180

Edwards, B. D., 646n157

Egan, M., 149n96, 248

Egan, T., 634n90

Ehrhardt, K., 86n55

Ehrhart, K. H., 156n124, 541n4, 545n19

Eisenbeiss, S. A., 480n99–100

Eisenberger, R., 113n16, 253n13, 482n111

Eisenkraft, N., 179n27, 684n63

Ekerlavaj, M., 635

Ekkirala, S., 142n26

Ekman, Paul, 138n6, 139n9, 164

Elauf, Samantha, 89

El-Erian, Mohamed, 493

Elfenbein, H. A., 138n7, 334n61n63, 682n53, 684n57n63, 690n90

Elfering, A., 644n144, 645n150

Elias, M., 188n80

Ellard, J. H., 270n100

Ellemers, N., 372n66

Eller, Aryeh, 696

Elliot, A. J., 255n25, 258n48

Elliott, E. K., 157n113

Ellis, A. J., 326n21

Ellis, A. P. J., 331n51, 372n72

Ellison, Sara Fisher, 369

Elpidorou, Andreas, 165

Else-Quest, N. M., 148n56

Emans, B., 410n85

Emshwiller, J. R., 174n5

Engelhart, Kenneth G., 424

Ensari, N., 464n12

Epel, E., 154n97

Epitropaki, O., 396n29

Epley, Nicholas, 192

Erdogan, B., 470n34n36, 554, 597n100

Erez, A., 157n119, 147n78, 472–473n47

Ergen, Charlie, 550

Erickson, T., 375n90

Eriksen, H., 145n68

Ernst, C., 512n43

Erwin, D. G., 626n43

Eschleman, K. J., 121n56

Estrada, Cindy, 680

Estrada, E., 330

Everly, B. A., 89n77

Ewing, John, 656

F

Fabrigar, L. R., 110n6

Facchin, S., 399n53

Fairweather, J., 197n127

Fallon, N., 55n50, 119n37

Fan, J., 584n38

Fang, R., 144n49

Fang, Y., 470n32

Faragher, J., 78n6

Farh, C. I. C., 373n79, 669n11

Farh, J., 148n90, 373n79, 669

Farh, J.-L., 113n17

Farmer, S. M., 260n63

Farr, J. L., 143n42, 195n112, 196n123, 197n129

Farrell, Chris, 101

Fasel, U., 642n124

Fassina, N. E., 554n82

Fast, N. J., 397n38, 398n42

Faure, C., 343n114

Fay, D., 148n87

Feeney, M. K., 485n149

Fehr, R., 173n2

Feild, H. S., 365n33

Feinberg, M., 430n21

Feinholdt, A., 155n99

Feintzeig, R., 119n38, 314, 429n18

Feldman, D. C., 83n25–27, 84n32, 88n70, 480n90–91

Felps, W., 125n73

Fenley, M., 481n101

Ferguson, J. M., 552n68

Ferrier, W. J., 95n103

Ferrin, D. L., 4485n135n139, 689n86

Ferris, D. L., 118n34, 255n22, 258n28n47, 331n50, 390n5

Ferris, G. R., 344n115, 395n23, 400n54, 403n61, 406n69, 689n87–88

Ferris, L. J., 321n2

Ferzandi, L., 372n71

Festinger, Leon, 110n5

Fidas, Deena, 90

Fiedler, Fred, 466–467n17–18

Field, H. S., 164, 646n153

Fields, G., 174n5

Filatotchev, I., 119–120n39

Finchilescu, G., 632n57

Fineman, S., 561n112

Finkelstein, L. M., 87n65–66

Finlay, W. M. L., 323n15

Fioretti, Bob, 46

Firth, B. M., 96n107

Fischer, A. H., 148n55

Fischer, R., 645n148

Fish, R. S., 426n4

Fisher, C. D., 150n69

Fiss, P. C., 625n23

Fitzgerald, B., 547n39

Fitzpatrick, Jonathan, 428

Fitzsimmons, S. R., 326n23

Fitzsimons, Declan, 494

Fleeson, W., 140–141n20

Fleischman, G., 589n76

Fleishman, E. A., 92n89, 93n96

Fletcher, P. O., 183n41

Flexon, Bob, 543

Fligstein, N., 621n6

Flueckiger, L., 644n145

Flunger, B., 262n68

Flynn, A., 518n69

Flynn, Ed, 320

Flynn, F. J., 147n81, 395n3, 397n37

Foldes, H. J., 157n122

Folger, R., 124n67, 183n40, 190n87, 269n89, 271n102

Foo, M., 41n16, 158n134

Ford, Henry, 505–506

Ford, Henry II, 556

Ford, J. D., 623n20

Ford, J. K., 489n170, 545n20

Ford, L. W., 623n20

Ford, M. T., 145n41, 255n23, 258n44, 270n967, 290, 642n127

Ford, R. C., 516n55n57

Forgas, J. P., 178n20

Fornaciari, C. J., 564n119

Forni, A. A., 621n2–4

Förster, J., 634n77

Forsyth, D. R., 144n55, 146n71–72

Forte-Trammell, S., 41n17

Foss, N. J., 511n39

Foster, J. L., 463n8

Foti, R. J., 143n38

Fotsch, B., 521n74

Foulkes, N., 393n15

Francesca, G., 154n87–88

Francis, E., 292n22

Frauenheim, E., 583n29, 648

Freedman, Marc, 101

Freeman, E. C., 160

Freeman, Jo, 504

Frei, Brent, 491

Fremeth, A. R., 547n40

French, J., 391n7n9–10

Frese, M., 148n86–87, 264n76, 472n44, 634n76
Freund, P. A., 684n64, 688n81–82
Frey, W. H., 78n4
Freyer, B., 360n12
Frick, R., 185n51
Fried, J., 677n37
Fried, Y., 287n1n15, 646n156
Frieder, R. E., 179n25, 481n105n107n109
Friedman, R., 176–177n16, 672n21, 677n43, 687n75
Friedman, R. S., 634n77
Friedrich, A., 262n68
Fritsche, I., 331n44
Fritz, C., 641n118, 647n171
Frohlich, T. C., 549n51
Fromen, A., 297n45
Fruin, M., 196n117
Fry, L. W., 479n84, 542n10, 562n114
Fry, R., 632n58
Fu, P. P., 396n31n33, 411n90, 677n42
Fuchs, S., 625n25
Fuerst, A., 407n74
Fugate, M., 623n18, 637n96
Fulmer, I. S., 37n3, 121n51, 301n80
Furman, P., 304n98
Furst, S. A., 372n67

G

Gabelica, C., 257n32
Gabriel, A. S., 149n62, 647n168
Gaddis, B. H., 464n8
Gage, Phineas, 142
Gaillot, M. T., 398n41
Gaines-Ross, Leslie, 436

Gaissmaier, W., 340n101

Gajendran, R. S., 470n35

Galagan, P., 587–588n64

Galbraith, J. R., 515n54

Gale, S. F., 443

Galenson, David, 84

Galic, Z., 584n37

Galinsky, Adam D., 258n43, 398n42, 668n8, 679n47, 683n55

Gallagher, M. W., 141n18

Gallagher, P., 140–141n20

Gallupe, R. B., 335n72

Galvin, B. M., 473n55

Galvin, F. M., 482n114

Gamerman, E., 45n24

Gamlem, Cornelia, 69

Ganegoda, D. B., 183n40

Ganster, D. C., 639n112

Ganzach, Y., 93n94

Gao, D., 584n38

Garcia, J. M., 481–482n108

Garcia-Zamor, J.-C., 564n120

Gard, M. G., 148n54

Gardner, W. L., 253n12, 365n35, 479n86, 488

Garfield, M. J., 323n17

Garman, A. N., 626n43

Garrett, R. P., 306n110

Gartzia, L., 85n40

Garud, R., 394n18, 556n88

Garza, A. S., 113n19, 272n109

Gavin, J. H., 374n83

Gavin, M. B., 365n35

Geard, D., 147n52

Gebauer, Julie, 124

Gebbia, Joe, 463

Gebert, D., 374n86

Geddes, D., 151n74

Gehman, J., 394n18

Gelfand, M., 689n85

Gelfand, M. J., 449n89, 677n41, 551n59

Gengler, A., 109n1

Gensler, L., 521n73

Gentry, W. A., 137n8, 403n63

George, Bill, 437

George, E., 122–123n59

George, G., 82n17

George, J. M., 157n116, 272n114

Georgellis, Y., 121n57

Gerber, P., 90n83

Gerhart, B., 37n3, 125n74, 268n85, 301n72, 303n90–91, 304n97

Ghandi, 480–481

Ghosh, S., 520n72

Ghumman, S., 89n74

Giamanco, B., 442n67

Gianaros, P. J., 644n139

Giangreco, A., 625n27

Gibbs, J. L., 288n6

Gibson, C. B., 288n6

Gibson, D. E., 137n1–3

Gielnik, M. M., 194n103

Giese, K., 325n20

Giessner, S. R., 480n99

Gigerenzer, G., 183n38, 366

Giglio, G., 632n60

Gilboa, S., 646n156

Gill, C., 479n87

Gillespie, M. A., 544n15, 550n52

Gillespie, N., 483n127

Gillies, Jenni, 602

Gilman, L., 132

Gilovich, Thomas, 290

Gimore, D. C., 403n63

Giner-Sorolla, R., 139n10

Gino, Francesca, 145n40, 183n41, 191n88, 196n118, 260n55, 304n101, 464n4, 554n77, 599n104

Ginsberg, David, 39

Gittell, J. H., 514n51

Gladwell, Malcolm, 187

Glasman, L. S., 110n4, 111n8

Glass, I., 320

Glatt, Eric, 603

Glavas, A., 37n7

Glibkowski, B. C., 485n138

Glomb, T. M., 153n83–84, 154n95–96, 155n98, 672n20

Glusica, Zlatko, 645

Goadsduff, L., 621n2–4

Goddard, M. J., 262n73

Goetzel, R., 649n181

Gogus, C. I., 626n41

Gold, M. A., 180n28–29

Goldberg, Alan, 254

Goldberg, L. R., 138n12

Goldberg, S. G., 86n60

Golden, T. D., 297n45

Golder, S. A., 137n7, 143n35n37, 145, 146,

Goldstein, A., 621n6

Goldstein, H. W., 554n81

Goldstein, N. J., 328n35

Goman, Carol Kinsey, 438n60, 455

Gomez, J.-C., 382

Goncalo, J. A., 198n138, 331n42, 342n107

Gong, Y., 148n91, 195n113

Gongloff, M., 390n3

Gonzalez, J. A., 86n55

González-Morales, M. G., 637n93

Gonzalez-Moreno, A., 368

Gonzalez-Mule, E., 331n43, 367n40

Gonzalez-Roma, V., 363n22, 374n81

Goodman, M., 581n19

Goodstein, J., 559n105

Goodwin, G. P., 175n9

Goranova, M., 302n84

Gore, W. L., 487

Gorman, J. C., 357n2–3

Górska-Kolodziejczyk, El'zbieta, 560–561

Gory, J., 90n83

Gosling, S. D., 138n11

Gottfredson, L. S., 92n88

Gouveia, A., 249n2

Gowan, M. A., 144n56

Graeber, D., 514n50

Graen, G. B., 469n26

Graham, Martha, 195

Grand, J. A., 80n12

Grandey, A. A., 148n59, 150n66n69

Granhag, P. A., 448n88

Grant, A., 140n16, 397n40, 604n126

Grant, A. M., 147n80, 151n107, 155n104, 287n1n15, 290n19, 291n20–21, 292n23, 395n3, 473n58

Grasso, A., 518n68

Gratton, Linda, 375n90

Graves, L. M., 256n26

Grawitch, M. J., 157n113

Gray, B., 677n40

Gray, J. H., 487n152

Gray, K., 581n15

Green, J., 579n4

Green, Logan, 35–36

Green, S. G., 335n65

Greenaway, K. H., 321n8

Greenbaum, R., 56n59, 289n7, 480n94, 481n103, 559n102

Greenberg, J., 267n83–84

Greene, Jeremy, 136

Greene, John, 113

Greenhouse, S., 603n121

Greenstein, F. I., 1152n78

Greenwald, J., 54n48

Greenwald, R., 363n21

Greenwald, Tony, 199

Greenwood, R., 525n98

Greer, L., 337n85, 373n76, 668n10, 669n35

Gregoire, K., 442n67

Gregory, M. E., 375n88, 588n69

Greguras, G. J., 149n60n62

Griepentrog, B. K., 579n6, 585n50

Grieten, S., 630n54

Griffin, B., 409n84

Griffin, M. A., 640n114, 641n117, 649n178

Griggs, R. A., 329n38

Grijalva, E., 143n41, 145n58n60n62n64

Grodal, S., 434n42

Gross, J. J., 154n90

Grosser, T. J., 260n56, 429n17

Grossman, R. J., 623n15

Grote, G., 373n75

Groth, M., 149n64

Groysberg, B., 334n61n63, 485n136–137

Gruenfeld, D. H., 679n47

Gruley, B., 557n97
Gruys, M. L., 559n105
Guarana, C. L., 473n53
Guardado, Kely, 189
Guay, R. P., 157n126
Gubler, T., 277
Guemo, M., 336n76
Guest, H. S., 250n5–6
Guilbault, R. L., 187n69
Guillaume, Y. F., 368n48
Gula, B., 366
Gully, S. M., 579n2
Gunia, B. C., 191n89, 683n54
Gunnthorsdottir, A., 337n82n84
Gurchiek, K., 587n63
Gurtner, A., 371n60
Gurven, M., 144n51
Guthrie, J. P., 298n64, 520n71, 521n76
Guttman, H. M., 375n87

H

Habib, J., 636n92
Hackett, R. D., 113n17, 124n70
Hackman, J. R., 287n2, 506n7
Hack-Polay, D., 86n52
Hader, Bill, 529
Häfner, A., 647n160
Haga, W., 469n26
Hagger, M. S., 328n33, 333n56
Haidt, J., 132n27
Haimann, C. R., 308n123
Hakanen, J. J., 645n149
Halbesleben, J. R. B., 408n79, 521n81

Hale, J. M. S., 140n14

Halevy, N., 398n42, 668n8

Halperin, E., 154n90n92

Halzack, S., 303n94

Ham, J., 408n78

Hambrick, D. C., 145n69, 331n41, 552n72

Hamel, G., 552n71

Hamilton, D. L., 177n17

Hamilton, K., 372n71

Hammer, L. B., 587n62

Hammond, Larry, 560

Hammond, M. M., 143n42, 195n111–112, 196n122, 197n129

Hampson, S. E., 138n12

Han, J., 599n106

Han, J. H., 301n79, 305n108, 306

Han, T., 305n107

Han, Y., 511n36

Hancocks, P., 389

Handfield, R., 521n78

Hangsheng, L., 650n185

Hannah, S. T., 479n84, 480n89

Hargis, M. B., 412n92, 604n130

Hargrove, D. F., 638n100

Hargrove, M. B., 638n100, 649n183

Harms, P. D., 144n53, 145n58n64, 464n10

Harold, C. M., 153n114, 579n6, 585n50

Harper, S., 82n17

Harper, Z., 195n108

Harrington, A., 633n66

Harrington, B., 604n125

Harris, J. N., 689n87

Harris, K. J., 397n36, 407n71–73, 410n86

Harris, T. B., 197n136, 567, 585n51n58

Harrison, D. A., 96n106n108–109, 111n9, 114n22, 121n50, 272, 361n16, 364n27, 374n83

Hart, T., 451n91

Hartel, C. E. J., 151n71

Harter, J. K., 561n109n111

Hartke, D. D., 467n19

Hartmann, K., 363n20

Hartnell, C. A., 541n3, 542, 545n17

Hartog, D. N., 144n57

Hartwig, Maria, 192

Harvey, J., 120n42

Harvey, J.-F., 514n49

Harvey, P., 175n10

Haslam, S. A., 328n31

Hasler, B. P., 145n32

Hassan, H., 468n23

Hassard, J., 528n107

Hassard, J. S., 329n40

Hastings, Reed, 477

Hastings, S. E., 373n77

Hatton, Les, 325

Hauenstein, M. A., 143n38

Hauserman, N., 398n49

Hausknecht, J. P., 124n71, 583n31

Hawking, Stephen, 195

Hawver, T. H., 464n9

Haynes, Berneta, 98

Hayward, R., 547n38

He, W., 197n135

Healey, A., 86n63

Heaphy, E., 56n55

Hebl, M., 85n39, 86n57, 88n69, 585n52

Hechanova-Alampay, R., 527n102

Hedges, Kristi, 437

Heimpel, S. A., 153n82

Hekman, D. R., 125n73, 479n83

Helfat, C. E., 510n32

Helft, M., 623n13

Heller, M., 601n119

Hempel, P., 511n36

Henderson, J. E., 690n93

Heng, X., 690n90

Henle, C. A., 481n104

Henn, S., 519

Hennebry, K. A., 188n77

Herath, D., 517n67

Herker, D., 512n41

Hermida, R., 150104–105

Hernandez, A., 363n22, 374n81

Hernandez, M., 470n37

Herper, M., 549n48

Hershcovis, M. S., 331n47

Hershey, J. C., 485n140

Hertel, G., 374n84

Hertlein, Jim, 656

Hertwig, R., 185n55

Herzberg, Frederick, 251–252, 290

Hewlin, P. F., 334n60, 447n82

Heywood, J. S., 302n87

Hezlett, S. A., 485n143

Hideg, I., 685n67

Hiemstra, A. M. F., 581n13

Higgins, A., 148n56

Higgins, C. A., 635n83

Higgins, E. T., 258n45, 396n30

Higgins, M., 677n41

Highhouse, S., 115–116n24, 411n92, 630n52

Hildenbrand, K., 477n74

Hildreth, J. D., 674n32

Hilfer, Alan, 112

Hilfiger, Tommy, 392

Hill, L., 580n12

Hill, N. S., 637n95

Hill, Vernon, 257

Hiller, N. J., 124n71

Hindle, T., 505n4

Hinds, P., 508–509n19

Hinds, P. J., 469n34

Hinings, C. R., 525n98

Hinshaw, A., 689n89

Hirschfeld, R. R., 365n33

Hirst, E. J., 55n51, 582n27

Hirst, G., 197n134, 371n65, 430n20

Hitlin, P., 506n9

Hmieleski, K. M., 185n50

Ho, S. S., 270n98

Hoch, J. E., 361n14

Hochman, G., 304n102

Hochwarter, W. A., 395n23, 400n56, 406n67n69

Hoegl, M., 191n91

Hoeber, I. J., 197n132

Hofer, J., 254n19

Hoffman, B. J., 120n48, 154n118

Hoffman, D. A., 543n7

Hofmann, D. A., 463n4, 546n22, 646n158

Hofmans, J., 109

Hofstede, Geert, 157–159

Hogan, J., 463n7

Hoge, W., 60n62

Holladay, C. L., 96n110

Holland, John, 155n119

Holland, K., 126n76

Hollenbeck, J. R., 95n104, 187n72, 258n38, 362n17–18, 366n34, 375n91, 490n171, 510n33, 515n53

Hollis, A., 93n93

Holman, D., 140n16

Holtz, B. C., 153n114, 579n6, 585n50

Homan, A. C., 95n104, 270n93, 371n61, 670n17

Homburg, C., 407n74

Hon, A. H. Y., 197n137, 626n30

Hong, Y., 677n43

Hoobler, J. M., 85n46

Hoover, Ryan, 373

Hoppenot, Y., 518n68

Hopson, M. C., 451n91

Horner, M. T., 597n101

Hotz, R. L., 138

Hou, L., 338n93

Hou, W., 302n84

House, R. J., 1584n129, 468n22, 471n41, 478n75

House, Robert, 468, 471

Houston, Derrick, 665–666

Howard, D. J., 408n76

Howard, Joy, 570

Howard, Olga, 101

Howard-Greenville, J., 547n37

Howell, A., 546n23

Howell, J. M., 635n83

Ho-Ying Fu, J., 482n120

Hsieh, J. J. P.-A., 197n135

Hsieh, T., 543n11

Hsiung, H.-H., 120n42

Hu, J., 364, 471n39, 482n118, 600n115

Hu, W., 197n128

Huang, G., 298n56

Huang, L., 191n89, 480n93, 559n104

Huang, S.-H., 289n14

Huang, X., 197n135

Huang, Y., 328n32, 338n87, 512n40

Huber, G. P., 505n2, 510n27–29, 513n34, 516–517n44n48n60–62, 524n96

Hüffmeier, J., 684n64, 688n81–82

Hugg, J., 45n28

Hughes, A. M., 375n88, 588n69

Hülshager, U. R., 149n65, 155n99, 634n75n78, 647n163

Humberd, B., 604n125

Humphrey, R. H., 118n32, 155n103, 464n9

Humphrey, S., 360n11

Humphrey, S. E., 36n4, 95n104, 118n30, 187n72, 288n3, 365n31n34n37, 366n41, 367, 375n91, 463n2, 526n88, 514n53

Hung, J., 644n137

Huning, T. M., 647n161

Hunter, E. M., 297n44

Hunter, J., 583n33

Hur, Y., 151n77

Hurst, A., 120n40

Hurst, C., 141n21, 164, 482n110, 684n58

Husock, H., 582n28

Hussain, I., 597n98

Huston, T., 188n76

Hutchens, S. A., 326n30

Huy, Q. N., 624n21, 625n26n28

Hyatt, D. E., 364n24, 370n54

Hymowitz, C., 579n4

I

Iaconi, G. D., 331

Ifshin, Chloe, 454

Ilgen, D. R., 362n17, 372n74, 514n33

Ilie, A., 120

Ilies, R., 121n51, 92n63, 125n121, 126n132–133, 128n140, 464, 465n13n15, 398n49, 490n60, 644n115, 648n146

Iliescu, D., 226

Ion, A., 120

Ireland, R. D., 528n93

Irvin, Michael, 454

Isaacson, W., 46n36

Isen, A. M., 113n43, 125n107n119, 673n24–25

Isidore, C., 301n70

Isnardi, Christina, 611

Ispas, D., 120

Ito, T. A., 140n15

Iwata, Satoru, 182

J

Jackson, C. L., 261n65–66, 271n103, 370n55, 371n57, 639n103

Jackson, T. A., 159n130

Jacobs, G., 525n80, 606n134, 626n33

Jacquart, P., 471n42, 473n45n48

Jaffe, E., 54n49, 109n21

Jaklic, M., 635n86

James, LeBron, 92, 366, 392

James, L. R., 139n13

Jamieson, S. D., 123n101

Janardhanan, N. S., 373n76

Janis, I. L., 341n103

Janiszewski, C., 185n53

Jansen, K. J., 556n90

Janssen, O., 623n19

Janssen, Ryan, 129

Jaramillo, J. F., 559n101

Jargon, J., 525n75

Javidan, M., 158n129, 466n16

Jay, J., 633n64

Jay-Z, 392

Jefferson, Brad, 491

Jehn, K. A., 313, 339n97, 469n5–6, 667n10, 668, 669n13

Jensen, J. M., 61n95, 267n82

Jentzsch, I., 382

Jermier, J. M., 487n161, 543n10

Jerneic, Z., 584n37

Jetten, J., 321n2, 335n69

Jhun, S., 426n5

Jia, L., 372n69, 634–635n81

Jiang, K., 129n75, 600n115

Jiang, Ping, 390

Jin, J., 151n75

Jinseok, S., 669n15

Jobs, Steven P., 69, 195, 536

John, Daymond, 83

John, O. P., 138n11

Johnson, A., 149n64

Johnson, A. B., 429n16

Johnson, B., 494

Johnson, D. E., 472–473n47

Johnson, E. C., 156n125, 545n18

Johnson, J. L., 547n41

Johnson, Lyndon B., 98

Johnson, M. D., 121, 375n91

Johnson, P. D., 546n27

Johnson, R. C., 143–144n46

Johnson, R. E., 118n34, 258n46–47, 264n76, 481n102, 403n62, 603, 641n120

Johnson, T. D., 87n67

Jokisaari, M., 645n149

Joly, Hubert, 259

Jonas, K., 476n62

Jonason, P. K., 144n54, 146n74

Jondle, D., 559n100

Jones, C., 557n94

Jones, Carl, 425

Jones, J. R., 253n13

Jones, K. S., 110n7, 122n93

Jones, L. M., 543n7

Jooa, J. L., 154n87–88

Jordan, M. H., 365n33

Jose, I. J., 151n106

Josefy, M., 528n93

Joseph, D. L., 191n73n75, 143n41, 375n88, 583n35, 588n69

Jose Saez-Martinez, F., 368

Joshi, A., 85n44, 87n67, 367n43–44, 368

Joshi, M., 321n12

Judge, T. A., 120n46, 124n63, 147n48, 157n121, 158n132–133, 137n5, 141n21, 143n40, 146n77, 147n78, 152n110, 164, 255n4, 261n65–66, 364, 464, 465n13n14, 405n57, 478n77–78, 684n58, 626n39, 647n133

Juillerat, T., 287n1, 290n15

Jung, E. J., 668n7

Junqi, S., 149n92

Jussila, I., 288n5

Juster, R.-P., 644n142

K

Kacmar, K. M., 482n119, 397n36, 407n71–73, 410n86

Kagitçibasi, C. E., 333n55

Kahn, R. L., 326n24–25

Kahneman, Daniel, 101

Kaiser, R. B., 463n7

Kalanick, Travis, 461

Kalish, Y., 647n170

Kalkhoff, W., 333n57

Kalou, Z., 558n99

Kamdar, D., 152n109, 463n5

Kammer, J. E., 340n101

Kammeyer-Mueller, J. D., 117n63, 555n85, 643n133

Kandola, Binna, 127

Kane, J. S., 180n30

Kane, K., 149n94

Kane, R., 395

Kanfer, R., 149n98, 264n76

Kang, S. K., 581n14

Kansara, S., 121n52

Kanthak, J., 363n20

Kantrowitz, T. M., 149n98

Kaplan, Ron, 491

Kaplan, S. N., 160n139, 142n29

Kappas, Arvid, 138

Kappel, B., 194n103

Kaptein, M., 546n28–29

Karabell, Z., 43n21

Karakowsky, L., 262n69

Karau, S. J., 336n77n79n80

Karlgård, Rich, 46n34, 357n1, 368n50–52, 369

Karmin, C., 51n39

Karpen, I. O., 53n47

Kase, R., 395n21

Kashy, D. A., 448n87

Kasuku, J., 437

Katerberg, R., 321n10

Kato, M., 321n5

Katsamanis, A., 438n61

Kauflin, J., 37n2

Kaufman, Lindsey, 533

Kaufman, Micha, 535

Kay, A. C., 180

Kazmer, M. M., 324n19

Kearney, E., 374n86

Keating, Caroline, 51

Keegan, A., 626n33

Kehoe, R. R., 600n113

Keith, N., 634n76

Kelkar, A., 531n103

Keller, K., 551n59

Kellermanns, F. W., 404n66

Kelley, H. H., 175n12–13, 176

Kelley, K., 482n110

Kelln, B. R. C., 270n100

Kelloway, E. K., 644n141

Kelly, J., 307n118–119

Kendrick, K. M., 328n32

Kennedy, J. C., 603n108

Kenny, E. J., 80n11

Kenrick, D. T., 148n58

Kepes, S., 321n12, 600n111

Kerin, R. A., 408n76

Kern, M. C., 183n39

Kerr, N. L., 335n74, 343n113

Kerr, S., 487n161

Kerr, Steven, 277

Kessler, A., 431n26

Kessler, S. R., 134

Khan, A. K., 160n138

Khazanchi, S., 634n73

Kiefer, T., 685

Kierein, N. M., 180n28–29

Kiesler, S., 512–513n19

Kiewitz, C., 160n137, 406n67n69

Kilduff, G. J., 682n53, 685n66

Kilduff, M., 147n84, 393n16

Killeen, M. B., 86n60

Kim, E., 153n83–84

Kim, J., 635n90

Kim, K., 96n107, 157n126

Kim, K. H., 195n109

Kim, P. H., 485n135n139

Kim, S., 301n79, 305, 306, 647n167

Kim, T., 197n133, 368n46

Kim, U. E., 333n55

Kim, Y., 152n109, 591n85

King, E. B., 85n39, 57n73

King, L., 142n22, 125n112n114

King, Martin Luther, 98

King, Z., 395n21

Kinicki, A., 541n3, 542

Kinicki, A. J., 545n17, 623n18, 637n96

Kirk, A. K., 253n14

Kirk-Brown, A., 546n23

Kirkendol, S. E., 448n87

Kirkman, B. L., 96n107, 158n128, 476n69

Kisamore, J. L., 137n6

Kish-Gephart, J. J., 123n61

Kitagawa, Hidekazu, 686

Kitsantonis, N., 52n45

Klebanov, M. M., 160, 142n29

Klein, H. J., 258n38, 648–649n174–175

Klein, K. J., 86n61, 338n88

Klein, K. W., 640n116

Klein, N., 192n92–95

Kleingeld, A., 257n33, 258n39

Kleinmann, M., 584n44

Klotz, A. C., 360n8, 367n39, 373n78, 669n12n14

Kluemper, D. H., 121n81, 137n9, 144n48

Knebi, Chuck, 61

Knight, A. P., 338n88

Koch, A. J., 84n38

Koch, Charles, 608

Koenig, A. M., 487n159

Koh, C., 599n108

Koh, Y., 45n26

Kohles, J. C., 487n153n155

Kolbe, M., 373n75

Kolokinsky, R. W., 400

Kong, D. T., 689n86

König, C. J., 583n36

Konrad, A. M., 600n110

Konradt, U., 374n84

Koo, R. C., 307n120

Kooij-de Bode, H. J. M., 124n111

Koole, S. L., 153n80n85

Korn, M., 52n43, 437n55

Korsgaard, A. M., 288n4

Korsgaard, M. A., 349

Korytkowski, Elizabeth Wright, 286

Kostova, T., 326n28

Kotkin, J., 297n43

Kotrba, L. M., 544n15

Kotter, John, 628–629n48

Kotter, J. P., 548n44

Kovacic, M. P., 584n37

Kovalenko, Maria, 393

Kovjanic, S., 476n62

Kowalski, K. B., 589n75

Kozłowski, S. W. J., 361n14, 372n74

Kraatz, M. S., 624n21, 625n28

Kraiger, K., 83n24, 590n80–81, 591

Kram, K. E., 485n141

Kramar, R., 398n46–47

Kramer, A.-C., 194n103

Kranz, G., 553n75

Krause, N., 300n69

Kraut, A. I., 38n11

Kraut, R. E., 426n4

Kray, Laura, 685n66, 688–689n83

Krettenauer, T., 139n12

Kring, A. M., 148n54

Krings, F., 399n53

Krisk, S. D., 408n81

Kristiansen, M. B., 259n53

Kristof-Brown, A. E., 476n66

Kristof-Brown, A. L., 156n125, 545n18

Krizan, Z., 84n33, 174n7, 343n111

Kruglanski, A. W., 396n30

Krumm, S., 363n20

Kruse, K., 441n66

Kuban, S., 528n93

Kubicek, B., 639n107

Kudisch, J. D., 392n11

Kuenzi, M., 56n59, 546n24, 559n102

Kühberger, A., 186n64

Kulik, C. T., 80n9, 50n17, 262n72, 270–271n101, 687n79

Kumar, N., 511n13

Kundu, P., 328n36, 329n37

Kupfer Schneider, A., 689n89

Kuvaas, B., 591n87

Kwan, H. K., 195–196n115

Kwoh, L., 95n101, 427n55, 582n20, 590n77

Kwon, K. J., 389

Kwong, J. Y. Y., 186n58, 596n96

L

Labedo, O. J., 406n70

Labianca, G., 429n17

Labroo, A. A., 673n24–25

Lacy, P., 547n38

Laham, S. M., 178n20

Lahneman, B., 547n37

Lam, S. S. K., 477n73, 480n95, 483n124

Lam, W., 470n30

Lambert, L. S., 545n17

Lamborghini, Ferruccio, 393

Lambrechts, F., 630n54

Lanaj, K., 258n46, 362n17, 514n33, 603

Landells, E., 390n4

Landis, B., 144n49

Lando, A.L., 323n14

Lang, J. W. B., 139n65, 123n99, 626n40, 647n163

Lange, D., 482n114

Lange, T., 121n57

Langer, E., 131

Langfred, C. W., 360n7

Laninge, Niklas, 194

Lanivich, S. E., 582n21

Lant, T. K., 556n88

Lanzara, G. F., 550n54

Lapierre, L. M., 297n49, 604n129

LaReau, J., 295n36

Larkin, I., 277

Larraza-Kintana, M., 305n106

Larrick, R. P., 185n49, 683n56

Larsen, R. J., 143n31

Laschinger, H. K. S., 589n72

Lasio, D., 89n81, 91n86

Latham, Gary, 256n28–29, 275

Laursen, K., 515n39

Lavoie, A., 404

Lawson, Lance, 679–680

Leary, K., 687n74

LeBoeuf, R. A., 181n32

LeBreton, J. M., 331n46, 463n7

Lechner, C., 404n66

Lee, C., 298n56, 373n79, 475n11

Lee, F. K., 149n95

Lee, J., 197n133, 257n34, 368n46

Lee, J. J., 145n40

Lee, K., 159n136

Lee, L., 292n24

Lee, S., 304n99, 668n7

Lee, T. H., 125n74

Lee, Y., 155n120

Lee, Y.-T., 121n49

Lee Myung-bak, 388

Lehman, Jake, 100

Lehmann-Willenbrock, N., 431n30

Lei, L., 679n48

Leiponen, A., 514n32

Leising, D., 137n1

Leiter, M. P., 589n72

Lelieveld, G., 684n65, 685n70

Lemmon, G., 85n46

Lemoine, G. L., 121n52

Lens, W., 196n119

Lentz, E., 485n147

Lentz, Tim, 100

Leonard, A. S., 321n10

Leonardelli, G. J., 178n24, 487n157–158

Leonardi, P., 427n7

Leong, J. L. T., 411n90

Lepak, D. P., 600n114–115

LePine, J. A., 113n18, 120n42, 270n97, 272n108n110–111, 370n55, 371n57, 376n93, 415–416n125n128–129, 639n103–105, 642n129

LePine, M. A., 639n103–104

Lepisto, L. R., 116n25

Leroy, H., 479n85–86

Lescornez, Philippe, 561

Leslie, L. M., 551n59

Lester, S. W., 349

Leung, A., 156n122

Leung, K., 270n98

Levashina, J., 408n82

Leventhal, G. S., 268n87

Levine, Julie, 295

Levine, S., 111n31, 469

Levine, T. R., 448n86

Levitt, S. D., 192n100

Levitt, Steven, 67

Levitz, J., 81

Levy, F., 506n11

Levy, P., 91n85

Levy, P. E., 598n102

Lewicki, R., 678n46

Lewin, K., 627n46

Lewis, G. J., 321n13

Lewis, Michael, 278

Lewis, M. W., 633n62

Li, A., 142n26, 482n112

Li, A. N., 470n38

Li, N., 197n136, 476n69, 563

Li, W.-D., 148n87

Li, Y., 677n42

Lian, H., 124n66, 390n5

Liang, C., 308n129

Liang, J., 113n17

Liang, S.-G., 155n102, 157n123

Liao, C., 482n115

Liao, H., 197n130, 470n38, 672n20

Lichtenstein, D. R., 121n53

Lickel, B., 321n9

Liden, R. C., 471n34n39, 482n115n118

Lidogoster, H., 677n39

Lieb, R., 644n145

Lieberman, Charles, 132

Liechti, S., 481n101

Lienhardt, N., 586n57

Liersch, M. J., 185n48

Lievens, F., 429n15, 584n45–47

Li Hongfei, 179

Lim, S., 331n49

Lin, H.-M., 156n110

Lin, L.-H., 551n63

Lin, M., 410

Lin, S., 338n87

Lin, S.-H., 481n102

Lin, Z., 307n118–119

Lindsell, C. J., 84n34

Ling, Y., 477n70

Linski, C. M., 298n62

Lipman, J., 431n33

Lipponen, J., 398n43

Lips-Miersma, M., 564n119

Liptak, A., 89n75

Litwiller, B., 644n143

Liu, C., 643n136

Liu, D., 125n75, 197n130, 470n37

Liu, H., 157n120

Liu, L. A., 687n75

Liu, M., 687n77

Liu, W., 176–177n16, 677n43

Liu, X., 470n35

Liu, Y., 403n62, 410n88, 516n40

Livingston, B. A., 164, 684n58

Llorens, S., 260n60

Lloyd, G. C., 252n9

Locander, W. B., 559n101

Locke, C. C., 688–689n83

Locke, Edwin, 256n29–30, 275, 627n47

Lockwood, A., 485n148

Lockwood, N. R., 113n20

Lodwick, Terry, 286

Loewenstein, G., 158n128

Logel, C., 80n10

Lohr, S., 46n32

Lohse, O., 137n1

Loi, R., 197n130

Lok, P., 543n9

Long, D. M., 149n63

Long, L., 301n78

Long, R. J., 308n127

Lootens, H., 149n93n97

Lopez, P. N., 464n11

Lopez, S. J., 141n18

Lopez-Kidwell, V., 260n56, 429n17

Lorinkova, N. M., 297n44

Lorsch, Jay, 304

Lount, R. B. Jr., 336n75, 337n83

Lount, R. J., 364n26

Lovewell, D., 307n122

Lovewell-Tuck, Debbie, 129

Lowe, C., 521n79

Lowe, K. B., 488

Lowrey, A., 52n41

Loyd, D. L., 338n91

Lubatkin, M. H., 477n70

Lublin, J. S., 427n9

Luciano, M. M., 362n19

Ludwig, S., 184n47

Luk, D. M., 96n106n109

Luke, Jacob, 305

Lukits, A., 190n84

Lumineau, F., 690n93

Luna-Arocas, R., 600n109

Luo, Y., 512n40

Luria, G., 44, 647n170

Luthans, Fred, 40–41, 40n15, 55n54, 308n162, 479n82

Lyons, B. J., 582n26

Lytle, T., 442n68

Lyubomirsky, S., 142n22, 157n112n114

M

Ma, J., 481n102

Ma, Pony, 304

Macey, W. H., 114n21, 544n4n19

Machiavelli, Niccolo, 144

MacKenzie, S. B., 120n47

Mackey, J. D., 481n105n107n109

Macy, M. W., 143n35, 145, 146, 143n7

Maddux, W. W., 138n8

Madera, J. M., 585n52

Madhani, Amreen, 285–286

Madison, K., 175n10

Madjar, N., 157n115

Maeriac, J. P., 120n48

Maertz, C. P., 198n139, 604n128

Magee, J. C., 679n47

Magley, V. J., 331n49

Mahon, Lisa, 319–320

Mai, K. M., 326n21

Maio, G. R., 152n111

Majchrzak, A., 361n15

Malhotra, A., 361n15

Malik, S. H., 468n23

Mallory, G. R., 428n13

Maloney, M. M., 469n36

Maltby, E., 583n30

Mandela, Nelson, 120

Manegold, J. G., 78n7

Maner, J. K., 398n41

Mannix, E., 338n94

Mannix, E. A., 374n80, 677n38

Mannor, M. J., 367n41

Manson, T. M., 137n6

Manstead, A. S. R., 126n125, 690n92

Manwell, L. A., 153n82

Marcario, Rose, 571

Marcchione, Sergio, 635

Marcelo, Sheila, 156

March, J. G., 182n34

Marchand, A., 644, 644n142

Marcus, A. A., 547n40

Margerison, C., 367n42

Margolis, J. D., 398n44

Marinova, S. V., 463n5

Mark, M. M., 446n77

Markham, S. E., 308n128

Marques, C., 195n114

Marr, J. C., 587n60

Marshall, T. R., 604n131

Martens, M. L., 62n66

Martin, Al, 411

Martin, J., 543n8

Martin, Jill, 494

Martin, R., 396n29

Martinko, M., 160n137, 175n10

Martocchio, J. J., 298n54

Marvin Ellison, 488

Maslach, C., 342n107

Maslow, Abraham, 250–251n4

Massenkoff, M., 144n51

Masson, T., 331n44

Masuda, T., 138n8

Mathe, K., 546n27

Mather, M., 147n53

Matheson, C., 39n12–13

Mathieu, J., 359n4, 378

Mathieu, J. E., 362n19, 371n58

Matousek, A., 331

Matsuura, M., 321n5

Matta, F. K., 684n59

Matthews, R. A., 145n41, 642n127

Mattila, A. S., 63n67

Mattke, S., 650n185

Maurer, R., 96n105

Mauss, I. B., 154n91

Mawritz, M., 476n63, 481n103

Maxfield, M., 473n50

Maxham J. G. III, 121n53

Mayer, D. M., 24n59, 156n124, 480n94, 482n117, 559n102

Mayer, Marissa, 295, 296, 297

Mayer, R. C., 483n123

Mayer, S. E., 188n79

Maynard, D. C., 145n59n63

Maynard, M. T., 359n4

Maynes, T. D., 431n32

Mayo, M., 473n51

Mazei, J., 688n81–82

Mazerolle, M. D., 139n13

Mazzola, J. J., 644n140

McAfee, George, 585

McBey, K., 262n69

McCall, Ginger, 132

McCance, A. S., 110n7, 154n93

McCann, D., 367n42

McCann, L., 528n107

McCarthy, D., 306n111

McCarthy, D. J., 565n124

McCaul, K. D., 142n26

McClelland, David, 252–254n11, 414

McCord, M. A., 142n28, 149n41

McCormick, B. W., 331n43, 367n40

McDaniel, Jonathan, 126

McDermott, Bill, 479

McDonald, Ian, 540

McDonald, Robert, 259

McDonnell, S. R., 598

McEvoy, G. M., 291n17

McFarland, L. A., 408n81, 584n42

McGinley, Frances, 494

McGinnis, E., 188n79

McGrane, V., 52n40

McIlroy, Rory, 366

McIntyre, D. A., 300n68

McKay, P. F., 84n52, 86n56, 125n75

McKee, G. H., 308n128

McKenna, D. D., 38n11

McKenzie, C. R. M., 185n48

McLarty, B. D., 137n9, 144n48

McLean, B., 414

McLellan, Jamie, 202

McMillon, Doug, 655

McNamara, G., 186n59

McNeill, I. M., 256n27

Mecevic, Mefit “Mike,” 558

Mechlinks, Joe, 120

Meglino, B. M., 288n4

Mehl, M. S., 143n32

Mehra, A., 321n10

Meier, L. L., 642n124–125, 645n150

Meinert, D., 38n8–10, 24n60, 115n46, 145n66, 637n93

Melchers, K. G., 584n44, 586n57

Meloy, M. G., 182n36

Melwani, S., 198n138

Menegatti, M., 447n79

Mennecke, B. E., 335n73

Menon, T., 482n120

Menzel, A. J., 398n41

Mercer, M., 526

Mercurio, Z. A., 112n13

Merkulova, N., 584n44

Mertins, V., 302n88

Merz, A.-S., 583n36

Mesco, M., 523n92

Meserve, R. J., 191n90

Mesmer-Magnus, J. R., 372n73, 674n30

Mesquita, B., 328n34

Metallinou, A., 438n61

Meyer, A. H., 644n145

Meyer, C. J., 365n31n37, 366

Meyer, J. P., 159n130

Meyer, R. D., 150n104–105, 151n106

Meyerson, D. E., 434n42

Miao, C., 118n32

Michalcova, S., 632n60

Michel, A., 637n93

Michel, J. S., 604n130

Miggo, Steve, 561

Mihelich, M., 561n110

Miles, E., 154n89

Milkman, K. L., 646n158

Milkovich, G. T., 301n72

Millan, Yaima, 118

Millar, E., 194n107

Miller, B. K., 267n81

Miller, E. L., 341n104

Miller, George, 369

Miller, J. G., 506n8

Miller, S., 301n74–75

Miller, T. L., 37n6

Milliken, F. J., 447n80n82

Milliman, J. F., 552n68

Minbaeva, D., 395n21

Miner, J. B., 42n18

Miners, C. T. H., 464n11

Minton-Eversole, T., 587n63

Mintz, David, 84

Mintzberg, Henry, 39

Miquelon, P., 648n173

Mirabito, A. M., 650n184

Miranda, Steven, 656

Mirza, B., 637n98

Misangyi, V. F., 472–473n47

Mishra, A. K., 521n82

Mistler, S. A., 323n14

Mitchell, A. A., 487n159

Mitchell, J. A., 559n100

Mitchell, M. S., 271n102

Mitchell, T. R., 125n73, 250n7

Mithel, M., 55n53

Miyamoto, Y., 411n91

Moag, J. F., 269n90

Mobley, W. H., 463n6

Moffitt, K. R., 186n66

Mogilner, C., 260n55

Mohammed, S., 368n47, 372n71, 551n32

Mohan, P., 621n9

Mohanty, S. N., 156n109

Molleman, E., 410n85

Moloney, L., 518n69

Mondejar, R., 432n34

Monga, V., 45n25

Monin, P., 565n125

Montag, T., 198n139

Montes, C., 673n26

Moon, H., 187n72, 366n34, 463n5, 519n53

Moore, C., 177n35, 427n10, 389n2

Moore, D. A., 182, 678n44

Moore, H., 604n131

Moore, S. E., 446n77

Morag, I., 44

Morgan, B. B., 323

Morgan, J., 510n26

Morgenson, G., 185n56

Morgeson, F. P., 36n4, 118n30, 288n3, 367n41

Mori, Ikuo, 686

Moriyasu, Isao, 182

Morozov, E., 45n22, 14n37

Morris, J., 528n107

Morris, M. A., 86n56

Morris, M. W., 473n49, 684n61

Morrison, E. W., 447n80–82

Morrison, R., 124n66

Mortinussen, M., 643n135

Morton, L. C., 148

Mosakowski, E., 635n84

Moscoso, S., 583n34

Moses, Jarrod, 556–557

Moskowitz, J. T., 154n97

Mount, M. K., 137n5, 142n25, 143n44, 584n39, 594n93

Mozur, P., 436n50, 437n56–57

Mueller, J. S., 198n138
Mueller, P. A., 434n39
Mulki, J. P., 559n101
Mullainathan, S., 86n54
Mullens, A. B., 142n26
Mumford, M. D., 93n96
Munsch, C. L., 295n34
Munson, Michelle, 491
Munyon, T. P., 397n34
Munz, D. C., 153n86, 157n113
Murnane, R. J., 506n11
Murnieks, C. Y., 635n84
Muros, J. P., 157n122
Murphy, M. C., 81n13, 181n8
Murray, A., 513n45
Musch, J., 187n73
Mutch, A., 524n95
Muthuri, L., 323n14
Mycoskie, Blake, 147
Myer, A. T., 547n32
Myers, B., 156n108

N

Nadella, Satya, 489
Nafziger, J., 184n47
Nagarajan, N. J., 487n154
Nagengast, B., 262n68
Nahrgang, J. D., 36n4, 128n30, 143n39, 288n3, 463n2, 475n60–61, 478n79, 490n171
Naik, G., 52n46
Nakajima, C., 119–120n39
Nandkeolyar, A. K., 142n26, 482n12
Naquin, C. E., 376n92
Narayanan, S., 438n61

Nash, John Forbes, 196

Nauman, S., 473n53

Neale, M. A., 350, 353, 373

Neeley, T., 427n7

Neff, N. L., 143n42, 195n112, 196n123, 197n129

Nelissen, P. T. J. H., 86n64

Nelson, D. L., 564n106, 649n183

Nelson, P. E., 447n83

Nerstad, C. G. L., 196n122

Nesterkin, D. A., 626n34

Netemeyer, R. G., 121n53

Neuberg, S. L., 148n58, 323n14

Neubert, M. J., 482n119

Newman, D. A., 111n9, 114n22, 151n73n75, 145n62, 272n113, 583n35

Newman, G. E., 120n43–45

Newman, J. M., 301n72

Ng, K.-Y., 599n108

Ng, T. W. H., 83n25–27, 84n32, 88n70, 142n23, 480n90–91

Nguyen, H., 149n64

Ni, N., 522n85n87

Nicas, J., 564

Nichols, E., 427n11

Nicklin, J. M., 255n23, 258n44

Niederhoffer, K., 429n16

Nieminen, L. R. G., 550n52

Nifadkar, S. S., 668n9

Nijstad, B. A., 157n117, 195n110

Nils, F., 154n94

Nisbett, R. E., 91n87

Nishi, L. H., 147n79

Nishii, L. H., 677n41, 600n114

Nitttrouer, C. L., 88n69

Niu, Q., 647n167

Niu, X., 298n56
Nixon, A. E., 644n140
Nixon, D. R., 197n131
Nocera, J., 266n77
Nohe, C., 642n125
Noorderhavin, N., 565n125
Norton, J., 300n69
Norton, S., 446n74
Nosek, Brian, 199
Nunez, N., 156n108
Nunner-Winkler, G., 139n12
Nyberg, A. J., 123n60, 579n9
Nye, C. D., 110n7, 154n93

O

Oaks, Nathaniel T., 388
Obama, Barack, 472, 405
O’Boyle, E. H., 151n75, 144n55, 146n71–72
O’Brian, Ken, 275
O’Brien, K. E., 118n33
O’Brien, K. R., 88n69
Oc, B., 427n10, 389n2
O’Connor, K. M., 158n127
O’Day, B., 86n60
Odean, Terrance, 185
Odira, P. R., 323n14
Odle-Dusseau, H. N., 587n62
O’Driscoll, M. P., 638n99
Ogunfowora, B., 480n98
Oh, H., 147n84
Oh, I., 584n39
Oh, I.-S., 148n27, 149n37, 163n126
Ohlott, P. J., 256n26

Ohly, S., 150n68, 639n107

O’Keefe, P. A., 124n62

Oldham, G. R., 125n115, 287n2, 510n7

O’Leary-Kelly, A. M., 333n52

O’Leary, Michael, 610

Olekalns, M., 686n71, 687n79

Oliver, Vicky, 417

Olson, J. M., 152n111

O’Neill, H., 582n24

O’Neill, T. A., 365n36, 373n77

Ong, M., 258n42

Oppenheimer, D. M., 434n39

Oppenheimer, M., 563n117

Ordóñez, L. D., 258n43

Oreg, S., 553n49, 625n29, 626n31n37

O’Regan, E., 604–605n132

O’Reilly, C. A., 541n2, 544n14

O’Reilly, J., 642n122

Orth, U., 146n76

Örtqvist, D., 644n147

Osawa, J., 436n50, 437n56–57

Osburn, H. G., 298n61

Osorio, Guisell, 76

Osterloh, Bernd, 299

Ostroff, C., 545n21

Ou, A. Y., 541n3, 542

Ouratulain, S., 160n138

Overholt, A., 95n100

Ovide, S., 434n38

Owens, B. P., 479n83

P

Paauwe, J., 601n118

Pachur, T., 185n55

Paetzold, R. L., 54n62

Pager, Devah, 608

Paine, J. B., 120n47

Pajo, K., 292n24

Pan, C., 447n81

Pan, Y.-C., 289n14

Panaccio, A., 555n86

Paramore, Hannah, 491

Parboteeah, K. P., 197n91

Park, G., 341n105

Park, H., 41n17

Park, J. K., 258n40

Park, J. S., 89n74

Park, M., 389

Park, S., 470n33

Park, T.-Y., 61n63

Park, Y., 647n167n171

Parker, K. N., 145n61

Parker, S. C., 635n85

Parker, S. K., 195n111

Park Guen-hye, 387–388

Parks, K., 510n34

Parks, L., 303n90–91, 304n97

Parry, E., 154n117

Parsons, C. K., 121n52

Partyka, J., 144n54, 146n74

Pastor, J. C., 473n51

Patel, P. C., 93n95, 267n82, 339n99

Patel, Sujan, 540

Paterson, T. A., 480n93, 559n104

Pathak, P. J., 148n89

Patriotta, G., 550n54

Patterson, F., 584n47

Patton, G. K., 120n46

Paul, A. M., 261n67, 301n77

Paulhus, D. L., 687n78

Paustian-Underdahl, S. C., 84n36, 521n81

Payne, S. C., 546n26, 554n84, 597n101

Pearce, C. L., 472n46, 487n153n155

Pearce, Erica, 432

Pearsall, M. J., 626n42

Pearson, A. W., 156n123

Pearson, C., 159

Pearson, J. C., 447n83

Peccei, R., 625n27

Pedersen, T., 511n39

Pedigo, P. R., 38n11

Peeters, H., 584n45

Peeters, M. C. W., 297n49

Pendleton, A., 306n112

Peng, A. C., 480n95, 483n124, 681n51, 594n94

Penke, L., 145n38

Penner, L. A., 401–402n59

Pentland, Alex, 46

Pereira, D., 644n144

Pereira, G. M., 298n61

Perman, S., 392n12

Perrewe, P. L., 344n115, 403n61

Perry, S. J., 297n44

Perry, S. P., 175n8

Perry-Smith, J. E., 197n126, 515n38

Peters, L. H., 467n19

Peters, M., 52n44

Peters, Tom, 127

Peterson, R. S., 374n80, 671n19, 677n38

Peterson, S. J., 482n114

Petes, Peter, 602

Petty, R. E., 110n6, 444n71, 446n76, 395, 3n25

Pfarrer, M. D., 306n114

Pfeffer, J., 401n58

Phillips, J. M., 579n2

Phillips, K. W., 178n24, 338n91n95, 487n157–158

Piazza, J., 175n9

Picascia, S., 142n24

Piccolo, R. F., 270n97, 289n7, 370n55, 371n57, 464, 465n13n14, 473n57, 478n77–78

Pierce, B., 559n103

Pierce, J. L., 288n5

Pierce, L., 277

Pierro, A., 396n30

Pieterse, A. N., 371n59

Pillemer, J., 687n74

Pina e Cunha, M., 564n121

Pinneker, L., 647n160

Pisano, G. P., 522n89

Pitesa, M., 397n39

Ployhart, R. E., 123n60, 124n72, 579n9, 591n85

Podsakoff, N. P., 639n103

Podsakoff, P. M., 120n47, 431n32

Poelmans, S. A. Y., 644n138

Pohlmann, J. T., 467n19

Pollack, J. M., 464n9

Polman, E., 342n107

Polzer, J. T., 334n61n63, 551n57

Poole, E., 562n113

Poole, M. S., 425n1

Poortvliet, P. M., 641

Popken, B., 399n51

Poppe, M., 391n8

Porat, R., 154n90n92

Porath, C., 159, 588–589n70

Porcelli, A. J., 187n68

Poropat, A. E., 142n24

Porter, C., 52n43

Porter, C. O. L. H., 626n41

Porter, S., 448n88

Post, C., 372n70

Postlethwaite, B. E., 360n8, 367n39, 373n78, 669n12n14

Postmes, T., 642n121

Poteet, M. L., 392n11

Potocnik, K., 194n100, 633n70–71, 634n80

Poverny, L. M., 142n24

Powell, G. N., 85n50

Pozzi, Alberto, 611

Pozzoli, D., 289n13

Pratt, M. G., 157n115, 183n43, 561n95

Prefontaine, Steve, 556

Prem, R., 639n107

Pressman, S. D., 141n18

Price, Dan, 300

Price, K. H., 374n83

Priem, R. L., 302n84

Priola, V., 89n81, 91n86

Privault, C., 518n68

Probst, Robert, 529

Probst, T. M., 298n54

Prouska, R., 625n25

Prum, Eric, 529

Prussia, G. E., 623n18, 637n96

Pucik, V., 626n39

Puffer, S. M., 565n124

Pugh, S. D., 551n58

Pullen, A., 400
Pullig, C., 154
Purdic-Vaughns, V. J., 178n23
Purnell, N., 436n50, 437n56–57
Purvanova, R. K., 37n5
Purvis, K. L., 84n35
Putin, Vladimir, 521
Pyrillis, R., 549n50

Q

Qi, J., 196n120
Qian, S., 118n32
Qian, Z., 177n18
Quattrone, John, 623
Queenan, J., 431n28
Quinn, R., 56n55, 479n82
Quinn, R. P., 326n23–24
Quiñones, M. A., 96n113
Quirk, Peter, 432
Qureshi, I., 470n32

R

Raab, M., 367
Rafaeli, A., 557n95–96
Rafferty, A. E., 625n24, 640n114
Raghuram, S., 470n35
Ragins, B. R., 86n56
Rahim, M. A., 673n27–29, 681n50
Raineri, Ellen, 55
Raja, U., 403n64
Ramirez-Marin, J., 687n76
Rampbell, C., 595n95
Ransdell, E., 556n87
Rapoport, A., 337n81n83

Rapp, T., 359n4

Rathblott, Ruth, 492

Rauthmann, J. F., 144n52

Raven, B., 391n6–7n9

Raver, J. L., 93n98, 267n82

Ravlin, E. C., 326n22, 431n25

Ray, Rachael, 530

Raymark, P. H., 179n24, 584n41

Raymund, P., 482n108

Read, S. J., 175n11

Reade, C., 326n28

Reagan, Ronald, 472

Reay, T., 521n83

Reb, J., 214n14, 303n95

Rebar, A. L., 221n52

Reddy, S., 221n51, 229n105, 254, 647n165

Ree, M. J., 95n104

Reed, B., 320

Reeves, E., 306n111

Rego, A., 195n113, 564n121

Reich, T. C., 332n46

Reiche, B. S., 121n49

Reicher, S., 328n30

Reilly, G., 268n85, 579n9

Reilly, P., 689n89

Reimer, T., 340n100

Reineke, Kristen, 643

Reinhard, M.-A., 216n25

Ren, H., 677n40

Ren, L. R., 87n63

Renn, R. W., 647n161

Rentzelas, P., 328n32, 333n55

Resick, C. J., 145n70, 476n63, 480n92

Restuborg, S. L. D., 482n108

Reyna, C., 177n18

Reynolds, G., 194n104

Rhee, S.-Y., 426n5

Rhoades, L., 113n16

Rhodes, C., 400n55

Rice, D. B., 183n39

Rice, Mike, 270

Rich, B. L., 113n18, 261n65–66, 270n97, 272n108n110–111, 639n105, 642n129

Richard, O. C., 95n106

Richardson, A. M., 643n135

Richardson, H. A., 427n8

Richardson, K. M., 646n159, 647n164, 649n182

Richardson, N., 342n107

Richeson, J. A., 86n58, 338n94

Richmond, F. L., 197n130

Richter, A. W., 197n124n133, 371n65

Ricks, T. E., 481

Rico, R., 339n97

Ridgeway, C. L., 295n34

Riemer, M., 548n43

Ries, Eric, 548n47

Riggio, R. E., 464n12

Rigoglioso, M., 338n89

Rimé, B., 228n94

Rink, F., 364n26

Rinne, T., 197n126

Rioux, S. M., 402n59

Riper, T. V., 374n85

Rivkin, W., 224n67

Robbins, J. M., 270n96

Robbins, S. P., 183n45

Robert, C., 142n32, 298n54

Roberts, B., 436n46, 591n82

Roberts, J. A., 482n119

Roberts, L. M., 56n55

Robins, R. W., 88n69, 146n76

Robinson, A., 298n63, 306n113

Robinson, Jackie, 100

Robinson, M. A., 474n59

Robinson, S. L., 233n135, 332n44, 333n51, 365n30, 642n122

Robison, J., 560n108

Roccas, S., 168n113

Rocco, Julie, 295

Rockstuhl, T., 118n31

Rodan, S., 196n116

Rodgers, Aaron, 334

Rodgers, M. S., 408n77

Rodriguez, D., 673n26

Rodriguez Mosquera, P. M., 222n55

Roeleveld, A., 392n14

Rofcanin, Y., 685

Rogan, Seth, 532

Roh, H., 85n44, 368n44

Rokeach, M., 153n115

Rometty, Virginia, 37

Romme, A. G. L., 519n70

Roomkin, M. J., 305n103

Root, R. W., 426n4

Rosen, B., 256, 361n15

Rosen, C. C., 118n34, 255n22, 258n47, 639n112

Rosen, M. A., 183n43

Rosen, P. J., 260n61

Rosete, Marvin, 118

Rosette, A. S., 178n23, 487n157–158

Roskes, M., 195n109, 258n48

Roth, P. L., 84n35, 86n54, 111n9, 582n21, 584n41–42

Rothbard, N. P., 151n107

Rothschild, F., 601n120

Rothschild, Mitch, 491

Rothstein, H. R., 646n159, 647n164, 649n182

Rotundo, M., 592n89

Roulin, N., 408n82

Rousseau, D. M., 43n19, 483n121, 685

Rowling, J. K., 92

Rozin, P., 175n9

Rubenstein, A. L., 223n63, 555n85

Rubin, M., 335n68

Rubini, M., 447n79

Rubino, C., 336n77

Ruddy, T. M., 362n19, 364n24, 370n54

Ruderman, M. N., 256n26

Rudolph, J. V., 151–152n108

Runhaar, P., 600n116

Rupp, D. E., 190n85, 232n131, 271n107

Rus, C. L., 196n118

Rusnak, Andy, 70

Russell, J. A.,

Russell, P. S., 213n10

Russell, Rick, 44

Russell, Z. A., 689n87

Russo, J. E., 182n35

Ryan, A. M., 90, 81n13, 89n75, 408n81, 550n52, 582n26

Ryan, Liz, 312

Ryan, M. K., 85n40

Ryan, R., 255n21n25

Ryan, S., 82n17

Ryan, Tamra, 464

Rynes, S. L., 303n90–91, 304n97

S

Saboe, K. N., 143n36n45–46

Sabramony, M., 300n69

Sackett, P. R., 85n38, 142n23, 584n40n43n46, 592n89

Sacramento, C. A., 477n74

Sadler-Smith, E., 183n44, 558n99

Sadun, R., 46n29

Saffie-Robertson, M. C., 599n103

Safian, R., 479n81

Sagiv, L., 153n113

Saks, A. M., 149n99, 554n82

Salanova, M., 260n60

Salas, E., 183n44, 323n17, 375n88, 588n69, 590n79

Salazar, Veronica, 76

Salgado, J. F., 583n34, 634n75n78–79

Salovey, P., 464n11

Salvador, R., 56n59, 676n36

Salvador, S., 559n102

Salvaggio, A. N., 147n79, 544n13

Sampson, Jenna, 55

Sanchez-Manzanares, M., 339n97

Sandberg, J., 447n78

Sandberg, Sheryl, 462

Sanders, K., 600n116

Sang-deuk Lee, 388

Sansfacon, S., 329n38

Santiago, Luis, 388

Santos, J. P., 591n83

Santuzzi, A. M., 87n66, 649n176

Sasovova, Z., 395n20

Saunders, D., 678n46

Scala, Domenico, 569

Scandura, T. A., 485n142

Scanlan, T. J., 511n37

Schaerer, Michael, 698n55

Schaffer, G., 219n42

Schalk, R., 626n32

Scharloth, J., 137n1

Schaubroeck, J. M., 272n112, 477n73, 480n89, 483n124

Schaubroeck, M., 480n95

Schaufeli, W. B., 260n60

Schaumberg, R. L., 186n59

Schaveling, J., 626n32

Scheck, J., 518n69

Scheiber, N., 603n123

Scheier, M. F., 647n169

Schein, E. H., 552n65

Schein, V. E., 627n44

Scheithauer, H., 197n127

Scherer, K. T., 332n45

Scherwin, V. M., 473n49

Schewe, A. F., 223n65

Schildt, H. A., 556n88

Schiller, Michael, 446

Schippers, M. C., 336n80, 371n61

Schkade, D., 217n34

Schleicher, D. J., 147n81, 335n64

Schlosser, T., 121n58

Schmader, T., 322n9

Schmeichel, B. J., 258n40

Schmidt, A. M., 260n57n62, 544n15, 545n20

Schmidt, F. L., 583n32–33, 586n59

Schmidt, K.-H., 124n69, 224n67

Schmit, Mark, 102

Schminke, M., 217n28, 546n24n30–31, 547n36

Schmitt, A., 224n68

Schmitt, M. T., 642n121

Schmitt, N., 93n95

Schneider, B., 64, 64n69, 147n79, 541n4, 544n13, 545n19, 554n81, 600n114

Schneider, C., 254n19

Schneider, P. B., 408n80

Schoenborn, S., 472n44

Schollaert, E., 584n45

Schoorman, F. D., 483n123

Schramm, J., 506n10, 517n64

Schriber, R. A., 88n69

Schuh, S. C., 476n62

Schulte, M., 545n21

Schultz, Howard, 230

Schultz, Nick, 437

Schulze, W., 371n58

Schwall, A. R., 143n42, 195n111

Schwartz, Daniel, 428

Schwartz, J. E., 217n34

Schwartz, N., 216n25

Schwartz, S. H., 153n113, 292n22

Schweitzer, K., 230n108

Schweitzer, Maurice E., 275, 258n48, 485n140, 599n104, 686n72

Schwochau, S., 398n49

Schyns, B., 487n156, 625n29

Scott, B. A., 124n63, 221n48, 261n65–66, 271n104, 483n125, 643n133

Scott, K. D., 308n128

Scott, K. L., 482n108

Scott, K. S., 37n3

Scudamore, Brian, 247

Scullen, S. E., 594n93

Searle, B. J., 639n108

Sebastiano, A., 625n27

Sedatole, K. L., 257n35

See, K. E., 447n81

Segal, J., 442n69

Segers, M., 257n32

Seibert, S. E., 112n12, 178n20

Seijts, G. H., 371n64, 648n174–175

Seiling, J., 632n58

Semmer, N. K., 371n60, 645n150

Sen, S., 119n35

Senge, P. M., 635n89, 636n91

Seo, M.-G., 225n76, 637n95n97

Seppälä, T., 398n43

Serlie, A. W., 581n13

Serota, K. B., 448n86

Serrano, G., 673n26

Serri, F., 89n82, 91n88

Severance, L., 449n90

Shaffer, J. A., 96n112, 142n26, 408n83, 482n112, 586n56

Shaffer, M. A., 96n109

Shafir, E., 181n31

Shah, A., 360n10

Shah, N. P., 62n65, 334n61

Shakespeare, William, 324

Shallcross, A. J., 228n91

Shalley, C. E., 511n38

Shamir, B., 472n42n45, 473n51

Shao, P., 480n92

Shao, R., 177n16, 271n107

Shapiro, D. L., 372n67

Sharma, S., 684n62

Shavitt, S., 396n32

Shaw, J. C., 261n65–66, 270n91

Shaw, J. D., 61n63, 95n106, 144n49, 410n86

Sheehan, M. K., 593n91

Sheeran, P., 228n89

Sheikh, S., 186n64

Sheldon, K. M., 255n25

Sheldon, O. J., 364n26

Shellenbarger, S., 55n52, 82n23, 112, 194n105, 263, 431n24, 432–433n35–37, 440n64–65, 638n101–102

Shen, L., 649n179

Shepherd, L., 308n124 n126

Shi, J., 403n62

Shi, L., 643n136

Shields, J. L., 308n127

Shih, E., 408n77

Shih, M. J., 89n77

Shin, D., 600n110

Shin, J., 637n97

Shin, S. J., 197n132, 368n45–46

Shipp, A. J., 57, 150n101, 555n84, 556n90

Shirako, A., 684n63, 685n66n69

Shirom, A., 646n156

Shishkin, P., 81

Shiv, B., 232n128

Shleicher, D. J., 147n83

Shmulyian, S., 545n21

Shockley, K. M., 295n33

Shore, L. M., 118n31, 469n27

Short, C., 221n52

Shoss, M. K., 142n31, 482n111

Shrkeli, Martin, 209, 210

Shu, L. L., 191n87

Shuffler, M. L., 403n63

Shull, A., 188n78

Shuttlesworth, D. E., 326n29

Siegel, M., 84n34

Sijbom, R. B. L., 623n19

Sikandar, H., 468n23

Sillito, S. D., 340n99

Sills, Judith, 164

Silver, T., 289n10

Silverman, R. E., 52n42, 85n37, 430n19, 487n162, 554n76

Silverthorne, C., 644n137

Sim, J., 482n120

Simha, A., 547n33–34

Simms, T., 215n19

Simon, L. S., 141n21, 482n110, 514n49

Simons, T., 479n85

Simonton, D. K., 196n115, 478n75

Simpson, J. A., 484n132, 485n134

Simsek, Z., 477n70

Simson, D., 192n98

Sinaceur, M., 687n73

Sinclair, R. C., 446n77

Singh, R., 86n56

Sinha, R., 373n76

Sippola, A., 97n114

Sitkin, S. B., 483n121

Sitzmann, T., 590n80, 591n81

Skarlicki, D. P., 124n67, 177n16, 270–271n100–101, 271n107

Skerlavaj, M., 196n121

Skinner, B. F., 262

Slater, D. J., 547n41

Slaughter, J. E., 113n19, 272n109

Sleebos, E., 372n66

Sleesman, D. J., 186n58, 362n18

Slind, M., 485n136–137

Sloan, Alfred, 46

Slocum J. W. Jr., 543n10, 562n11

Slomski, S., 144n54, 146n74

Sluiter, J. K., 645n151

Smale, A., 97n114

Small, D. A., 689n85

Smith, A. K., 185n50

Smith, Brad, 479

Smith, C., 436n51

Smith, D. B., 554n81

Smith, D. M., 222n58

Smith, H., 621n7

Smith, J., 438n62

Smith, K. G., 306n114, 627n47

Smith, M. A., 137n6

Smith, P. L., 686n71

Smith, S. M., 110n6

Smith, W. K., 633n61

Smith-Jackson, T. L., 640n116

Smollan, R. K., 625n22

Smothers, J., 138

Smulian, M., 588n65

Snyder, L. A., 644n143

Solinger, O. N., 109n3

Soll, J. B., 185n48

Solomon, M., 88n69

Solomon, R. C., 212n5

Solomon, S., 473n50

Soltis, J., 41n17

Soltis, S. M., 395n20

Somech, A., 196n119, 677n39

Son, J., 85n44

Song, F., 306n116

Song, H.-C., 622n10

Song, Z., 233n134, 555n85

Sonnenfeld, J. A., 487n154

Sonnenshein, S., 197n123

Sonnentag, S., 641n118, 647n162n166

Sonntag, K., 642n125

Sorensen, K. L., 216n23

Sorensen, M., 142, 142n29

Sosik, J. J., 145n65

Sotomayor, Sonia, 98

Sousa, F., 195n113

South, E. I., 322n8

Spain, S. M., 144n53

Spataro, S. E., 397n37

Spears, R., 689n84

Spector, P. E., 643n136, 644n138n140

Spell, C. S., 339n96, 526n99

Spence, J. R., 332n49

Spencer, S. J., 80n10, 232n131

Spicer, A., 56n58

Spisak, B. R., 487n160

Spitzmuller, M., 121n51

Spreitzer, G., 56n55

Spreitzer, G. M., 112n11, 372n67, 521n82

Srivastava, S., 138n11

Staats, B. R., 219n40, 554n77, 646n158

Stack, Laura, 433

Stainton, L., 521n83

Stajkovic, A. D., 308n130

Stalker, G. M., 522n84

Stam, D., 372n66

Stanko, T. L., 288n6

Stanley, D. J., 159n130

Stanovich, K. E., 188n80, 191n89

Stanton, J. M., 149n100

Stanton, R., 221n52

Staples, D. S., 338n85

Stavrova, O., 121n58

Staw, B. M., 186n56

Stebbins, S., 550n51

Steel, D. G., 197n126

Steel, E., 517n63

Steel, P., 158n128

Steers, R. M., 552n66

Steinel, W., 232n126, 670n17

Steinmann, F., 185n54

Stellar, J., 430n21

Stephanz, Mark, 90

Stephens, P., 307n121

Sterling, P., 639n113

Stern, I., 410n87

Sterns, Harvey, 83

Stevens, C. K., 149n95

Stevens, G. W., 518

Stevens, M. J., 289n9n12

Stewart, D., 590n80

Stewart, G. L., 359n6, 586n55

Stewart, J. B., 527n105

Stewart, Potter, 541

Stewart, S. M., 559n105

Stewart, T. A., 360n12

Stinglhamber, F., 279n13

Stock, A., 647n160

Stolyarov, G., 521n79

Stone, A. A., 217n34

Story, Susan, 491

Stoute, Steve, 392

Stouten, J., 479–480n88

Strathdee, Sally, 514

Strauss, K., 685

Ströhle, S., 647n160

Sturman, M. C., 470n33

Su, S.-W., 626n38

Su, Y.-F., 626n38

Suar, D., 230n109

Subirats, M., 544n13

Subramanian, N., 186n64

Suddath, C., 581n18, 687n80

Sue-Chan, C., 258n42

Suflas, A., 82n20, 85n48–49, 86n59, 88n72, 89n81

Sugarman, B., 513n46

Sullivan, Louis, 397

Summers, J. K., 432n34, 408n80

Sun, L., 196n120

Sung, S. Y., 591n88

Surface, E. A., 262n71

Surowiecki, J., 43n20

Sutherland, Naomi, 85

Sverdlik, N., 626n31

Swaab, Roderick I., 683n55

Swarns, R., 425n2

Sweeney, B., 559n103

Sweere, Dale, 101

Swider, B. W., 150n103, 585n51, 586n55n58

Swinbourne, C., 433

Syrek, C. J., 312, 477n72

T

Taggar, S., 371n64

Takahashi, H., 321n5

Takeuchi, R., 372n69,

Talley, L., 438n59

Tam, A. P., 224n70

Tamborski, M., 188n74

Tamir, M., 228n92

Tan, C. L.-L., 434n43–44

Tan, J. A., 118n34

Tanigawa, N., 323n15

Tannenbaum, S. I., 378

Tapon, F., 306n116

Tarantino, Quentin, 196

Taras, V., 158n128

Tasa, K., 371n64

Tasselli, S., 393n16

Tavares, S. M., 591n83

Taves, M., 45n23

Tay, W. D., 644n143

Taylor, A., 635n87

Taylor, B., 121n55

Taylor, Frederick, 46

Taylor, Lynn, 416

Taylor, M. S., 178n20, 637n95n97

Taylor, P. J., 483n126

Taylor, S. G., 427n8, 582n22

Taylor, S. R., 257n31

Teeter, S. R., 84n33

Temple, S., 438n59

ten Brinke, L., 192n98

Tenbrunsel, Ann, 177

Tenne-Gazit, O., 476n67

Tepper, B. J., 481n104n106

Tergesen, A., 82n19, 83–84n28–31

Terwel, B. W., 313

Tesluk, P. E., 225n76

Tetrick, L. E., 270n96, 308n123, 469n27

Thatcher, Margaret, 472

Thatcher, S. M. B., 339n97n99

Thatcher, S. B., 339n98

Thau, S., 397n39

Themanson, J. R., 260n61

Theuwis, F., 641

Thiel, A., 325n19

Thierry, H., 264n75

Thomas, B., 262n70

Thomas, D. C., 326n22, 431n25

Thomas, H. C., 124n72

Thomas, J. P., 148n88

Thomas, Katie, 210

Thomas, K. W., 671n18

Thomas, S. C., 583n31

Thomason, S., 180n29

Thompson, K. M., 397n34

Thompson, L. L., 683n54

Thompson, M., 405

Thompson, T. F., 151–152n108

Thomson, Anthony, 257

Thoresen, C. J., 120n46, 626n39

Thoroughgood, C. N., 547n32

Thorpe, D., 119n36, 120n41

Tiedens, L. Z., 85n47

Tierney, P., 260n63

Tilcsik, A., 89n77, 581n14

Tilelli, Maggie, 549

Tilstone, P., 362

Timberlake, Justin, 392

Tims, M., 446n75

Tindale, R. S., 343n112

Titlow, J. P., 548n46

Tkaczyk, C., 295n40

Todorov, A., 179n25

Todorova, G., 675n33

Toker, S., 647n170

Tolli, A. P., 260n62

Tolson, H., 635n90

Tomas, Jose, 428

Tong, Andrew, 390

Tong, K., 270n98

Toossi, M., 77n1, 78n5, 82n18

Torelli, C. J., 396n32

Tornau, K., 148n86

Toyoda, Akio, 507

Traphagan, John, 567

Trapnell, P. D., 687n78

Trauffer, N., 583n36

Travers, C. J., 298n65

Treadway, D. C., 395n23, 400n54, 403n61

Trenberth, L., 307n118–119

Treviño, L. K., 123–124n61, 331n40, 394n18, 480n89n96–97

Trevor, C. O., 125n74, 268n85

Triandis, H. C., 333n54

Tropp, L., 632n57

Troy, A. S., 228n91

Trump, Donald, 437, 473

Trump, R. C. E., 88n70

Truxillo, D. M., 648n172

Tsai, W., 231n120
Tsai, W.-C., 232n129
Tschan, F., 371n60
Tucker, M. A., 585n48
Tuckey, M. R., 229n101, 639n108
Tujague, Frank, 111
Tumulty, K., 473n52
Tung, R. L., 82n22
Turban, D. B., 41n16, 149n95
Turner, L., 82n20, 85n48–49, 86n59, 88n72, 89n81
Turner, T., 305n105, 306n111
Turnley, W. H., 267n80, 271n106, 408n79
Turusbekova, N., 410n85
Tushman, M. L., 511n37
Twain, Mark, 193
Twenge, Jean M., 154n118, 160
Tyler, K., 590n78
Tynan, R. O., 376n92

U

Uggen, Christopher, 608
Uggerslev, K. L., 554n82
Uhl-Bien, M., 470n28
Unckless, A. L., 147n83
Underhill, C. M., 486n146
Unsworth, K. L., 256n27
Unzueta, M. M., 89n78
Upshur-Lupberger, Terrie, 225n72
Ursin, H., 145n68
Ursiny, Tim, 164
Urwin, P., 154n117
Uy, D., 185n52
Uy, M. A., 233n134

V

Vaara, E., 565n125

Valacich, J. S., 335n71–72

Valentine, S., 589n76

Vallerand, R. J., 648n173

van Aken, M. A. G., 219n38

Van Bavel, J. J., 327, 335n67, 341

Van Beest, I., 232n126, 684n65, 685n70

Vanbeselaere, N., 328n33

Vance, R. J., 124n71

Vancouver, J. B., 254n20

van Dam, K., 625n29

Vandenberg, R. J., 649n177

Vandenberghe, C., 555n86

Van den Bossche, P., 257n32

Van den Broeck, A., 255n22, 256n28

Vanderbloemen, W., 381

Vanderpool, C., 470n33

Van der Vegt, G. S., 372n68, 512n42

Van Deusen, F., 604n125

Van De Voorde, K., 601n118

van Dierendonck, D., 482n113, 521n80, 606n134

van Dijk, E., 232n126, 684n65, 685n70

van Dijk, H., 335n65

van Dijke, M., 479–480n88, 482n117

van Duin, D., 446n75

Van Dyne, L., 152n109

Van Eerde, W., 264n75

van Emmerick, H., 253n12

van Engen, M. L., 335n66

van Ginkel, W. P., 197n131, 230n111, 371n59n62

Van Gogh, Vincent, 196

Van Hoya, G., 149n93n97, 429n15

Van Iddekinge, C. H., 179n24, 582n21, 584n41

Van Kleef, G. A., 95n107, 232n124–126, 270n93, 670n17, 684n65, 685n67–68n70, 687n73, 690n92

Van Knippenberg, D., 95n107, 197n131n133, 230n111, 232n124, 270n93, 368n48, 371n59n61–62n65, 430n20, 480n100

van Mierlo, H., 257n33, 258n39

van Olffen, W., 109n3

van Paasschen, Frits, 446

Van Reenan, J., 46n29

Van Rooy, D. L., 600n112

Van Ruitenbeek, G. M. C., 87n65

Van Steenberghe, E. F., 297n49

Van Veldhoven, M., 291n18, 601n118

van Vianen, M., 222n55

Van Vugt, M., 487n160

Van Yperen, N. W., 623n19

Van Zant, A. B., 688–689n83

Vargas-Estrada, E., 330

Vecchio, R., 468n20, 470n29

Vega, T., 85n51

Venkataramani, V., 197n124, 335n64

Vesely, R., 565n126

Vest, M. J., 156n123

Victor, D., 424

Vidyardhi, P. R., 470n34

Villado, A. J., 552n69

Vilnai-Yavetz, I., 557n96

Vinokur, A., 341n103

Vinson, G., 231n122

Visser, V. A., 232n124

Viswesvaran, C., 113n14, 148n88, 600n112

Vodori, Grant, 129

Voelpel, S. C., 374n86

Vogel, R. M., 271n102

Vogenberg, Randy, 602

Vohs, K. D., 258n40

Voigt, K., 551n61

Volpone, S. D., 336n77

von Aarburg, M., 586n57

Von Glinow, M. A., 372n67

Vonk, R., 408n78

von Ruden, C., 144n51

Vora, D., 326n27

Vornholt, K., 87n65

Voss, K., 374n84

Vrij, A., 448n88

Vroom, Victor, 264

W

Wager, T. D., 644n139

Wagner, K., 436n48–49n52, 436–437n54

Wagner, R., 561n109n111

Wagner, U., 632n57

Waldman, D. A., 472n46, 473n55, 633n65

Waldock, David, 375

Walker, H. J., 579n5, 582n22

Walker, K., 522n85n87

Walker, L. S., 84n36

Walker, R., 428n12, 548n45

Walker, W. J., 301n80

Wall, J. A. Jr., 334n58

Wallace, J. C., 262n70, 546n27, 646n157

Waller, M. J., 373n75

Walter, F., 333n53, 372n68, 512n42

Walter, J., 404n66

Walton, G. M., 80–81n13

Waltz, Ken, 57

Waltz, P. R., 87n66–67

Walumbwa, F. O., 272n112, 360n34, 479n84

Wanberg, C. R., 96n111, 149n98, 485n143, 555n85

Wang, C., 196n116

Wang, E., 677n42

Wang, G., 112n12, 584n39

Wang, H., 272n112

Wang, J., 191n88, 683n54

Wang, L., 110n7, 191n88, 228n93, 470n37

Wang, M., 148n91, 149n92, 195n112, 403n62

Wang, P., 272n112

Wang, Q., 121n56

Wang, S. S., 94n100, 174n6

Wang, X.-H., 470n32

Wang, X. M., 596n96

Wang, Y., 411n92, 463n6

Ward, A.-K., 431n25

Ward, E. A., 391n6

Waring, R., 293n28

Warrick, D. D., 552n68

Wasti, S. A., 399n52

Watson, A. M., 152n108, 217n33, 219n39, 220n44

Wayne, J. H., 78n8

Wayne, S. J., 85n46, 469n27, 482n115, 485n138

Webb, J. W., 626n41

Webb, T. L., 228n89

Weber, J., 489n168

Weber, L., 52n42, 82n21, 116n26n28, 137n2–3, 579n11, 582n25, 590n77

Weber, Max, 471, 471n40

Webster, Jeffrey, 321

Wechsler, P., 85n41

Wee, S., 583n35

Weeks, K. P., 186n65

Wegener, D. T., 444n72

Wei, F., 257n34

Wei, X., 302n87

Weigley, S., 300n68

Weinberger, M., 504, 508n17

Weiner, Jeff, 44

Weingarden, S. M., 145n70

Weingart, L. R., 675n33

Weinstein, Elaine, 304

Weiss, H. M., 214n14

Weiss, Matthias, 83

Welch, Jack, 43, 297n50

Welch, S., 297n50

Weller, I., 125n74

Wellman, J. D., 335n69

Wellman, N., 143n39, 496n2, 475n60–61, 478n79

Welsh, E. T., 485n143

Wendell, Daren, 291

Wendt, H., 253n12

Wesley C. L. II, 37n6

Wesson, M. J., 258n38, 270n95

West, Harry, 586

West, R. F., 188n80, 191n89

Westman, M., 647n170, 649n180

Westphal, J. D., 410n87

Westwood, R., 543n9

Wetzel, Jim, 679–680

Wheeler, A. R., 521n81

Wheeler, B. C., 335n72

Wheeler, M., 687n74

Whetten, D., 525n98

Whitaker, B. G., 397n35

White, E., 126n77, 304n100

Whitman, D. S., 145n70, 148n88, 582n22, 600n112

Whitman, Meg, 489

Whitmore, Jaqueline, 434–435

Wiemann, S., 584n40

Wiersma, U. J., 225n77

Wiesenfeld, B. M., 269n88, 297n46

Wieth, M. B., 231n118

Wild, E., 270n91

Wilderom, C. P. M., 225n77

Wilk, S. L., 336n74, 337n82

Wilken, B., 411n91

Wilkins, C. L., 335n69

Wille, B., 146n73n75

Willer, R., 430n21

Williams, David K., 479

Williams, D. E., 37n6

Williams, Dennis, 680

Williams, J. C., 295n34

Williams, J. R., 598n102

Williams, K. D., 336n77n79

Williams, M. J., 85n47

Williams, Serena, 366

Willis, J., 179n25

Wilson, D. C., 86n53

Wilson, E., 679–680n49

Wilson, K. S., 684n59

Wiltermuth, S. S., 186n59, 196n117, 304n101

Wincent, J., 644n147

Wingfield, N., 95n101

Winter, D. G., 254n18

Wisse, B., 232n124

Witt, L. A., 142n31

Witvliet, C., 601n117

Woehr, D. J., 84n36, 120n48, 593n91

Wolfe, D. M., 326n23–24

Wolfson, N. E., 83n24

Wong, J. H. K., 644n141

Wong, K. F. E., 186n57, 596n96

Wood, A. M., 149n96, 150n102

Wood, D., 137n1

Wood, J. V., 227n82

Wood, M. B., 589n73

Wood, S., 291n18

Wood, Tyler Cohen, 192

Woodford, Michael, 401

Woodman, Nick, 471

Woods, Tiger, 186, 261

Woodward, Ella, 171–172

Woodyard, C., 507n14

Woolaert, Guy, 51

Wooldridge, J. D., 219n41, 290n16, 642n127

Worthy, D. A., 145n67

Wright, Frank Lloyd, 397

Wright, P. M., 190n85, 298n64, 302n86, 600n113

Wrzesniewski, Amy, 112, 119, 297n46n48

Wu, C.-H., 195n110, 463n6

Wu, G., 683n56

Wu, L.-Z., 195–195n114

Wu, P., 41n16

Wu, S. Y., 342n109

Wu, T.-Y., 301n78

Wu, X., 594n94

Wu, Y.-C., 646n155

Wurtz, O., 591n86

Wysocki, B. Jr., 302n83

Xu, C., 308n129

Xu, J., 410n88

Xu, X., 196n116

Y

Yam, K. C., 173n2

Yammarino, F. J., 488n163

Yan, X. H., 677n42

Yang, L., 641n120

Yaniv, I., 185n47, 342n108

Yates, C., 632n60

Ye, G., 302n87

Yeh, Q.-J., 289n8

Yellen, Janet, 62

Yerkes, R. M., 645n152

Yi, X., 197n127

Young, M. J., 473n49

Youssef, C. M., 55n54

Yu, G., 177n18

Yu, R., 328n31

Yuhoon, Ki, 549

Yuki, M., 212n8

Yukl, G., 396n31n33

Z

Zablah, A. R., 121n54

Zacks, R. T., 231n118

Zajac, E. J., 625n23

Zanna, M. P., 180

Zapata, C. P., 152n110, 270n97

Zecher, Linda, 491

Zell, E., 84n33, 174n7

Zellars, K. L., 344n114

Zellmer-Bruhn, M. E., 676n36

Zepata-Phelan, C. P., 267n83–84

Zernike, K., 303n92

Zerres, A., 684n64

Zhang, A., 177n18

Zhang, H., 195–196n114

Zhang, L., 144n56

Zhang, S., 322n11

Zhang, T., 183n39

Zhang, X., 195–196n114, 306n114

Zhang, Y., 301n78, 338n92

Zhang, Z., 144n49, 149n92, 196n120

Zhang, Z.-X., 476n68, 511n36

Zhao, H. H., 178n20

Zhao, L., 338n85

Zhao, X., 63n67, 143n42, 195n111

Zhong, J. A., 470n30

Zhou, H., 192n91–94

Zhou, J., 194n100, 231n116, 368n45, 430n20, 633n70, 634n71–72n80

Zhou, M., 482n116

Zhu, C., 430n20

Zhu, J., 96n111, 482n116

Zhu, W., 145n65

Zhu, Y., 476n64

Ziegert, J. C., 156n124, 338n87

Zielinski, D., 579n7

Zigas, Caleb, 76

Zikic, J., 149n99

Zimbardo, Philip, 326

Zimmer, George, 670

Zimmer, John, 35–36

Zimmerman, R. D., 143n35, 150n101n103, 156n125, 545n18, 586n59

Zimmern, Andrew, 529

Zinko, R., 689n88

Zivnуска, S., 407n73, 410n86

Zohar, D., 476n67, 546n22

Zuckerberg, Mark, 303, 305, 391, 479, 577–578

Zukin, Cliff, 160

Organization Index

A

ABB, 515

Abbott, 605

AbbVie, 605

Accenture, 605

Accurate Biometrics, 263

Admiral, 561

Adobe, 489

AirAsia, 564

Air Bed & Breakfast (Airbnb), 461

Alexian Brothers Health System, 57

Alexion Pharmaceuticals, 548–549

Alibaba's Tmall, 336

Amazon, 45, 69, 83, 369, 431, 655, 692

Amazon Mechanical Turk (MTurk), 414, 506

America Online (AOL), 551, 605

American Airlines, 564

American Enterprise Institute, 437

American Express, 520, 605

American Water, 491

Animoto, 491

Apple, 50, 69–70, 76, 90, 223, 431, 503, 522, 578, 621

Asana, 578

Aspera, 491

A. T. Kearney, 605

Auglaize Provico, 560

Autodesk, 557

B

BAE Systems, 45

Baidu, 557

Bain and Company, 37, 551
Bank of America, 90, 263
Bank of China, 51
Bank of the West, 45
Baptist Health of South Florida, 118
BBC, 328
Bell Aliant, 424
Berkshire Hathaway, 184
Best Buy, 259, 295, 4489, 526
BetterWorks, 431
BHP Billiton, 489
Blockbuster, 187
Blue Cross Blue Shield, 605
BMW, 50, 360, 512, 515
Boeing, 515
Booz Allen Hamilton, 553
Boston Consulting Group, 95, 455
Bread Winners Café, 46
Bristol-Myers Squibb, 605, 671
British Petroleum (BP), 89
Brooklyn Dodgers, 100
Brunello Cucinelli, 523
Bureau of Labor Statistics, 235
Burger King, 50, 428
BusinessWeek, 489
BuzzFeed, 431

C

California Correctional Peace Officers Association (CCPOA), 696
Care.com, 156
Careerbuilder.com, 416
CARE Fertility, 578
Carlson, 605

Carnegie-Mellon University, 687
Carnival Cruise Lines, 427
Caterpillar, 113, 523
ChildNet, 549–550
Christchurch Women’s Hospital, 514
Chrysler, 360, 590, 635
Cisco, 360
Citi, 605
Clear Channel Communications, 553
Coca-Cola, 51, 129, 172, 237, 493, 508, 518
Colgate-Palmolive, 604, 605
Collins, 529
Commando Squadron Royal Engineers, 631
Continuum, 586
Co-operative Bank of Kenya, 323
Coors Brewing, 446
Costco, 300–301
CultureIQ, 567

D

Dallas Mavericks, 194
Dallas Museum of Art, 45
Deliveroo, 380
Dell Computer, 682
Deloitte Consulting, 551
DeNA, 182
DentalPlans.com, 643
Diamond Trust Bank, 323
Dish Network, 550
Disney, 114
Dropbox, 578
Dunkin’ Donuts, 517
DVD.com, 517

Dynegy Inc., 543, 557

E

eBay, 45, 489

Echo Nest, 548

Eco Safety Products, 194

Eli Lilly & Co., 446

EMC Corporation, 432

EMM Industries, 325–326

Enron, 473

Enterprise, 36, 511

Ernst & Young, 70, 90, 296

Etsy, 692

Everett Clinic, 308

Executive Women International (EWI), 286

F

Facebook, 37, 45, 54, 76, 108, 125, 160, 202, 303, 331, 391, 436, 452, 462, 479, 553, 577–578, 582

Factset Research, 557

Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA), 569

FedEx, 552

Fiat-Chrysler, 635

Fishbowl, 479

Five Guys Burgers and Fries, 189

Flickr, 438

Forbes, 196, 357, 369, 548, 604

Ford Motor Company, 50, 295, 360, 506 556, 561

Fortune, 125, 461, 558

Fuji Heavy Industries, 686

G

Genentech, 558, 649

General Electric (GE), 43, 136, 259

General Motors (GM), 141, 189, 360, 623, 680

Gilead Sciences, 393
GitHub, 487,
Glassdoor, 129, 429,
GlaxoSmithKline, 519
Globoforce, 308
Goldman Sachs, 95, 489, 558
Google, 45, 125, 129, 438, 442, 519, 520, 525, 553, 557, 578
GoPro, 471
Gorky Automobile Factory (GAZ), 521
Gravity Payments, 300
Graze.com, 45
Green Bay Packers, 334
Greer Laboratories, 44

H

Habitat for Humanity, 120, 292
Haier, 524
Hallmark Cards, 375
Harlem Educational Activities Fund, 491
Harley-Davidson Motor Company, 361
Harris, Rothenberg International, 637
Hartford Financial Services Group, The, 293
Harvard University, 154, 199, 476
Hay Group, 551
HealthSouth, 473
Hefei No. 4 People's Hospital, 179
Hewlett-Packard, 44, 523, 550, 561, 605
Hoa's Tool Shop, 194
Hobby Lobby, 91
Hochtief, 445
Home Depot, 292, 488
Honda, 50, 360, 452
Houghton Mifflin Harcourt, 491

I

IBM, 37, 90, 157, 192, 443, 515

IKEA, 552

Innocent Drinks, 493

Institute for Integrated Healthcare, The, 602

Intel, 285–286

International Civil Aviation Organization, 692

International Committee of the Red Cross, 370

International Paper, 560–561

Interstate Batteries, 562

Intuit, 479, 548

J

Jack in the Box, 125

JCPenney, 488

Jimmy John's, 517

Jive, 438

Johnson & Johnson, 605, 650

John Lewis, 348–349

JP Morgan Chase, 558

K

Kentucky Fried Chicken (KFC), 126

KeySpan, 304

Kickstarter, 623

Kimpton Hotels & Restaurants, 556

Kinsey Consulting, 455

Koch Industries, 608

Kroger, 45

L

La Cocina, 75–77

Lehman Brothers, 35

Lenovo, 520

LinkedIn, 44, 436, 437

Lions Gate Entertainment, 611

L'Oréal, 375

Lyft, 35–36, 692

M

Major League Baseball (MLB), 100

ManpowerGroup, 61,

Marketplace Chaplains USA, 563

Marks & Spencer, 522

Marriott International, 461

Mary Kay Cosmetics, 265

Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), 381

Masterfoods, 561

Max's Burgers, 201

McDonald's, 50, 392, 443, 517, 518

McKinsey & Co., 95

Medtronic, 437

Memo, 129

Men's Wearhouse (MW), 561, 670

Mercedes-Benz, 50, 83

Mercer, 95

Messagemind, 434

Metro Bank, 257

Metro-Goldwyn-Mayer (MGM), 516

Microsoft, 95, 489, 507–508, 552, 557,

Minneapolis Institute of Arts, 45

Moleskine SpA, 523

Molson Coors, 113

MotionSavvy, 433

Motorola Mobility, 520

MTS Systems, 235

Myers & Briggs Foundation, 140

Mylan, 209–210

N

NASA, 70, 120, 194

National Basketball Association (NBA), 303

National Football League (NFL), 88, 583, 669–670

National Hockey League (NHL), 268

National Labor Relations Board (NLRB), 443

NestléPurina, 604

Netflix, 45, 129, 477, 517

New York Knicks, 374

New York Times, The, 666

New Yorker, The, 43

Nielson Holdings, 45

Nike, 556

Nintendo, 182

Nissan, 321, 360, 633

Nokia, 489

Nordea Bank AB, 565

Nordstrom, 54, 269, 544

O

O2E Brands, 247

Oakhurst Dairy, 423–425

Oath, 551

Ohio Department of Natural Resources, 625

Olympus, 401

Orchard Hardware Supply, 586

Oticon A/S, 517–518

P

Paramore, 491

Patagonia, 570–571

Paulson & Co., 210

Pearson, 605
Peppercomm, 431
PepsiCo, 524
Pew Research Center, 88
PGi, 442
Pharmaceutical Research and Manufacturers of America (PhRMA), 210
Pinterest, 438
Portland Furniture Mart, 671–672
PricewaterhouseCoopers (PwC), 293, 539–540
Princeton University, 180
Procter & Gamble, 259, 507, 510, 515
Product Hunt, 373
Project Implicit, 199
Prudential, 605
Public Utilities Board (Singapore), 82

R

RadioImmaginaria, 355–356
Recreational Equipment, Inc. (REI), 325, 557, 605
Reebok, 392
Renault, 127
R.J. Reynolds Tobacco, 563
Robert W. Baird, 605
Rogers Communications, 424–425
Rothenberg International, 565
Ryanair, 610

S

SABMiller, 602
SAC Capital Advisors, 414
Safelite AutoGlass, 561
Salesforce.com, 113, 443
Salvatore Ferragamo SpA, 523
Sam's Club, 301

Samsonite, 427

Samsung Electronics, 503–504, 549

Sanofi, 405

SAP, 94, 443

Sarku Japan, 583

SAS Institute, 125, 557, 604

Scripps Health, 531

7-Eleven, 517

Siemens, 548

Skype, 440

Smartsheet.com, 491

Smith & Wesson, 588

Social Cast, 438

Socialtext, 438

Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum, 45

Southern Mississippi Correctional Institution, 665–666

Southwest Airlines, 524, 552, 561

Sports Direct store, 570

Spotify, 548

Stanford University, 235, 326–328, 476

Staples, 221

Starbucks, 230, 360, 425, 562

Stryker, 291

Sturdisteel, 563

Subaru, 686

Subway, 253

Sue Weaver Cause, 608

Switch, 434

T

Taco Bell, 69, 189, 563

Talko, 434

Target, 488

Tata, 588

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), 375

Tericent Holdings, 304

Texas Children's Cancer Center, 292

Thai Takenaka, 264

Threadless, 557

3M, 522, 547

Time Warner, 551

TMBC coaching organization, 495

Tofutti, 84

Tommy Hilfiger, 392

Tom's of Maine, 561

TOMS Shoes, 147

Towers Watson, 125

Toyota, 507

TRANSCO, 96

Translation, 392

Trex, 491

Turing Pharmaceuticals, 209

Turner Broadcasting, 605

TweetDeck, 442

20th Century Fox, 516

Twilio, 434

Twitter, 45, 54, 55, 217–218, 431, 436, 437, 443, 452, 532

Tyco, 473

Tyson Foods, 561, 563

U

Uber, 45, 461, 692, 623

Uber Eats, 380

Ubisoft Entertainment, 545

UBS, 366

UC Berkeley, 415

Udemy, 239

United Airlines, 532–533

United Auto Workers (AUW), 680

United Entertainment Group, 556–557

United States Air Force, 230

University of California–San Diego, 476

University of North Carolina–Chapel Hill, 56

US Airways, 564

U.S. Department of Labor and Department of Health and Human Services, 650

U.S. Small Business Administration, 365

V

Valve Corporation, 487

Verizon, 551, 605

Virgin Cola, 172

Virgin Group, 139, 437, 474, 552

Vitals, 491

Voice software, 434

Volkswagen, 50, 299

W

W&P Design, 529

Walmart, 79, 300–301, 523, 655

Warby Parker eyewear, 571

Warner Bros., 516

Wegmans, 553

Wells Fargo, 164, 247–248

Wellspring, 543

Western Electric Company, Hawthorne Works, 329–331

Westin Hotels, 111

Wetherill Associates, 561

Whisper, 129

Whole Foods Market, 76, 375

Wikis, 438

Wipro, 588

W. L. Gore & Associates, 60, 487, 552, 605, 633

Women's Bean Project, 464

WorkOne, 61

WorldCom, 473

X

Xerox, 518

Y

Yahoo!, 295, 296, 526, 551

Yammer, 443

Yik Yak, 129

YouTube, 248, 438

Z

Zappos, 121, 519, 543

Zimride, 35–36

Subject Index

A

Ability, 92–94

- intellectual, 92–93

- mental, influence on decision making, 188

- physical, 93–94

- of team members, 365

- trust development, 484

Absenteeism, 60–62, 123, 124

- age and, 83

- reduced by flextime, 294

Abusive supervision, 481–482

Accommodating, conflict and, 673, 674

Accountability, leadership and, 481

Achievement, intrinsic factor of motivation, 251, 252, 273

Acquisitions and mergers, organizational culture and, 551

ACT test, 92

Action research, organizational change and, 629

Action teams, 372–373

Active cultures, 570–571

Active listening, 431

Adaptability, as organizational culture, 541

Adhocracy, type of organizational culture, 541

Administrators, 38

Advancement motivation, 251

Advice giving, 254

Adviser, key role of team, 368

Affect, 211–217

Affect intensity, 217

Affective component, of attitude, 109, 110

Affective Events Theory (AET), 224–225

Affectively charged, decision making, 183

Affirmative action, ethics and, 79

Affirmative Action Programs (AAPs), 96, 98
for unemployed veterans, 79

Age
communication, language and, 446–447
mood, emotions and, 221
in workforce, 82–84, 101–102

Aggression, as deviant workplace behavior, 332

Agreeableness, 141, 143–144, 463

All-channel, small-group network, 428–429

Allostatic models, 639

Alternative work arrangements, 292–297

Ambiguity, tolerance for, 195

Ambiguous responsibility, 340

American Sign Language (ASL), 433

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA), 86, 87, 587

Americans with Disabilities Act Amendments Act (ADAAA) of 2008, 87

Analysis, action research, 629

Anchoring bias, 185

Anger, in negotiations, 684–685

Anger management, workplace and, 235

Anthropology, OB and, 48

Antisocial behavior, 146, 332, 333

Anxiety, negotiations and, 686

Apolitical, 407

Apologies, impression management technique, 409

Application forms, 580–581

Appreciative Inquiry (AI), OD and, 632

Apprenticeship programs, 325

Apps, communication and, 437, 442

Arbitrator, 690

Architecture, of an organization, 526

Arousal, 260, 261

Aspiration range, 679

Assembly line, 505–506

Assertiveness, 463, 673

Assessment centers, 584

Assessor, key role of team, 368

Assimilation, role play and, 326–328

Assist, downsizing strategy, 521

Attentional processes, 263

Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD), 87

Attitudes, 109–110

- importance of, 111
- job (*See* Job attitudes)
- work-life satisfaction, 232–233

Attribution theory

- of leadership, 487
- perception, judgment and, 175–177

Authentic leadership, 479

Authority, 508

Autoimmune disorders, 87

Automatic processing, 444

Autonomy, job characteristics model and, 287, 288

Availability bias, 185

Avoidant people, 146

Avoiding, conflict and, 673, 674

B

Background checks, employment, 581–582, 608

Baldness, masculinity and, 83

Bargaining strategies, 665–666, 678–682

Barriers to effective communication, 445–448

Barrio Adentro plan (Cuba), 611–612

Basic skills training, HR and, 587–588

BATNA (best alternative to a negotiated agreement), 683, 686

Behavior

- attitudes and, 110–111

- conflict management, 673–675

- creative, 195

- defensive, 407

- internally/externally caused, 175

- laziness, 278

- motivated by employee tracking, 263

- norms and, 329–331

- operant conditioning, 262

- organizational citizenship, 256, 258

- and organizational designs, 526–528

- organization's focus on, 256

- performance evaluations and, 592–593

- reinforcement theory of motivation, 262–264

- stress and, 645–646

Behavioral component, of attitude, 109, 110

Behavioral ethics, 191–192

Behaviorally Anchored Rating Scales (BARS), 595

Behavioral science, big data and, 43–46

Behavioral structured interviews, 586

Behavioral theories of leadership, 464–466

Behaviorism, 262

Belonging, as a paradox, 633

Benefit programs

- flexible, 306–307

- HR and, 601

Benevolence, trust development, 484

Bias

- anchoring, 185, 679

- availability, 185

- common in decision making, 183–185

- confirmation, 185
- gender, 84–85
- hindsight, 187
- in-group, 677
- maternal wall, 85
- overconfidence, 184–185
- in performance evaluations, 596
- reducing, errors and, 184
- self-serving, 176
- social loafing and, 336
- values and, 152–153

Big data, use of in business

- background of, 43–45
- current usage, 45
- for dummies, case incident, 70–71
- limitations, 46
- new trends, 45–46
- social physics, 46

Big Five Personality Model, 139, 140–144

- model of how traits influence OB criteria, 143
- openness to experience, linked to creativity, 195
- personality of team members, 365–367
- predicting behavior at work, 142
- traits in negotiation, 684
- trait theories of leadership, 463–464

Biographical characteristics, of employees, 82–88

Black Swan (film), 603

Blink (Gladwell), 187

Blogs, communication and, 437, 442

Bluffing, defensive behavior, 407

Board representatives, type of representative participation, 299

Body language, 438–439

Body movement, communication and, 438

Bonus pay, 304

- variable-pay program, 301

Borderline people, 146

Boundary spanning

- organizational structure and, 511–512

- teams, 360, 362–363

Bounded rationality, 182–183

Brainstorming, groups and, 343

Breaking Bad (television), 67

Breast-feeding at work, 601

Bribery, 191–192, 387–388

Buck passing, defensive behavior, 407

Bureaucracy, as organizational structure, 513–515

Business school, narcissism and (OB Poll), 145

Button-down culture, 564

BYOD (bring your own device), ethics and, 454

C

Capacity, environment and, 524

Carbon footprint, 362

Career, in organizational behavior, 49–57

Career OBjectives features

- advice, giving, 254

- disabilities, accommodating, 433

- firing employees, 598

- flextime, 296

- getting a better job, 685

- late to work, 177

- leadership, 465

- learning to lead, 563

- making job better, 122

- organizational structure, choosing, 518

- peer pressure in groups, 341

- personality tests, 138
- political behavior at work, 404
- screaming boss, 233
- sexual identity at work, 90
- team composition, 369
- teams, stress and, 641
- termination, 61

Caring climate, 546

Causes, of creative behavior, 193, 194

Centralization, organizational structure and, 510, 527

CEOs

- early leadership roles, 491

Chain, small-group network, 428, 429

Chain of command, organizational structure, 508–509

- authority, 508
- unity of command, 508

Challenge stressors, 638–639

Change

- failing to, 655
- forces for, 621–622
- innovation, stimulate, 633–635
- Kotter’s eight-step plan for implementing, 628–629
- learning organizations and, 635–636
- Lewin’s Three-Step Model, 627–628
- organizational culture as barrier to, 550
- paradox, managing, 633
- planned, 622–623
- politics of, 627
- resistance to, 623–627
- stress and, 636–637
- unfreezing the status quo, 628

Change agents, 623

Channel richness, communication and, 439

- formal vs. informal channels, 426
- Chaplains, in the workplace, 563
- Characteristics, employees' ability, 92–94. *See also* Ability
- Charismatic leadership
 - attribution theory of leadership and, 487
 - dark side of, 473
 - defining, 471
 - influence followers, 472–473
 - situational, 473
 - socialized, 480
 - theory of, 471–472
 - transformational vs., 478
- Cheating, ethics and, 154
- Chicago Manual of Style*, 424
- Chronic illness, 87
- Chronic pain, 87
- Circular structure, organizational, 519
- Citizenship
 - careers and, 256, 258
 - evaluating performance, 592
- Civility training, 588–589
- Civil Rights Act of 1964, 90
- Clan type, organizational culture, 541
- Clarification, negotiation process, 683
- Clarity, situation strength, 150
- Clifton StrengthsFinder, 495
- Climate, organizational, 545–546, 591
- Closure, negotiation process, 683
- Coalitions, influence tactic, 395
- Coercion
 - coercive power, 390
 - resistance to change and, 626–627
- Cognitive ability test, 583

Cognitive component, of attitude, 109, 110

Cognitive dissonance, 110

Cognitive evaluation theory, 255, 263

Cognitive impairments, 87

Cognitive reappraisal, 228

Cohesiveness, of group, 337

Collaboration

- characteristic of organization's culture, 541

- conflict and, 673

- employability skill, 65, 66

- overload, 202

Collective bargaining, 681, 690, 692, 695–696

Collective cultures, team vs. individual negotiations, 681

Collective identification, 322

Collective turnover, 123

Collectivism, 157

Communicate, downsizing strategy, 521

Communication

- apprehension, 447–448

- barriers, 445–448

- cultural guide to, 450–451

- defining, 425

- direction of, 426–430

- downward, 427

- employability skill, 65, 66

- of ethical expectations, 559

- formal small-group networks, 428–429

- functions/process of, 425–426

- grapevine, 429–430

- HR practices and, 600–601

- interunit, change and, 634

- lateral, 428

- managers and, 41

- modes of, 453–454
- nonroutine, 440
- nonverbal, 438–439
- oral, 430–434
- organizational, stress and, 649
- persuasive, 443–445
- processes, model of, 426
- resistance to change and, 625
- and success of telecommuting, 297
- telephone and, 433–434
- upward, 427–428
- video/conference calling, 432–433
- written, 423–425, 434–440

Communication channel, 426

- channel richness, 439
- choosing methods of, 440–442
- and information richness, model of, 439
- information security, 442, 443

Communication process, 426

Communication styles, 439

Company policies, 252

Compassion, organizational culture and, 558

Compensation

- asking for a raise (OB Poll), 249
- benefits as employee motivators, 306–307
- hygiene factor of motivation, 252
- pay structure, establish, 300–301
- variable-pay program, 301–306

Competition

- change and, 621, 622
- collaboration and, 636
- conflict and, 673, 674

Complementary in content, culture/leadership styles, 545

Complexity, environment and, 524

Compromising, conflict and, 673, 674

Computer-based job training, 590–591

Conceptual skills, of managers, 40

Conciliator, 690

Conference calling, 432–433

Confirmation bias, 185

Conflict

- defined, 667

- inter-role conflict, 326

- levels, in teams, 373–374

- loci of, 669–670

- management, 675

- relationship, 373, 374

- task, 373–374

- types of, 667–669

- unit performance and, 668

- work-life, managing, 603–604

Conflict-handling intentions, 673

Conflict-intensity continuum, 674

Conflict management techniques, 675

Conflict process

- behavior, 673–675

- cognition and personalization, 672–673

- intentions and, 673

- model of, 671

- outcomes, 675–677

- potential opposition or incompatibility, 671–672

Conformity

- norms and, 328–329, 341

- pressures, 340, 343

Conformity, impression management technique, 409

Conscientiousness, 463

- dimension, of personality, 141, 149
- influence on decision making, 187
- at work, 142, 149
- Consensus, 176
- Consequences, situation strength, 151
- Consideration, leadership and, 465–466
- Consistency
 - in action, 176
 - situation strength, 150
- Constraints, situation strength, 151
- Consultation, influence tactic, 395
- Context
 - innovation and, 634–635
 - perception and, 174–175
 - team context, 364–365
- Contingency theories of leadership, 466–469
 - Fiedler model, 466–467
 - leader–participation model, 468–469
 - Situational Leadership Theory (SLT), 468
- Contingency variables, 48–49
- Contingent reward leadership, 475
- Contingent selection tests, 587
- Contrast effects, 178
- Contributor, 286
- Controlled processing, 444
- Controller, key role of team, 368
- Controlling, as managerial role, 38, 39
- Cookie Monster study, 415
- Cooptation, resistance to change and, 626
- Core Self-Evaluations (CSE), 118, 146–147
 - linked to creativity, 195–196
- Core values, 543
- Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)

- authentic leadership and, 479, 481
- carbon footprint and, 362
- circular structure and, 519
- employee volunteering, 292
- internships and, 611
- job satisfaction, 119–120
- motivation to, 247–248
- norms and, 331
- organizational strategies, 522
- workplace spirituality and, 562

Corruption, in politics, 387–388

Cortisol, stress and, 476, 641

Cost-minimizing organizations, 523

Counterproductive conflicts, 676

Counterproductive Work Behavior (CWB)

- aggression, 332
- conscientiousness, 142
- emotional intelligence testing, 226
- individual task outcomes, 592
- job dissatisfaction, 123–125
- moods/emotions and, 233–234

Coworkers, drinking with (OB poll), 322

Creative outcomes, 197–198

Creativity

- creative environment, 196–197
- cultural environment and, 188–189
- expertise/ethics and, 196
- idea evaluation, 194–195
- information gathering and, 194
- innovation and, 195, 197–198
- intelligence/personality and, 195
- OB, moods/emotions and, 231
- problem formulation and, 194

- teams vs. individuals, 197, 345
- Creator, key role of team, 368
- Credit checks, employment and, 582
- Criminal records, employment check and, 582, 608
- Critical incidents, performance evaluations and, 595
- Critical thinking
 - and diverse work groups, 345
 - employability skill, 65, 66
- Cross-cultural negotiations, 677
- Cross-cultural training, 591
- Cross-functional teams
 - and chain of command, 509
 - self-managed work, 359–360
- Cross-hierarchical teams, 517
- Cross-training (job rotation), 286, 289–291
- Crowd-sourcing, 506
- Cultural context, communication and, 449–450
 - high-context vs. low-context cultures, model, 439
- Cultural differences, stress at work and, 643–644
- Cultural identity, 91
- Cultural values, 157–159
- Culture-change strategies, work-life initiatives, 605
- Culture clash, 551
- Culture(s), organizational. *See* Organizational culture
- Customer organizational structure, 515
- Customer orientation, characteristic of organization's culture, 541
- Customer satisfaction, 121
 - and relational job design, 291–292
- Customer service, 53, 232
- Cyberloafing, 202–203
- Cybersleuthing, 442

D

Dark triad personality traits, 144–146, 463–464

Data, behavioral science and, 43–46

Data mining emotions, 237–238

Day of week, emotions, moods and, 219, 220

Deceit, organizational culture of, 569

Decentralization, organizational structure and, 510

Decision making

- affectively charged, 183
- bounded rationality, 182–183
- effects of collaboration overload, 202
- ethics and, 190–193
- group, 339–343
- Implicit Association Test (IAT), 199
- importance of creativity, 193–198
- individual differences in, 187–189
- intuitive decision making, 183
- Management by Objectives (MBO) programs, 259
- nonconscious decision making, 199
- OB, moods/emotions and, 230
- organizational constraints, 189–190
- in organizations, 181–187
- perception and individual, 181
- rational, 181–182
- satisficing, 182–183
- and work teams, 378

Decision role, of managers, 39, 40

Decisions, 181–183

Decoding, communication and, 426

Deductive reasoning, intellectual ability, 92

Deep acting, 223, 228

Deep-level diversity, 78

- groups, 338

Defensive behaviors, 407

Demands, stress and work and, 639

Demographics

- biographical characteristics, 82–88

- differentiating characteristics, 88–91

- diversity and, 77–78, 367–368

- and leadership, 487

- workforce, 52

Departmentalization, 507–508

Departmental objectives, 259

Dependence, power and, 389

- creation, 392–393

- general dependence postulate, 392

- non-substitutability, 393

- social network analysis, 393–395

Design, step of appreciative inquiry, 632

Destiny of organization, step of appreciative inquiry, 632

Detail orientation, characteristic of organization's culture, 541

Deviant workplace behaviors

- moods/emotions and, 233–234

- typology of, 332

- in work groups, 332–333

Diagnosis, action research, 629

Differentiating characteristics of employees

- cultural identity, 91

- physical abilities, 93–94

- religion, 88–89

- sexual orientation/gender identity, 89–91

- tenure, 88

Dimensions of the Learning Organization Questionnaire (DLOQ), 635–636

Direction, individual effort for goal achievement, 249, 250

Direct services, work-life initiatives, 605

Disabilities, 86–88

Disabled workers

- accommodating, 433
- as biographical characteristics, 86–87
- unlawful treatment of, 86–88

Disappointment, in negotiations, 685

Discovery, step of appreciative inquiry, 632

Discrimination, 79–82

- disabled workers and, 86–88
- gender, 84–85
- race/ethnicity, 85–86
- religious, 88–89
- sexual orientation/gender identity and, 89–91
- stereotype threat, 80–81
- in workplace, forms of, 81–82

Diseconomies of work specialization, 506

Displayed emotions, 222–223

Dissatisfaction, motivation and, 251–252

Disseminator role, of managers, 39, 40

Dissonance, attitudes, behavior and, 110

Distinctiveness, 175

Distributive bargaining, 678–679

Distributive justice, 267–268

Disturbance handler role, of managers, 39, 40

Diversity

- demographic characteristics, 77–78
- of groups, 95, 338–339, 345
- levels of, 78
- management, 78
- organizational culture as barrier to, 550–551
- of team members, 197, 367–368, 369

Diversity management strategies

- effective diversity programs, 96
- employees and, 94–95
- groups, diversity in, 95

Diversity programs, 96

Divisional objectives, 259

Divisional structure, organizational, 515

Division of labor, 505–507

Dominant culture, 543

Downsizing, organizational structure, 520–521

Downward communication, 427

Dreaming, step of appreciative inquiry, 632

Driving forces, 627–628

Drug testing, employees, 587

Due process, performance evaluations and, 597

Dutch elementary school teachers, 477

Dyadic conflict, 669

Dynamic environments, 524

Dysfunctional conflict, 667

Dysfunctional organizations, culture and, 551

Dysfunctional outcomes, conflict and, 676

E

Economic shocks, change and, 621, 622

Economic uncertainties, stress and, 640

Economies of work specialization, 506

Effective managers, 40–42

Effectiveness, 63, 591

- communication, barriers to, 445–448
- evaluating group, model of, 343
- of group decision making, 340
- team effectiveness model, 363

Effects, of creative behavior, 193, 194

Efficiency, 63, 340

Effort–performance relationship, 264, 265

Ekman’s Facial Action Coding System (FACS), 237

e-lancing, 506

- e-learning, 590–591
- e-mail, as communication, 434–435, 441–442
 - collaboration overload, 202
 - tips for professional writing, 435
- Emotional Competence Inventory (ECI-2), 226
- Emotional contagion, 232
- Emotional dissonance, 223–224
- Emotional Intelligence (EI), 225–227, 238–239, 391, 463–464, 646
- Emotional intelligence assessment, 226
- Emotional labor, 222–224
- Emotional sharing, 425
- Emotional stability, dimension of personality, 141, 142–143
- Emotional states (OB Poll), 215
- Emotional suppression, 228
- Emotion regulation
 - ethics of, 229
 - influences/outcomes, 227–228
 - techniques, 228–229
- Emotions, moods and, 211–217
 - Affective Events Theory (AET), 224–225
 - anger, at work, 235
 - communication and, 446
 - conflict and, 673–675
 - creativity, 231
 - customer service, 232
 - data mining emotions, 237–238
 - decision making and, 230
 - deviant workplace behavior, 233–234
 - emotional states (OB Poll), 215
 - ethics and, 216–217
 - experiencing, 214–216
 - functions of, 216–217
 - irrationality and, 216

- job attitudes, 232–233
- leadership, 231–232
- moral emotions, 213
- motivation, 231
- negotiations and, 232, 684–687
- norms and, 328
- OB applications, 230–234
- positive/negative affect moods, 213–214
- safety/injury and work, 234
- selection, 230
- smiling, 212
- sources of, 217–222
- types of emotions, 211–212
- Empathy, negotiations and, 686
- Employability Skills Matrix (ESM), 65–66, 75
- Employee Assistance Plan (EAP), 565, 637, 648
- Employee engagement, job attitudes and, 113–114
- Employee Involvement and Participation (EIP), 298–299, 649
- Employee recognition program, 307–308
- Employee(s)
 - behavior, organizational structure and, 526–528
 - benefits, use to motivate, 306–307
 - burnout, 37
 - diverse, 94–95
 - firing, 598
 - intrinsic rewards, motivation and, 307–308
 - job engagement and, 272
 - learning organizational culture, 556–558
 - organizational politics, response to, 406–407
 - organizational social media strategy, and, 443
 - requests of flexibility, 609–610
 - resistant to change, 653–654
 - rewards to motivate, 299–306

- sabbaticals, stress and, 649
- socialization, organizational culture and, 553–555
- social media presence and, 452
- stress at work (OB Poll), 638
- telecommuting, 295–297, 526
- tracking/monitoring at work, 263
- variable-pay program, 301–306
- volunteering and, 292
- well-being, at work, 54–55
- withdrawal behavior, 60–62
- workplace spirituality and, 561–564
- Employee Stock Ownership Plan (ESOP), 301, 306
- Employee tell-all websites, 129
- Employment interview, perception and, 179
- Employment options, in organizational behavior, 49
- Employment policies, HR and, 601–603
- Enacted cultural values, 545–546
- Enactive mastery, 260
- Encoding, communication and, 426
- Encounter stage, of socialization, 554
- Engagement, job, employee and, 272
- Enhancement, impression management technique, 409
- Enterprise social software, 436
- Entrepreneur role, of managers, 39, 40
- Entry socialization options, 555
- Environment, organizational structure/strategy and, 524–525
 - creativity, 196–197
 - three-dimensional model of, 525
- Environmental Protection Agency (EPA), 194
- Epistemic interdependence, 526
- Equal Employment Act (South Africa), 98
- Equal Employment Opportunity Commission (EEOC), 86
 - and background checks, 582, 608

sexual harassment, 398–399

sexual orientation of government employees, 89

third-party negotiations, 690

Equity theory, 266–267. *See also* Organizational justice

Errors

common errors and biases in decision making, 183–187

escalation of commitment, 186

reducing, 184

risk aversion, 186–187

Escalation of commitment, 186

Espoused cultural values, 545–546

Esteem needs, 250

Ethical behavior, 56

Ethical choices, 56

affirmative action and unemployed veterans, 79

carbon footprints, 362

cheating personality, 154

choosing to lie, 193

compassion, organizational culture and, 558

empathy to negotiate more ethically, 686

flexible structures, deskless workplace, 519

HIV/AIDS, multinational organizations and, 602

interview impression management, 410

leaders, holding accountable, 481

managers, emotional intelligence tests and, 226

office talk, 112

organizational change, stress management and, 648

organizational social media strategy, employees and, 443

peer pressure, 330

technology, employee tracking and, 263

vacation deficit, burnout, 57

Ethical Climate Index (ECI), 546–547

Ethical Climate Theory (ECT), 546–547

Ethical culture, 546, 559

Ethical dilemmas

- behavioral ethics and, 191

- BYOD (bring your own device), 454

- culture of deceit, 569

- data mining emotions, 237–238

- defining, 56

- drones, use of, 69

- employee tell-all websites, 129

- illegitimate tasks, 312

- organizational politics and, 416

- overly assertive employees, 496–497

- rewards, 277

- sexual harassment and office romances, 416

- teams, ethical breaches of, 380–381

- tokenism in the workplace, 100

Ethical dimension, of organizational culture, 546–547

Ethical leadership, 479–481

Ethical training, 559

Ethical work climate, 546–547, 559

Ethics

- behavioral, 191–192

- creativity and, 196

- decision making and, 190–192

- of emotion regulation, 229

- emotions, moods and, 216–217

- goal-setting and, 259

- lying and, 192–193

- personality tests and, 138

- of political behavior, 411

- of rewards, 277

- training, 559

Ethnicity

- as biographical characteristic, 85–86
- criminal background checks and, 608
- diversity demographics and, 77–78
- stereotype threat, 80–81

e-training, 590–591

Evidence-Based Management (EBM), 43

Exchange, influence tactic, 395

Exclusion

- in groups, 327
- type of discrimination, 81

Excuses, impression management technique, 409

Exemplification, impression management technique, 409

Exercise, mood, emotions and, 221

Exit response, 123

Expatriate adjustment, 95

Expectancy theory of motivation

- integrating, 273
- model of, 265
- stock analyst example, 266
- three relationships between rewards and performance, 264

Experienced stress, 642

Expertise, creativity and, 196

Expert power, 391

External equity, 300

Externally caused behaviors, 175

Extraversion, 141, 143, 148, 149, 164

Extraverted (E) versus Introverted (I), MBTI personality type, 140

Extrinsic motivation, 251–252

Extrinsic rewards, 560

Extroversion, 463, 519

F

Face-time, 297, 361, 362

Face-to-face communication, 440

Face-to-face vs. virtual teams, 361

Face validity, 584

Facial expressions, emotions and, 212, 237, 438

Facial-recognition software, 581

Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) of 1938, 301

Family issues, as stressor, 642

Faultlines, 339

Favoritism, in-group, 322–323

Favors, impression management technique, 409

Feedback

- action research, 629

- communication and, 425, 426

- goal-setting theory and, 256–257

- interviewers and, 586

- job characteristics model and, 287

- Management by Objectives (MBO) programs, 259

- oral communication and, 431

- performance evaluations and, 593–594, 597–599

- self-efficacy and, 260

- survey, OD and, 630

Felt conflict, 672

Felt emotions, 222

Femininity, 157

Fiedler contingency model, 466

Figurehead, manager as, 39

Filtering, as communication barrier, 445

Firing employees, 61, 598, 604–606

First impressions, personality and, 148

Fit, workplace values, personality and, 155–157

Fixed pie, 679

Fixed vs. variable socialization, 555

Flat organizations

- design options for, 516–519
- simple structure for, 513

Flattery, impression management technique, 409, 417

Flexibility at work, 130–131, 293–295

Flexibility factors, physical abilities, 94

Flexible benefits, 306–307

Flexible structures, organizational structure, 519, 531

Flextime, 293–295, 296, 605

Floor time, 44

“Folly of Rewarding A, While Hoping for B” (Kerr), 277

Food delivery, 380

Forced comparison, 595

Formal channels, 426

Formal group, 320

Formalization

- culture vs., 544
- organizational structure and, 510–511

Formal power

- coercive, 390
- legitimate, 391
- reward, 390–391

Formal regulations, 189

Formal small-group networks, 428–429

Formal vs. informal socialization, 555

Formation stage, of group development, 323, 324

Fragmentation, learning organization and, 636

Franchise forms, of network organization, 517

Frenemies, 405

Full range of leadership model, 475

Functional conflict, 667, 676–677

Functional outcomes, conflict and, 675

Functional structure, organizational, 507, 514–515

Fundamental attribution error, 176

G

Gainsharing, 310

Gender

- baldness, masculinity and, 83

- bias, 85

- as biographical characteristic, 84–85

- communication styles, 455

- differences in power, 416–417

- diversity demographics and, 77–78

- emotions, mood and, 221–222

- group diversity and, 338

- identity, in workforce, 89–91

- influence on decision making, 188

- negotiations and, differences in, 687–689

- pay gap (OB Poll), 77

- percentage of men/women working (OB Poll), 52

- sexual harassment, 398–399

- stereotype threat, 80–81

- team composition and, 369

General dependence postulate, power and, 392

General Mental Ability (GMA), 93

Generational values, 153–154

Geographic departmentalization, 507

Geographic organizational structure, 507, 515

Gig economy, 277–278, 692

Global context, of organizational culture, 564–565

Globalization

- affirmative action around the world, 98

- cultural issues, 50–51

- foreign assignments, 50
- low-cost labor, movement of jobs to countries with, 51
- managerial challenges, 50–51
- GLOBE framework for cultural values, 158–159
- GMAT test, 92
- Goal commitment, goal-setting theory and, 257–258
- Goals
 - benefits of, 275
 - challenging or unattainable, 249
 - common purpose, teams, 371
 - joint effects of goals and self-efficacy on performance, 251
 - negative consequences of, 275
 - objective, 256
 - organizational goals and motivation, 249–250
 - path-goal theory, 468
 - relationship to performance, 257–258
 - and self-concordance, 255–256
 - specific, 256–257, 371
 - stress management and, 648–649
 - stretch goals, 259, 275
- Goals-effort loop, 272
- Goal-setting theory, 256–260, 273, 275
 - ethics and, 259–260
 - feedback, 256–257
 - goal commitment, 257–258
 - implementing, 259
 - Management by Objectives (MBO), 259
 - national culture, 258
 - and self-efficacy theory, 260
 - task characteristics, 258
- The Godfather* (film), 690
- Gossip
 - Counterproductive Work Behavior (CWB), 123

- dealing with rumors and, 430
- in the office, 112, 327
- Graduate admissions tests in business (GMAT), 92
- Grapevine, communication and, 429–430
- Graphic rating scales, performance evaluations and, 595
- Green practices, 622
- Ground rules, negotiation process, 683
- Group decision making, 339–343
 - benefits of, 340
 - brainstorming, 343
 - effectiveness/efficiency of, 340
 - groupthink/groupshift, 340–342
 - nominal group technique, 343
 - polarization, 342
 - strengths of, 340
 - techniques, 342–343
 - weaknesses of, 340
- Group norms, 328–333
 - behavior and, 329–331
 - conformity and, 328–329
 - culture and, 333
 - emotions and, 328
 - negative, group outcomes and, 332–333
 - positive, group outcomes and, 331
- Group order ranking, 595
- Group roles, 324–328
 - key/allocation of, 367, 368
 - role conflict, 326
 - role expectation, 325–326
 - role perception, 325
 - role play, assimilation and, 326–328
- Group(s)
 - cohesion, 62, 337

- conflict and, 672
- defined, 320
- development, 323–324
- diversity in, 95, 338–339, 345
- effectiveness, 343
- formal, 320, 321
- functioning, 62
- informal, 321
- ingroup, 322
- interaction, status and, 334
- intragroup trust, survival and, 349
- norms, 328–333
- outgroup, 323
- polarization, 342
- processes, model of, 371
- size and dynamics, 335–337
- social identity theory, 321–322
- social identity threat, 323
- stages of development, 323–324
- status as, 333–335
- teams vs., 357–358
- temporary, 323–325
- toxic, gossip and exclusion, 327

Groupshift, 342

Group status, 335

Groupthink, 340–342

H

Halo effect, 178, 278

Halo error, 596

Happiness, money and, 290

Harrison Assessment, 495

Hawthorne Studies, 329–331

Heredity, personality and, 138

Heterogeneity, 524

Heuristics, 178

Hidden disabilities, 87–88

Hierarchical groups, 335

Hierarchy of needs, Maslow, 250–251

Hierarchy type

- organizational culture, 541

High-context cultures, 449

High-Performance Work Systems (HPWS), 600

Hindrance stressors, 639

Hindsight bias, 187

Hiring practices

- application forms, 580–581
- background checks, 581–582
- contingent selection tests, 587
- interviews, 585–587
- model of, 580
- moods/emotions and, 230
- performance-simulation tests, 584–585
- placement decisions, stress management and, 647
- sustaining organizational culture, 552
- written tests, 583–584

Historical precedents, organizational decision making, 190

HIV/AIDS, multinational organizations, ethics and, 602

Hofstede's framework (of cultural values), 157–159

- compared to the GLOBE framework of cultural values, 159
- creativity linked to dimension of individuality, 197
- justice differences, 271

Holland's typology of personality and congruent occupations, 155

Homeostatic perspective, 639

Hope, trait linked to creativity, 195

Horns effect, 178

“Hot” team members, 366

House of Cards (television), 325

Human capital resources, 579

Human Resources (HR) management

- leadership role of, 599–606

- managers and, 41

- performance evaluations and, 591–599

- recruitment practices, 579

- selection practices, 579–582

- social media and, 54

- substantive/contingent selection, 582–587

- training and development programs, 587–591

Human skills, of managers, 40

Human trafficking, 612

Humor, communication and, 431

Hygiene factors

- of a job, 252

- job enrichment, 290

I

Idea champions, innovation and, 635

Idea evaluation, 194–195

Idea generation, creative behavior and, 194

Illusory correlation, 219

Imitation strategy, 523

Implementation, negotiation process, 683

Implicit Association Test (IAT), 199

Importance, power and, 393

Impression management

- defensive behaviors, 407

- of interviewer, 410

- performance evaluations, 409–411

- techniques, 409

Incentives, for team players, 375–376

Incivility, type of discrimination, 81

Independence climate, 546

Individual approaches to stress management, 647

Individual decision making, 181, 339–340. *See also* Decision making

- cultural differences, 188–189
- gender and, 188
- mental ability, 188
- personality and, 187–188
- in stress at work, 642–643

Individual factors related to political behavior, 402–403

Individual-focused transformational leadership, 476

Individualism, 157

Individual objectives, 259

Individual practices, of socialization, 555

Individual ranking, 595

Individual sources, of resistance to change, 624

Individual task outcomes, performance evaluations and, 592

Individual vs. collective socialization, 555

Inductive reasoning, intellectual ability, 92

Inequity, 334–334

Informal channels, 426

Informal group, 321

Informal training, 590

Informational justice, 269–270

Informational role, of managers, 39, 40

Information-based strategies, work-life initiatives, 605

Information gathering, creative behavior and, 194

Information overload, 446

Information richness, 439

Information security, communication and, 442, 443

Informed exchange, communication and, 425, 426

Ingratiation, influence tactic, 395

Ingroups, 469–471

- bias, 677

- favoritism, 322–323

Initiating structure, leadership and, 464–465

Injustice, reactions to, 270–271

Innovation

- context and, 634–635

- creativity, organizations and, 197–198

- defining innovation, 633

- diversity of work groups, 345

- idea champions, 635

- OB Poll, 195

- organizational culture and, 548–549

- sources of innovation, 634

Innovation companies, 529

Innovation strategy, 522–523

Inputs, OB model, 58–59

In Search of Excellence, 44

Inspirational appeals, influence tactic, 395

Instant Messaging (IM), 435, 441

Institutionalization, as organizational culture liability, 550–551

Institutional practices, 552–553

Institutions, organizational structure/strategy and, 525

Instrumental ethical climate, 546

Instrumental values, 153

Insults, type of discrimination, 81

Integrative bargaining, 481–484

- distributive vs., 480

Integrity

- characteristic of organization's culture, 541

- HR, employment tests, 584

- trust development, 484

Intellectual abilities, 92–93

Intelligence

- creativity and, 195

- self-efficacy and, 261

Intelligence Quotient (IQ), 92

Intelligence tests, 583

Intensity, individual effort for goal achievement, 249–250

Intentions, conflict and, 673

Interacting groups, 342–343

Interactional justice, 269–270

- definition and example of, model, 268

Interest level, persuasive communication and, 444

Intergroup conflict, 669

Intergroup development, OD and, 631–632

Internal equity, 300

Internally caused behaviors, 175

International assignments, 95

Internet surfing, 249

Internships, 579, 602, 611

Interpersonal communication, 431

Interpersonal demands, stress and, 641–642

Interpersonal justice, 270

Interpersonal role, of managers, 39

Interpersonal skills

- importance of, 37–38

- training and, 588

Inter-role conflict, 326

Interview derailment (OB Poll), 585

Interview(s)

- HR, employment selection and, 585–587

- impression management, 408–409, 410

- perceptual judgments, 179

- structured, 586

- unstructured, 585

Intimidation, type of discrimination, 81

Intonations, communication and, 438

Intragroup conflict, 669

Intragroup trust, survival and, 349

Intrinsic motivation, 196

- effect of job enrichment, 290
- extrinsic motivation vs., 251–252
- and extrinsic rewards, 255
- factors related to job satisfaction, 251–252

Intrinsic rewards, employee motivation and, 307–308, 376

- creating team players, 376
- two-factor theory of motivation, 252

Introversion, 164, 345, 519

Intuition

- affectively charged, 183
- decision making and, 183
- systematic study and, 43–46

Invest, downsizing strategy, 521

Investiture vs. divestiture socialization, 555

Invisible disabilities, 87–88

IQ

- tests, 92, 93
- transformational leaders and, 478

Israel, military in, 476

J

Jargon, 431, 558

Job attitudes

- average levels by facet, 117
- distinct, 114
- employee engagement, 113–114
- organizational commitment, 112–113
- Perceived Organizational Support (POS), 113

- satisfaction/involvement, 111–112
- work-life satisfaction, 232–233
- Job Characteristics Model (JCM), 287–289
- Job conditions, 118
- Job crafting, 130–131
- Job design
 - elements of, as motivating factors, 286–287
 - Job Characteristics Model (JCM), 287–289
 - redesign elements, as motivating factors, 287
 - relational, 291–292
- Job dissatisfaction
 - absenteeism and, 124
 - Counterproductive Work Behavior (CWB), 123–125
 - hygiene factors and, 252
 - managerial issues, 125–126
 - responses to, 123
 - theoretical model of, 122–123
 - turnover and, 124–125
 - two-factor theory of motivation, 251–252
- Job engagement, motivation and, 125, 272
- Job enrichment, 290–291
- Job experience, stress at work and, 642–643
- Job interviews, HR, employment and, 585–587
- Job involvement, 112
- Job knowledge, 595
- Job performance, 120, 646
 - men vs. women, 84–85
- Job redesign, 289–292
 - alternative work arrangements and, 292–297
 - job enrichment, 290–291
 - relational job design, 291–292
 - rotation, 286, 289–291
- Job rotation

drawbacks of, 290

as motivating factor, 286, 289–290

temporary assignments, 285

Job satisfaction

age and, 84

average levels of, by country and facet, 117

benefit of flextime, 293

causes of, 117–120

conditions, 118

Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR), 119–120

happy places (OB Poll), 116

and interpersonal skills, 37

involvement and, 111–112

linked to job rotation, 289

measuring, 115–116

outcomes, 120–122

pay, 119

personality and, 118

repetitive tasks, 289

self-managed work teams, 359

telecommuting, 296

two-factor theory of motivation, 251–252

of workers, 116–117

worst jobs for, 115

Job security, 252

Job sharing, 295

Job training, 590

Judging (J) versus Perceiving (P), MBTI personality type, 140

Judgment, of others, perception and

applications of short cuts, 179–180

contrast effects, 178

employment interviews, 179

halo and horns effects, 178

selective perception, 178

stereotyping, 178–179

Justice, organization, 190, 266–271. *See also* Equity theory; Organizational justice

Justice outcomes, 270–271

Justice promotion, 271

Justification, negotiation process, 683

Justifying, defensive behavior, 407

K

Knowledge application, 65, 66

Kotter's eight-step plan for change, 628–629

Kuuki, 532

L

Labor

emotional, 222–224

low-cost in foreign countries, 51

Labor unions, 692

Laissez-faire, leadership behavior, 475

Language

as barrier to communication, 446–447

body, 438

cultural barriers to communication and, 447, 448–450

gender and communication differences, 455

in meetings, 431

organizational culture and, 558

Lateral communication, 428

Law and code climates, 546

Layoffs, HR management and, 604–606

Laziness, 278

Leader–Member Exchange (LMX) theory, 469–471

Leader–member relations, 467

Leader–participation model, 468–469

Leaders

selecting, 488–489

training, 489–490

Leadership

assessment tests and, 494–495

authentic, 479

behavior theories of, 464–466

CEOs and, 491

charismatic, 471–473

contemporary theories of, 469–478

contingency theories of, 466–469

creativity and, 197

defining, 462–463

employee engagement and, 272

employee perceptions of job characteristics, 289

ethical, 479–481

full range of leadership model, 475

holding leaders accountable, 481

HR management and, 599–606

keep enemies close, 405

Leader–Member Exchange (LMX) theory, 469–471

learning, 563

as managerial role, 38, 39

mentoring and, 485–486

OB, moods/emotions and, 231–232

poor, 465

power and, 389–390

responsible, 478–482

servant, 482

skills, developing, 469

teams, structure of, 364

trait theories of, 463–464

transactional/transformational, 474–478

trust, 483–485

Leadership, challenges to

attribution theory of, 487

selecting leaders, 488–489

substitutes for/neutralizers of, 487–488

training leaders, 489–490

Lean communication channel, 439

Lean management, 521

Lean Startup, The (Ries), 548

Learning

impairments, 87

managing, 636

as a paradox, 633

Learning organizations, organizational change, 635–636

Least Preferred Coworker (LPC) questionnaire, 466

Legitimacy, influence tactic, 395

Legitimate power, 391

Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual, and Transgender (LGBT) citizens, rights/freedoms of, 89–90

Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual, Transgender, and Questioning (LGBTQ) employees, 89

Letters

as communication, 434, 440–441

of recommendation, 581–582

Lewin's Three-Step Model of the Change Process, 627–628

Liaison, managers and, 39

Lie to Me (television), 237

Life satisfaction, 84, 121–122

Linker, key role of team, 368

Listener burnout, 431

Literature, on OB, 67

Loci of conflict, 669–670

Long-term orientation, 157

Low-context cultures, 449–450

Loyalty, employee/employer, outdated concept, 127

Loyalty response, 123

LSAT test, 92

Lying

communication and, 448

ethics and, 192–193

M

Machiavellianism, 144, 463–464, 403

Maintainer, key role of team, 368

Management by exception, 475

Management by Objectives (MBO), 259

Management by Objectives and Results (MBOR), 259

Management by Walking Around (MBWA), 44

Manager. *See also* Organizational behavior (OB) as career

- allocation of activities of, by time, 41

- conceptual skills of, 40

- decisional roles, 40

- defined, 38

- diversity management, 94–96

- effective vs. successful managerial activities, 40–42

- emotional intelligence tests and, 226

- human skills of, 40

- informational role, 40

- interpersonal role, 39

- job dissatisfaction and, 125–126

- job satisfaction and, 113

- technical skills of, 40

- work of managers, 38–39

Manipulation, resistance to change and, 626

Market type, organizational culture, 541

Masculinity, 157

Maslow's hierarchy of needs, 250–251

Material symbols, organizational culture and, 557–558

Maternal wall bias, 85

Matrix structure, organizational, 515–516

Mayer–Salovey–Caruso Emotional Intelligence Test (MSCEIT), 226

MCAT test, 92

McClelland's theory of needs, 252–254

Measuring

- job satisfaction, 115–116

- personality, 137

Mechanistic model, of organizational structure, 522, 523

Mediations, HR management and, 604–606

Mediator, in negotiations, 690

Medical exams, employment and, 587

Meetings, communication in, 431–432

Memo (app), 129

Memory, intellectual ability, 92

Mental ability, influence on decision making, 188

Mental models, 372–373

Mentoring, 485–486

Merit-based pay, 301, 303

Message characteristics, persuasive communication and, 444

Message, communication and, 426

Meta-analysis

- cognitive evaluation theory and intrinsic motivation, 255

- of the Implicit Association Test (IAT), 199

Metamorphosis stage, of socialization, 554

Microbreaks, 647

Microspecialization, 506

Millennial generation, 160

Mindfulness, 228–229, 236–237

Minority groups, affirmative action and, 95, 96, 98

Mintzberg's managerial roles, 39

Misrepresenting, defensive behavior, 407

Mockery, type of discrimination, 81

- of Social Learning Theory, 263–264

Modular structure, 516–517

Money

- happiness and, 290

- power and, 389–390

Moneyball (Lewis), 288

Money-based strategies, work-life initiatives, 605

Monitor role, of managers, 39, 40

Moods, emotions and, 211–217

- basic, positive/negative affect and, 213–214

- negotiations, 684–687

- structure of mood, 214

Mood states, 213–215

Moral blind spots, 191

Moral disgust, 213

Moral emotions, 213, 214

Moral norms, 190–191

MotionSavvy, 433

Motivating Potential Score (MPS), 288–289

Motivation, 255–266, 286–287

- benefits, employees and, 306–307

- Cognitive Evaluation Theory (CET), 255

- Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) and, 247–248

- creativity and, 196

- effect of deviant workplace norms, 333

- Employee Involvement Programs (EIP), 298–299

- equity theory, organizational justice, 266–271

- expectancy theory, 264–266

- extrinsic vs. intrinsic factors in workplace, 252

- goal-setting theory, 256–260

- hierarchy of needs, 250–251

- hygiene factors, 252, 290

- integrating theories of, 272–274

- intrinsic, 196, 251–252, 290

- intrinsic rewards, employee and, 307–308

- by job design, 287–289

- job engagement, 272

- job enrichment, 290–291

- job redesign and, 289–292
- job rotation, 289–290
- Maslow’s hierarchy of needs theory, 250–251
- McClelland’s theory of needs, 252–254
- OB, moods/emotions and, 231
- organizational goals, 249
- participative management, 298
- reinforcement theory, 262–264
- representative participation, 298–299
- rewards to motivate employees, 299–306
- self-determination theory, 255–256
- self-efficacy theory, 260–262
- Social Learning Theory, 263–264
- two-factor theory, 251–252

Motivation-hygiene theory, 251–252

Motor reproduction processes, 263

Multinational culture, 564

Multiteam systems, 361–363

Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI), 139–140

Myth or Science features

- bald is better, 83
- first impressions, 148
- good citizenship, 256
- gossip/exclusion, toxic groups and, 327
- happy workers, happy profits, 125
- “hot” team members, 366
- keep enemies close, 405
- management by walking around, 44
- money can’t buy happiness, 290
- organizational culture, change and, 543
- sleep, work and, 645
- smiling, 212
- stereotypes, 180

stress, leadership and, 476
team negotiation in collective cultures, 681
telecommuting, 526
24-hour workplace, 603
writing skills vs. speaking, 437

N

Narcissism, 144–145, 160, 188, 463–464
National culture, goal-setting theory and, 258
National Labor Relations Act (NLRA), 443
National Labor Relations Board (NLRB), 443
Need for Achievement (nAch), 253–254, 273
Need for Affiliation (nAff), 253–254
Need for Cognition, 444
Need for Power (nPow), 253–254
Negative affect, 213–214
Negative leniency, evaluations, 595
Negative norms
 deviant workplace behavior, 332–333
 group outcomes and, 332–333
Negative stereotypes, 180, 199
Neglect response, 123
Negotiation
 distributive bargaining, 678–679
 effectiveness, individual differences in, 683–689
 integrative bargaining, 679–682
 OB, moods/emotions and, 232
 in social context, 689–690
 team vs. individual, in collectivist culture, 681
Negotiation process
 bargaining/problem solving, 665–666, 683
 clarification/justification, of positions, 683
 closure/implementation, 683

- ground rules, define, 683
- preparation/planning, 682–683
- Negotiator role, of managers, 39, 40
- Networked organizations, 54, 516–517
- Networking, managers and, 41
- Network structure, 516–517
- Neuroticism, personality trait, 148
- Neutralization, 203
- Neutralizers, of leadership, 487–488
- New Economic Policy (NEP), Malaysia, 98
- Noise, communication and, 426
- Nominal group technique, 343
- Nonmoney-based bonuses, 304
- Nonsubstitutability, power and, 393
- Nonverbal Advantage: Body Language at Work, The* (Goman), 455
- Nonverbal communication, 438–439, 442
- Norming stage, of group development, 323
- Norms, 328
 - cultural, 91
 - group, 328–333
 - and status, 334
- Number aptitude, intellectual ability, 92

O

- OB. *See* Organizational behavior
- Objective goals, 256
- Objectives, Management by, 259
- Observational learning, 263
- Observer-rating surveys, 137
- Obsessive-compulsive people, 146
- OD. *See* Organizational Development
- Office romances, ethics of, 416
- Off-the-job training, 590

Ohio State Studies, 464–466

Onboarding, 129–130, 553

Online applications, 581

Online recruiting, 579

On-the-job training, 590

Open-air offices, 529

Open-collar culture, 564

Openness to experience, dimension of personality, 141, 143

Operant conditioning theory, 262

Oral communication, 430–434, 440, 448

Organic model, or organizational structure, 522, 523, 634

Organization, 38

- decision making in, 181–187

- innovation, creative outcomes and, 197–198

Organizational Behavior (OB)

- absolutes and, 48–49

- anthropology and, 48

- applications of emotions/moods, 230–234

- defined, 41–42

- deviant workplace behavior, 332–333

- implications for managers, 66

- job attitudes, 111–114

- negotiations, gender differences in, 687–689

- personality traits that influence, 143, 146–149

- power and, 389–390

- psychology and, 47–48

- social psychology and, 48

- sociology and, 48

Organizational Behavior (OB), as career, 49–57

- culture, adapting to differing, 51

- customer service, 53

- diversity in workforce, 53

- economic pressures, 50

- employability skills, 64–66
- employee well-being, at work, 54–55
- ethical behavior, 56
- globalization and, 50–51
- networked organizations, 54
- people skills, 53
- social media and, 54
- work environment, positive, 55–56
- workforce demographics, 52
- workforce diversity, 53

Organizational Behavior (OB) model, 58–64

- attitudes, stress and, 59
- basic model, 58
- inputs, 58–59
- outcomes, 59–64
- processes, 59

Organizational change

- action research, 629
- Kotter's eight-step plan for implementing, 628–629
- Lewin's three-step model, 627–628
- Organizational Development (OD) and, 629–632
- stress management and, 648

Organizational Citizenship Behavior (OCB), 59–60, 120–121

- and career, 256, 258
- decrease in as a result of discrimination, 82
- employee selection process and, 582
- group activities and, 323
- group influence on, 322
- influence of psychological contracts, 326
- servant leadership and, 482
- transformational leaders, 474
- trust and, 485

Organizational climate, culture and, 545–546

Organizational commitment, 112–113

and job rotation, 289

Organizational communication, stress at work and, 649

Organizational culture(s)

active, 570–571

adapting to different, 51

as asset, 549–550

benefits, as employee motivation, 307

bonus pay and, 304

change and, 543

climate and, 545–546

collectivist, conflict and, 677

communication and, 448–451

compassion and, 5578

contrasting, 542

create for change at work, 632–637

creating, 551–556

creativity and, 197

day-of-week mood effects across, 219

of deceit, 569

defining, 541–542

as descriptive term, 542

dimensions of fit (job) and, 156–157

dominant, 543

emotions and, 212

Employee Involvement Programs (EIP) and, 298

employee recognition programs and, 308

ethical, 546

ethical decision criteria and, 190–192

ethical dimensions of, 546–547

flextime and, 293

formalization vs., 544

functions of, 544–545

global context of, 564–565

globalization, challenges of, 50–51

goal-setting theory and, 258

guide to communication, 450–451

Hofstede's dimensions and, 157–158

how employees learn, 556–558

how they form, 555–556

impact on employee performance/satisfaction and, 566

individual decision making and, 188–189

innovation and, 548–5449

job sharing and, 295

justice and, 271

language and, 558

leadership and, 466

as liability, 550–551

mood and, 215

negative, 550–551

negotiation and, 681, 687

norms and, 91, 95, 333

performance evaluations in different, 599

piece-rate pay plan and, 302

political behavior at work and, 404

positive, 559–561

power tactics and, 396

psychological contracts, 326

representative participation programs, 298–299

rituals of, 556–557

role expectation and, 325–326

selection/top management/socialization methods of sustaining, 552–553

self-serving bias and, 176

sexual harassment and, 398

social loafing and, 336

social media use and, 437, 443, 452

- social needs and, 252–251
- spirituality and, 561–564
- stereotyping and, 180
- stories of, 556
- strong vs. weak, 544
- subcultures, 543
- sustainability and, 547–548
- symbols of, 557–558
- team composition and, 368–369
- team negotiations and, 681
- telecommuting and, 295
- trust and, 484–485
- uniformity, 543
- values and, 157–159
- variable-pay programs and, 301

Organizational demography, 367

Organizational Development (OD)

- appreciative inquiry, 632
- intergroup development and, 631–632
- process consultation, 630–631
- sensitivity training, 630
- survey feedback, 630
- team building and, 631

Organizational factors, stress

- employee involvement in, 649
- employee sabbaticals and, 649
- management and communication and, 649
- redesigning jobs, 649
- wellness programs, 649–650, 652

Organizational factors related to political behavior, 402, 403–406

Organizational goals

- motivation, 249
- and rewards, 264–265

Organizational justice, 266–271, 526

- culture and, 271

- definition and example of, 268

- distributive, 267–268

- ensuring, 271

- informational, 269–270

- interactional, 269–270

- interpersonal, 270

- justice outcomes, 270–271

- model of, 268

- procedural, 268–269

Organizational politics, power and, 400–402

- impression management, 408–411

- mapping your political career, 412–413

- OB poll, 400

- response to, 406–407

Organizational size, strategy and, 524

Organizational sources, of resistance to change, 624

Organizational strategies, structure and, 522–525

- environment, 524–525

- innovation strategy, 522–523

- institutions, 525

- model of, 522

- size, 524

- technology, 524

Organizational structure

- assessment, 518

- boundary spanning, 511–512

- bureaucracy, 513–514

- centralized/decentralized, 510, 527

- chain of command, 508–509

- choosing a, 518

- circular, 519

- customers, 515
- departmentalization, 507–508
- designing, questions/answers before, 505
- determinants and outcomes, 528
- divisional structure, 515
- downsizing, 520–521
- economies/diseconomies, of work specialization, 506
- employee behavior and, 526–528
- environment, 524–525
- flexible, 519
- formalization, 510–511
- functional, 514–515
- institutions and, 525
- matrix structure, 515–516
- mechanistic vs. organic models of, 522
- simple structure, 513
- size, 524
- span of control, 509–510, 527
- strategies, 522–524
- strategy/structure relationship, 523
- team structure, 517–519
- technology, 524
- virtual structure, 516–517
- work specialization, 505–507, 526–527

Organizational survival, 63–64

Organizations

- common shortcuts in, 179–180
- constraints on decision making and, 189–190

Organizer, key role of team, 368

Organizing

- as managerial role, 38
- as a paradox, 633

Outcomes

equity theory, 266, 267

organizational justice, 270–271

Outcomes, OB model

group cohesion, 62

group functioning, 62

Organizational Citizenship Behavior (OCB), 59–60

productivity, 63

survival, 63–64

task performance, 59

withdrawal behavior, 60–62

Outgroups, 323, 469–471

Overconfidence bias, 184–185

Overconforming, defensive behavior, 407

Oversharing, in the office, 112

P

Panel interviews, 586

Paradox theory, change and, 633

Participation

downsizing strategy, 521

overcoming resistance to change, 625

Participative management, 298

Path-goal theory, 468

Pay, job satisfaction and, 119

Pay-for-performance, 301–306

Pay structure

balancing internal and external equity, 300

establishing, 300–301

Peer coaches, 553

Peer pressure, 330, 341

Peers, power and, 397

People skills, 53

Perceived conflict, 672

Perceived inequity, 334

Perceived Organizational Support (POS), 113

Perceiver, perception and, 173–174

Perception

- context and, 174–175

- defined, 173

- factors that influence, 174

- individual decision making, 181

- judgment and, 175–180

- perceiver, 173–174

- selective, 445–446

- social-learning theory, 263

- stress at work and, 642

- target, 174

Perceptual speed, intellectual ability, 92

Performance evaluations, 365, 409–411

- behavior, 592–593

- Behaviorally Anchored Rating Scales (BARS), 595

- bias in, 596

- critical incidents, 595

- defining performance, 591–592

- feedback and, 597–599

- forced comparisons, 595

- graphic ratings scales and, 595

- improving, 595–597

- individual task outcomes, 592

- international variations in, 599

- organizational constraints on decision making, 189–190

- perception, judgment and, 180

- purposes of, 592

- 360-degree evaluations, 593, 594

- traits and, 593

- by whom, 593–594

- written essays, 594
- Performance expectations, perception and, 179–180
- Performance-reward relationship, 264, 273
 - monitoring employee expectations, 306
- Performance-simulation tests, employment and, 584–585
- Performing, as a paradox, 633
- Performing stage, of group development, 323
- Perseverance, trait linked to creativity, 195
- Persistence, individual effort of goal achievement, 249, 250
- Personal aggression, as deviant workplace behavior, 332
- Personal approach, influence tactic, 395
- Personal economic problems, 642
- Personal factors, in stress at work, 642
- Personal growth opportunities, intrinsic reward, 252
- Personality
 - change, acceptance of, 626
 - cheating, 154
 - creativity and, 195
 - defining/measuring, 137–139
 - first impressions and, 148
 - heredity and, 138
 - individual decision making and, 187–188
 - job satisfaction and, 118
 - negotiation style and, 684
 - persuasive communication and, 444
 - self-efficacy and, 261
 - situations and, 150–152
 - as source of emotions/moods, 217
 - stress at work and, 643
 - of team members, 365–367
 - training programs and, 591
 - traits that influence OB, 143
 - traits that matter most to success, 142

- trait theories of leadership, 463–464, 466
- undesirable traits of, 144–146
- values and, 152–154
- workplace values and, 155–157

Personality frameworks

- Big Five Personality Model, 139, 140–144
- Dark Triad, 144–146
- Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI), 139–140

Personality tests, 138, 583–584

Personality traits, 139

- OB and, 146–149

Person–group fit, 156–157

Person–job fit theory, 155

Person–organization fit, 156

Person–supervisor fit, 156–157

Perspective-taking, 686

Persuasive communication, 425, 443–445

Physical abilities, of employees, 93–94

Physical distance, communication and, 438–439

Physical exercise, stress and, 647

Physical work conditions, 252

Physiological needs, 250

Physiological symptoms, of stress, 644

Piece-rate pay plan, 301, 302–303

Planned change, 622–623

Planning, as managerial role, 38

Planning, negotiation process, 682–683

Playing dumb, defensive behavior, 407

Playing safe, defensive behavior, 407

Point/Counterpoint features

- affirmative action programs, 98
- CEOs, leadership and, 491
- creativity, teams vs. individuals, 345

- criminal backgrounds, employers and, 608
- employer/employee loyalty, out of date, 127
- goals, 275
- Implicit Association Test (IAT), 199
- literature on OB, 67
- narcissism, millennials and, 160
- nonunion positions and the gig economy, 692
- open-air offices, 529
- positive organizational culture, 567
- power, 414
- social media presence, employees and, 452
- stress reduction, organizational encouragement of, 652
- teams, empowering, 378
- yelling, 235
- Polarization, 335, 342
- Policies, company, 252
- Politeness, in negotiations, 686
- Political, category of deviant workplace behavior, 332
- Political behavior, 400
 - ethics of, 411
 - individual/organizational factors contributing to, 402–406
 - at work, 404
- Political Correctness (PC) norms, 331, 332
- Political map, your career and, 412–413
- Political skill, 396–397
- Political uncertainties, stress and, 640
- Politicking, 402
- Politics, organizational, power and, 400–402
- Politics of change, 627
- Position power, 467
- Positive affect moods, 213–214
 - importance in becoming employed, 149
 - personality trait linked to creativity, 195

- Positive diversity climate, 86
- Positive leniency, evaluations, 595
- Positive norms, group outcomes and, 331
- Positive organizational behavior, 55–56
 - employee strengths, build on, 560
- Positive organizational culture, 559–561
- Positive relationships, overcoming resistance to change, 625–626
- Positive stereotypes, 180
- Positivity offset, 214
- Post-Occupancy Evaluation (POE), 529
- Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder (PTSD), 87
- Potential, of teams, 358, 371
- Potential stressors, 642
- Power
 - abuse of, 397–399
 - bases of, 390–392
 - dependence and, 392–395
 - differentials, sexual harassment and, 398–399
 - effective types, 392
 - formal power, 390–391
 - leadership and, 389–390
 - organizational politics and, 400–402
 - peers and, 397
 - personal, 391–392
 - tactics, 395–397
 - variables, 398
 - want of, 414
- Power distance, 113, 157
- PowerPoint, 434, 508
- Prearrival stage, or socialization, 554
- Predicting events, data analytics, 45
- Preparation, negotiation process, 682–683
- Pressure, influence tactic, 395

Preventing catastrophes, data analytics, 45

Prevention, defensive behavior, 407

Prevention focus, 258

Prior knowledge, persuasive communication and, 444

Proactive personality, 148–149, 195

Problem, 181

Problem formulation, creativity and, 194

Problem-solving

- negotiation process, 683
- skills training, 588
- teams, 359

Procedural justice, 268–269

- definition and example, model of, 268
- and Employee Involvement Programs (IEPs), 299

Process conflict, 667

Process Consultation (PC), OD and, 630–631

Process departmentalization, 507

Processes, OB model, 59

Producer, key role of team, 368

Product departmentalization, 507

Production, category of deviant workplace behavior, 332

Production blocking, 343

Productivity, 63

- increased by flextime, 293
- of self-managed work teams, 360

Product/service organizational structure, 515

Profit-sharing plan, 301, 305

Programme for International Student Assessment (PISA), 348

Promoter, key role of team, 368

Promotional opportunities, intrinsic reward, 252

Promotion focus, 258

Property, category of deviant workplace behavior, 332

Prosocial motivation, 292

Protective mechanisms, 559

Protégé, 485–486

Psychological challenges, 87

Psychological contract, 325–326

Psychological empowerment, 112

Psychological symptoms, of stress, 644–645

Psychology, OB and, 47–48

Psychopathy, 146, 463–464

Punctuated-equilibrium model

- model of, 324
- stages of, 323

Pygmalion effect, 179–180, 261

Q

Quality-control teams, 359

QUILTBAG (Queer/Questioning, Undecided, Intersex, Lesbian, Transgender, Bisexual, Asexual, Gay), 89

R

Race

- as biographical characteristic, 85–86
- criminal background checks and, 608
- diversity demographics and, 77–78
- merit-based pay and, 303
- stereotype threat and, 80–81

Racial Intelligence Training and Engagement (RITE) academy, 100

Raise, asking for, 249

Randomness error, 186

Randstad's Workplace 2025 survey, 286

Rational, 181

Rational decision-making model, 181–182

Rational persuasion, influence tactic, 395

Reactiveness, 636

Realistic job previews, 585

Receiver, communication and, 426

Recognition, intrinsic factor of motivation, 251, 252

Recognition programs, employee, 304, 307–308

Recovering ponderers, 647

Recruitment practices, 579

Redesigning jobs, organizational change and, 649

Redundant, culture/leadership styles, 545

Redundancy, 654–655

Reference groups, 329

References, employment, 581

Referent power, 392

Reflexivity, 371

Regulations, 189

Reinforcement processes, 264

Reinforcement theory of motivation

- integrating, 273–274
- operant conditioning and behaviorism, 262
- social-learning theory and, 263–264

Relational identification, 322

Relational job design, 291–292

Relationship conflicts, 373, 374, 667

Relationship-oriented, LPC questionnaire result, 466

Relationships

- negotiations and, 682–683, 690
- positive, resistance to change and, 625–626
- stress, job performance and, 646

Relaxation techniques, stress and, 647

Religion, workplace diversity and, 88–89

Representative participation, 298–299

Reputation, negotiations and, 689–690

Resistance point, 679

Resistance to change, overcoming

- coercion, 626–627
- communication and, 625

- fairly implement changes, 626
- manipulation/cooptation and, 626
- participation and, 625
- positive relationships, 625–626
- select individuals who accept change, 626
- sources of, 624
- support/commitment, building, 625

Resource allocator role, of managers, 39, 40

Resources

- assessing with social network analysis, 393–395
- human capital, 579
- innovation and, 634
- stress at work and, 639
- teams and, 364

Responsibility, intrinsic factor of motivation, 251, 252

Restraining forces, 627–628

Results/outcome organization, characteristic of organization's culture, 541

Résumé, 581

Retention processes, 263

Reward power, 390–391

Rewards

- ethics of, 277
- extrinsic vs. intrinsic motivation, 255
- incentives to be a team player, 375–376

Rewards–personal goals relationship, 264

Reward systems

- contingent reward leadership, 475
- ethics of, 277, 559
- extrinsic, 560
- intrinsic rewards, motivation and, 307–308
- organizational constraints, 189
- teams, 365, 375–376
- variable-pay programs, 301–306

- workplace spirituality, 561
- Rich communication channel, 439
- Risk aversion, 186–187
- Risk taking, trait linked to creativity, 195
- Rituals, organizational culture and, 556–557
- Role conflict, 326, 555, 641
- Role model, 559
- Role overload, 555
- Role play, assimilation and, 326–328
- Roles
 - allocation of in teams, 367, 368
 - ambiguity, 402, 403–404
 - defined, 324
 - demands, stress and, 641
 - expectations, 325–326
 - group, 324–328
 - perception, 325
 - stress, 296, 649
- Romances, office, 416
- Rules climate, 546
- Rumors, dealing with, 430

S

- Sabbaticals, 649
- Safety
 - workplace, emotions, moods and, 234
- Safety-security needs, 250
- Satisfaction
 - age and, 84
 - motivation and, 251–252
- Satisficing, 182–183, 681
- SAT test, 92
- Scandals, in politics, 387–4388

Scapegoating, defensive behavior, 407

Scarcity, power and, 393

Schadenfreude, 321

Schizotypal personality disorder, 146

Selection practices

- application forms, 580–581
- background checks, 581–582
- contingent selection tests, 587
- interviews, 585–587
- model of, 580
- moods/emotions and, 230
- performance-simulation tests, 584–585
- placement decisions, stress management and, 647
- sustaining organizational culture, 552
- written tests, 583–584

Selective perception, 178, 445–446

Self-actualization needs, 250

Self-concordance, 255–256

Self-confidence, trait linked to creativity, 195

Self-Determination Theory, motivation and, 255

Self-efficacy, 149, 684

- increasing in others, 261–262
- influence of feedback, 260
- trait linked to creativity, 195

Self-esteem, personality trait, 148, 149

- influence on decision making, 188

Self-fulfilling prophecy, 179–180, 261

Self-generated feedback, 257

Self-managed work teams, 359–360

- and chain of command, 509

Self-monitoring, 147

Self-promotion, impression management technique, 409

Self-protection, defensive behavior, 407

- Self-serving bias, 176
 - personality traits linked to, 188
- Sender, communication and, 426
- Seniority, 88, 301
- Sensing (S) versus Intuitive (N), MBTI personality type, 140
- Sensitivity training, OD and, 630
- Serial vs. random socialization, 555
- Servant leadership, 482
- Service departmentalization, 507
- Sex
 - as biographical characteristic, 84–85
 - emotions, mood and, 221–222
- Sexual harassment
 - power and, 398–399, 416
 - type of discrimination, 81
- Sexual orientation, in workforce, 89–91
- Shared meaning, of cultures, 544
- Shortcuts
 - in judging others, 178–179
 - used in organizations, 179–180
- Short-term orientation, 157
- Sick leave, 60, 652
 - liberal policies and absenteeism, 124
- Silence, as barrier to communication, 447
- Similarity error, 596
- Simple structure, organizational structure and, 513
- Situational Judgment Test of Emotional Intelligence (SJT of EI), 226, 584
- Situational leadership theory, 468
- Situation strength theory, 150–151
- Size, of organization, 524
- Skills
 - collaboration, 65
 - communication, 65

- critical thinking, 65
- employability skills, 65, 66
- interpersonal, 37–38
- job characteristics model and, 287
- knowledge application, 65
- leadership (OB poll), 469
- of managers, 40
- people, 53
- social responsibility, 65

Skype (videoconference), 440

Sleep

- deprivation, work and, 645
- disorders, 87
- mood, emotions and, 221

Small group networks, 429

Smiling, mood, emotions and, 212

Social activities, emotions, mood and, 219–220

Social-belongingness needs, 250

Social Cognitive Theory, 260–262

Social context, of negotiations, 689–690

Social Identity Theory, groups and, 321–322

Social identity threat, 323

Socialization

- entry, options, 555
- formal vs. informal, 555
- method of sustaining organizational culture, 553–555
- model, 554

Socialized charismatic leadership, 480

Social Learning Theory, 260–262, 263–264

Social loafing, 336–337, 370, 374

Social media

- for business purposes, 442
- communication and, 436–437, 438

- dependence, power and, 393–395
- employee use of, monitoring, 452
- management issues and, 54
- returns on using, 442
- wasting time with, 249

Social network analysis, assessing resources, power and, 393–395

Social physics, 46

Social pressures, 111

Social psychology, OB and, 48

Social responsibility, 65, 66

Social sharing, emotions and, 228

Social support, stress at work and, 643, 647

Social sustainability practices, 547

Social trends, change and, 621, 622

Sociogram, 394, 395

Sociology, OB and, 48

South Africa Equal Employment Act, 98

Span of control, organizational structure and, 509–510, 527

Spatial visualization, intellectual ability, 92

Speaking skills vs. writing skills, 437

Specialization, learning organization and, 636

Specific goals, 256–257, 371

Specificity of goals, 259

Spirituality, organizational culture and

- achieving, 563
- characteristics of, 562
- criticisms of, 564
- importance of, 562
- reasons for, 562

Spokesperson role, of managers, 39, 40

Stalling, defensive behavior, 407

Stand Out (Buckingham), 495

Stanford prison experiment, 326–328

Starburst form, of network organization, 517

Start-up firms, innovation, culture and, 548–549

Star Wars (film), 67

Statistics, data and, 43–46

Status, as group property, 333–335

Status Characteristics Theory, 333–334

Status inequity, 334–335

Status quo, 627

- unfreezing, 628

Stereotype, 79, 80–81, 178–179

- cultural, 564
- gender, 84–85, 687–689
- groups and social identity threat, 323
- negativity of, 180
- of older workers, 82
- sex, 90

Stigmatization, status and, 335

Stories, organizational culture and, 556

Storming stage, of group development, 323

Strategic competency model, 518

Strategy-Structure Relationship, 523

Strength factors, physical abilities, 94

Stress, 59

- additivity of stressors, 632, 642
- allostasis, 639
- behavioral symptoms of, 645–646
- consequences of, 642–646
- cultural differences and, 643–644
- defining, 637–639
- demands/resources, 639
- emotion, mood and, 219
- environmental factors of, 640
- flextime and, 294

- impacts of, 656
- individual differences in, 642–643
- job performance and, 646
- leadership and, 476
- model of, 640
- negotiations and, 686
- organizational change and, 636–637
- organizational factors of, 640–642
- personal factors of, 642
- physiological symptoms of, 644
- psychological symptoms of, 644–645
- sources of, 640
- stressors, 638–639
- in teams, 641
- and well-being, 619–620
- work as top source of, 638
- working when sick and, 652

Stress management

- individual approaches to, 647
- organizational approaches to, 647–650
- organizational change in, 648
- organizational encouragement of, 652

Stressors, additivity of, 632

Stress reduction programs, 652

Stretch goals, 259

Stretching, defensive behavior, 407

Strong culture, 544

Structural variables, innovation and, 634

Structured interviews, 586

Subcultures, 543

Subgroups, 339

Substance abuse, Counterproductive Work Behavior (CWB), 123

Substitutes, for leadership, 487–488

Success, probability of, 253

Successful managers, 40–42

Supervision, quality of, 252

Support and commitment, overcoming resistance to change, 625

Surface acting, 223, 228

Surface-level diversity, 78

 groups, 338

Surveillance, big data and, 46

Survey feedback, OD and, 630

Survival, 63–64

Sustainability, 249–250, 547–548

Symbols, of organizational culture, 557–558

Systematic study, intuition and, 43–46

System-imposed time constraints, 190

T

Talking, in the office, 112

Tardiness, Counterproductive Work Behavior (CWB), 123

Target, perception and, 174

Target point, 679

Task characteristics

- goal-setting theory and, 258

- and motivation, 286

- repetitive tasks and employee motivation, 289

Task conflicts, 373–374, 669

Task demands, stress and, 640

Task identity, job characteristics model and, 287

Task-oriented, LPC questionnaire result, 466

Task performance, 59, 592

Task significance, job characteristics model and, 287

Task structure, 467

Team building, OD and, 631

Team cohesion, 372, 552

Team composition, 363

- cultural differences and, 368–369

- diversity of, 95, 367–368, 369

- key roles, allocation of, 367, 368

- member abilities, 365

- member preferences, 370

- personality, of members, 365–367

- size of, 369–370

Team context, 363

- adequate resources, 364

- leadership structure, 364

- performance evaluation/reward system, 365

- trust and, 364–365

Team development behaviors, 375

Team efficacy, 371

Team identity, 372

Team orientation, characteristic of organization's culture, 541

Team players, 374–376

- hiring, 374

- training, 375

Team processes, 363, 370–374

- cohesion, 372

- common plan/purpose, 371

- conflict levels, 373–374

- effects of, model, 371

- efficacy, 371–372

- identity, 372

- mental models, 372–373

- social loafing, 374

- specific goals, 371

Teams

- action teams, 372–373

- conflict and, 373–374, 669

- and creativity, 197

- cross-functional, 359–361

- disadvantages of, 376

- diversity in, 95, 197, 367–368, 369

- empowering, 378

- ethical breaches of, 380–381

- four types of, model, 359

- groups vs., 357–358

- member preferences, 370

- model of, 363

- multiteam system, 361–363

- negotiations vs. individual, collectivist culture and, 681

- popularity of, 357

- problem solving, 359

- reflexivity, 371
- self-managed work, 359–360
- size of, 369–370
- smart vs. dumb, 381–382
- social loafing, 374
- stress level of, 641
- tests used to determine if teams are needed, 376
- virtual, 360–361

Team structure, organization, 517–519

Teamwork (OB Poll), 358

Technical skills, 38

- of managers, 40
- training, HR and, 588

Technology

- change and, 621, 624, 640
- ethics of employee tracking, 263
- organizational structure/strategy and, 524
- 24-hour workplace, 603
- virtual teams, 360–361

Telecommuting, 526

- benefits to society, 297
- drawbacks of, 297
- jobs suited for, 295–296
- working from home, OB poll, 297

Telephone, communication and, 433–434

Temporary assignments, 285

Temporary groups, 323

Tenure

- group diversity and, 338
- importance to employees, 286
- innovation and, 634
- workplace diversity and, 88

Terminal values, 153

Terminations, 61, 604–606

Tests, to determine if a team is necessary, 376

Text messaging, 435, 441

Theft, Counterproductive Work Behavior (CWB), 123

Thematic Apperception Test (TAT), 414

Theory of Mind, 381

Thinking (T) versus Feeling (F), MBTI personality type, 140

Think Like a Freak (Levitt & Dunbar), 67

Third-party negotiators, 690

301 Smart Answers to Tough Interview Questions (Oliver), 417

360-degree evaluations, 593, 594

Three-stage model of creativity, 194–195

Time, trust and, 485

Time allocation, work, managers/professionals, 435

Time-based strategies, work-life initiatives, 605

Time-management techniques, stress and, 647

Time of day, emotions, moods and, 217–219, 220

Tipping Point, The (Gladwell), 187

Tokenism, 100

TopCoder program, 506

Top management method, of sustaining organizational culture, 552–553

Traditional management, 41

Trafficking Victims Protection Act, 612

Training and development programs, HR and, 587–591

- basic skills training, 587–588
- civility, 588–589
- computer-based, 590–591
- ethics, 589
- interpersonal skills, 588
- on-the-job training, 590
- for performance evaluators, 597
- problem-solving skills, 588
- program effectiveness, evaluate, 591

- technical skills, 588
- Trait Activation Theory (TAT), 151–152
- Trait Emotional Intelligence Questionnaire (TEIQue), 226
- Traits, performance evaluations and, 593
- Trait theories of leadership, 463–464, 466
- Transactional leadership, 474–478
 - characteristics of leaders, model, 474
 - transformational vs., 478
- Transformational leadership
 - charismatic vs., 478
 - evaluation of, 476–478
 - how it works, 475–476
 - transactional vs., 478
- Trust, leadership and
 - culture and, 484–485
 - development/nature of, 484
 - outcomes of trust, 483–484
 - propensity, 484
 - regaining lost, 485
 - time and, 485
- Trust, teams and, 364–365
 - virtual teams, 380–381
- Trust propensity, 484
- Turnover rates, 60–62, 296
 - age and, 83
 - job dissatisfaction and, 124–125
- Two-factor theory, of motivation, 251–252

U

- Uncertainty avoidance, 157
- Underwater meeting, 456
- Uniform cultures, 543
- Unity of command, 508

University of Oxford Style Guide, 424

Unretirement (Farrell), 101

Unstructured interview, 585

Upward communication, 427–428

U.S. Bill of Rights, 190

U.S. Equal Employment Opportunity Commission (EEOC), 86, 90

U.S. Human Rights Campaign, 90

U.S. Small Business Administration, 365

Utilitarianism, as ethical yard stick, 190

V

Vacation deficit disorder, 57

Values, 152–159

- cultural, 157–159

- dominant in workforce, 154

- generational, 153–154

- importance/organization of, 153

- as reason for pursuing goals, self-concordance, 255–256

- reflected in attitude, 111

- terminal vs. instrumental, 153

- workplace, link to personality, 155–157

Value system, 152

Variable-pay program, 301–306

- bonus, 304

- employee-stock ownership, 306

- evaluation of, 306

- merit-based, 303

- piece-rate pay plan, 302–303

- profit-sharing plan, 305

Verbal comprehension, intellectual ability, 92

Verbal persuasion, 260, 261

Veterans, unemployed, 79

Vicarious modeling, 260, 261

Videoconferencing, communication and, 432–433

Video résumés, 581

Virtual management, 516–517

Virtual résumés, 436

Virtual structure, organizational, 516–517

Virtual teams, 359, 360–361

- importance of team identity, 372

- to reduce carbon footprint, 362

- trust and, 380–381

- vs. face-to-face teams, 361

Vision, 472

Vision statement, 472

Vocational Preference Inventory questionnaire, 155

Voice, in communication, 431–432

Voice response, 123

Volatility, environment and, 524

Volunteering, employee, 292

W

Weak culture, 544

Weather, emotions, moods and, 219

Well-being, stress and, 619–620

Wellness programs, stress management and, 649–650

Wheel, small-group network, 428, 429

Whisper (app), 129

Whistle-blowers, 190, 400, 401

Wonderlic Cognitive Ability Test, 93

Work, stress and, 637–639

Workaholism, 603, 643

Work arrangements, alternative, 292–297

- flextime, 293–295, 296

- job sharing, 295

- telecommuting, 295–297

Workers' cooperatives, 305

Work-family conflict

- caused by telecommuting, 297

- decreased with flextime arrangements, 293–294

- family issues and stress, 642

Workforce, changing nature of, 621, 622

Workforce demographics, 52

- percentage of men and women working (OB Poll), 52

- values dominate in, 154

Workforce diversity, 53

Work group, 357–358

Working from home, OB poll, 297

Work-life conflicts, managing, 603–604

- family issues and stress, 642

Work-life initiatives, 605

Work-life satisfaction, 232–233

Workplace diversity, 82, 338–339, 345. *See also* Biographical characteristics of employees

- differentiating characteristics, 88–91

Workplace environment

- discrimination, 79–82

- positive, 55–56

Workplace incivility, 332

Workplace spirituality, 561–564

Work sample tests, 584

Works councils, type of representative participation, 299

Work specialization, 505–507, 526–527

Work team, 357–358

World politics, change, 622

Writing skills vs. speaking skills, 437

Written communication, 434–439

- apps and, 437

- blogs, 437, 442

- choosing, 440–441

e-mail, 434–435

instant messaging, 435, 441

letters, 434, 440–441

PowerPoint, 434

social media, 436–437, 442, 443, 452

text messaging, 435, 441

Written essays, performance evaluations and, 594

Written tests, employment, HR and, 583–584

integrity, 584

intelligence or cognitive ability tests, 583

personality tests, 583–584

Y

Yik Yak (app), 129

Z

Zero-sum approach, 404